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Russian & Ukrainian officials meet in Abu Dhabi for their first peace talks since Feb as Trump's envoys launch a new push to end war, **P 20**

IT IS 11.11

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US defence secretary Pete Hegseth blasts efforts to impeach him as a farce that would embolden US adversaries, as he lashes out at his political opponents in Congress and media in an unapologetic defence of his record, P 20

India's star-keeper batter Rishabh Pant is likely to leave for New Zealand on Thursday after getting fitness clearance from BCCI Centre of Excellence, P 23

British writer M John Harrison wins Booker Prize for fiction for 'The End of Everything', a satirical dystopian novel whose themes of 'catastrophe and apocalypse' chime with our uneasy times, P 20

Anthropic PBC is seeking a fully-diluted valuation of about $1.4 trillion in its initial public offering, in a bid to make history as the first frontier artificial intelligence lab to go public, P 20

For 2nd yr in row, China's trade surplus tops $1tn

China's trade surplus exceeded $1 trillion for a second straight year, according to official data released Tuesday, as pressure mounts for greater balance in trade with Beijing. Between Jan and Oct, China logged a $1.04tn trade surplus, putting it on track for surpassing last year's record $1.2tn trade surplus, as exports surged, driven by hi-tech goods. P 21

Renowned activist Bunker Roy dead

Sanjit 'Bunker' Roy, the Barefoot College founder who spent over five decades proving that India's rural communities could be sustainably self-sufficient without requiring "rescuing", died in Rajasthan's Tilonia Tuesday. He was 81. P 16

Body cams must for issuing Ggn challans

A day after a home guard was arrested for allegedly extorting money in the name of a Diwali gift, Gurgaon police commissioner Shibash Kabiraj made body-worn camera surveillance mandatory during challan proceedings. P 6

80% of Delhi's pollution Monday due to crackers

AQI Improves To 'Poor' For 2 Hrs Before Slipping Back

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New Delhi: Firecracker emissions accounted for more than 80% of Delhi's pollution load on Monday, a day after Diwali, according to the Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology's models, highlighting the sharp impact of fireworks on the capital's air quality. The contribution came even as the city was already battling high pollution levels from multiple sources.

The situation, however, showed some improvement on Tuesday, with the AQI at 299 at 4pm, bringing it into the 'poor' category from 'very poor' a day earlier. However, it deteriorated to very poor by 6pm with an AQI of 302.

▶PJB FARM FIRES SHOW RISING TREND, P 2

Toxins from Diwali firecrackers lingered on Tuesday as well, with IITM showing 29.9% of pollution contribution due to firecrackers between 1am and 9am, while secondary organic compounds — formed due to chemical reactions of emitted particles in air — were the secondary source at 17.5% of net pollution on Tuesday. IMD attributed the improvement in air quality largely to more favourable wind conditions, which helped disperse pollutants that had accumulated over the city and barred intrusion of stubble smoke from neighbouring states.

▶Vehicular emissions, P 2

Piyal Bhattacharjee

Union minister Sarbananda Sonowal (3rd from left) and Delhi CM Rekha Gupta with others during the inauguration of Namo Yamuna cruise service at Sonia Vihar. The cruise ride lasts about 40 minutes and costs ₹500. About 60 people took a ride Tuesday | P 5

Man freed in '07 UP CRPF camp strike shot dead

Krishna Chaudhary & Rajshekhar Jha | TNN

Meerut/New Delhi: Unidentified assailants fatally shot Sharif Khan, one of four death-row convicts acquitted last year in the 2007 Rampur CRPF camp attack case, minutes after he emerged Tuesday from a UP police station where he had reported for a routine verification. Sharif (65) had walked barely 300 metres from Khajuria police station in Rampur district when the gunmen fired 16 rounds at him and fled, investigators quoted witnesses as saying.

The deceased had spent 17 years in jail before Allahabad high court acquitted him and three others in Oct 2025, citing procedural and other lapses in investigating the terrorist attack in which seven CRPF troopers and a rickshaw-puller died.

▶ 'No clue of threats,' P 24

MEA slams US court summons to Doval, RAW ex-chief Goel

'Pannun's Lawsuit Frivolous, His Claims Fabricated'

New Delhi: Govt Tuesday dismissed a US court civil summons naming National Security Adviser Ajit Doval and former R&AW chief Samant Goel as a "frivolous lawsuit" driven by "fabricated and malicious" claims, asserting that designated Khalistani terrorist Gurpatwant Singh Pannun's legal maneuvering did not hold any merit, **reports Rajshekhar Jha.**

"...Requests for the service of judicial documents in India can only be routed through India's designated central authority, that is, the ministry of law and justice," MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said.

MEA's reaction came on reports of the US state department notifying India via a diplomatic note about a civil suit filed by SFJ member Pannun regarding an alleged plot to assassinate him.

▶'Routine step', P 24

India calls USCIRF a 'biased entity'

The US Commission on International Religious Freedom is a "biased" entity with a "blatantly" political agenda, MEA said, trashing remarks by two USCIRF officials on gurdwaras being targeted in India. MEA wondered why was USCIRF mum on attacks on religious places in US. P 24

Ladakh council polls on Dec 4, protests erupt

Srinagar: Kargil shut down Tuesday and political groups in Leh threatened an agitation after Ladakh announced Dec 4 elections to its eight autonomous hill development councils, rejecting demands to avoid holding the polls during the harsh winter months, **reports Naseer Ganai.**

Chief secretary Ashish Kundra described the elections as a "watershed moment" and a turning point for democracy in the UT. Defending the decision, Kundra said schools would remain open until Dec 15 and there was no reason adults could not turn out to vote. He said deputy commissioners had been directed to provide heaters and other facilities at polling stations, besides separate queues for elderly.

▶'25% will be away', P 24

No takers for 409 MBBS seats even after spl round

As many as 409 MBBS seats remained unallotted even after the Medical Counselling Committee (MCC) conducted a special stray vacancy round, with the high fee structure in private medical colleges potentially being one of the factors behind the seats remaining unfilled, **reports Anuja Jaiswal.** Of the 946 vacant MBBS seats included in the special round's seat matrix, only 537 were allotted, leaving 409 unfilled. 14

▶4 out of 5 fgn medicine grads fail qualifier, P 14

For retd hires in PSCs, SC upholds pay minus pension

New Delhi: SC has upheld the "pay minus pension" principle applicable to retired govt officials appointed to constitutional posts, such as chairpersons or members of PSCs, **reports Dhananjay Mahapatra.**

A bench of Justices SVN Bhatti and N V Anjaria set aside a 2010 Uttarakhand HC judgment, which had declared Regulation 7(2) of the Uttarakhand PSC Regulations unconstitutional. The HC had ordered the payment of arrears of deducted salary to Lt Gen M C Bhandari, who was appointed chairman of PSC in Nov 2006 after retiring from the Army.

The PSC had fixed Lt Gen Bhandari's salary as the commission's chairman after deducting Rs 17,627, the pension drawn by him.

▶'Only for tenure', P 24

IN THE COURTS

- Calcutta HC halts man's **deportation to Bangladesh,** directs officials to submit detailed report | P 24
- **Grandson can't claim** share in **grandfather's property** held by his father: SC | P 16
- Madras HC orders FIR, account freeze in **TN library books scam** | P 16

Was repeatedly assaulted in Tihar: VanDyke

US national Matthew VanDyke, accused in a Myanmar terror module case, alleged in a handwritten affidavit submitted in Aug that he was repeatedly assaulted during his nearly six-month stay in Tihar jail.

VanDyke reportedly sent the affidavit to the American embassy, which has now surfaced as VanDyke's post.

"India threw me and several Ukrainians into prison for over six months. This was part of Russia's war against Ukraine," he wrote in the post. P 6

For the first time, Sonia confirms battle with cancer in memoirs

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: Sonia Gandhi's memoirs, released Tuesday, officially acknowledge what was long whispered within political circles but never publicly confirmed — her battle with cancer, which occurred during the second term of the UPA govt.

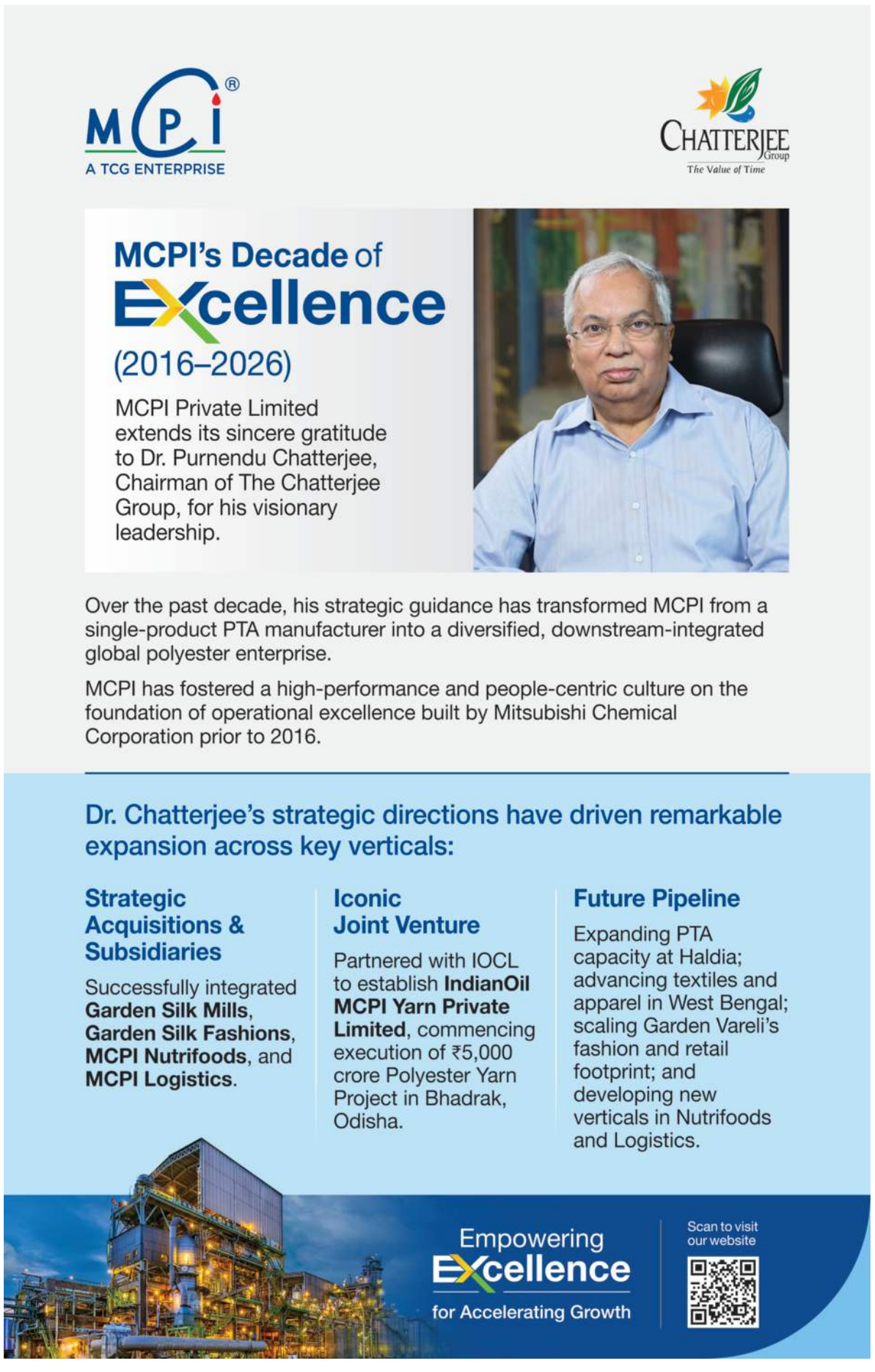
▶BJP calls memoirs bid to whitewash history, P 17

They also set the record straight on where her two surgeries took place — first at European Institute of Oncology, near Milan in Italy, and later at Erasmus University Medical Centre in Rotterdam — and not at Memorial Sloan Kettering Cancer Center in New York, as was widely speculated.

According to Sonia, while she had suffered from occasional bouts of asthma and allergies, she had no serious health troubles until 2010, when she was advised to undergo surgery for suspected breast cancer. She chose not to get operated on in India as she wanted to avoid a media frenzy.

▶'Saw Rajiv smiling', P 17

For TOI's coverage of Sonia Gandhi's 'Belonging', see P 12



One year on, Red Fort bears scars of blast horror | 5

TIMES CITY

THE TIMES OF INDIA, NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 11, 2026

TEMP ON TUESDAY
29.6° MAXIMUM | 15.7° MINIMUM

FORECAST Clear sky. Max & min temperatures on Wednesday would be around 29°C and 16°C

MOONSET 6.42PM (WED) MOONRISE 9.26PM (THU)
SUNSET 5.30PM (WED) SUNRISE 6.41AM (THU)

*AQI at 8pm
304
AQI IN DELHI ON TUESDAY (VERY POOR)

Liquor sales jumped 25% on Diwali eve | 5

Amid supply delays, govt schools told to buy books on their own | 8

Punjab Bucks Trend Of Decline In Farm Fires, But Delhi Avoids Big Hit

With Met Factors At Play, Their Share In Capital's PM2.5 Is Far Lower Than Last Few Years

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New Delhi: The declining trend in stubble burning incidents has been interrupted this season, with Punjab recording 5,002 farm fires from Sept 15 to Nov 10, compared with 4,195 during the corresponding period last year. Official data shows more than 91% of the crop has been harvested in Punjab. While Haryana, where 77% of the crop has been harvested, has witnessed 206 paddy residue burning events this time compared to 363 last year, UP's count this season is 689 compared to 1,902 last time, as per satellite data compiled by Indian Agricultural Research Institute.

However, the contribution of farm fires to Delhi's air pollution has remained low this season. Between Sept 15 and Nov 9, stubble burning accounted for 5% or more of Delhi's PM2.5 levels on only 13 days. Of these, the contribution crossed 10% on just three days.

In previous years, stubble burning's share in Delhi's PM2.5 levels had touched 30% on certain days. This season, however, the peak contribution was 16.3%, recorded on Nov 4, according to the data of Decision Support System, which estimates the contribution of stubble burning to Delhi's PM2.5.

However, according to experts, the daily contribution may be higher. Gufran Beig, founder of System of Air Quality and Weather Forecasting and Research (SAFAR) and chair professor at National Institute of Advanced Studies (NIAS), said, "It is known that satellites do not capture the stubble burning counts which happen after 4pm. To estimate the share of stubble burning to Delhi's PM2.5, DSS relies on the official stubble burning incidents, which is not accurate. Hence, the contribution has been low this season."

TOI in 2024 reported that farmers had shifted the timing of stubble burning to avoid satellite overpass times and escape detection of farm fires.

In 2025, the share of farm fires in Delhi's air quality surpassed 10% on eight days, including over 20% on only one day. In 2024, the contribution of stubble burning was above 20% on 14 days, according to DSS data. However, the peak single-day source of stubble burning in Delhi's PM2.5 was 35.2% in 2024, 35.4% in 2023, 34% in 2022, 48% in 2021, 42% in 2020, 44% in 2019 and 58% in 2018.

Beig said the share of paddy residue burning events has been low from Sunday to Tuesday due to a change in wind direction to easterly.

"Due to an approaching feeble western disturbance, the wind direction was changed. However, as western disturbance is weak, rain, which could have provided temporary respite, is unlikely. As wind direction is again expected to change to north-westerly which aids in transfer of smoke from burning sites to Delhi, the intrusion of stubble is expected to be more from Wednesday evening," said Beig.

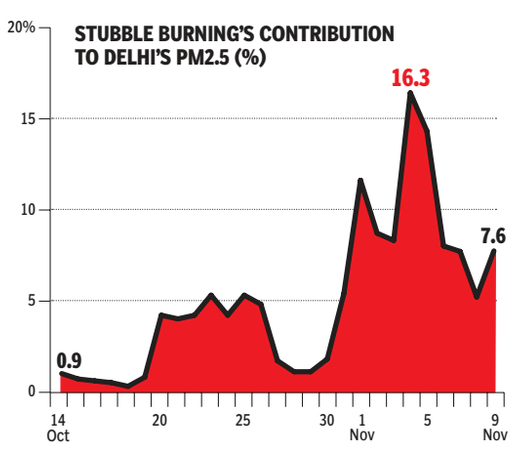
Sunil Dahiya, founder of think tank Envirocatalyst, said, "The modelling to calculate the contribution of farm fires to PM2.5 is done using the official stubble burning counts and does not consider the burnt area. However, multiple sources have confirmed the actual incidents are higher than the reported."

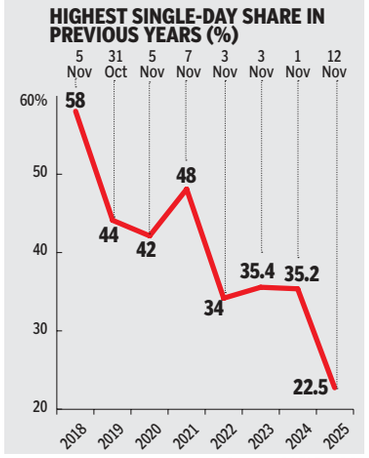
FARM FIRE SHARE OVER 10% ON JUST THREE DAYS

Contribution of stubble burning accounted for 5% or more of Delhi's PM2.5 levels on only 13 days this season

Of these, it exceeded 10% on three days

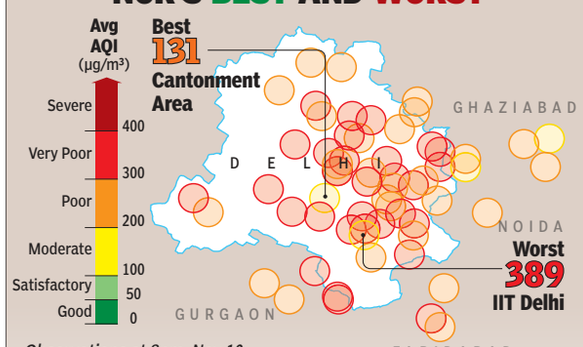
Experts say as many farmers burn stubble after satellite overpass time, the share of paddy residue burning events on Delhi's PM2.5 may be higher





Source- SAFAR & DSS

NCR'S BEST AND WORST

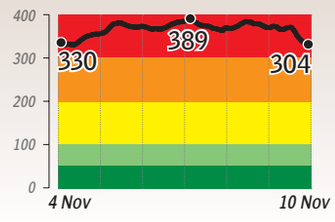


Observations at 8pm, Nov 10

Avg AQI of metro cities

Delhi	304
Mumbai	149
Chennai	148
Bengaluru	140
Kolkata	127

Delhi's 24-hour trend (last 7 days)



Source: CPCB

PM readings above 1,000 ug/m³ appear as data gaps: CPCB

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New Delhi: Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB) Tuesday said that its analysers were calibrated to measure particulate matter concentrations only up to 1,000 micrograms per cubic metre and could not display readings beyond it on Diwali night for several hours. Nor were these readings considered for calculating the average AQI, it said.

The anti-pollution watchdog, which operates several of the 60 stations measuring pollution in ambient air, said this a day after **TOI** reported its stations had stopped giving data on particulate matter at the peak of the Diwali pollution.

Delhi has 60 stations that continuously measure ambient air quality. Of them, 43 are operated by Delhi Pollution Control Committee (DPCC). The remaining are operated by CPCB, IMD and IITM. CPCB compiles the data from the 60 stations and calculates the 24-hour average AQI.

On Diwali night, DPCC gave readings that surpassed 1,000 micrograms per cubic metre. At least at 11 locations, the hourly PM2.5 concentration was above 2,000 micrograms per cubic metre and in four, it was more than 3,000.

CPCB explained that "the particulate matter analysers deployed at the time of introduction in 2015... were calibrated for a measurement range of 0-1,000 micrograms per cubic metre. Accordingly consistent with this, the system of automated data validation treats hourly readings beyond the calibrated range as outside the range, and such readings are not used in the computation."

It said that "during extreme episodes... like Diwali firecracker bursting, this may appear as a data gap at the particular station, and those hours do not contribute to the 24-hour average of relevant pollutant for concerned station."

It said that its methodology was under review. "Internal deliberations with respect to the processing of data are underway," CPCB said.

It added that the AQI's upper limit of 500 represents the highest level of health concern. "An AQI of 500 or above indicates almost the same health risk, that is the severe category," it said. It may "cause respiratory effects on healthy people and serious health impacts on people with lung diseases. Beyond this level, the AQI remains in the 'severe' category and extrapolation of the index would not alter the assigned health impact category."

The capping at 500 is a design feature of the index, CPCB explained.

The anti-pollution watchdog added that short-lived spikes of pollutant concentrations in ambient air, such as during the bursting of firecrackers, are episodic and short-lived.

Sunil Dahiya, founder of think tank Envirocatalyst, said CPCB is meant to collect and analyse data that tracks whether the steps, policies and actions taken to cut air pollution are actually working.

"Withholding the exact numbers cripples the analysis needed to judge measures taken on the ground, such as restrictions on firecrackers or an outright ban," he said.

Delhi to take another shot at cloud seeding?

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New Delhi: India's choked capital could this week witness yet another attempt at cloud seeding, with the hope that rain provides some relief to its residents.

In a joint attempt by Delhi International Airport Ltd, Delhi govt and IIT Kanpur, a specialised Beechcraft 200 of a Bengaluru-based company landed at IGI Airport Tuesday morning, said sources. The Beechcraft, parked at an IGIA hangar, could not do sorties Tuesday due to absence of clouds and will try to enhance precipitation over the next two-three days as and when cloud formation happens depending on the situation, they added.

Delhi govt, however, denied any such plan. In Oct 2025, Delhi executed three cloud-seeding trials in partnership with IIT Kanpur to mitigate its heavy air pollution. The trials had failed to trigger actual rainfall due to insufficient atmospheric moisture levels.

"The aircraft used that time was one that could fly only to an altitude of 10,000 feet and do cloud seeding. The Beechcraft 200 being used now can go up to an altitude of 25,000 feet and the company is a specialised one for this task," said people in the know.

The company, according to its website, "is primarily committed to continue advances in the field of weather modification, either it is identifying the potential benefits of cloud seeding or monitoring air quality". About cloud seeding, it states, "We intend to develop new techniques... to produce artificial rain, which will guarantee monsoon clouds break into torrential rains."

Incidentally, a fresh western disturbance is approaching north India that is likely to bring rains to the plains of northwestern India later this week.

Vehicular emissions third biggest source of pollution day after Diwali

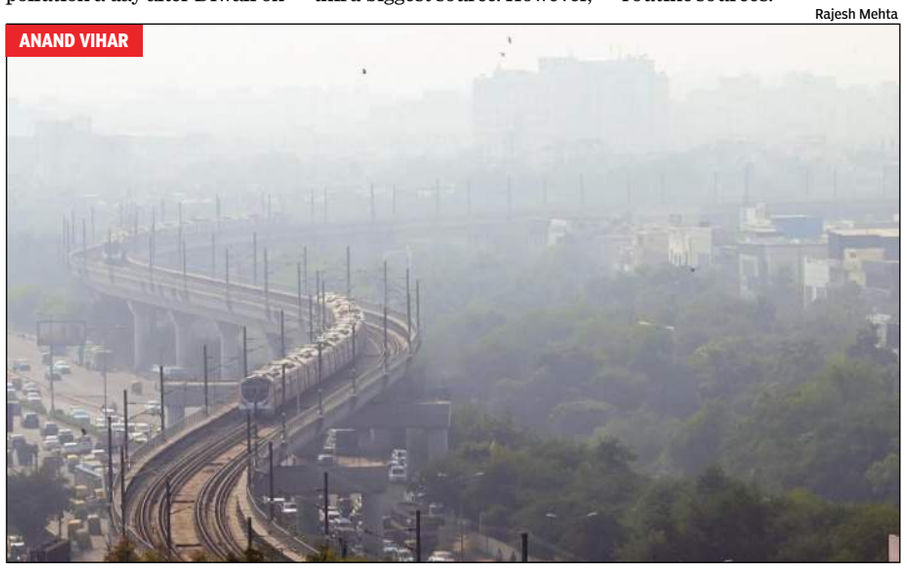
▶Continued from P1

The easing came despite a significant number of farm fires being reported in neighbouring Punjab. An assessment of the decision support system for air quality management indicated that stubble burning was not a major contributor to Delhi's pollution load on Monday. This suggests that the immediate post-Diwali pollution spike was driven primarily by local fireworks rather than a major influx of crop-residue smoke.

The high contribution from firecrackers followed a sharp deterioration in air quality during the festival. Delhi's average AQI was 376 on Diwali, Nov 8, the highest recorded for the festival in five years. It remained in the 'very poor' category on Monday, with the city waking up to a thick layer of smog and several monitoring stations reporting severe air quality.

IITM's model estimates the contribution of different sources to the city's particulate pollution a day after Diwali on Nov 9, including secondary organic compounds, at 5.8%, the second dominant source, and vehicular pollution at 4.4%, the third biggest source. However, the city's air quality will depend on how effectively winds disperse the remaining pollutants and on emissions from routine sources.

Rajesh Mehta



EVEN AS DELHI CHOKED ON BAD AIR — MADE WORSE BY BURSTING OF FIRECRACKERS ON DIWALI — DECIBEL LEVELS HIT THE ROOF

How sound of celebration may lead to silent, but long-term health hazard

Kushagra.Dixit@timesofindia.com

New Delhi: The noise of Diwali may fade after the celebrations, but its effects on health can last much longer. From ringing in the ears and temporary hearing loss to disturbed sleep, anxiety and increased blood pressure, doctors warn that exposure to loud firecrackers can take a toll on both physical and mental well-being, with children particularly vulnerable.

Delhi Pollution Control Committee's latest assessment has found that 19 of the 26 monitored locations recorded higher noise levels this Diwali than last year. None of the 26 areas assessed this year met the standards and all were noisy.

Readings ranged from 57.5 to 89.1 dB (A), with Karol Bagh recording the highest level. Sonia Vihar saw the sharpest year-on-year increase of 16.6%.

Dr Atul Kumar Mittal, chairman of ENT department at FMRI Gurgaon, said sudden exposure to loud sounds could damage the delicate structures of the inner ear, resulting in temporary or, in severe cases, permanent hearing loss and tinnitus, or ringing in the ears.

"Children are particularly vulnerable as their auditory systems are still developing," he said. Prolonged exposure can also cause sleep disturbances, irritability, difficulty concentrating and increased stress. In children, it may affect learning and academic performance.

He advised people to maintain a safe distance from loud firecrackers, avoid bursting them near residential areas and use appropriate ear protection where necessary.

The impact of noise goes beyond the ears. Dr Gita Prakash, consultant of internal medicine at Max Hospital, said prolonged exposure to traffic, construction, loudspeakers and firecrackers could increase stress hormones and blood pressure, disturb sleep and cause irreversible hearing loss.

"Noise is not just an annoyance, it is also a silent health hazard," she said, adding that children are especially vulnerable. "Chronic exposure can lead to poor concentration, delayed learning, irritability and disturbed sleep. Even loud toys, television and firecrackers can cause harm," she said, advising parents to keep volumes low, use hearing protection for children at loud events and ensure quiet time for sleep and study.

Dr Neeta Kejriwal, HOD and director of paediatrics department at Pacific One-Health, New Delhi, said sudden, high-intensity sounds could trigger fear, anxiety, irritability and sleep disturbances in children, while loud bursts might cause acoustic trauma, tinnitus and, in severe cases, permanent hearing damage.

Children with autism spectrum disorder and sensory sensitivities may experience heightened distress and sensory overload, she said.

Doctors advised that parents should keep children away from firecracker bursts, use hearing protection where necessary and create quiet spaces at home during peak celebrations.

The issue is not limited to Diwali as city suffers multiple episodes of noise outbursts year round. **TOI** reported in Aug how DJs and loudspeakers during religious processions expose Delhiites to prolonged high-volume noise. ENT specialists then warned of similar risks. The latest Diwali readings again underline how noise pollution remains a recurring public-health concern in the city.

Tarun Rawat

Delhi Pollution Control Committee's latest assessment has found that 19 of the 26 monitored locations in the capital recorded higher noise levels this Diwali than last year

'Our windows shook': Karol Bagh at top of Delhi's Diwali noise readings

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New Delhi: The bursts came in waves on Diwali night in Karol Bagh. A firecracker would go quiet and another would go off and the sound carried from the street into bedrooms. In some parts of the neighbourhood, residents said, the gaps between explosions were the only respite until the early hours.

Once again, Karol Bagh registered the highest Diwali noise reading among the 26 locations monitored by Delhi Pollution Control Committee (DPCC). At 89.1 dB(A), it was barely below last year's 89.2.

The prescribed limits for commercial areas are 65 dB (A) by day and 55 at night. This year, noise levels rose at 19 city stations compared with 2025.

On Pusa Road, what stood out was how long the bursts kept coming. Ravindra Lal Dhawan, who has lived in the area for more than 70 years, said he usually spends most of Diwali at home and could hear the crackers clearly indoors.

"It was especially loud at night, and the crackers went on till morning. It was very difficult to sleep," he said. "The noise gets louder during the festive season. Even when you're sitting at home, you feel it. It causes a lot of trouble for older people, and it's especially hard on those who are unwell."

Anushka Kogta

According to residents, the chaos in Karol Bagh is part of an ordinary day

A RESIDENT SAYS

It is particularly disturbing for animals. I kept my cat inside one room with all the windows closed, but still cracker sounds shook our windows. They feel very scared by the noise

ANOTHER SAYS

There is massive bursting of crackers even when govt says only green crackers are allowed. Who will come and check whether they are green or not? It went on non-stop till the wee hours

The late-night bursts also raised questions about enforcement. Taran Deep, a Karol Bagh resident who has a shop in Gaffar Market, wondered who was checking which firecrackers people were setting off.

"There is massive bursting of crackers even when govt says only green crackers are allowed. Who will come and check whether they are green or not? It went on non-stop throughout the area till the wee hours," he said.

While Taran Deep wondered what could be done on the street, Amrit Kumar was trying to see what could be done inside his room. The UPSC aspirant, who lives in rented accommodation in Karol Bagh, shut the windows to shield his cat, Shiro, from the blasts.

"It is particularly disturbing for animals. I kept Shiro inside one room with all the windows closed, but still cracker sounds shook our windows. They feel very scared by the noise," he said.

According to some residents, the chaos in Karol Bagh is part of an ordinary day. As the shops open and the lanes fill, shoppers weave between vehicles and delivery vans inch through traffic. At busy crossings, where people on foot look for a gap and vehicles queue, the honking cuts through the market chatter. How much of the din reaches indoors depends on the stretch, residents said, but the congestion that feeds it returns every market day.

For Murli Mani, aged around 70, the crossings on major roads are chokepoints. A footbridge, he said, would give pedestrians another way across and reduce congestion, which eventually contributes to noise. On his stretch, however, he said traffic generally moves so slowly that drivers have little reason to honk. "The noise I find hardest to ignore is during Kanwar Yatra processions when they carry huge loudspeakers," he said.

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Man's attempt to murder wife foiled in central Delhi, two held

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: Delhi Police foiled an alleged attempt to kill a woman in west Delhi after discovering that her husband, who had earlier murdered her lover, was planning to target her next. Police said they mounted surveillance around her residence in Tilak Vihar and intervened before he could carry out the alleged attack.

The accused, Kunal (28), and his associate, Piyush (22), were arrested in connection with the murder of the 19-year-old youth in central Delhi's Prasad Nagar. According to police, the victim had allegedly been living with Kunal's wife for the past three months, fuelling hostility between the two.

Following the murder, Prasad Nagar police launched an investigation and used CCTV footage, technical surveillance and local intelligence to trace the alleged involvement of Kunal and Piyush. The weapon allegedly used in the crime and the scooter suspected to have been used by the accused were also recovered.

During Kunal's interrogation, investigators learnt that he was allegedly planning to kill his wife as well. DCP (Central) Rohit Rajbir Singh said personnel in plain clothes were discreetly deployed around her residence in Tilak Vihar to ensure her safety and monitor the suspects' movements.

In a separate murder case, an 18-year-old youth, Brijesh, was stabbed to death in JJ Colony, Bawana, on Nov 9. Police received a PCR call about an injured youth lying unconscious with stab wounds and shifted him to a hospital in Narela, where doctors declared him dead. Probe revealed that Brijesh was allegedly attacked near E-Block following an earlier quarrel with Fardeen (18). A murder case was registered, and police used CCTV footage to trace and arrest the accused.

₹6.5cr transactions using stolen PAN; man faces ₹9.2cr tax liability

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New Delhi: A telecom company employee earning around Rs 12.6 lakh annually was allegedly shown to have carried out business transactions worth Rs 6.5 crore in just two months, leading to an income tax department inquiry over the alleged undisclosed income of Rs 9.2 crore.

The transactions were allegedly carried out by fraudsters who used his PAN and KYC documents to obtain two GST registrations, float fictitious firms and open bank accounts in his name. The economic offences wing (EOW) of Delhi Police has registered an FIR on Nov 3 after the man approached police, claiming identity theft.

The complainant learnt about the alleged identity theft on Sept 9 this year, when he received an income tax department notice under section 133(6) of the Income-tax Act. The notice, dated Aug 20, was sent to an address in Ghaziabad that he had vacated in 2013.

According to his complaint, unknown persons used his PAN to obtain two GST registrations in Delhi and operate fictitious business entities. They allegedly opened bank accounts in his name and filed GST returns reflecting a turnover of Rs 6.5 crore in just two months, April and May 2019.

The complainant told investigators that he had never applied for GST registration, opened any business bank account, appointed a chartered accountant or tax practitioner, or issued or received any tax invoice. He also denied receiving any money, commission or financial benefit from the alleged transactions.

The scale of the alleged fraud became apparent when the department attributed transactions worth Rs 9.2 crore to his PAN and raised questions about undisclosed income. The complainant said his actual income for 2019-20 was Rs 12.6 lakh, on which TDS of Rs 1.4 lakh had been deposited.

In his complaint to EOW, he expressed fear that his identity might have been misused for other transactions as well, potentially exposing him to tax demands, penalties and prosecution for activities he claimed had nothing to do with him.

Police will also examine whether any bank officials or persons involved in processing GST registrations facilitated the fraud. Further investigation is under way.

Student suspended for 'luring' DU girls with concert trip

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New Delhi: Delhi University's Ramanujan College has suspended a third-year student following allegations that he attempted to "induce female students, including freshers, to travel to Ahmedabad for a Diljit Dosanjh concert by offering monetary benefits, gifts and other incentives."

Anas Khan, a BA (Hons) Hindi student in Semester V, has been suspended from the college till Feb 1, 2027, according to a suspension letter dated Nov 6, issued by the college. The letter states that the matter was examined by the college's proctorial committee after considering the complaint, Khan's explanation and findings of the preliminary inquiry.

The suspension notice states: "This letter serves as formal notice of your suspension from Ramanujan College in connection with the complaint received against you regarding allegations of inducing female students of the college to travel to Ahmedabad for attending the Diljit Dosanjh show by offering monetary benefits, gifts and other incentives."

Ramanujan College directed the student to submit a written undertaking acknowledging the seriousness of the incident and assuring that such misconduct will not be repeated. The letter warns that any recurrence could invite stricter action

During the suspension period, Khan has been barred from participating in regular academic and extracurricular activities of the college. However, considering that he is a third-year student, he has been permitted to appear in scheduled university examinations. He can also visit the college for pending internal assessments or assignments, but only after obtaining prior permission from the proctor.

The college has also directed him to submit a written undertaking acknowledging the seriousness of the incident and assuring that such misconduct or indiscipline will not be repeated. The letter warns that any recurrence of a similar incident or involvement in another serious act of indiscipline could invite stricter disciplinary action, including termination from the college, following due process.

Khan was associated with NSUI and had also contested the Delhi University Students' Union (DUSU) elections as a candidate of the organisation. NSUI has distanced itself from him, saying it had suspended him on Sept 12, during the DUSU election period itself, over alleged anti-organisational activities and indiscipline.

In a statement, NSUI Tuesday condemned the alleged misconduct. The letter stated: "Due to your involvement in anti-party activities during the Students' Union Election, you are hereby suspended from the NSUI, with immediate effect. Henceforth, you shall no longer be associated with or participate in any activities of the organisation."

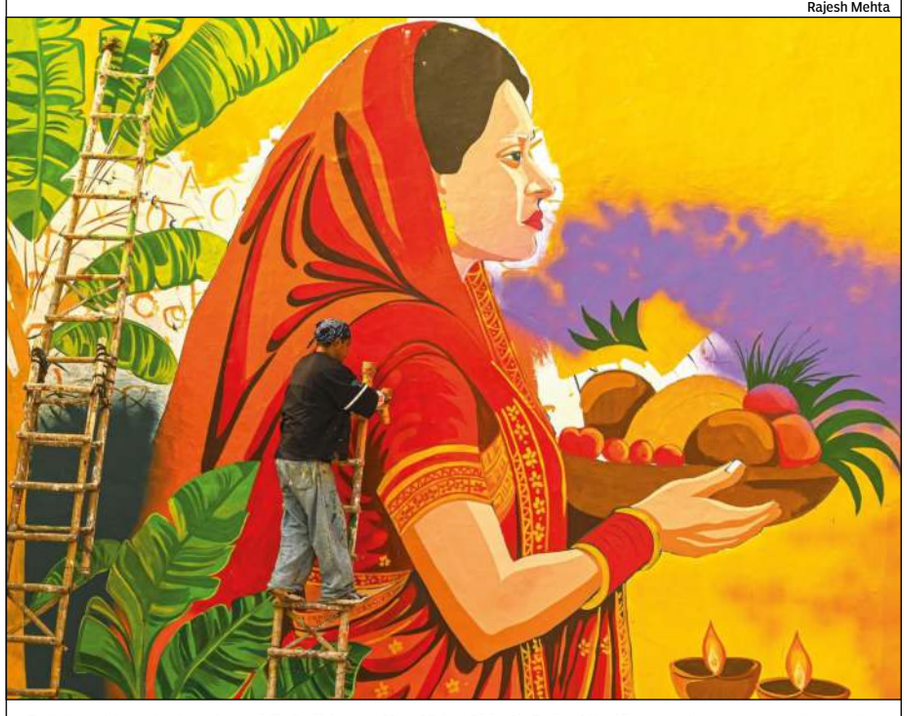
Meanwhile, the ABVP demanded a fair, transparent and time-bound investigation into the allegations, followed by strict legal action if they are established.

In its statement, ABVP referred to alleged WhatsApp messages circulating on social media, claiming that "Khan had offered to take female fresher students, reportedly including those aged 17-18, to concerts and provide travel and other facilities in exchange for spending time with certain men and facilitating financial benefits." It said the authenticity of the messages and allegations needed to be established through an investigation.

The allegations against Anas Khan are yet to be established. Khan could not be contacted immediately.

DELHI DECKS UP FOR CHHATH

Rajesh Mehta



Delhi govt has declared a **public holiday on Nov 16 for Chhath Puja.** All offices, autonomous bodies and PSUs under the state govt will remain closed for the festival, on the directions of LG TS Sandhu. CM Rekha Gupta, meanwhile, has rolled out a citywide preparation plan for the festival, roping in multiple departments and district administrations to ensure devotees have access to safe, well-prepared ghats

Delhi Gets Its First Electric Cruise On Yamuna: ₹500 For 45-Min Ride

30 Passengers Per Trip; Pilot To Cover 4km Sonia Vihar-Jagatpur Stretch

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New Delhi: About 60 people took a ride as Delhi Tuesday launched the 'Namo Yamuna River Cruise Service' in Sonia Vihar, marking the beginning of a new recreational tourism initiative along the river.

The service will offer visitors a 35-45-minute cruise experience along the Yamuna, with electric boats, a riverfront terminal and family-oriented recreational facilities. The pilot project, developed by Delhi govt in coordination with Inland Waterways Authority of India, covers the 4km Sonia Vihar-Jagatpur stretch. An electric cruise with a capacity of 30 passengers has been introduced, while another vessel of the same capacity is expected to join the service by Feb-March 2027.

The service was inaugurated by Union minister for ports, shipping and waterways Sarbananda Sonowal in the presence of chief minister Rekha Gupta, water minister Parvesh Verma and tourism minister Kapil Mishra.

Gupta said the initiative was not merely a cruise or boat service, but an effort to reconnect people with the Yamuna and its cultural and religious significance.

"Namo Yamuna Safari reflects our faith and devotion to Maa Yamuna," she said, adding that Delhi residents would now be able to enjoy a cruise experience in their own city instead of travelling to places such as Prayagraj.

"The initiative aims to create a new tourism destination in the capital by combining boating with entertainment, food and outdoor activities," said Verma.

The riverfront terminal at Sonia Vihar has two floating jetties for passenger boarding and disembarking, ticket counters, a waiting area, paid parking, a food court and commercial shops.

The premises have an entry fee of Rs 50 while the proposed fare for a complete cruise journey is Rs 500. The timings for the cruise are 9am till 8pm. The service will remain closed from July 1 to Sept 30 every year during the monsoon season. The project includes a theme-based musical fountain showcasing the story of Lord Krishna and the significance of Yamuna, a children's play zone, gaming activities, and ecological and walking trails. Separate toilet facilities, a sewage treatment plant and a charging station for electric cruises have also been developed.

Mishra said the river safari would provide a new recreational experience to families. "Govt's effort is to develop new tourism opportunities along the Yamuna and give Delhi residents an opportunity to enjoy themselves while connecting with their cultural and natural heritage," he added.

However, environmental concerns have also been raised over the project. Bhim Singh Rawat, associate coordinator, South Asia Network on Dams, Rivers and People, said similar proposals in the past had not materialised because of inadequate water flow in the Yamuna.

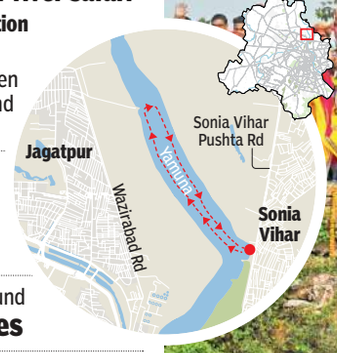
He cautioned that cruise operations and associated noise could disturb aquatic life and migratory birds, particularly in the stretch upstream of Wazirabad, where human intervention has so far been limited. He said govt should prioritise restoring ecological flow, reducing pollution and protecting the river's floodplains.

PLAY ZONE, WALKING PATHS, MUSICAL FOUNTAIN AND MORE

Photos: **Piyal Bhattacharjee**

Location for river safari

Area of operation
4-km stretch between Sonia Vihar and Jagatpur



30 No. of passengers each trip

Duration: Around **45 minutes**

₹50 Per person entry fee to the premises

₹500 Fare per person for cruise journey

Cruise timings **9am to 8pm**

People gather during an event which was organised to mark the launch of the Yamuna cruise service near Sonia Vihar

Minister Parvesh Verma takes a water jet bike ride during the launch of the cruise service in Yamuna near Sonia Vihar

Another electric cruise likely by **Feb-March 2027**

Keeping in view the river conditions during monsoon, the service will remain closed between **July 1 and Sept 30**

OTHER FACILITIES

- A riverfront terminal at Sonia Vihar with ticket counters, a guard room, paid vehicle parking, a waiting area, a food court and commercial shops
- Two floating jetties to facilitate passenger boarding and disembarkation
- Children's play zone
- Gaming activities
- Ecological trails and walking paths
- A theme-based musical fountain showcasing the story of Lord Krishna and the glory of Yamuna

Boost for Ghazipur WTE plant after tariff approval from DERC

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New Delhi: Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) has received regulatory approval from Delhi Electricity Regulatory Commission (DERC) for the power tariff of its proposed waste-to-energy plant at the Ghazipur landfill, clearing a key hurdle for the project.

MCD Standing Committee chairperson Satya Sharma said DERC has approved a tariff of Rs 7.4 per unit for electricity generated by the 2,000-tonne-per-day plant, which is expected to produce 20 MW of power. "DERC approved the tariff through its Oct 13 order on a petition filed under Section 63 of the Electricity Act, 2003," Sharma said.

The project, estimated to cost Rs 488 crore, will receive Rs 122 crore in viability gap funding from Centre under the Swachh Bharat Mission-Urban 2.0.

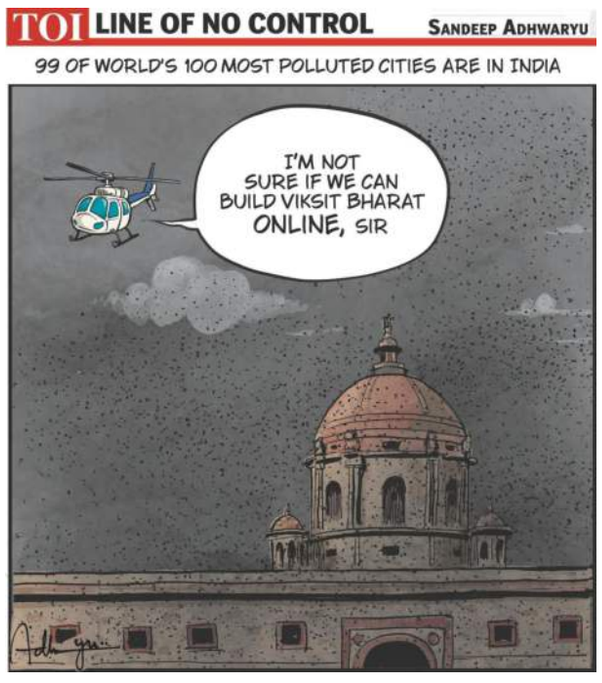
According to MCD, the facility will process 2,000 metric tonnes of municipal waste daily and convert it into electricity, strengthening the city's waste-management infrastructure. The project is expected to be completed within 18 months of commencement and become operational by Dec 2028.

Officials said the agency has been selected following technical and financial evaluation, with the bidder offering the lowest power tariff being chosen. The project will be developed under the public-private partnership (PPP) model. The selected agency will finance, construct and operate the plant for 25 years after commercial operations begin, while MCD will provide land within the Ghazipur landfill complex.

"Now that anticipatory approval has been received, we will issue a letter of intent to the agency to start work at the site near Gate No. 3 of the Ghazipur landfill," an official said, adding, "It will approach DERC again later for finalising the power purchase agreement."

Sharma said the project would help reduce dependence on conventional waste disposal methods while generating electricity from municipal waste. "Environmental norms prescribed by National Green Tribunal, Delhi Pollution Control Committee and other regulatory bodies would be followed during construction and operation of the facility," she said.

Besides Ghazipur, MCD is also planning two more waste-to-energy plants and expanding the capacity of the Narela-Bawana, Tehkhand and Okhla facilities. These projects are expected to increase the city's waste-processing capacity from 7,642 tonnes per day to 8,150 tonnes per day by 2028.



Liquor sales jumped 25% this Diwali eve

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New Delhi: Delhi recorded a 25% jump in liquor sales on the eve of Diwali this year compared to 2025, with the single-day revenue rising to Rs 79.2 crore on Nov 7 from Rs 63.4 crore on Diwali eve in 2025. Sales during the fortnight preceding Diwali also registered a 13.5% increase, according to Delhi govt data.

According to a comparative analysis of liquor sales during the pre-Diwali period of 2025 and 2026, "the increase was particularly pronounced on the day immediately preceding Diwali", said a source.

The surge in sales during the festive period is largely attributed to the increase in social gatherings, parties and celebrations around Diwali. With families and friends getting together, households stock up for entertaining guests, said officials. Gifting is another contributing factor, with premium liquor bottles often finding a place in festive hampers and being exchanged as gifts among friends, relatives and business associates. The extended holiday period also encourages people to make bulk purchases, they added.

Liquor sales in Delhi during the two weeks preceding Diwali this year witnessed a significant increase over the corresponding period in 2025. "The total sales increased from Rs 519 crore in 2025 to Rs 589.2 crore in 2026, registering a growth of 13.5%," said an official. Diwali day was a dry day in Delhi.

The category-wise breakup was not immediately available. Officials, however, said wine, whisky, Scotch whisky and premium liquor brands led the festive sales.

The range of liquor available in the city has expanded over the years. The number of registered liquor brands increased from 1,470 in 2023-24 to 1,579 in 2024-25, giving consumers a wider choice across Indian-made foreign liquor, imported spirits, wine and beer.

The number of liquor bottles sold in Delhi rose around 12%, increasing from close to 3 crore in 2025 to 3.3 crore in 2026. The jump was sharper on Diwali eve, when bottle sales increased 16.7%, from 34.7 lakh in 2025 to 40.5 lakh in 2026.

Delhi's liquor consumption has seen fluctuations in recent years. Sales, including beer, stood at 2.3 crore cases in 2021-22 and increased to 2.7 crore cases in 2022-23. They subsequently declined to 2.2 crore cases in 2023-24 before recovering to 2.3 crore in 2024-25.

The excise department has set a revenue collection target of Rs 7,200 crore for 2026-27 against Rs 7,148 crore in 2025-26.

Delhi's retail liquor trade is handled by four govt-run corporations. They operate around 725 retail liquor vends across the city. Private retailers are currently not permitted to run liquor stores in the city.

Back to normal? Not quite. Year on, Red Fort bears scars of blast horror

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New Delhi: A year after the Red Fort blast, which rocked the Chandni Chowk market and the area near the monument, locals say the terror caused by the incident remains fresh in their minds.

As noisy hawkers and honking cars crawled through the cramped roads, a silent tribute meeting was organised Tuesday in memory of those who lost their lives in the blast, a haunting reminder of the past in a seemingly normal-looking marketplace.

On Nov 10, a car laden with explosives was detonated outside Red Fort, killing 12 people. The area, which saw heavy traffic, was sealed off for over a week after the incident and it took months for visitors to return to the nearby Chandini Chowk market, said locals. "The crowd is back, but the market still hasn't recovered," said Sanjay Bhargava, a garment showroom owner.

The lane in which the blast occurred is now packed with honking cars and e-rickshaws, and the market lanes witness hawkers and buyers scrambling to find a path to move. However, shop owners said their sales are much less compared to the years before the incident. "The congestion and lawlessness in the area is back. Wholesale buyers are, therefore, scared to come here," added Bhargava.

Jatin Kumar

Mother of Pankaj Kumar Sahni, one of the victims of last year's Red Fort blast, at an event to mark the first anniversary of the incident

The tribute brought many of the victims' families to Red Fort for the first time after the blast. Ashok Randhawa (70), who organised the event, said it was about showing support to the grieving families. "A family never forgets the death of their loved ones. We want them to feel they're not alone in their sorrow," he said.

WHEN DELHI WAS ROCKED
Nov 10, 2025

Among the people who have returned to the area is Vijay Yadav (50), a street vendor. His water trolley is dented with holes from the impact of the blast. The trolley saved his life, said Yadav. "I bent to pick up a bottle at the exact moment the blast occurred and my cart was struck with shrapnel. It gave me a second life," he said.

The blast, however, cut open his forearm. Yadav was allegedly not eligible for Delhi govt's compensation as he didn't have a medico-legal certificate for the wound. "When I visited the hospital the following morning to get my hand treated, they refused to give me an MLC. I spent my own money on treatment and now I'm back at the same place to pay my wife's medical bills," said Yadav.

Another injured, Rita Prasad (26), got Rs 20,000 compensation from govt. A car wiper had perforated her right leg that day, causing a deep wound. Her father has spent over three times the compensation amount on her treatment, which is still on, she said. She has been told by doctors she can't run or play sports. "I was an athlete back in school. Now, I'm lucky I get to walk properly."

At the end of the tribute meet, the victims' families embraced each other before walking back into the crowded street. "They already have to suffer the emotional pain of losing their sole breadwinner. Should they also have to suffer financially?" said Randhawa.

Before J&K blast, how plan to bury explosives in Jasana was buried

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Gurgaon: On Nov 14 last year, an explosion at Nowgam police station in Srinagar killed nine people. These were the same explosives that had been found at hideouts used by Al Falah University doctors and taken from Haryana to Jammu & Kashmir for the investigation into the white coat terror module that was involved in the suicide bombing near Red Fort metro station in Delhi on Nov 10.

In the 48 hours of discussions preceding the decision to move the explosives, senior Haryana Police officers had advised against doing so, sources involved in the Delhi blast module probe told **TOI**. Faridabad police had also zeroed in on a site near Jasana village to bury the 358kg of ammonium nitrate.

According to sources, officials cautioned that moving such a huge quantity of sensitive material nearly 1,000km could be dangerous. But J&K Police personnel, according to the sources, insisted that the explosives needed to be taken to Nowgam, where the first FIR in the terror module case had been registered. The sources said J&K Police personnel said the explosives were 'case property' in the FIR registered at Nowgam police station and had to remain in their custody. "The J&K team cited legal procedures and rejected the disposal of explosives here in Jasana. We withheld our vehicles rather than put our personnel at risk," a senior Haryana police officer said.

The consignment, which was seized from a room rented by prime accused Muzammil Ahmad Ganaie, was eventually loaded onto a Tata 407 and taken to Nowgam, escorted by three police vehicles. The explosives reached J&K on Nov 10 last year.

Around 11.20pm on Nov 14, the seized material exploded at the police station when a forensic science laboratory (FSL) team was collecting samples for examination. Nine persons — a state investigation agency officer, three FSL personnel, two crime-scene photographers, two revenue officials on magisterial duty and a tailor assisting the team — were killed. Thirty-two people were injured.

J&K Police chief Nalin Prabhat had described the incident as "accidental". " Given the volume, the FSL team had been carrying out the process for two days. The material was unstable and sensitive, but was being handled with utmost caution. Unfortunately, an accidental explosion took place," he had said.

TOI

12 people died in the Red Fort blast

Haryana cops credited their J&K counterparts for exposing the network. "They deserve credit for acting on the posters and pursuing the leads. Had they not done so, the network may not have been exposed in time," a senior officer said.

OP Singh, the Haryana DGP at the time of the incident, said the inquiry must establish what actually happened. "Nine persons lost their lives at Nowgam. We owe them a careful answer. An inquiry committee is examining the incident," he added.

He also called for a national protocol regarding handling of explosives. "Large recoveries of explosives are risky to move and store. The narcotics law has a tested answer — draw samples, videograph the rest, have a magistrate certify it, and destroy the bulk safely near the place of seizure. Explosives need the same provision. It would protect both the evidence and the people who handle it."

The probe into the terror module had begun a month before this blast – on Oct 19 – when J&K Police found Jaish-e-Mohammad (JeM) posters threatening cops and security personnel in Nowgam. An FIR under relevant sections was registered at Nowgam police station.

The probe led police to professionals and students suspected of links with JeM and Ansar Ghazwat-ul-Hind, and to Al Falah University, where Ganaie taught and worked. On Oct 30, a J&K Police team came to Faridabad with a search warrant and arrested Muzammil from the university campus. He was taken to J&K on transit remand.

Securing Red Fort area: More guards, 300 CCTV cameras, vehicle checks

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: A year after a high-intensity blast ripped through the area near Red Fort, Delhi Police has significantly strengthened security arrangements around the historic monument, increasing surveillance, deploying additional private security guards and making anti-sabotage checks a regular exercise to prevent any untoward incident.

The explosion, which took place near the Red Fort Metro station on Nov 10 last year, triggered a security review in the national capital, particularly in the sensitive areas of Old Delhi. Since then, police have stepped up monitoring of the area, with nearly 300 CCTV cameras installed to keep a close watch on movement and activities around the monument and adjoining localities, police sources said.

Many of these cameras are equipped with advanced video analytics featuring the facial recognition technology linked to a comprehensive criminal database. The personnel strength was earlier doubled from 17 to 35 officers at the Red Fort police post to improve on-ground monitoring and law enforcement.

The cameras are being used to strengthen surveillance and help security personnel track suspicious movement. Police are also coordinating with local traders and other stakeholders to improve security coverage in the crowded market areas.

Apart from electronic surveillance, anti-sabotage checks have been intensified around Red Fort. Police teams conduct regular inspections of the area and dog squads are often deployed to check for suspicious objects and possible threats. Bomb disposal teams are also involved in security inspections as part of the enhanced arrangements.

Jatin Kumar

A year on, candles lit in remembrance

The security of parking areas has also received special attention. The number of security guards has been increased to ensure they can keep a watch on vehicles and alert police if they notice anything suspicious. Particular attention is being paid to vehicles parked for unusually long periods or those whose presence cannot be verified. Such vehicles are subsequently checked by cops and bomb and dog squads, police officials said.

A vehicle equipped with a facial recognition system has also been stationed near the monument during large gatherings to assist in identifying any suspicious persons. Police said they are maintaining coordination with other security agencies and local businesses to ensure all security concerns are immediately reported and verified.

Body cams now mandatory for cops checking vehicles in Gurgaon

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Gurgaon: A day after a home guard was arrested for allegedly extorting money in the name of Diwali gift, police commissioner Shibash Kabiraj made body-worn camera surveillance mandatory during challan proceedings. He also warned that personnel stopping vehicles without cameras could face departmental action.

The directions, issued Tuesday, came after a video of the home guard allegedly demanding illegal gratification in the name of a gift went viral on social media. Police said the accused was arrested after the incident.

The new measures also hold zonal officers and traffic inspectors accountable for corrupt practices by cops under their supervision.

"Under the new guidelines, traffic cops will have to conduct challan proceedings under body-worn camera surveillance to ensure transparency and protect both motorists and police personnel. Departmental action will be taken if personnel stop vehicles without using a body-worn camera, according to the instructions," an officer said.

The commissioner has also ordered that traffic personnel be deployed through a random, computerised system every 60 days. The move is aimed at preventing irregularities that may arise when personnel remain posted at the same location for long periods.

ACP-rank officers posted in the police control room have been directed to regularly monitor CCTV cameras and analyse footage to identify suspicious activity.

Police have appealed to residents to immediately report any illegal demand by police personnel or other employees on duty.

Assaulted In Tihar, Denied Treatment, Claims US Man

'Terror Module' Accused Links Arrest To Russia-Ukraine War

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: US national Matthew VanDyke, accused in a Myanmar terror module case, alleged in a handwritten affidavit submitted in Aug, two weeks before a chargesheet against him was filed, that he was repeatedly assaulted during his nearly six-month stay in Tihar jail.

He said he was punched in the chest and denied medical treatment for nearly 24 hours when he needed immediate attention-.VanDyke reportedly sent the affidavit to the US embassy.

The affidavit has now surfaced as VanDyke's post on X Monday. "India threw me and several Ukrainians into prison for over six months. This was part of Russia's war against Ukraine," he wrote.

VanDyke was granted default bail this year after the court found the chargesheet incomplete while the UAPA investigation remained pending

"I will reveal shocking details about this story over the next few months, in both posts and media interviews," the American added.

In the affidavit, VanDyke urged US embassy officials to "make it very clear to any Indian officials" that if he got "angry" with the contents of the chargesheet the NIA was preparing to file, he would approach the media and courts with details of his alleged custodial torture.

He also sent a distress alarm to his family, describing what he called a "series of attacks" inside Tihar. He alleged that he was beaten with a police baton on his chest and arms. When contacted by **TOI**, Tihar authorities declined to comment.

The NIA arrested VanDyke and six Ukrainians-- Kaminskyi Viktor, Hurba Petro, Slyviak Taras, Ivan Sukmanovskyi, Stefankiv Marian and Honcharuk Maksim-- in March at various airports after they allegedly travelled to Mizoram without required permits and crossed into Myanmar. The agency suspected their links with armed groups operating in Myanmar, several of which maintain bases in Northeast India.

Although the case was registered under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA) in April, the NIA's chargesheet invoked only Sections 21 and 23 of the Immigration and Foreigners Act, 2025. The agency told the court that its investigation into the UAPA angle was on and a supplementary chargesheet could be filed if an offence was made out.

VanDyke was subsequently granted default bail this year after the court found the chargesheet incomplete while the UAPA investigation remained pending.

He came to India in Oct to appear before a court in Delhi. He is allowed to stay in the US till Feb 24, 2027. The US embassy has not spoken on the matter.

Fake notices to X: Minor held

New Delhi: Delhi Police is learnt to have apprehended a juvenile in connection with the case of alleged fraudulent notices sent to social media platform X, asking it to block the accounts of Internet Freedom Foundation (IFF) and Software Freedom Law Centre (SFLC).

The suspect, a Class-XII student, was detained from Srinagar and produced before Juvenile Justice Board, sources said. Police didn't disclose the motive behind the act.

The crime branch of Delhi Police had filed an FIR for forgery and impersonation, and begun investigation even as X informed Delhi High Court that the takedown notices were sent by "some impostor, and not by Delhi Police".

X earlier issued notices to IFF and SFLC stating that a communication signed by special commissioner HGS Dhaliwal had sought the takedown. The alleged notices mentioned that the posts were defamatory towards RSS. TNN

Councillors may have to pay for damage to public property

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New Delhi: The MCD special privileges committee has proposed fixing accountability for damage to public property allegedly caused by councillors during house meetings by recovering the cost of damage from them.

In a letter to the mayor recently, the committee suggested issuing notices to the councillors or including the amount in their property tax demand if they fail to pay for the damage caused.

The move follows the Oct 22 house meeting, during which a discussion on anti-pollution measures in their respective wards turned into a stormy confrontation. Councillors allegedly threw water and papers at each other, damaged microphones and jostled with one another. The commotion forced the house to wind up proceedings without any meaningful discussion. The matter was subsequently referred by the mayor to the special privileges committee for deciding on the necessary action.

In his response, committee chairman Narendra Kumar wrote to mayor Pravesh Wahi on Oct 26, recommending that MCD assess the total loss caused to municipal property and determine the liability of all councillors found responsible.

"They should then be issued notices to deposit their respective share of the damage in the municipal treasury under the appropriate head of account," the letter said.

If any councillor failed to deposit the amount within a stipulated period, the sum could be included in his or her property tax demand and recovered through appropriate proceedings, the chairman suggested.

The mayor forwarded the committee chairman's letter to the MCD commissioner on Nov 5, seeking necessary action. "Please take necessary steps and inform about the action taken in this regard," Wahi wrote.

In the letter, Kumar has argued that elected councillors cannot claim immunity from criminal or civil liability after deliberately damaging municipal property, even if the incident happened inside the MCD house during a meeting.

He said the privileges of elected representatives are limited to official functions and do not extend to acts such as assault and vandalism. The privileges cannot be used as a shield against accountability for criminal acts.

The letter also referred to section 500 of the Delhi Municipal Corporation Act, 1957, which treats the councillors, mayor and municipal officials as public servants.

Portion of ceiling falls at IIMC hostel

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: A portion of a washroom ceiling in the girls' hostel of Indian Institute of Mass Communication (IIMC), Delhi, collapsed Sunday, raising concerns over safety and maintenance of the hostel building.

Videos and photographs of the incident, showing a large chunk of the ceiling on the washroom floor and the rusted iron reinforcement beneath it, have circulated on social media.

According to students who spoke to **TOI**, the roof had been in a dilapidated condition for a long time. They alleged that they had verbally complained to the hostel administration several times and asked for repairs, but no action was taken.

No one was injured. Students said a major mishap was averted as several of them were away for the Diwali break.

An administrative officer at the hostel, who did not wish to be named, confirmed that the ceiling collapsed around Diwali and said repairs were currently under way. "Most students are away for the Diwali festivities. Only around 10-15 students may be in the hostel now.... Repair work on the ceiling is now in progress, and other areas requiring repairs are also being identified by a designated agency," the officer said.

NDMC to prioritise native species of tulips

New Delhi: Lieutenant governor TS Sandhu Tuesday directed New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) to build an indigenous tulip propagation cycle, expand seasonal blooms and prioritise native species by preserving and enriching the city's ecological heritage.

He visited NDMC's hi-tech nursery at Lodhi Garden to review tulip growth chambers, year-round sapling production and modern arboricultural equipment. The civic body has stored around 40,000 tulip bulbs harvested over previous seasons at the nursery and plans to use them for the upcoming flowering season as well as further trials to improve bulb size.

"Around 24,000 tulip bulbs will be planted across NDMC areas, while the rest will be used for trials to improve their size through controlled growth conditions," said an official.

Appreciating NDMC's efforts to promote local cultivation of tulips, LG said the initiative could serve as a model for other agencies.

The hi-tech nursery, spread over around 300 square metres, facilitates year-round multiplication and propagation of plants irrespective of seasonal variations. "It has a production capacity of 18,000-20,000 plants per cycle, with four cycles annually," said officials.

For the forthcoming season, NDMC plans to procure approximately 4.7 lakh tulip bulbs -- three lakh for NDMC and 1.7 lakh for DDA areas. It will also sell tulips in pots to the public.

NDMC is planning to develop a Tulip Garden at Nehru Park this year.

LG also reviewed the functioning of NDMC's Cactus House, which has around 400 specimens of different varieties of cacti and succulents. He also visited a tree ambulance, equipped with facilities to treat diseased and damaged trees. TNN

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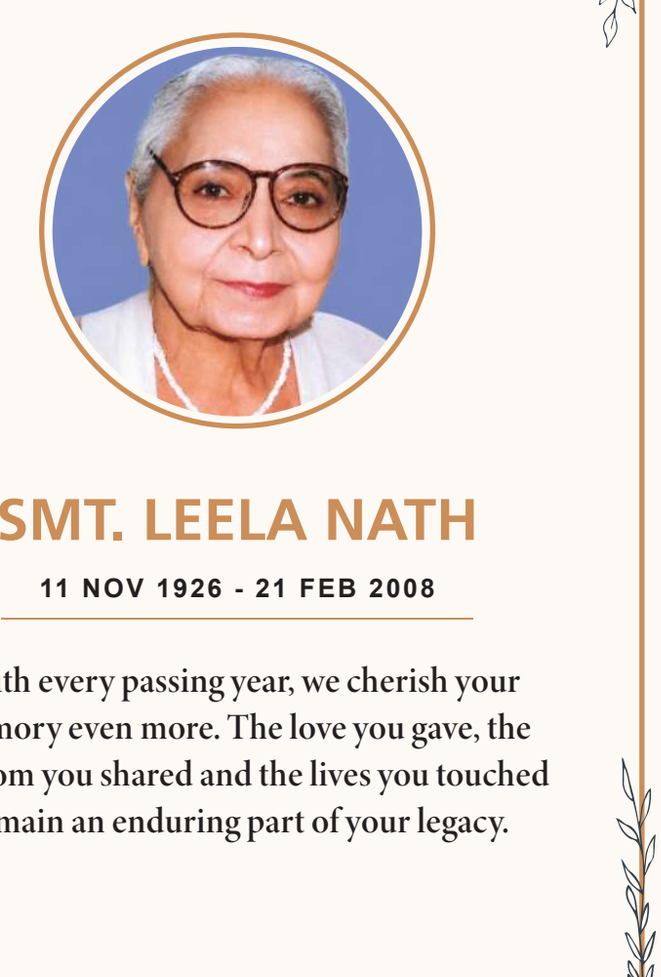

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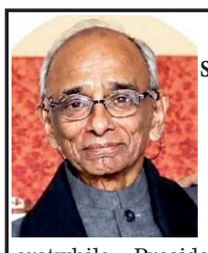
DG OS & Sr Col Comdt and all ranks of Army Ordnance Corps pray to the Almighty to grant peace to the departed soul & fortitude to the bereaved family to bear this irreparable loss. Cont:- Mrs Ombati Devi (Wife) Mob: 9892360989. Add: H No-84, Sec-6, Shradha Puri, Phase-1, Kankarkhera, Meerut



Surg Capt Vinod Mathew (Retd)

(28.01.1954 – 05.11.2026)

DGAFMS and all ranks of the AFMS family deeply mourn the sad demise of Surg Capt Vinod Mathew (Retd), erstwhile President Medical Board at INHS Asvini. An outstanding Officer and a dedicated medical professional, his invaluable contributions to the AFMS will be remembered with utmost respect. He will be deeply missed by his family and the AFMS fraternity.

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Vinod: 9958992088
Pankaj : 8130604727

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HC restrains action against waqf graveyard

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: Delhi High Court has restrained authorities from taking any action on a 17-acre graveyard in Civil Lines. It has directed the Centre to maintain status quo after the land and development office (L&DO) claimed ownership of the waqf-notified property and issued an eviction notice.

Justice Amit Mahajan passed the interim order on Nov 6 on a petition filed by the management of Qabristan Bagh Sher Jung. The court sought responses from the Centre and the Delhi Waqf Board and listed the matter for March 11, 2027, making it clear that no action should be taken concerning the property in the meantime.

The graveyard is managed by Anjuman Wakil-I-Quam Punjabian, a registered charitable society that has been in existence before 1910. It has centuries-old graves, shrines, a mosque and a madrasa.

The challenge followed an Oct 22 notice issued by the L&DO to four people identified as encroachers on a part of the land. They were asked to vacate within 15 days. The notice also asserted that the property belonged to the Government of India. The graveyard management contested this claim in court.

Amid Uneven Supply, Govt Schools Told To Buy Books

Activist Slams Circular, Asks How Principals Will Find Them

Meghna.Dhulia
@timesofindia.com

New Delhi: Amid complaints of delayed and uneven textbook supply in Delhi govt schools, Delhi Bureau of Text Books has asked education officials to make school heads directly procure second-term mathematics and social science textbooks for Classes VII and VIII.

The arrangement covers Volume II of both subjects in English, Hindi and Urdu for the 2026-27 academic session. The Nov 9 circular, addressed to deputy directors of education across zones 1 to 29, says heads of schools will buy the books "as per their actual requirement". Schools can use their Vidyalaya Kalyan Samiti (VKS) funds or buy the books upfront and submit bills for reimbursement under the prescribed procedure.

The bureau said the funding options were intended to ensure "timely procurement and distribution of the same to the students". The circular gives no deadline for schools to complete the purchases or hand the books to students. An education department official reiterated that the step had been taken to ease out the hassles and ensure that every child gets books.

TOI reported on Oct 29 that nearly seven months into the academic session, some Delhi govt schools were still waiting for textbooks of several subjects. Teachers said revisions to NCERT textbooks had made it difficult to reuse copies from outgoing batches. A school head in west Delhi said social science textbooks had arrived only around Sept, while teachers at a north Delhi school were relying on PDFs and printouts.

In a representation to the education department, education activist Ashok Agarwal had flagged shortages, particularly in English- and Urdu-medium sections. He said some schools got Class VII English-medium social science books only after the first term ended, while second-term books for social science and mathematics were still unavailable in some mediums. He also alleged that some students had received books while classmates in the same schools were still waiting.

A Nov 9 circular says that heads of schools will buy the books 'as per their actual requirement'. The arrangement covers Volume II of maths and social science for the 2026-27 session

"This circular is a farce. With the school year nearly over, principals have been told to buy second-term textbooks for Classes VII and VIII. If the Delhi Bureau of Text Books, which is responsible for printing and supplying them on time, cannot make them available, how will principals find them?" said education activist and lawyer Ashok Agarwal.

He added, "Schools must use their limited Vidyalaya Kalyan Samiti funds or pay upfront and seek reimbursement. Bulk purchases could eat into budgets for essential work, and reimbursements could take time. Shifting the burden looks like an attempt to cover up the bureau's failure and opens the door to counterfeit textbooks".

The shortages date back to the start of the academic session in April. Teachers told TOI in May that they were preparing worksheets and adapting lessons while waiting for printed textbooks. By late Oct, some schools were still relying on PDFs and printouts, and teachers said changes to the NCERT syllabus meant that books collected from outgoing batches could no longer fill the gap in some subjects.

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Bank receives bomb threat

New Delhi: A bomb threat call to a Bank of Baroda branch on Sansad Marg triggered a security scare Tuesday, prompting a search by police and a bomb disposal squad before it was declared a hoax. According to the fire department, a bomb threat call was received around 11.35 am on Nov 10, leading police and bomb squad personnel to search the bank premises.

Around 1.10 pm, police confirmed the search was still under way with bomb squad personnel present at the scene.

The threat was officially declared a hoax at 1.55 pm, bringing relief to the bank staff and people nearby. TNN

Fugitive in net after 16 years

New Delhi: Police arrested a 61-year-old fugitive, who had a Rs 50,000 bounty, in Uttar Pradesh's Hapur, ending a 16-year search following his life sentence for murder and dacoity.

According to police, in Nov 1997, accused Udaibir Singh and two accomplices were fleeing Bhera Enclave in Paschim Vihar when a local caught one of them. The other two then allegedly fatally shot the resident before robbing a passerby of his scooter at knife point to escape.

All three suspects were arrested and convicted. In 2010, Singh received a one-month parole after his son died, but he failed to return to jail and absconded. TNN

Student drowns in Rishikesh

Haridwar: A 22-year-old college student from Delhi drowned in the Ganga near Neem Beach in Tapovan area of Rishikesh on Monday after he was swept away by strong river currents.

The victim, Ashish Kumar of Mayur Vihar Phase-III in Delhi, was a BCom student and had travelled to Rishikesh along with seven friends, all in their 20s and hailing from Delhi.

The group ventured into the river to take a dip. While bathing, Kumar got caught in a powerful current. SDRF local in-charge Kavindra Sajwan told **TOI**, "Our team of expert divers rushed to the spot. After several attempts, they pulled the body out of the river. We've handed over the body to the police for autopsy." TNN

15.5L families get ₹142cr LPG aid directly in bank accounts

Abhinav.Rajput@timesofindia.com

New Delhi: More than 15.5 lakh ration cardholder families in Delhi received financial assistance for LPG cylinders as part of Diwali benefits, with Delhi govt transferring Rs 141.9 crore directly into their bank accounts through direct benefit transfer (DBT) Tuesday.

Chief minister Rekha Gupta launched the disbursement at an event at Talkatora Stadium by pressing a button to transfer the amount to beneficiaries. Symbolic cheques were also distributed to some beneficiaries.

Of the total beneficiaries, 1,24,964 families covered under the Pradhan Mantri Ujjwala Yojana (PMUY) received Rs 642 each, while 14,21,030 non-PMUY ration cardholder families received Rs 942 each. The assistance is aimed at helping families meet household expenses during the festive season.

Addressing the gathering, Gupta said Delhi govt was committed to providing financial assistance during festivals. Gupta said Diwali was a time not just for celebration but also for spreading joy and helping those in need. The initiative, she added, would provide financial relief to ration cardholder families.

The govt said beneficiary details were verified against ration card records and other relevant data before disbursement. Monitoring and audit mechanisms were also put in place to prevent duplicate payments, fund misuse and irregularities.

Food and supplies minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa said: "The objective is to reduce the burden of household expenses amid rising prices, increase savings for women and bring financial relief and prosperity into their lives."

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KATAKA
Odisha Police
Office of the D.G & I.G. of Police, Odisha, Kataka
Tel.:0671-2304001, Website :police.odisha.gov.in,
Email: igops.orpol@od.gov.in
RFP No. 27-RFP- Shortwave Diathermy -2026-2027 Date :09.11.2026
Online Bids through e-Tender Portal **https://tendersodisha.gov.in** are invited from the eligible bidders for Supply of **Shortwave Diathermy** for Odisha Police, Odisha, Kataka, during the current financial year 2026- 27 as per the schedule mentioned below.

Sl. No.	Name of Item	Approximate quantity
1.	Shortwave Diathermy	01 Set

Events	Date
RFP Issue Date	09.11.2026
RFP Submission Due Date and time	24.11.2026
Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bids	25.11.2026
Bid to RA enabled	Yes
Tender Document fee {(Non-refundable Rs. 590/- (Rs.500/- + 18% GST (Rs. 90/-)}	In favour of A.I.G. of Police (Prov.), Odisha, Kataka payable at Kataka. (Demand Draft)
EMD (Earnest Money Deposit) 18,000/- (Eighteen Thousand Rupees Only)	In favour of A.I.G. of Police (Prov.), Odisha, Kataka payable at Kataka. (Demand Draft)

The bid document with all information relating to the bidding process including cost of bid document, Prequalification criteria and terms & conditions are available in the websites: https://tendersodisha.gov.in The Authority reserves the right to accept / reject any part thereof or all the bids without assigning any reason thereof.
Sd/-
A.I.G. of Police (Provisioning,)
Odisha, Kataka.
(Tender Calling Authority)
OIPR-12001/12029/1/26-27/0044

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DIRECTOR

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(Sr. Sec. Recognised)
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• TGT: English, Sanskrit & Mathematics. (F)
• PRE - PRIMARY / NURSERY TEACHERS: (F)
• Art Teacher: (F)
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M = Male, F = Female

RP Mem. Sr. Sec. Public School K-3, Mohan Garden,uttam ngr Reqs-(M) Accountant 3 yrs Exp. Comp. optr (F) PGT,TGT,NTT Phy.Edu & Draw 8750067726/27

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RADIO COLONY, KINGSWAY CAMP, DELHI – 110009
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SUBJECT — No. of Post
NTT -One
Special Educator (Learning Disability)-PRT (Female) -One
PRT-All subjects (Female)-Two
PGT– English -Two
PGT – Maths - Two
TGT-English, Hindi, Sanskrit - One each
Supervisor - One
All posts require qualifications from recognised Board / Universities. Fluency in English, advance knowledge of Computer is must. Eligibility as per Delhi Govt. norms.
Application forms can be collected from School Reception from 23rd November to 08th December 2026 (Monday to Friday on all working days) between 8.00 a.m and 1.00 p.m.

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• HR
• ADMISSION COUNSELLOR
• TELE CALLERS
• PURCHASE OFFICER
JOB LOCATION: GREATER NOIDA
Interested candidates can apply at:
Email: hr@tips.edu.in
invitemetips@gmail.com
Contact: 45636922/23, 9315911710

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SALES

WALK-IN DRIVE, 14 NOV, 10AM - 4PM. Trip To Temples needs Sales Executives. Good communication skills, sales experience preferred, travel enthusiasts welcome. Competitive salary + incentives. 101, JOP Plaza, Sector 18, Noida. Carry resume and ID proof. Call Mridula Sharma: 7303151856

REQ Off Asst cum Runner, computer knowledge in Vasant Kunj. (Do not apply if you don't own conveyance). pur egosholegacy@gmail.com

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MEDICAL

REQD Lady Doctor (MBBS) part/full-time.15-yr-old Day Care Centre, Nangloi. Work: MTP, D&C & OPD. Per-patient share basis. 8178164141

VACANCY FOR RMO, Nurses, Pharmacist, TPA, Billing, Marketing Executive. Ramanta Hospital Sector 21 -D Faridabad. # 9999280028

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IFCI Financial Services Limited (IFIN) group invites Application for positions of: Chief Operating Officer - Chennai. For further details please visit our website: www.ifinltd.in/Career/Click-To-Post-Resume. Last date for applying: 17.11.2026

MULTIPLE VACANCIES

GURGAON bsd Hotel Reqs. (1) Senior Accountant (2) Executive Assistant (EA) Fluent in Eng., 2-3Yrs Exp in Short/ long hand dictation (3) Business Development/ Marketing Manager. Send CV at: speedlines44@yahoo.co.in

personal

CHANGE OF NAME

I, MANJULA W/o Sh Tarun Kumar, Resident of H.No. 1473, Sector 28, Faridabad 121008 do hereby declare that I have changed my name from MANJULA to MANJULA KAMBOJ and henceforth I shall be known as MANJULA KAMBOJ in all purpose, vide affidavit no. INDL 40094951378601Y sworn before the Notary Public at New Delhi on 06- Nov- 2026 MANJULA KAMBOJ and MANJULA both are same and one identical .

LOST & FOUND

I, Gaurav Pandey S/O Rajesh Pandey, have lost my X marksheet, Roll No: 6607052, Year 2017. If found, kindly contact 9319996079.

tender & notices

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE
General Public is hereby informed that my Client intends to Purchase Upper Ground Floor (First Floor) of House No.33, Road No. J-1 (J-1/33) situated in DLF CITY Phase-II, Gurgaon from the present Owner, M/S OM FINCAP PVT. LTD. Having its Registered Office at Shop No 4 Malka Ganj Delhi through its Director Sh. Om Parkash Dhingra. Any person/institution having any claim in respect thereof by way of Sales, Mortgage, Exchange, Gift, Charges, Trust, Inheritance, Possession, Lien Or lease or otherwise are requested to inform the same in writing to the undersigned within 7 Days failing which the claim(s) if any of such person(s)/institution will be considered to have been waived and /or abandoned & the Deal will be Concluded.
A.K.MUNJAL, ADVOCATE
M-6/14, DLF-2, Gurgaon, 9560492323
advocate.akmunjal@gmail.com

TENDERS

THE DELHI GOLF CLUB
Dr. Zakir Hussain Road,New Delhi-03
Quotations are invited from reputed vendors for "Purchase of Electric F&B Golf Cart" Detailed RFP can be downloaded from DGC website https://delhigolfclub.org/tendernotice/ Sealed forms mentioning word "PURCHASE OF ELECTRIC F&B GOLF CART)" in capital letters on top of the envelope must reach us before 16:00 Hrs. on 20th Nov.2026. Tender Box is placed in the Main Office of DGC.
Lt. Col. Rohit Singh (Retd)
Secretary
The Delhi Golf Club

NEW DELHI YMCA
Tender Notice: AMC for Computers & Peripherals
The General Secretary & CEO, New Delhi YMCA, 1 Jai Singh Road, New Delhi – 110001, invites online quotations for a Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract (AMC) for Computers & Peripherals with 3 Resident Engineers.
Submission Mode: Email to quotations@newdelhiymca.in by November 18, 2026.
The Management reserves the right to accept or reject any or all quotations without assigning any reason. The decision of the Management shall be final and binding. The final award of the contract is subject to negotiation.
For scope of work, please scan the QR code or visit:
www.newdelhiymca.in/resources/downloads

Bennett & Coleman THE TIMES OF INDIA
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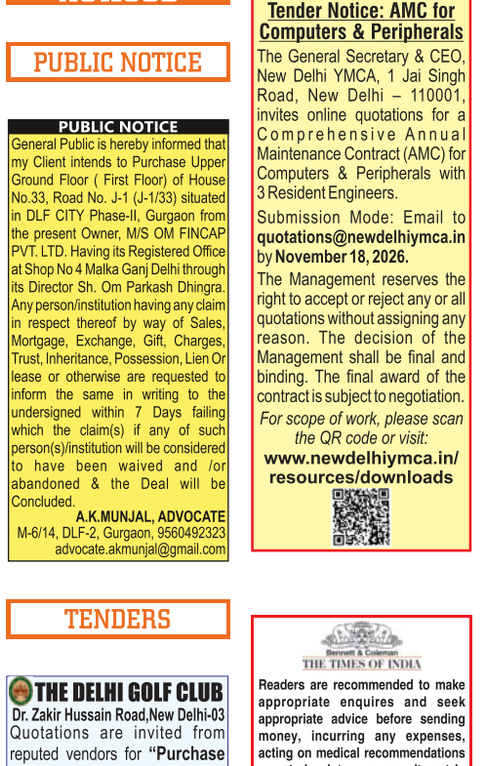

Jharkhand State Aarogya Society (JSAS)
Department of Health, Medical Education & Family Welfare
Government of Jharkhand
NIT Reference No: 03(वि0)AB-MMJAY-18/2026-1207 Date: 10th November, 2026
Notice Inviting Tender (NIT)
Selection of an Insurance Company to provide Group Health Insurance for beneficiaries of Ayushman Bharat –Pradhan Mantri Jan Aarogya Yojana (AB-PMJAY) and Mukhya Mantri Abua Swasthya Suraksha Yojana(MMASSY), Jharkhand (through e-procurement mode).
Jharkhand State Aarogya Society (JSAS), Department of Health, Medical Education & Family Welfare, Government of Jharkhand, through the Executive Director, JSAS, invites online tenders from eligible Bidder through e-procurement portal for "Selection of an Insurance Company to provide Group Health Insurance for beneficiaries of AB-PMJAY and MMASSY, Jharkhand". Interested Bidders can access and download the complete Tender Document and other related details from the e-Procurement Portal https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in
The major events (Time Schedule) under the bid process are:

Sl. No	List of Key Events	Critical Dates
1.	Date of Commencement of downloading bid document in e-procurement portal	From 1500 hours (IST) onwards on 12 November, 2026
2.	Last date of receipt of queries	19 November, 2026
3.	Pre-bid meeting (Bidders requiring clarification after the Pre-Bid Meeting may submit written requests within 01 day from the date of the Pre-Bid Meeting).	1130 hours (IST) on 27 November, 2026 The Pre-Bid Meeting will be held at the office address mentioned below.
4.	Date of Issuance of Pre-Bid queries clarification/Issue of Corrigendum/Addendum/ Extension (if required)	11 December, 2026
5.	Bid Submission Start Date and time	12 December, 2026, from 1130 (IST) onwards
6.	Last date and time of bid submission/ Bid Due Date	Up to 1400 hours (IST) on 30 December, 2026
7.	Date and time of Financial Bid opening	To be notified separately to technically qualified bidders

Technical Bids shall be opened online through the e-Procurement Portal in the presence of the Procurement Committee. The Financial Bids of only technically qualified bidders shall be opened online through e-procurement portal in the physical presence of the bidder's or their duly authorized representatives at the date, time, and venue notified by the JSAS. For further details regarding the bidding schedule, bidders are advised to regularly visit the e-Procurement Portal. Any queries or requests for clarification regarding this tender shall be submitted to the following email address: **ed-abpmjay@jharkhandmail.gov.in**
Bidders fulfilling the prescribed eligibility criteria, as specified in the NIT and the detailed Tender Document, may submit their bids online through the e-Procurement Portal https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in, complete in all respects, within the stipulated date and time mentioned above.
Bids submitted after the prescribed date and time shall not be accepted. The Authority reserves the right to accept or reject any or all bids, in whole or in part, without assigning any reason thereof. All correspondence/ communications relating to this tender shall be addressed to:
Executive Director, Jharkhand State Aarogya Society (JSAS)
Department of Health, Medical Education & Family Welfare
2nd floor, Health Directorate Building, RCH Campus,
Namkum, Ranchi-834010, Jharkhand
Sd/-
Executive Director
Jharkhand State Aarogya Society
PR 393677 Jharkhand State Arogya Society(26-27).D

Government of Jharkhand
Forest, Environment & Climate Change Department
Office of the Divisional Forest Officer, Chatra North Forest Division.
Van Bhavan, Chatra (Jharkhand) - 825401
Telephone No: 06541-296022,Email :
(1) dfo-chatranorth@gov.in (2) dfochatranorth@gmail.com
Notice No. .....01.....Chatra, Dated .....07.11.2026.....
WALK-ININTERVIEW

Particulars	Details
Posts/Roles and Tentative Number of Vacancies(subject to change):	Senior Research Fellow (SRF)- 01 and Junior Research Fellow (JRF)- 02
Date and Time of Walk-in Interview	20.11.2026 at 11:00 AM
Venue of Walk-inInterview:	Office of the Divisional Forest Officer, Chatra North Forest Division, Van Bhavan, Chatra (Jharkhand) 825401.
Documents Required at the Time of Interview:	Duly filled application form in the prescribed pro forma, along with self-attested copies of educational qualification and experience certificates. Candidates must produce the original documents at the time of verification.
Last Date for Submission of Application:	On or before 10:00 AM on 20.11.2026
Mode of Submission of Application:	E-mail to (1) dfo-chatranorth@gov.in, (2)dfochatranorth@gmail.com, or By Post to the Office of the Divisional Forest Officer, Chatra North Forest Division, Van Bhavan, Chatra (Jharkhand) 825401.
Contact for Queries:	(1) 8987790214 (2)9097740294 (1)dfo-chatranorth@gov.in (2)dfochatranorth@gmail.com

For detailed eligibility criteria, monthly remuneration, and terms, etc., please visit https://forest.jharkhand.gov.in/.
Note: Candidates are advised to carefully read all instructions, terms and conditions before submitting their applications.
वन प्रमण्डल पदाधिकारी,
चतरा उत्तरी वन प्रमण्डल
PR 393609 (Forest, Environment and Climate Changes)26-27*D

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE NO.-T-SEE-GSU-2026-27-08
CAO/CON/RSP/MHX for and on behalf of the President of India invites Open E-Tenders for the following works. The last date of online E-tendering is 08/12/2026 up to 15:00 hrs. All information and tender documents related to E-tender is available on website-www.ireps.gov.in. **(1)Name of Work:**Construction of Road Over Bridge and other related works in lieu of (1) level crossing no. 25 (spl) at kilometer: 104/37-39 between Mansi-Mahesh Khunt station., (2) level crossing No. 53 (spl) at Kilometer: 169/28-29 bet. TilrathBegusarai station. & (3) level crossing No. 30 (spl) at Kilometer: 115/28-30 between Khagaria-Mansi station, in the jurisdiction of Sonpur Division. **(2)Advertised Value (Rs.):** 2007232191.99 **(3)Earnest Money/Bid Security (Rs.):** 40144700.00 **(4)Date and Time of the Pre-Bid Conference:** 18/11/2026, 11:30 Hrs. **(5) Tender Closing Date Time:** 08/12/2026, 15:00 Hrs. The above tender notice is available on website www.ireps.gov.in. RIGHT OF RAILWAY TO DEAL WITH TENDER: Railway Administration reserves the right to postpone /modify or to cancel any one or all the tenders without assigning any reasons. **Dy. Chief Project Manager**
GatiShakti/Sonpur
PR/1301/SEE/GS/T/26-27/36

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
E- TENDER NOTICE
NO.- ECR-CAO-C-N-EPC-23-26-27
E- TENDER IS INVITED ON BEHALF OF THE PRESIDENT OF INDIA FOR THE UNDER MENTIONED WORK **(1)Name of work with it's location:** Engineering Procurement and Construction (EPC) Tender for Track works, including supply of ballast and P-Way materials, laying and linking of track, and other related miscellaneous works in connection with the doubling of the Darbhanga (excluding)-Sitamarhi (excluding) section from Ch. 39.400 km to Ch. 103.850 km (total length: 64.450 km), for 25-tonne axle load, under Samastipur Division of East Central Railway **(2)Approx. cost of the work of:** Rs. 173,23,19,625.56 **(3)Earnest money to be deposited:** Rs. 3,46,46,400.00 **(4)Date and time for closing of tender.:** 04.03.2027 at 14.30 hrs. **(5)Website particular, Notice board location where complete details of tender can be seen and addressed of the office from where the tender form be purchased etc.:** The above E-Tender, E-Tendering document alongwith full information is available on website i.e. http://www.ireps.gov.in. Note: In case of any descripencies found in tender notice, English version will be final. Tenderers are requested to visit the website http://www.ireps.gov.in atleast 15 days before last date of closing for latest corrigendum/corrections etc in response to this E-tender
CAO/Con/North
EC Rly, MHX, Patna
PR/1306/CN/N/MHX/CONST/T/26-27/40

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CONCURRENT SHOWS

BHARAT MANDAPAM, NEW DELHI
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Auto Expo 2027 THE MOTOR SHOW
04 - 09 FEBRUARY 2027
Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi, India

India International Tyre Show 2027

Bharat Battery SHOW
EXPO ON BATTERY & CHARGING

INDIA CYCLE SHOW 2027
International Bicycle & E-Bike Exhibition

nasscom mobility tech pavilion | THE ROAD AHEAD

IndianSteel ASSOCIATION
Steel Pavilion
DRIVING INNOVATION IN AUTOMOTIVE EXCELLENCE

YASHOBHOOMI, DWARKA, DELHI
04 – 07 FEBRUARY 2027 I (5 SHOWS)

2027 THE COMPONENTS & TECHNOLOGY SHOW
4th - 7th FEBRUARY, 2027
YASHOBHOOMI - INDIA INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION & EXPO CENTRE (IICC), DWARKA, NEW DELHI, INDIA

2nd BHARAT CONSTRUCTION EQUIPMENT Expo
4-7 FEBRUARY 2027
YASHOBHOOMI, DWARKA, NEW DELHI

AGRI MOBILITY & TECHNOLOGY EXPO
कृषि वाहन प्रदर्शनी
4 - 7 February 2027
Yashobhoomi, Dwarka, New Delhi

AIR MOBILITY EXPO 2027

CII Metro & Urban Mass Transit Expo 2027
4-7 February 2027 | Yashobhoomi, Dwarka, New Delhi

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FOLLOW US ON

CONTRAPUNTO

This is not a how-to book, whether to build an economy, an army, or a nation. It is an account of the problems my colleagues and I faced, and how we set about solving them

– LEE KUAN YEW, The Singapore Story

Her Story, History

Political autobiographies aren't about accepting one version of events, but an invitation to argue with it

A political autobiography can never be just a personal memoir. Especially when it comes to the 'important' politicians, who are deeply entwined in the evolution of a nation-state. But the reverse proposition also contains truth. That we cannot fully understand political history without understanding the private lives of those who shaped it. Sonia Gandhi's *Belonging: A Journey of Love* ticks both boxes. In any case, for Sonia, as her memoir makes clear, the distinction between personal and political was, understandably, not always clear. Taking a broader perspective, what is interesting in India is how strong a start this genre got. Gandhi, Nehru, Ambedkar, and Savarkar all penned memoirs. But the momentum, with honourable exceptions, did not last.

In the West, things are very different. In US, publishing an autobiography has almost become a requisite for running for high office. Both Rubio and Vance, tellingly, have put their memoirs out there. In Europe, post-office reflections are commoner, focused on legacy. Angela Merkel (*Freedom*) and Boris Johnson (*Unleashed*) have let rip in this vein. Actually, the genre is ascendent globally, a rising bridge between leadership and public persuasion. For general readers, what's often of most interest are the informal networks, personalities, rivalries…that never make it into govt documents.

Yes, such accounts can be selective and self-serving. Their facts are often open to question. But fact-checking should not lead to any point of view disappearing. Instead, the culture of political recollection should be cheered on, as a sort of heteroglossia, many-voicedness. Because the more witnesses are on record for a particular era, the better for democracy. After all, at its best, the political autobiography is not about accepting someone's version of history, but an invitation to argue with it, one that's open even to future generations.

"I spoke a lot about country, but there is not enough about my life," Advani regretted about *My Country My Life*. Perhaps Sonia Gandhi is more satisfied with how much of the private calculations behind her public decisions, such as declining India's prime ministership in 2004, she has revealed. If so, it's quite something after a lifetime of keeping her "inner world" to herself. We can think of the autobiography as another form of accountability. Whether or not it is enjoyed with a pinch of salt, depends on the reader.

Spy Who Loved Me

Honeytraps have been around forever. Why are we surprised if an ageing CEO succumbs?

Alice Huang has disappeared without a trace, leaving poor Jensen to shoulder the blame. And poorer he is, having lost $7bn and two places on the Forbes' list on Monday. You can bet he won't be humming '*Living Next Door To Alice*' ever again. Was Alice a Chinese spy? US intelligence thinks so, but don't expect China to admit it. Jensen, "honourable guy", as Trump calls you, don't feel bad, you may be the richest sexpionage victim in history. And it is a long history, stretching back into mythology. We can't resist mentioning Vishwamitra, whose grand ascetic enterprise the gods sabotaged by deploying Menaka.

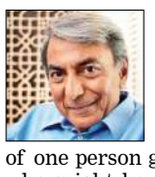
In our own time, industrial espionage is as big a worry as regular snooping for political and military secrets. In 2015, EU estimated 20% of businesses across the continent had suffered a trade secrets breach. In Germany, 17% of companies reported data theft between 2015 and 2017. Now, you have to be cutting-edge to be a target of espionage, and Jensen's Nvidia is currently the most cutting-edge in AI hardware. So it's not surprising if China, which is in a desperate race with US for supremacy, should want Nvidia's tech by any means, including honeytraps.

It's like the Cold War all over again. Back then, Soviets excelled at sexpionage. Every Western diplomat in Moscow was a target, and many succumbed. As Soviet foreign ministry spokesman Gennadi Gerasimov joked, "Recently, we have witnessed a loss of capability to resist the enemy." In Britain, a minister's affair with 19-year-old Christine Keeler, who was allegedly having a parallel affair with a Soviet naval attache, shook the Harold Macmillan govt in 1960s. In 2007, Chinese finance minister Jin Renqing resigned over an affair. Four years later, WikiLeaks revealed the woman was a suspected Taiwanese spy. So, nobody's really safe from sexpionage. Not even the honeypots themselves. Mata Hari, the most famous of them, was killed by a French firing squad for allegedly leaking Allied secrets to Germans in WW1. Decades later, it was revealed that she had only ever done one mission – and that for the French.

My birthday present

I got a great gift from people I've never met

Jug Suraiya



It was the best present I got last week for my birthday.

My delight at this most unexpected of presents was followed by a sense of puzzlement. How had these people – perfect strangers whom I've never met – somehow read my mind and pitched in to give me this great gift?

Was it a case of mental telepathy, by which the thoughts of one person get delivered, like a courier package, to the minds of others, who might be far away, and whose general whereabouts are unknown to the transferor, let alone their exact addresses, complete with PIN codes and mobile phone numbers?

Was I, unbeknownst to me, all these years a mental telepathist? Was I a mental Samuel Morse who, on May 24, 1844, sent the world's first telegraph, "What hath God wrought?"?

What indeed had God, or my mind, wrought, and that too without the benefit of all the wires and other paraphernalia that Morse's message had required for transmission?

Scientists have pondered 'action at a distance', defined as a non-contact force on an object by another object without any physical connect between the two.

second*opinion*

How did the apple fall on Newton's head? Having given it a bit of a think, Newton decided he'd better invent gravity. Which was fine, till along came Einstein and upset the Newtonian applecart by pulling relativity out of his hat.

But then in 1964, John Stewart Bell formulated Bell's Theorem, which suggested that if a pair of 'entangled' particles were to be placed at either end of the universe, changing the state of one would change the state of the other via instant communication, without the device of that other Bell, Alexander Graham, inventor of the telephone.

Had I been on some sort of psychic long-distance hotline with those people who gave me my birthday present?

Whatever the cause, I'm delighted. Because I couldn't have wished for a better birthday gift than to hear that, to use a cricket analogy, MAGA Donald scored a MAGA duck. Ta muchly, American voters.

India & L'Affaire Huang

Why should New Delhi care about US scrutiny of Nvidia boss's private life? Because, in part thanks to new Democratic majority, it may lead to tighter chip export controls. That's what we have to 'insure' against

Pranay Kotasthane

News from Nvidia this week, has been about Jensen Huang's private life. The company's board has opened an inquiry into reports that a woman with whom he was having an affair, may have been working for Chinese intelligence. Nvidia says it has no reason to believe any of its secrets were compromised. While there is intense scrutiny over Huang's conduct, what matters more is its implication on American chip export controls.

Huang has been the most prominent voice in Washington, for selling advanced chips to China. His argument made business sense. If Chinese firms keep buying Nvidia chips, they keep building on American tech, and the revenue funds the next generation of American research.

Keeping an adversary dependent on its tech also caps the pace at which China develops its chips, so there was a geopolitical rationale as well. This argument helped persuade Trump administration in Jan, to allow sales of Nvidia's H200 chip to approved Chinese buyers, with US govt taking a 25% cut.

But this argument now stands politically delegitimised. A new Democratic majority in Congress is already preparing to question Nvidia's China exports. Yes, export controls are an executive decision, taken by the commerce department. But US Congress can raise the political cost of selling to China, as it can summon executives and attach conditions to the department's budget.

We should expect calls for tighter checks on chip intermediaries, new rules on Chinese firms renting computing power abroad, and a rollback of the H200 deal.

Despite export controls back in favour in US, they are unlikely to be effective in slowing China's progress. Export controls work best on goods that are few, large, and immobile, like the lithography machines used to make advanced chips. GPUs, in contrast, are made in the millions, pass through layers of distributors and server makers, and have thousands of customers. Even when chip shipments are restricted, computing power can always be rented, as Chinese labs have done, using Nvidia GPUs located in Southeast Asian data centres to train their models.

Regardless, when an export control does not work, Washington rarely concludes that it should be dropped. It casts a wider net instead, and that is where India comes into the picture.

Biden administration's compute rationing plan, euphemistically called the AI Diffusion Rule, was one such net. Aimed at chips leaking through third countries, it would have capped India's imports at 50,000 H100-equivalent chips over three years. Trump administration withdrew it, but has dithered on a replacement thus far.

Image: AI

This debate can be thought of as two self-sustaining loops. In the first loop, Chinese purchases of US chips fund American research, which, in turn, keeps Chinese firms building on the American stack. In the second, denial pushes China to substitute, and its growing hardware output fuels further substitution. Tighter controls will likely boost the second loop, even as leakage continues.

While India cannot forecast Washington's mood, it must insure against this. To use one of Jensen Huang's formulations, AI has five layers, namely energy, chips, data centres, models, and applications. India's strategic posture on the chip export controls should be guided by the principle of maximising access across all five layers, while minimising dependence on any single provider. Four recommendations follow from this posture.

- First, India should use its membership of Pax Silica, the US-led chip supply chain grouping it joined in Feb, to negotiate guaranteed computing capacity in specific volumes, and on predictable terms. This grouping didn't exist when the last round of compute rationing regime was imagined. Membership by itself is no insurance.
- Second, India should maintain model pluralism as a deliberate strategy. American models can be used where they are best, Chinese open-source models where they are useful, and Indian models such as Sarvam's where dependence on a foreign provider is unacceptable. India should also stay out of any coalition that restricts the release of open-source models, since such restrictions would shrink its choices.
- Third, the India AI Mission should help accelerate the domestic design of AI inference chips. A growing share of AI progress now comes after a model is trained, through refinement and letting it reason longer when answering a query (also known as inference-time scaling). This shifts demand towards inference, where Nvidia's lead is weakest.

The method of 'model distillation' also means smaller models can now handle much of what Indian public services need, from translation to speech recognition. GOI can commit to buying inference chips designed or co-designed by Indian firms for its own compute pool.

- Finally, India should build credible checks on who uses its data centres, and for what purpose. If India attracts large data centres, it will face the questions now being asked of Singapore and Malaysia. Verification built *suo motu*, before Washington demands it, is easier to implement.

While the scandal will pass, demands for chip controls will resurface. What we shouldn't forget is that India's primary economic play in AI is at the applications layer. Policy should be oriented towards accelerating the diffusion of AI in the Indian industry, military, and public services.

The writer works on technology geopolitics at Takshashila Institution and has co-authored When the Chips Are Down: A Deep Dive into a Global Crisis (2023). Views are personal

Who Deserves Free Rations When Poverty Declines?

60mn Indian households spend more than they earn. But the strongest case for food assistance lies among economically vulnerable families struggling to meet everyday needs

Rajesh Shukla

When you don't know whether your earnings will cover essential expenses like food, transport, education and healthcare, GDP growth rates and poverty estimates become immaterial. Millions of Indian households know that feeling. Our surveys show that, in 2022-23, routine expenditure exceeded annual income for every fifth household (19.8%) in the country, which isn't as bad as 30.4% recorded in 2020-21, but far worse than 11.3% observed in 2015-16.

Does it mean all of those roughly 60mn households in 2022-23 were financially distressed? No. Some might have been drawing upon savings, managing seasonal earnings or temporarily borrowing against future income. So, it becomes important to find out which households lack sufficient economic resources to manage such imbalances, because this data can provide a legitimate basis for govt assistance.

That isn't easy because a financially pressured household can be part of any occupational category. Geographically, 44% are in UP, Bihar and MP. Sectorally, 40% of non-agricultural labour households spend more than they earn, compared with nearly 30% agricultural labour households. There are twice as many rural households in this category as urban households. What might surprise you is that one-third of all financially pressured households are part of the regular salaried class. That means expenditure income imbalances extend beyond casual employment.

Bottom 40% matters | So, which households should be considered financially "distressed" rather than "pressured"? For that, we have to look at per capita routine expenditure. Our 2022-23 survey microdata shows that, among the bottom 40% of households, median monthly income was approximately ₹11,800, against routine expenditure of ₹10,500. Yet, nearly 29% of these households – altogether some 34mn – spent more than they earned. And they made up almost six of every ten financially pressured households.

Unlike better-off households with a temporary expenditure-income imbalance, these families merit particular attention because their low expenditure levels, combined with insufficient current income, suggest limited capacity to finance essential needs.

This does not establish that every household in the bottom 40% is financially distressed, nor that all households above are secure. But it identifies a more relevant population for examining the need for social protection.

Consider a construction worker who can just about make ends meet when there's work, but faces several jobless weeks, or a small trader whose sales fluctuate sharply, or an agricultural household that earns around harvest a couple of times in a year. Even salaried households can experience pressure when one income supports several dependents, or housing, schooling and healthcare absorb a large chunk of earnings. These examples show that income adequacy, earnings regularity and the ability to finance unavoidable expenditure are related but distinct dimensions of household vulnerability.

Household category	Spending more than income (% of households)
All India	**19.8%**
Rural households	24.8%
Urban households	**11.2%**
Non-agricultural labour	40.2%
Agricultural labour	**29.5%**
Self-employed, agriculture	18.7%
Regular salaried	**17.6%**
Self-employed, non-agriculture	12.6%

Source: PRICE 360° household microdata, 2022-23

Economics of free rations | As poverty levels decline, questions naturally arise about India's large-scale foodgrain assistance, eligibility for it and number of beneficiaries. These are legitimate questions, given the fiscal resources involved. But the question we should be asking is, what economic vulnerability is food assistance intended to address?

Hunger, and food, cannot be put off. When earnings weaken, families can't simply stop feeding their children. Free cereals reduce the cash required for basic consumption, potentially releasing scarce resources for vegetables, pulses, transport, education and healthcare. Their economic value may, therefore, extend beyond conventional poverty relief by providing a predictable in-kind benefit when cash income is uncertain.

And the strongest case for such assistance lies among households with limited resources and weak financial buffers, rather than everyone whose expenditure temporarily exceeds income. The bottom 40% is a sizeable group where low expenditure and household budget pressure coincide. That's why expenditure adequacy and financial vulnerability deserve consideration alongside conventional poverty measures when evaluating coverage and eligibility.

Making protection effective | The policy challenge is not to expand or reduce food subsidy coverage, but to ensure that public resources protect households whose essential consumption is most vulnerable to inadequate or uncertain earnings. This requires identifying those who are economically vulnerable, qualify under existing eligibility rules, and whose household well-being increases with assistance.

A better evaluation would examine whether foodgrain support reduces distress borrowing, protects nutritional consumption and helps families maintain essential expenditure during income interruptions. Such evidence could inform future targeting without assuming that all expenditure-income imbalances represent hardship.

Free foodgrains cannot be a substitute for productive employment, adequate wages or stronger household savings, nor can they resolve the wider costs of healthcare and education. But for vulnerable families, predictable food assistance can protect part of the household budget when cash income is uncertain. The case for free foodgrains should therefore rest neither on poverty counts alone nor on the total number of households spending more than they earn. It should rest on identifying those whose limited resources make essential consumption genuinely vulnerable, and ensuring that assistance reaches them effectively.

The writer is MD & CEO of a non-profit research centre

Calvin & Hobbes

Sacred*space*

Technology is nothing. What's important is that you have a faith in people, that they're basically good and smart, and if you give them tools, they'll do wonderful things with them.

Steve Jobs

A Handwritten Letter Is A Mirror Of The Soul

Anup Taneja

In an era dominated by pixels and keyboards, people often dismiss putting pen to paper as a relic of the past. Yet, writing with a fountain pen offers profound cognitive and emotional benefits that digital devices cannot replicate. More than a communication tool, the fountain pen slows us down, connects our thoughts directly to our hands, and fosters human intimacy. It transforms writing from a detached mechanical chore into a deeply personal act of creation.

The fountain pen's primary advantage over a digital screen lies in the neurological connection between hand and brain. Typing is a highly repetitive, uniform action. Pressing the letter 'A' feels the same as pressing the letter 'Z'. In contrast, fluidly shaping cursive characters with a fountain pen engages complex motor pathways, which improves focus and memory retention. Author Graham Greene highlighted this cognitive intimacy when he remarked: "My two fingers on a typewriter have never connected with my brain. My hand on a pen does. A fountain pen, of course."

Bypassing mechanical interfaces, the fountain pen serves as a direct conduit for human thought. Digital devices also trap us in a cycle of constant correction and endless distractions. When typing on a laptop or mobile phone, the ease of hitting backspace encourages frantic, fragmented thinking. The flowing ink of a fountain pen, however, demands a deliberate mental slowdown. Because ink is permanent, a writer must think through a sentence entirely before committing it to the page. This practice cultivates deep patience and structural clarity. It turns a blank notebook into a distraction-free sanctuary.

Beyond personal cognitive benefits, writing with a pen builds exceptionally strong emotional bonds between people. Digital texts are mass-produced, instantaneous, and easy to discard. A handwritten letter, conversely, is a physical artefact that clearly shows time invested.

Byron captured this intimate sentiment beautifully, writing: "A handwritten letter is a mirror of the soul."

When you read someone's unique handwriting, you see their personality, their mood, and the raw, unedited vulnerability of their real-time choices. For a creative writer, a pen is not just a tool; it is an active collaborator that directly shapes the depth, complexity, and flow of a story.

Finally, choosing a fountain pen is a deliberate rejection of modern throwaway culture, an embrace of genuine human presence. While laptops and phones excel at speed and efficiency, they strip away the rich texture, raw emotion, and distinct individuality of human communication. A text message or an email is fleeting, safely confined to a digital cloud and easily deleted with a swipe.

In contrast, a fountain pen anchors our thoughts to the material world, transforming ephemeral impulses into a permanent, physical legacy. By linking the mind, hand, and heart, the fountain pen ensures that our stories and relationships remain deeply felt, tangible, and built to endure across generations. As Virginia Woolf beautifully observed in a letter to a friend: "Ink is a great bond between people."

The writer is senior academic fellow, ICHR

THE SPEAKING TREE

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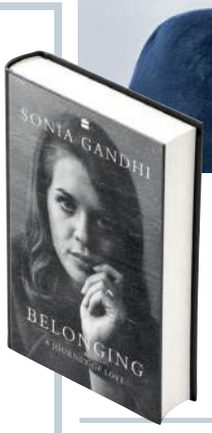
She came for love. Life took her into politics

Released on Tuesday, Sonia Gandhi's autobiography, **'Belonging: A Journey of Love'**, traces her passage from an Italian village to the centre of Indian politics, through a Cambridge romance, family tragedies and responsibilities she had fiercely resisted



GROWING UP IN ITALY

Her childhood, centred on Sangano, a small Italian village, unfolds through fragrant soups, forest walks with her grandfather, Christmas preparations and games in a friend's castle. Her mother stitched dresses and filled the house with music; her father's affection came with frightening discipline. Taking three walnuts without permission brought a punishment she never forgot. There were gentler excitements too: ice creams in the village square, chocolate and the dazzling arrival of Sophia Loren. Leaving for Orbassano broke her heart. For weeks, she waved at the train to Sangano, finding comfort in an imaginary journey back to the world she loved.

'To this day I cherish that period as the most idyllic of my childhood'

ORBASSANO: A BIGGER HOME, A STRICTER WORLD

Orbassano brought a spacious new home, separate bedrooms and fashionable furniture. But at 10, she entered a convent boarding school in nearby Giaveno, exchanging village freedom for prayers, silence and strict routines. During the 1957 Asian flu pandemic, she developed pneumonia and, she writes, lifelong asthma. She stayed until 14, then travelled daily to a foreign-language institute in Turin. Encouraging teachers, discussions, cafés and clothes shops opened up a freer world. Languages became her route beyond home and familiar surroundings, eventually taking her to England to study English.

'The strictness of the nuns left me with a permanent distaste for enforced regimentation on children, curbing their free-spiritedness'

CAMBRIDGE: COLD WEATHER, STRANGE FOOD

Cambridge meant homesickness, unfamiliar manners and meals she could barely swallow. Staying with a family chosen by her English school, she threw breakfasts out of the window for neighbourhood cats; tinned spaghetti on toast made supper another ordeal. A bicycle helped her find her way around, despite traffic moving on the unfamiliar side. A delicatessen supplied ham, cheese and bread, while the Greek-owned Varsity restaurant offered reassuringly familiar meals. Gradually, the city opened up through friends, cafés and outings. Even English food found redemption in scones, strawberry jam and clotted cream.

'Everything was alien to me: the language, the people, and most of all the food'

MEETING RAJIV

At the Varsity restaurant, a quiet, handsome young man caught her eye. A mutual friend introduced them, and their attraction was immediate. Rajiv's gentleness, humour and reassuring presence transformed her experience of England. They shared music, films, parties and excursions in his battered Volkswagen. Money was tight: he sold ice cream, picked strawberries and worked bakery shifts, sometimes skipping meals. Her father's objections and a prolonged separation tested the relationship, sustained by frequent letters. Eventually, he allowed her to visit India. She arrived in Jan 1968; the couple married the following month.

'I knew, that very instant— it was un colpo di fulmine, a bolt of lightning'

FINDING A HOME WITH INDIRA

Marriage brought her into an unfamiliar household, with formal routines, numerous staff and a formidable mother-in-law. Food, language, clothes and customs required adjustment. Indira's kindness helped, but intimacy developed gradually: Sonia initially could not bring herself to address another woman as "Mummy". The relationship deepened through shared meals, journeys and household responsibilities. Rahul and Priyanka's births created new bonds, with Indira an affectionate grandmother. For years, Rajiv's flying career allowed them a contented family life. Politics surrounded the household, but Sonia's attachment to India grew first through the people she loved.

'My mother-in-law had been the centre of our universe'

THE PRIVATE WORLD BEGINS TO BREAK

The Emergency brought politics painfully into family life. She acknowledges coercive sterilisation and destructive slum clearances, describing Rajiv's attempts to pass complaints to his mother and her reluctance to hear them. Her account nevertheless presents Indira as besieged and increasingly troubled by excesses. Defeat in 1977 displaced the family; victory brought them back in 1980. Then Sanjay died in a plane crash. Pressure mounted on Rajiv to enter politics. Sonia resisted fiercely, fearing the loss of their ordinary life. She eventually accepted his decision, but describes it as a surrender after months of arguments.

'I fought with him (Rajiv) for almost a year'

1984: THE FEAR BECOMES REAL

After Operation Blue Star, danger shadowed the family. When Indira was shot on Oct 31, 1984, Sonia rushed with her to hospital. Grief turned to panic when Rajiv said he had been asked to become Prime Minister. She begged him to refuse, convinced he too would be killed, but he accepted. The anti-Sikh riots following Indira's assassination remain a painful part of her account: she acknowledges failed governance and complicity by some people in authority, while defending Rajiv against authorising violence. Later, she questions whether her own trauma had prevented her from comprehending the victims' suffering.

'I knew, I knew it then in my heart: Rajiv's path would lead to the same end'

RAJIV AS PRIME MINISTER

Public life consumed their time and privacy. She travelled with Rajiv, witnessed deprivation across India and watched their children grow up under security restrictions. Her account of his premiership is also an emphatic defence. On Bofors, she acknowledges that agents were involved despite his assurances, but insists he was innocent of corruption. She recalls challenging him over Shah Bano before defending his compromise. On Ayodhya, she portrays him as seeking a negotiated settlement. Political attacks and fractured friendships deepened their isolation; she repeatedly returns to his determination to work despite the pressure.

'Rajiv was accused of being the one thing he could never be: corrupt'

1991: CHILDREN BECOME HER PROTECTORS

Priyanka brought the news that Rajiv was dead. Sonia describes collapsing into her daughter's arms, then enduring the journey to collect his remains and the public rituals of mourning. Her memories are fragmented; some details came back only through others. Rahul and Priyanka began shielding her from distressing reports and photographs. She revisits security failures and questions about the assassination investigation, but the emotional centre is her shattered family. When her sister urged her to return to Italy, she refused: India was her home and her children's country.

'I had become the child to be protected, they the parents whose care for their mother brought them to shield her'

THE SIKH GUARDS INDIRA RETAINED: After Blue Star, Indira refused to replace Sikh guards on principle, even while warning Sonia to restrict the children's movements.

THE FUNERAL INDIRA DID NOT WANT: Indira wanted her body left in a Himalayan crevasse, without a conventional funeral. Rajiv could not comply; scattering her ashes over the mountains became his compromise.

THE BABY THEY LOST: Their first child, a boy, was born prematurely on Jan 18, 1969, and died soon afterwards. Sonia describes their heartbreak and her refusal to have his body released into a river. Rajiv and Sanjay instead buried him beneath a flowering pink bougainvillea bush at the family's Mehrauli farm. On subsequent visits, the couple would stop there with a flower.

THE PAINFUL CALL TO KARUNANIDHI: Approaching the DMK for an alliance in 2004 revived memories of what she describes as its support for the LTTE. She recalls trembling before calling Karunanidhi, wondering whether joining hands would betray Rajiv.

PRANAB'S HINT: She recalls Pranab Mukherjee suggesting a change at the top around 2010. She understood it as a hint of his prime ministerial ambitions and gently changed the subject.

THE RELUCTANT POLITICIAN STEPS FORWARD

For years, she resisted appeals to enter active politics. Congress's decline, factional splits and the BJP's rise gradually made withdrawal feel like an abandonment of Rajiv and Indira's commitments. Private readings of the Bhagavad Gita helped her resolve the struggle between fear and duty. She began campaigning and took over Congress in 1998. Political education came quickly: a failed attempt to assemble a majority in 1999 exposed misplaced trust in assurances from prospective allies. An internal challenge over her foreign birth brought another crisis. She resigned, then returned under pressure from workers.

'Where my duty lay was clear to me; what that implied was the terrifying part'

Photos: INC, TOI Archives, Getty Images

2004: THE OFFICE SHE WOULD NOT ACCEPT

After the election victory, colleagues and allies assumed she would become Prime Minister. She says she had privately decided otherwise months earlier, but concealed that intention to prevent a leadership struggle. Pressure briefly overwhelmed her: at one meeting she mumbled assent, alarming her children. She reconsidered, fearing both the personal consequences and a destabilising campaign over her foreign birth. She rejects the claim that President Abdul Kalam blocked her appointment. Her final refusal brought emotional protests from colleagues. She chose Manmohan Singh, whose experience, integrity and independence from party factions reassured her.

'It wasn't a Prime Minister's post that I'd lost — I never wanted it anyway'

MANMOHAN'S GOVT, SONIA'S PARTY

She describes a division of responsibility built on trust: Singh ran the govt, while she managed Congress and its alliances. Differences were discussed frankly. She rejects claims that she examined PMO files or controlled administrative appointments. Her own policy role centred on the National Advisory Council, which pressed for welfare legislation covering information, employment, food and other rights. She presents economic growth and social protection as complementary commitments. The 2009 re-election vindicated that approach in her eyes. Behind the formal arrangements, she describes heavy workloads and precious weekends with her family.

'...The government under Dr Manmohan Singh, and the party under me'

ILLNESS BEHIND THE PUBLIC LIFE

In 2010, she underwent surgery for suspected breast cancer near Milan. A pancreatic growth detected the following year brought another operation, in Rotterdam. She feared cancer had spread and wondered whether she would survive or need chemotherapy. Before leaving, she wrote instructions for Rahul and Priyanka in case things went wrong. The pancreatic growth proved precancerous. Her children remained close; Priyanka slept on the hospital floor for more than a week. Alongside fear and relief runs her resentment that public office might deny her privacy even in illness.

'Would I come through it? Would I need to undergo chemotherapy?'

DEFEAT, RAHUL AND AN UNFINISHED BATTLE

She acknowledges fatigue and complacency in the UPA's final years, while blaming hostile campaigns for overshadowing its achievements. Defeats in 2014 and 2019 brought renewed struggles. Rahul resigned as Congress president; she reluctantly returned until Mallikarjun Kharge's election in 2022. Her account of Rahul's yatras combines political hope with a mother's anxiety over his safety. She sees the 2024 election as a reprieve for constitutional democracy, while sharply criticising the Modi govt's conduct. The memoir closes with love for India intact, but an admission that her political mission remains unfulfilled.

'Although I tried my best, I didn't succeed in beating back the forces I'd set out to fight'

From gene therapy to transplants, crowdfunding is helping families in the state bridge critical healthcare gaps through collective generosity, writes **Preetu Nair**

₹50 crore to treat 3 toddlers. Keralam chips in

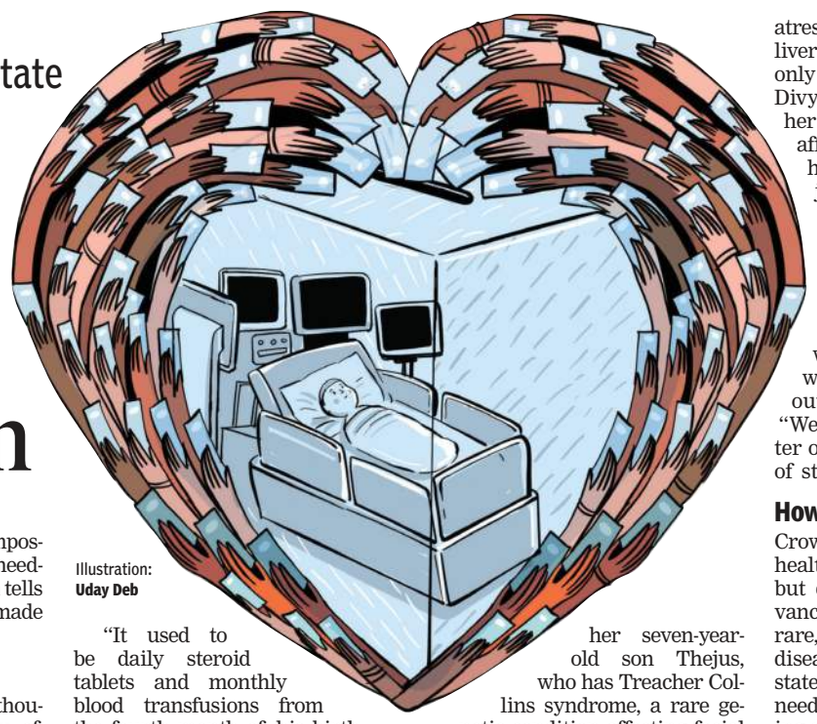


Illustration: **Uday Deb**

It has been a little over two weeks since a village in Keralam's Kozhikode rallied around three toddlers with a rare genetic disorder. Rs 50 crore is needed for their treatment; already, more than Rs 7 crore has poured in.

The triplets — David Magnus Arun, Ethan Moses Arun and Oliver Jonah Arun, aged one year and eight months — have spinal muscular atrophy (SMA) Type 2. For their middle-class parents, the cost of treatment seemed insurmountable. The family and its well-wishers initially approached friends and acquaintances. When they realised their personal networks would not be enough, they launched a crowdfunding drive to help the children access gene therapy.

Arun PD, the kids' father, quit his private-sector job to care for the premature triplets; his wife works at a private firm. The couple was devastated when they learnt the cost of treatment, but the response to the campaign has given them hope of reaching the target.

"On a personal level, it is impossible for us to raise the money needed to save our children," Arun tells **TOI**. "But crowdfunding has made this task feel achievable."

Power Of Many

The triplets' family is among thousands across Keralam, many of them financially weak, who have turned to crowdfunding after they were confronted by serious illness. Contributions from neighbours, villagers, local organisations and strangers have helped several families meet treatment costs.

For Baasim's family, crowdfunding helped raise Rs 45 lakh for a bone marrow transplant. Now 14, Baasim has Diamond-Blackfan anaemia (DBA), a rare inherited bone marrow failure disorder. His haemoglobin level would fall as low as 3g/dL, against a normal range of 13.5 to 17.5g/dL for males. His transplant was particularly complex, with a high risk of rejection.

"It used to be daily steroid tablets and monthly blood transfusions from the fourth month of his birth till the age of 12. Now, my son can live a normal life," says Saneera Hans, Baasim's mother, a resident of Ambalapuzha. "He is now able to attend regular school and plays football. His father was the donor, yet when the doctors advised us to decide on the transplant before he turned 12, we were stressed. My husband had just returned home as he lost his job in the Gulf, and my son's health started deteriorating fast. The village got together to raise funds through crowdfunding, which facilitated the transplant in less than a month."

Sharanya SS, a resident of Nedumangad, hopes to raise funds for her seven-year-old son Thejus, who has Treacher Collins syndrome, a rare genetic condition affecting facial development, hearing and speech. He will need three facial reconstruction surgeries after turning 10 to perhaps lead a more normal life.

The family has used crowdfunding before. When Thejus was five, Sharanya, a homemaker, and her husband, an autorickshaw driver, raised Rs 8.5 lakh for specialised bone-conduction hearing aids. The devices bypass his closed ear canals and transmit sound to the inner ear. "For ordinary people like us, crowdfunding brings hope," Sharanya says.

Four-year-old Diya S of Vithura in Thiruvananthapuram district was diagnosed with biliary atresia, a rare and life-threatening liver disease. A transplant was the only way to save her. Her mother, Divya, was ready to donate part of her liver, but the family could not afford the surgery. "We would have lost her when she was just six months old," she says. "She needed an urgent liver transplant, which cost Rs 25 lakh at a private hospital. We had no money."

The family turned to crowdfunding. "The money was credited to our account within four days of putting out the appeal," Divya says. "We managed to save our daughter only because of the kindness of strangers."

How Crowdfunding Works

Crowdfunding helps fill gaps in a health system that serves many but does not always provide advanced treatment for chronic, rare, genetic and life-threatening diseases at govt hospitals. The state govt's We Care project assists needy people not covered by existing schemes, while other schemes support rare-disease treatment. Their limitations, however, can leave a funding gap.

Neighbours and villagers are often joined by local organisations, expats and people with no connection to the patient. Appeals circulate on social media, news reports, community groups and online fundraising platforms. NGOs involved in crowdfunding say they receive three to four genuine medical cases a month, the amounts sought ranging from a few thousand rupees to even crores.

But responses vary widely. Nishanth Unni, who's been trying to raise Rs 2 lakh for a 43-year-old neighbour's treatment, says crowdfunding moves much slower when the patient is an adult. "People respond much faster when it's a child," he says. After a month and a half, his neighbour has managed to raise only Rs 60,000.

'Support On Every Front'

Manya Sharma, managing partner at Milaap, a crowdfunding platform that's helped families in Keralam, says fundraising can meet expenses extending beyond hospital admission.

"When a family receives a critical diagnosis, they need support on every front, and crowdfunding is one more layer of that support," Sharma says. "Insurance and govt schemes give families a vital foundation, and crowdfunding builds on top of it, helping families meet the wider needs of a long treatment journey. The impact is often felt most after discharge. Recovery brings recurring medicines, diagnostics, travel to treatment centres and months without an earning member. Fundraising helps families through that whole stretch."

> **"The money was credited to our account within four days. We managed to save our daughter only because of the kindness of strangers**
>
> —**DIVYA** | RAISED ₹25 LAKH FOR HER DAUGHTER'S TREATMENT

Transparency is key, say those involved in crowdfunding. Donors should be able to understand a patient's medical and financial condition, see how contributions are used and assess their impact. Campaign organisers — family members, friends, colleagues, elected representatives and prominent community members — play a crucial role.

"Almost 75% to 80% of crowdfunding in Keralam is for medical causes," says Nikhil Kumar, member, Kripa Foundation, an NGO that helps with crowdfunding. "But people here also fund education, pets and animal welfare, and build houses for the poor." People in Keralam have pooled money to support victims of the 2018 floods, rebuild homes after the Wayanad landslide, protect livelihoods and assist vulnerable communities.

A Few Sour Notes

Even as many crowdfunding stories have happy endings, some have sparked controversy. In 2020, a 22-year-old Kannur woman's campaign for her mother's liver transplant drew scrutiny after donations reached Rs 1.2 crore, against the target of Rs 20 lakh. The dispute concerned how the surplus should be handled.

In 2021, Kerala High Court emphasised the need for govt oversight, asking, "Where's the money going? From where is the money coming? Is there any control or monitoring by the state over this collection of money?" The court clarified that it was not interdicting crowdfunding.

"It is essential to develop legislation or control mechanisms," says Lekha D Bhat, assistant professor, department of epidemiology and public health, Central University of Tamil Nadu, who works on medical crowdfunding in India.

PUBLIC NOTICE

Date: 11.11.2026

PUBLIC NOTICE TO HOLDERS OF FIXED DEPOSITS WITH INDUSIND BANK LIMITED BOOKED THROUGH PAYTM PAYMENTS BANK LIMITED

This notice is issued jointly by **Paytm Payments Bank Limited** (undergoing winding up) ("**PPBL**"), acting through its Official Liquidator, Mr. Girikumar M. Nair, and IndusInd Bank Limited ("**IBL**") for the information of all customers whose fixed deposits ("**FDs**") were booked with IBL through PPBL, whether by auto-sweep from their PPBL account or on their own instructions ("**FD Holders**").

1. The Reserve Bank of India cancelled PPBL's banking licence on April 24, 2026, and the Hon'ble Delhi High Court ordered the winding up of PPBL by its order dated July 8, 2026. PPBL acted only as IBL's business correspondent. Your FDs are held in the books of IBL and do not form part of PPBL's assets.
2. IBL remains liable to pay the principal, accrued interest and overdue interest (if any) on each FD, and will make all payments directly to FD Holders.
3. **FD Holders with active FDs may contact IBL through the following: Customer Care number - 1860 267 7777; E-mail: reachus@indusind.com; Closest IndusInd Bank Branch; or Website. https://www.indusind.bank.in/in/en/personal/deposits/servicing-to-paytm-customers.html IBL will independently verify your KYC details (including through the CKYC Registry, with your consent) and reconcile your FD records with KYC details shared by PPBL before releasing payment.**
4. Once verification is complete, IBL will credit the FD maturity proceeds to your bank account as supplied by you to IBL, or through any other mode permitted by law.
5. If your FD has not yet matured, you may continue it until its maturity date.
6. If IBL has already paid your FD proceeds into your PPBL account, such amounts will be paid in accordance with the process followed for the winding up proceedings of PPBL depending on the date of payment of amounts by IBL to PPBL.

All payments are subject to KYC Verification, any freezing order or direction of a court, law enforcement agency or other authority.

All queries and complaints relating to FDs should be addressed to IBL through the contact details provided in Paragraph 3 above. The above contact details are also displayed on PPBL's website at **https://www.paytm.bank.in/.**

Official Liquidator
Paytm Payments Bank Ltd
(In Winding up)

Chief Administrative Officer
IndusInd Bank Ltd.

TIRUMALA TIRUPATI DEVASTHANAMS:TIRUPATI
VIGILANCE & SECURITY DEPARTMENT

"E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE" Date:06-11-2026

"E-Tender 2 nd call invited for the work of Supply, Installation, Testing and Commissioning of CCTV Cameras, erection of poles and associated accessories for the newly constructed TTD Paediatric Super Specialty Hospital, Tirupati, including Three (03) years of Comprehensive On-site Warranty and Five (05) years of Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract (CAMC)". The tender document will be available for download from **11.11.2026 at 11.00 AM.** The last date and time for submission of bids is **07.12.2026 at 05.00 PM.** The pre-bid meeting will be held on **18.11.2026 at 11.00 AM.** For further details, visit www.tirumala.org or tender.apeprocurement.gov.in to view and download the Tender Document. For enquiries, contact 0877-2264279 between 10:30 AM and 05:00 PM on working days.

TTD-40021(31)/1/2026 - PRO SEC (Adv. No. 235). Date - 10.11.2026 **Executive Officer**

CHANDIGARH INSTITUTE FOR TRANSFORMATION
Appointments

CORRIGENDUM

The TORs for the posts of Team Leader, Sector Expert I and Sector Expert II, published on October 17, 2026, have been updated. The changes in experience are notified on the website: **https:/www.chandigarh.gov.in/information/public-notices.** The last date of submission of forms is now November, 20th, 2026.

UJVN Ltd.
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprises)
H.Q:- "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. ROAD, Dehradun-248006.
Phone :- 0135-2763808 & Fax : 0135-2763508
CIN No. - U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

RO No. 1069 **Date: 09.11.2026**

Short Term Tender Notice

Office of the Executive Engineer (Generation), Ramganga Power Station, Kalagarh (Pauri-Garhwal) invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:

T.No.: 19/EE(Gen.)/Klg/2026-27

Name of work/Supply: In-situ restoration of the damaged top overhang portion of the stator winding and repair of stator core end packets of Generator Unit No. 2 (66 MW).

Estimated cost : Rs. 13,50,000.00 (GST extra)

Date of Availability of bid document on website : 10.11.2026

Last date for submission of tender : 24.11.2026 up to 11:00 Hrs

For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website **"www.ujvnl.com"**

Executive Engineer (Gen.)

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

NEW DELHI MUNICIPAL COUNCIL
COMMERCIAL DEPARTMENT
PALIKA KENDRA : NEW DELHI

PUBLIC NOTICE

One-Time Amnesty Scheme for Waiver of Late Payment Surcharge (LPSC) for Domestic and Dhobi Ghat Water Consumers in NDMC Area -2026

The New Delhi Municipal Council hereby notifies a One-Time Amnesty Scheme for waiver of Late Payment Surcharge (LPSC) as per details given below:-

100% LPSC WAIVER	70% LPSC WAIVER
If payment made by 31.12.2026	If payment made by 01.01.2027 - 31.03.2027

- Waiver will be applicable only on LPSC accumulated till April, 2026 billing cycle.
- LPSC waiver shall be granted only after full payment of the Principal amount and current dues.
- The scheme is strictly time-bound and no benefit shall be available after the expiry of the notified period.
- This scheme is valid only for the Domestic and Dhobi Ghat consumers of NDMC.

To avail the benefit, consumer shall approach:

Citizen Facilitation Centre (CFC), Ground Floor, S.B.S. Place, Gole Market, New Delhi- 110001.

Sd/-
Director (Commercial)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No-DRM/C/Agra/Catg./PBCO/e-auction/26 **Date : 06.11.2026**

E-Auction Notice

On behalf of the President of India, The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager-North Central Railway, Agra invites E-Auction for 08 Premium Brand Catering Outlet at Platform of various Railway Stations over Agra Division for a period of Five years.

Category	Auction Catalogue No.	Name of Station	Category	Station Code	Total No. of Stalls
Premium Brand Catering Outlet (PBCO)	CATG-AGRA-PBCO	Agra Cantt	A-1	AGC	03
		Mathura Jn.	A-1	MTJ	05

Auction Starting Time : Date 25.11.2026 Time 12:00 Hrs.

Note :- Prospective bidders are requested to visit e-Auction Leasing Module on IREPS website **(www.ireps.gov.in)** for more details. The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue number. **2554/26 (AS)**

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONCR

Government of Punjab
State Health Agency, Punjab
Department of Health and Family Welfare
BSNL Circle Office, 4th Floor, Sector-34, Chandigarh
Visit us at: www.sha.punjab.gov.in, E-mail: ceo.sha.pb@punjab.gov.in

No. SHA/Admin/2026 **Date:**

Notice Inviting Tender
FOR HIRING OF CONCURRENT AUDIT AGENCY
(Medical Audit, Field Investigation and Verification)

Online Competitive bids are invited from eligible bidders for hiring of concurrent Audit Agency (Medical Audit, Field Investigation and Verification) at State Health Agency, Punjab.

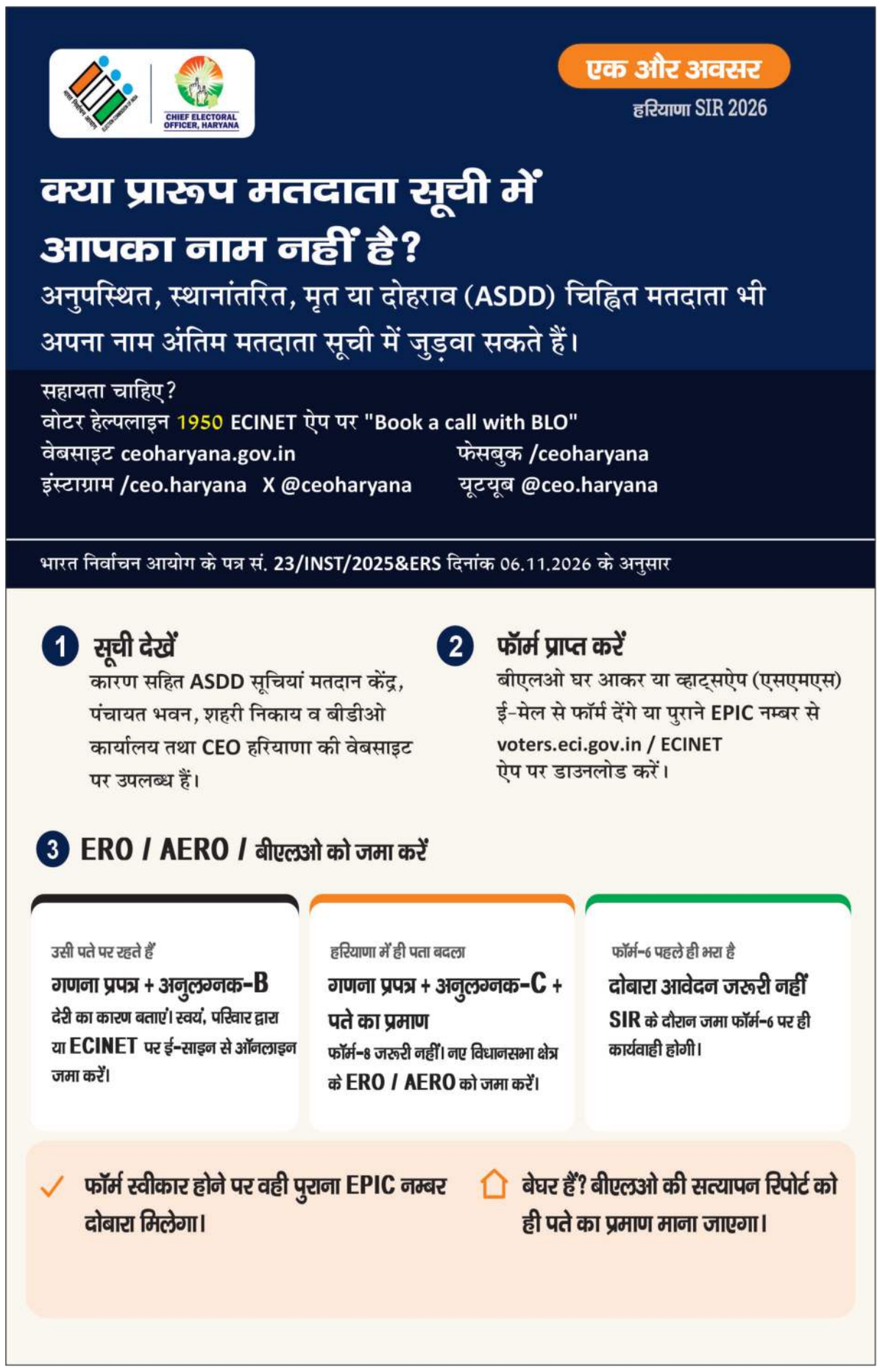
The Tender Document shall be available on the website/ e-tender portal eproc.punjab.gov.in with effect from 11.11.2026. Bidders shall submit their Bids on this website/ e-tender portal as per the guidelines specified in the Tender Document. It shall be the responsibility of the Bidders to regularly check the website/ e-tender portal for any notice/ addenda issued in this regard.

All correspondence/ communications on the Tender Document should be made at the above address and at email id: shapunjab.tender25@gmail.com

Any corrigendum/addendum issued in connection with the tender shall be uploaded on the e-Procurement Portal and the official website of SHA Punjab (shapunjab.gov.in).

Sd/-
Chief Executive Officer
State Health Agency, Punjab

DPR/Pb.:1957/12/2026-27/16936



Department of Consumer Affairs
Bureau of Indian Standards
National Standards Body of India

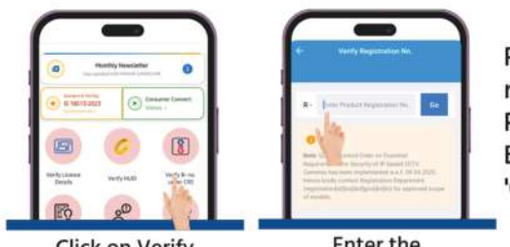
BRAND CHECK
FEATURES CHECK
SAFETY ???

You Must Check
BIS MARK

CBC 08103/13/0008/2627

How to verify BIS Quality Mark?

Scan to Download BIS CARE APP
Google Play App Store



Click on Verify R-Number
Enter the Registration Number

Register complaints regarding safety of Product of or misuse of BIS marks by using 'Complaints' feature.

Follow us on: @Indianstandards

ऑफिस ऑफ़ इन्शुरन्स आम्बड्समैन
OFFICE OF THE INSURANCE OMBUDSMAN

CIO
काउन्सिल फॉर इन्शुरन्स आम्बड्समैन
Council for Insurance Ombudsmen

11TH NOVEMBER
INSURANCE OMBUDSMAN DAY

Now you can lodge your complaint online from the comfort of your home:
https://cioins.co.in/complaint/online

INSURANCE OMBUDSMAN

There are 18 Insurance Ombudsman across the country to listen to your unresolved grievances.

Every insurance company operating in India (Life, General & Health) has a well organized Grievance Redressal System. If you have any grievance against your insurer/ insurance broker related to your insurance policy, first approach your insurer. If you are not satisfied, then you may contact Office of the Insurance Ombudsman for redressal of your grievance in an impartial manner and without any cost.

Your complaint:*

- Should pertain to Life Insurance, General Insurance or Health Insurance policies issued by insurance companies in India.
- Should pertain to personal lines of insurance, group insurance policies or personal line policies issued to sole proprietor firms and micro enterprises.
- Can be made by the policy-holder himself/herself or by his/her legal heir or assignees or nominees as recorded in policy.
- Must be related to the grievance that has been rejected entirely or partially by the insurance company.
- Must be made within one year from the date of rejection by the insurance company.
- Cannot be on a matter that is or has been under litigation in any other forum.

*Conditions apply

For more information, please visit *www.cioins.co.in*

Office of Insurance Ombudsman / Council for Insurance Ombudsmen does not involve directly or through any representative in selling any insurance policy nor does it announce any bonus for insurance policies, nor does it make any kind of payment. Beware of fraudsters impersonating as employees of Bima Lokpal / CIO / ECOI / GBIC.

E-mail ids of 18 offices of Insurance Ombudsman are as follows:-

Ahmedabad: oio.ahmedabad@cioins.co.in
Bengaluru: oio.bengaluru@cioins.co.in
Bhopal: oio.bhopal@cioins.co.in
Bhubaneswar: oio.bhubaneswar@cioins.co.in
Chandigarh: oio.chandigarh@cioins.co.in
Chennai: oio.chennai@cioins.co.in
Delhi: oio.delhi@cioins.co.in
Guwahati: oio.guwahati@cioins.co.in
Hyderabad: oio.hyderabad@cioins.co.in
Jaipur: oio.jaipur@cioins.co.in
Kochi: oio.ernakulam@cioins.co.in
Kolkata: oio.kolkata@cioins.co.in
Lucknow: oio.lucknow@cioins.co.in
Mumbai: oio.mumbai@cioins.co.in
Noida: oio.noida@cioins.co.in
Patna: oio.patna@cioins.co.in
Pune: oio.pune@cioins.co.in
Thane : oio.thane@cioins.co.in

Scan **QR**

Issued in public interest

CBC 15227/13/0003/2627

TIMES NATION

* THE TIMES OF INDIA, NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 11, 2026

BUDDHADEB BHATTACHARJEE WAS A 'GOOD MAN' IN 'BAD PARTY', SAYS SUVENDU ADHIKARI

DAYS AFTER TALKS WITH NC REBELS, FAROOQ MOOTS ADVISORY GROUPS FOR MINISTERS

YOU SAID IT

Buxa tigress now 'Bhutan-bound'

The tigress from Bengal's Buxa that had escaped to Assam before being brought back was moving towards Bhutan, having escaped her enclosure Sunday. While the tigress is moving slowly, she is using the same route that tigers from Bhutan take, moving to and from Buxa. The tigress was still within Buxa tiger reserve limits Monday. While three kunki elephants from the reserve were already engaged, three more were brought in. A team of foresters, dhakis, cracker teams have also been deployed along the border. TNN

HC: Booze find no cause to seize car

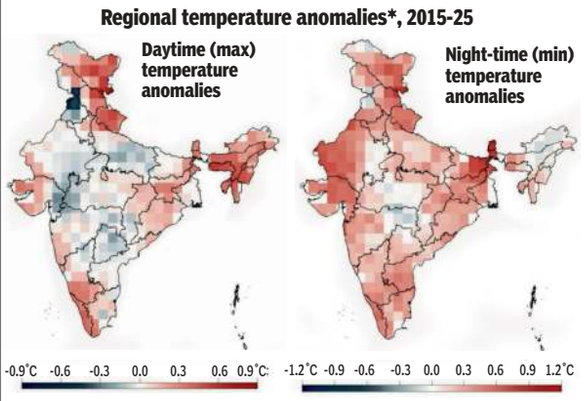
Odisha HC has ruled that mere recovery of liquor from a vehicle cannot justify its confiscation, directing authorities to release a seized car to its owner. Justice Sashikanta Mishra said excise authorities must independently establish its use in an alleged offence. The case involved Umesh Patra's vehicle, from which 68 bottles of non-duty-paid Indian-made foreign liquor were recovered in Mayurbhanj in April 2025. Patra claimed the bags belonged to a co-passenger who had requested a lift, saying they contained wedding items. TNN

STATISTICS A slice of life in numbers

India's heat problem continues well past sunset

In the past decade, night-time temperatures rose more across India than daytime temperatures. However, hilly northern and N-E states saw a sharper rise in daytime heat, making afternoons hotter

Regional temperature anomalies*, 2015-25



*Temperature anomalies show how much warmer or cooler a period was compared with the 1991-2020 long period average. A positive anomaly means temperatures were above normal, while a negative anomaly means they were below normal. Source: DataForIndia

400+ MBBS seats find no takers even after special vacancy round

Steep Fees At Private Colleges Likely Deterrent

Anuja.Jaiswal@timesofindia.com

New Delhi: As many as 411 MBBS seats remained unallotted even after the Medical Counselling Committee (MCC) conducted a special stray vacancy round, with the high fee structure in private medical colleges potentially being one of the factors behind the seats remaining unfilled.

Of the 948 vacant MBBS seats included in the special round's seat matrix, only 537 were allotted, leaving 411 unfilled. These vacancies raise questions about the affordability of medical education, particularly in private colleges where fees can run into lakhs of rupees.

High costs may have deterred some NEET-qualified candidates from opting for these seats, although the allotment data does not establish the reasons for individual choices.

A health ministry official said last year, only around 60-70 MBBS seats had remained vacant. "SC had directed us to conduct four rounds of counselling, but we conducted a fifth round as well. Despite that, more than 400 seats remain without allotments."

"In many institutions, fees that were around at Rs 15 lakh have increased to Rs 25 lakh to Rs 30 lakh. Govt medical college seats and those in reputed private institutions are getting filled. Vacancies are concentrated in some private colleges. These institutions need to review their fee structures and the quality of education and infrastructure they offer. If fees remain this high, increasing the number of seats will serve little purpose as students can't afford them," the official said.

GAP IN MEDICAL EDUCATION

- 837 MBBS seats vacant after previous stray round
- 109 additional vacancies due to non-joining
- 948 vacancies in the special-round matrix
- 537 seats allotted
- 411 seats without allotments
- 57% vacancies allotted
- 43% without allotments

4 out of 5 foreign medicine grads fail qualifier

New Delhi: Nearly four out of five foreign medical graduates (FMGs) who appeared in the Oct 2026 Foreign Medical Graduate Examination, mandatory for foreign-trained doctors seeking to practise in India, failed to qualify. Only 9,354 candidates passed, as against 31,539 who failed, taking the pass percentage to 22.9%.

The results come after months of protests by FMGs over the June examination, following which the National Board of Examinations in Medical Sciences announced a series of measures, based on a committee's recommendations.

However, the national FMG In-charge, said feedback suggested the Oct paper didn't appear to follow the recommendations. — **Anuja Jaiswal**

MSY ordered firing on kar sevaks to avert civil war, says SP MP

Rajeev.Dikshit
@timesofindia.com

Varanasi: Samajwadi Party MP from Ballia, Sanatan Pandey, justified the police firing on 'kar sevaks' in 1990, saying the then chief minister **Mulayam Singh Yadav** issued the order to "save the Constitution and prevent a civil war in the country".

Pandey said, "Netaji's (Mulayam's) order was against those who acted against the Constitution... He acted in accordance with the Constitution and court orders."

"SP's actions are guided by the principles of social equality and communal harmony. BJP, RSS, VHP and Bajrang Dal ignored the Constitution and court orders," he added.

Pandey's remarks came a few days after it was announced that SP chief Akhilesh Yadav is likely to visit Ram Mandir in Ayodhya on Dec 12, which triggered attacks from BJP.

Will make Ayodhya global capital of Sanatan pilgrimage, promises Akhilesh

Lucknow: Seeking to corner BJP over the Ram Temple donation theft, SP chief **Akhilesh Yadav** said his party was committed to restoring Ayodhya's honour.

In a post on X, the former UP CM said the loot had hurt the "faith of the devotees" and led to a decline in the number of faithfuls and pilgrims visiting Ayodhya, leaving a direct impact on the temple town's economy.

He vowed to restore the people's faith by putting in place a transparent system for the Ram Temple management, if his party is voted to form the govt in 2027. "We will make Ayodhya the global capital of Sanatan pilgrimage by providing it with world-class infrastructure," he said. TNN

Jailed ex-mantri on FB: Won't fight Punjab poll

Chandigarh: Jailed former minister and AAP's Patti MLA, Laljit Singh Bhullar, announced in a Facebook post that he would not contest the 2027 Punjab assembly elections. The post triggered BJP to raise concerns over mobile phone access inside state prisons, with senior spokesperson Pritpal Singh Baliawal questioning whether Bhullar authored the post himself from custody and urged his family to clarify if it was authentic.

The former minister has been in judicial custody since his March 23 arrest following the alleged suicide of a Punjab State Warehousing Corporation district manager, who accused him of harassment and pressure. TNN

Robots helping Army to keep eye on Pak border

Surendra.Singh
@timesofindia.com

New Delhi: Indian Army has started a new chapter of border surveillance in Jammu & Kashmir where four-legged robots, along with their human colleagues and military dogs, are keeping a tight vigil in difficult terrains in forward areas.

The Army has also modernised its border surveillance through artificial intelligence, high-tech sensors, smart-fencing and satellite integration and multi-agency intelligence coordination along LoC.

It has also integrated laser-based counter-drone systems and laser-intrusion detection components along parts of the border in J&K.

But the centre of attraction are the four-legged robotic units that have been patrolling the difficult terrains of the over 740-km-long LoC. Army received the first batch of 100 four-legged robotic units, known as MULE (multi-utility legged equipment) in June 2024 and has since extended active deployment to sensitive border areas such as Akhnoor and Rajouri. Videos of the robotic mules patrolling in Akhnoorwent viral recently.

"The machines also help in providing logistics in rugged and difficult terrains in forward areas," a defence source said. They also support ambush operations and help track enemy movements.

UP draft roll delayed, final one to be on time

Lucknow: EC has pushed back the date of publication of Uttar Pradesh's draft electoral roll by five days to Nov 17, while retaining Jan 4, 2027, as the deadline for publication of the final electoral roll across all 403 assembly constituencies.

The revision also shifts the window for filing claims and objections, giving voters from Nov 17 to Dec 16 to seek inclusion, deletion or correction of entries in the electoral rolls.

UP chief electoral officer Navdeep Rinwa said Tuesday that the revised schedule for the special summary revision (SSR) of assembly electoral rolls 2027 had been issued by EC, with Jan 1, 2027, remaining the qualifying date for determining voter eligibility. TNN

Oxford museum returns stolen Naga skulls

Guwahati: A century-long journey home has begun for 39 Naga remains — stolen from their homeland during colonial rule, stripped of their identity as ancestors, and reduced to exhibits in a British museum. Oxford's Pitt Rivers Museum formally handed them back to a Nagaland delegation Monday, ending a decades-long wait for repatriation and their final rites in the state.

The remains, mostly skulls, will be laid to rest at a shared memorial in a park in Nagaland, a step towards what elders described as "a respectful rest" and healing a colonial-era wound.

Museum director Laura Van Broekhoven called the transfer "a historic moment that will be part of stories told to next generations".

The remains reached Oxford between the 1910s and 1940s. The museum acknowledges that some were seized during military operations. After displaying them for decades, it removed them from public view in 2020 as part of its "decolonisation process".

— **Prabin Kalita**

कला, संस्कृति एवं भाषा विभाग
दिल्ली सरकार

URDU ACADEMY, DELHI
organises
36th Urdu Drama Festival

13 TO 18 NOVEMBER, 2026 AT 6.30 P.M. (DAILY)

VENUE: SRI RAM CENTRE, SAFDAR HASHMI MARG, MANDI HOUSE, NEW DELHI

13 NOVEMBER, 2026
UMRAO JAAN
DIRECTION : MR. VARUN SHARMA
WRITTEN BY : MIRZA HADI RUSWA
PRESENTATION : THEATRE LEELA ACTING STUDIO & PERFORMING ARTS SOCIETY

14 NOVEMBER, 2026
KANJOOS
DIRECTION : MS. SAMPA MANDAL
WRITTEN BY : MR. MOLIERE
PRESENTATION : DRISHYAM TRUST

15 NOVEMBER, 2026
DOOSRA KAMRA
DIRECTION : MR. AHAD KHAN
WRITTEN BY : MS. ZAHIDA ZAIDI
PRESENTATION : TYCIA FOUNDATION

16 NOVEMBER, 2026
BULLE SHAH
DIRECTION : MR. ARVIND SINGH CHANDRAVANSHI
WRITTEN BY : MR. PRATAP SEHGAL
PRESENTATION : SUMUKHA RANG MANDAL

17 NOVEMBER, 2026
GHALIB-E- AZAM
DIRECTION : MR. RAVI TANEJA
WRITTEN BY : DR. C. D. SIDHU
PRESENTATION : COLLEGIATE DRAMA SOCIETY

18 NOVEMBER, 2026
MAHJABEEN HUN, MEENA HUN, NAAZ HUN....
DIRECTION : DR. M. SAYEED ALAM
WRITTEN BY : DR. M. SAYEED ALAM
PRESENTATION : SOCIAL PRIDE WELFARE SOCIETY

C.P.O. BUILDING
KASHMERE GATE, DELHI-6
Ph.: 011-23863858- 9891954430

Seats are available on a first-come, first-served basis.

PLEASE TAKE YOUR SEAT BEFORE SCHEDULED TIME. HANDBAGS, CAMERAS, EATABLES ITEMS AND UNNECESSARY GOODS ARE NOT ALLOWED. PLEASE KEEP THE MOBILE OFF IN THE AUDITORIUM.

You are cordially invited

SECRETARY
URDU ACADEMY, DELHI

DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0280/26-27

INSTITUTE OF HUMAN BEHAVIOUR & ALLIED SCIENCES (IHBAS)
(Hospital based autonomous academic Institute, under Government of National Capital Territory of Delhi dealing with)
"Brain- Mind Problems & Their Solutions"
Dilshad Garden, Delhi 110 095 (India)
Tel.: 22114021 Extn. 285, E-mail: jda-ihbas@delhi.gov.in Website: www.ihbas.delhi.gov.in

Advt. No. 2/6198/26/Estt/IHBAS 10443 Dated: 05.11.2026

Recruitment Notice

Applications are invited from the citizens of India for the following Faculty posts on Regular Basis

Part-A									
S. No.	Name of post	No. of Post	Reservation					Pay Matrix Level	Mode of Recruitment
			UR	SC	ST	OBC	EWS		
1	Professor (Neuro-radiology)	01	01	--	--	--	--	Level-14A; Rs.168900-220400	Regular basis
2	Professor (Neuro-surgery)	01	01	--	--	--	--	Level-14A; Rs.168900-220400	Regular basis
3	Professor (Psychiatry)	01	--	--	--	01	--	Level-14A; Rs.168900-220400	Regular basis
4	Professor (Neuro-anesthesia)	01	01	--	--	--	--	Level-14A; Rs.168900-220400	Regular basis
5	Additional Professor (Neurosurgery)	01	01	--	--	--	--	Level-13A2+; Rs.148200-211400	Regular basis
6	Additional Professor (Psychiatry)	04	02	01	--	01		Level-13A2+; Rs.148200-211400	Regular basis
7	Additional Professor (Neurology)	01	01	--	--	--	--	Level-13A2+; Rs.148200-211400	Regular basis
8	Additional Professor (Clinical Psychology)	01	01	--	--	--	--	Level-13A2+; Rs.148200-211400	Regular basis
9	Associate Professor (Neuro-radiology)	01	01	--	--	--	--	Level-13A1+; Rs.138300-209200	Regular basis
10	Associate Professor (Psychiatry)	05	--	--	01	04	--	Level-13A1+; Rs.138300-209200	Regular basis
11	Associate Professor (Neurology)	03	02	--	--	01	--	Level-13A1+; Rs.138300-209200	Regular basis
12	Associate Professor (Neuro-anesthesia)	01	01	--	--	--	--	Level-13A1+; Rs.138300-209200	Regular basis
13	Associate Professor (Psychiatric Social Work)	01	01	--	--	--	--	Level-13A1+; Rs.138300-209200	Regular basis
14	Assistant Professor (Psychiatry)	08	--	01	--	07	--	Level-12 Rs.101500-167400	Regular basis
15	Assistant Professor (Neurology)	02	--	01	--	01	--	Level-12 Rs.101500-167400	Regular basis
16	Assistant Professor (Neurosurgery)	01	--	--	--	01	--	Level-12 Rs.101500-167400	Regular basis
17	Assistant Professor (Neuro-anesthesia)	02	01	--	--	01	--	Level-12 Rs.101500-167400	Regular basis
18	Assistant Professor (Neuro-radiology)	01	--	--	--	01	--	Level-12 Rs.101500-167400	Regular basis
19	Assistant Professor (Nero-psychopharmacology)	01	--	--	--	01	--	Level-12 Rs.101500-167400	Regular basis
20	Assistant Professor (Psychiatric Social Work)	01	--	--	--	01	--	Level-12 Rs.101500-167400	Regular basis
	TOTAL	38	14	03	01	20	--		

(Allowances will be as per rules. For details of eligibility criteria i.e. Qualification, Experience, Age & Application Format please visit our website (**www.ihbas.delhi.gov.in**). Interested and eligible candidates may apply with appropriate format photograph, along with duly attested copies of qualification, Diploma/Degree, experience certificates etc., Demand Draft of Rs.1000/- (Exempted for SC/ST and PwD candidates) in favour of "Director, IHBAS". Upper age limit is relaxable for Scheduled Caste, Scheduled Tribe and Other Backward Classes and PwD candidates as per rules. However, OBC certificate issued by the Authority of Delhi Govt., only will be accepted. Institute reserves the right to increase/decrease, fill or not to fill any/all the vacancies.
Age Relaxation of 5 years will be applicable for Government employees as per GOI guidelines.
PwD reservation as per Govt. Rules.
Allowances will be as per Rules. Category of Posts mentioned at Sl.No. 01 to 07, 09 to 12 & 14 to 19 are **'Medical Discipline'** and Sl.No.08, 13 & 20 are **'Non Medical Discipline'**.
The application duly filled-in along with necessary documents must reach to the Office of Director, IHBAS, Dilshad Garden, Delhi-110095 **on or before 10.12.2026**. The applicant who is in service of Central Govt./State Govt./Public Sector Undertaking/Autonomous Body shall have to submit his/her NOC at the time of interview. A certificate from the employer is also required to be submitted that in case of his/her selection his department will be relieved him/her to join IHBAS.
(For complete details please visit our website **www.ihbas.delhi.gov.in**)

(Lt. Col. R.K. Sharma)
Joint Director (Admn)

DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0281/26-27

MENTAL ILLNESSES ARE TREATABLE

DEPARTMENT OF ARCHAEOLOGY
GOVERNMENT OF N.C.T. OF DELHI
2nd Floor, B-Block, Vikas Bhawan – II, M.G. Road, Civil Lines, Delhi-110054
Email: deptt-ofarchaeology@delhi.gov.in
Phone: 011- 23814026

FELLOWSHIP Applications are Invited for Fellowship i.e. Senior Research Fellow (SRF) & Junior Research Fellow (JRF) in the Field of Archaeology and Conservation

Category/ Field/Area of Research	Eligible Age	Amount (per Month)		Period	No. of Fellowships		Prescribed Qualification
		SRF	JRF		SRF	JRF	
Archaeology	Up to 40 years	Rs. 50,000/-	Rs. 25,000/-	1 Year	03 (UR)	03 (UR)	**SRF-** PhD in Ancient Indian History, Culture & Archaeology/History **Desirable:** Post Graduate Diploma in Archaeology from any recognized institute or university **JRF-** Masters in Ancient/Medieval Indian History or Masters in Archaeology
Conservation	Up to 40 years	Rs. 50,000/-	Rs. 25,000/-	1 Year	03 (UR)	03 (UR)	**SRF-** PhD in Conservation, Preservation or Heritage Management **Desirable:** Post Graduate Diploma in Conservation from any recognized institute or University **JRF-** Masters in Conservation, Preservation and Heritage Management Or Masters in Conservation

Please Note:-

- Those who are presently receiving a fellowship from Central/State Government are not eligible.
- Application forms and requisite terms & conditions are available at the Department or can be download from the following website link :-
- **https://archaeology.delhi.gov.in/latest-news**
- Application must reach the department within 30 days of publication of advertisement.

SECRETARY
(Art, Culture & Language/Archaeology)

DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0282/26-27

NORTHERN RAILWAY
e-Tender Notice

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/Traction Distribution, DRM's Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi for & on behalf of President of India, invites open e-tender for the under noted work:

Name of work with its location	Part-A: Replacement of overaged PSI assets in NDLS section inconnection with Design, supply, erection, testing & commissioning for Augmentation/Replacement of overaged PSI assets in DLI area of Delhi division.
Approx. Cost of work	Rs.2,50,25,570.61/-
Earnest Money Deposit	Rs.5,00,500/-
E-Tender Bid Online Submission period	19.11.2026 (00.00 Hrs.) to 03.12.2026 (15.00 Hrs.)
E-Tender Bid Submission End Date & E-Tender Open Date & Time	03.12.2026 (15.00 hrs)
Fund Allocation	Capital (PH-36)
Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	www.ireps.gov.in

E-Tender No.: 38-TRD-NDLS-2026-27 Dated : 10.11.2026 3940/2026

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PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited
(Regd. Office : PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)
Corporate identity Number U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website : www.pspcl.in
Office of the Superintending Engineer, DS Circle, PSPCL, Patiala, 66 KV Grid Sub Station Colony, DCW Road, Patiala -147001 (Punjab), 96461-01201, 96461-10963, E-mail: circlepatiala1@gmail.com

Tender Enquiry No. 43/SE/DS Circle, Patiala/2026-27 Dated: 10.11.2026

Superintending Engineer/DS Circle, PSPCL Patiala invites e-tender for Outsourcing of Labour Part for Erection, Testing & Commissioning of New 11KVLT/HT Lines on Rail/PCC Poles, Distribution T/Fs, Augmentation/Sagging of ACSR of HT/LT Lines, Cables laying, Guarding, Stay Set for Various Works such as Releasing of T/Well Connections, GSC/ISC Connections, Deloading of Overloaded T/Fs, Shifting of Meters Outside Consumer Premises, Preventive maintenance of HT/LT lines not involving conductor replacement or insertion of extra poles Earthing of DTs/Lines or any Development Works under DS Division Rajpura under DS Circle Patiala for F.Y. 2027-28.

For detailed NIT and Tender Specifications please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 10.11.2026, 06:00 PM onwards.

NOTE: Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

C1079/26, DPR/Pb.: 1079/12/2026-27/16920

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF HPLC WITH UV DETECTOR ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	06.11.2026 27.11.2026	1,65,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	8929299829 equipmentdgm2020@gmail.com
2	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF HPLC WITH PDA DETECTOR, FLUORESCENCE AND RI DETECTOR ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT.	06.11.2026 27.11.2026	75,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	8929299829 equipmentdgm2020@gmail.com
3	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF DISSOLUTION MACHINE AUTOSAMPLER ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT.	06.11.2026 27.11.2026	15,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	8929299829 equipmentdgm2020@gmail.com
4	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF ELECTRICAL AUTOPSY SAW STAND WITH ACCESSORIES ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	06.11.2026 20.11.2026	22,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	8929299829 equipmentdgm2020@gmail.com
5	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF AUTOREFRACTOMETER WITH ACCESSORIES ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	06.11.2026 27.11.2026	4,38,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	8929299829 equipmentdgm2020@gmail.com
6	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF ND YAG LASER ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	06.11.2026 27.11.2026	1,05,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	8929299829 equipmentdgm2020@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in Ro No. 50888

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Interdisciplinary Careers: Blend Skills, Increase Options

Abhijit Bhaduri

Mixing skills from two or more fields can create new opportunities you never thought of. Think of an engineer who understands law, or an HR manager who can read data. Employers are paying for this mix.

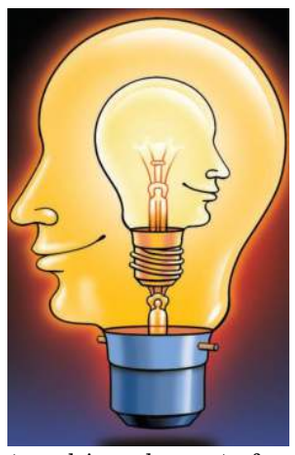
Burning Glass, a US firm that studied job ads, looked at nearly a billion job postings and found that one in eight is now highly hybridised, across more than 250 occupations. In a 2019 study, the firm projected that employment would grow by about 10% between 2018 and 2028, compared with 21% for highly hybridised roles, which is more than twice the overall rate. Such jobs also showed greater staying power, suggesting that roles combining multiple skill sets may be more resilient to labour market changes.

Highly hybrid jobs carried a 12% risk of automation, compared with 42% overall. And they pay. Marketing managers who know SQL, a database language, earned an average salary premium of 41%.

The human brain is naturally wired to connect ideas across different fields. It does not store knowledge in isolated compartments; it stores knowledge as interconnected webs, and new ideas spark where two webs blend.

Freshers: Blend Before You Set

In your first five years, feed your brain two diets. Each week, read one article from your field and one from the field next door: for example, an accountant who reads about how quick-commerce apps plan delivery routes. Next, take one person from another department for coffee each month and ask about their hardest problem. People love



to explain, and you get a free tour of their world. Last, keep a mash-up diary. Note each time an idea from one place fixed a problem in another. Five entries in, you have a story for every interview.

Mid-Career: Mind the Silo Gap

At work, silos mean teams that don't talk. Be different. Ask to sit in on one meeting a month with another team, framed as learning how your work affects theirs. The brain learns fastest when real problems sit at the table. When two teams start a joint project, offer to write a one-page summary. Each side uses different words for the same thing, and the translator earns trust from both. Then add one line to your LinkedIn headline that joins two fields. For example, "Accounts payable expert who understands product." Recruiters sort people fast. Give them a resume with two buyers.

Senior Pros: Wisdom on Tap

Ask a junior colleague to teach you a tool from their world, such as a design app or an AI assistant. Being a beginner keeps an experienced brain flexible and flips the usual hierarchy, which builds loyalty.

Start a monthly problem circle with people from different functions to tackle one real issue over coffee. You become the hub. Then give a free guest lecture at a local college on how two fields shaped your work. Teaching forces your brain to tidy what it knows, and it ties your name to the bridge you built.

None of these needs a resignation letter or a course fee. Pick the smallest idea and start.

(The writer is an executive coach and the former global head for learning and development at Microsoft)

CENTRAL UNIVERSITY OF SOUTH BIHAR
NH-120, Gaya-Panchanpur Road, Gaya-824236, Bihar
A++ NAAC
Recruitment Notice
Teaching & Non-Teaching Positions
Advt. No.- CUSB/Advt./49/2026 & CUSB/Advt./50/2026
Dated 06th November, 2026
Online applications are invited from eligible candidates for appointment to the **teaching** (Professor, Associate Professor & Assistant Professor) positions and **non-teaching** (Group 'A', 'B' & 'C') positions.
The details regarding qualifications, experience, process of recruitment and other instructions are available on the University Website: www.cusb.ac.in, along with this advertisement.
Registrar

इंडियन बैंक Indian Bank
(A Govt. of India Undertaking)
Corporate Office, 254-260, Avvai Shanmugam Salai, Royapettah, Chennai-600014
ENGAGEMENT OF CONSULTANT FOR INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY DEPARTMENT
ON CONTRACTUAL BASIS-2026
Vacancy: One (01)
Name of the post: Consultant for Information Technology Department (ITD) on Fixed Term Employment (FTE) on contractual basis
Period of Engagement: On Fixed Term Employment (FTE) on contractual basis for an initial period of six (06) months and extendable for further period of six months at a time as per the needs and requirements of the Bank based on review after completion of every six months, but in no case total tenure should exceed a continuous term of 5 years in the Bank
Mode of application: Offline application as per the prescribed format uploaded in careers page of Banks' website www.indianbank.bank.in
Age: Minimum Age – 50 years and Maximum Age - 65 years (inclusive of all relaxation) as on 01.11.2026
Application Fee / Intimation Charges (Non-refundable): Rs. 175/- (inclusive of GST) for SC/ST/PwBD candidates. Rs. 1000/- (inclusive of GST) for all other Candidates.
Last date of receipt of application: On or before 01.12.2026
Eligibility Criteria and Experience | Please visit our careers page at www.indianbank.bank.in for full details
Place: Chennai Date: 11.11.2026
Chief General Manager (CDO & CLO)

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REQUIREMENTS
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Interested candidates may apply online within 10 days at https://vischennai.ac.in/careers/
For more details, visit: www.vischennai.ac.in

नेशनल प्रोजेक्ट्स कन्सट्रक्शन कारपोरेशन लिमिटेड
(भारत सरकार का उद्यम)
NATIONAL PROJECTS CONSTRUCTION CORPORATION LIMITED
(A GOVERNMENT OF INDIA ENTERPRISE)
केन्द्रीय कार्यालय : प्लाट न. 148, सेक्टर-44, गुरुग्राम-122003 (हरियाणा)
CORPORATE OFFICE: PLOT NO. 148, SECTOR-44, GURUGRAM-122 003 (HARYANA)
Advt. No. NPCC/Regular/HR/Finance/IT/Rajbhasha/Law/Oct./2026
NPCC Limited, a Mini Ratna Category-I, Premier Schedule 'B' CPSU, is a subsidiary of WAPCOS Limited. The Company is engaged in Engineering Construction, Planning, Operation and Project Management Consultancy. The Company invites ONLINE applications to fill the following vacancies on regular basis:

S.No.	Name of Post	No. of Tentative vacancies	Pay Scale (₹.)
1.	General Manager (HR)	1	90000-240000 (IDA)
2.	Manager (Finance)	1	50000-160000 (IDA)
3.	Manager (HR)	2	50000-160000 (IDA)
4.	Manager(IT)	2	50000-160000 (IDA)
5.	Manager (Rajbhasha)	1	50000-160000 (IDA)
6.	Dy. Manager (Fin.)	4	40000-140000 (IDA)
7.	Dy. Manager (Law)	1	40000-140000 (IDA)

For details, please visit our Website – www.npcc.gov.in.
Head (HR)
NPCC Limited

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DIRECT RECRUITMENT OF MANAGEMENT TRAINEES & MANAGERS
Export-Import Bank of India invites applications from young professionals for the following positions.

Positions	Number of positions
Management Trainee	90
Manager	30

For details, please visit eximbankindia.in/careers
Last date for application: December 11, 2026
www.eximbankindia.in | Follow us on

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(A Govt. of India Undertaking)
Corporate Office, 254-260, Avvai Shanmugam Salai, Royapettah, Chennai-600014
ENGAGEMENT OF AI - CYBERSECURITY SPECIALIST OFFICERS
FOR INFORMATION SYSTEM SECURITY DEPARTMENT (ISSD)
ON CONTRACTUAL BASIS-2026
Vacancy: Five (05)
Name of the posts: 1. Vice President - AI Cybersecurity (01 vacancy) 2. Assistant Vice President - AI Cybersecurity (02 vacancies) 3. Associate Manager-Senior officer - AI Cybersecurity (02 vacancies)
Mode of application: Offline application as per the prescribed format uploaded in careers page of Banks' website www.indianbank.bank.in
Application Fee / Intimation Charges (Non-refundable): Rs. 175/- (inclusive of GST) for SC/ST/PwBD candidates. Rs. 1000/- (inclusive of GST) for all other Candidates.
Last date of receipt of application: On or before 01.12.2026
Eligibility Criteria and Experience | Please visit our careers page at www.indianbank.bank.in for full details
Place: Chennai Date: 11.11.2026
Chief General Manager (CDO & CLO)

इंडियन बैंक Indian Bank
(A Govt. of India Undertaking)
Corporate Office, 254-260, Avvai Shanmugam Salai, Royapettah, Chennai-600014
ENGAGEMENT OF AI SPECIALIST OFFICERS FOR AI CELL
ON CONTRACTUAL BASIS-2026
Vacancy: Eight (08)
Name of the posts: 1. Functional AI Role (Business & Use-Case Leadership)- AI Product Manager- Assistant Vice President (02 vacancies). 2. Technical AI Roles (Architecture, Engineering & Platforms)- AI Engineer / AI Architect- VP (01 vacancy), DVP (01 vacancy) & AVP (03 vacancies). 3. Risk, Audit & Governance Roles (Responsible AI & Compliance) - Responsible AI Officer- Assistant Vice President (01 vacancy).
Mode of application: Offline application as per the prescribed format uploaded in career page of Banks' website www.indianbank.bank.in
Application Fee / Intimation Charges (Non-refundable): Rs. 175/- (inclusive of GST) for SC/ST/PwBD candidates. Rs 1000/- (inclusive of GST) for all other Candidates.
Last date of receipt of application: On or before 01.12.2026
Eligibility Criteria and Experience | Please visit our careers page at www.indianbank.bank.in for full details
Place: Chennai Date: 11.11.2026
Chief General Manager (CDO & CLO)

DELHI DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
V. No. 5/2026/PB-I
VACANCY NOTICE
DDA intends to fill up following posts on deputation basis from eligible and willing officers belonging to Central Government/ State Government or Organizations dealing with public works or town planning.

Sl. No.	Name of Post	No. of Vacancies*	Level in the Pay Matrix as per 7th CPC
1.	Chief Engineer (Civil)	04*	Level-14

No. of posts are tentative and can be increased or decreased, as per the requirement of DDA, without prior notice.
The initial tenure of deputation period will be for 03 years extendable up to 05 years on year to year basis, which may, however, be terminated at any time before completion of period/ extended period at the discretion of DDA.
For complete details regarding eligibility criteria, terms and conditions etc., kindly visit DDA's website **www.dda.gov.in/personnel/advertisement**
Last date for submission of applications is **15.12.2026.**
(Sonika Singh)
Commissioner (Pers.)
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Shortlisted candidates will be contacted for an interview.

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at JIS Institute of Advanced Studies & Research (JISIASR) Kolkata, JIS University
(Post Graduate and Research Institute)

Centre for Data Science	AI and Machine Learning, Generative and Agentic AI in Computer Vision, Cloud Computing, Quantum Computing, Financial and Business Data Analytics, Internet of Things, Data Science in Health Care.
Centre for Interdisciplinary Sciences	Corrosion Science, Surface Engineering, Additive Manufacturing and 3D Printing, Nano Science & Technology, Biopolymer, Tissue Engineering, Drug Delivery, Polymer Technology.
Centre for Health Science & Technology	Medical Imaging & Image Processing, Biomedical Instrumentation, Cell Biology, Human Genetics, Host Pathogen Interaction, AI in healthcare.
Centre for Renewable & Sustainable Energy Studies	Fuel Cell and Battery, Wind and Bio Energy, Electric Vehicle, Solar photovoltaic and Solar Thermal, Smart Grid, Environmental Engineering.

QUALIFICATION & EXPERIENCE:
Professor/ Associate Professor: PhD with first class degree in relevant areas with minimum of 8 years experience in Teaching / Research / Industry out of which at least 2 years shall be Post PhD experience in reputed organizations and minimum 6 Research publications in SCI Journals.
Assistant Professor: PhD with first class degree in relevant field
SALARY:
As per norms (negotiable based on experience)
Salient Features :
1. Accommodation available on rent | 2. Institute Bus available
Interested candidates are requested to email their detailed resume with Testimonials, PAN & Aadhar Card along with a cover letter to opportunity@jisiasr.org / career@jisgroup.org by 30th November, 2026.
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Eligibility
• Essential Qualifications: Masters (M.A./M.Sc./M.Com) with B.Ed/M.Ed from a recognised University/Institution
• Desirable Qualifications: Holding Doctorate Degree from a recognised University/Institution and experience of administrative charge of a recognized senior secondary school
• Experience: Minimum 10 years of PGT experience with preferably at least 5 years as a Principal or Vice-Principal in a recognized CBSE senior secondary school.
• Age: Not exceeding 50 years (Age relaxation as per Delhi Government Recruitment Rules)
• Salary and Allowances: Salary and allowances as per government rules. Higher salary may be considered for deserving candidates commensurate with experience and qualifications
• Skills: Excellent leadership, strong command over CBSE norms, fluent English, and proven track record in academic excellence
Interested candidates may apply within 10 days from the date of advertisement on the school website www.svisgdelhi.com
Please note that only shortlisted candidates will be called for an interview

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THDC INDIA LIMITED
(अनुसूची 'ए' मिनी रत्न कैटेगरी–I, पीएसयू, एनटीपीसी लिमिटेड की सहायक कंपनी)
(Schedule 'A' Mini Ratna Category-I PSU, a subsidiary of NTPC Limited)
Advt. No - 08/2026
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Interested candidates may log on to our website **www.thdc.co.in** & visit Career Section-New Openings for Detailed advertisement in respect of eligibility criteria, selection process and other information regarding applying for the said post.
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Indian Institute of Management Jammu
Vacancy
IIM Jammu invites online applications for the following Positions:
Faculty Positions
1. Professors / Associate Professors
2. Professors of Practice / Associate Professors of Practice
3. Senior Consultants for Centers of Excellence & Academics
Non-Faculty Positions
1. Chief Administrative Officer
For details and updates, please visit
https://www.iimj.ac.in/career.php
Please apply online on or before **10.12.2026.** Application in any other format/means will be rejected. Reservation Policy will apply as per the Govt. of India Rules.

INDIA DIGEST

ANI

A Russian paraglider pilot was rescued after being stranded on high-tension power lines nearly 150m above ground for over two-and-a-half hours in Himachal's Mandi Tuesday

Arunachal MP's dam remarks trigger row

A row erupted in Arunachal Pradesh after BJP MP Tapir Gao said the 11,200-MW Siang Upper Multipurpose Project would be built "come what may". Anti-dam group Adi Bane Kebang-United demanded clarity, citing CM Pema Khandu's assurance that the project would not proceed without affected communities' consent.

Stray cracker kills 95-yr woman on bed

A 95-year-old bedridden woman died after her bed caught fire at her Indore home on Monday night. Her family claimed a stray aerial cracker entered her room and ignited the bed. Police, however, said the circumstances appeared suspicious. The woman suffered severe burns and was declared dead at a hospital around 3am. A probe is underway.

Harassment alleged in constable's suicide

A Telangana constable died by suicide at his home near Hyderabad Monday, with his family alleging harassment by loan-app agents. Srinivas (31) had lost over Rs 20 lakh to cricket betting and borrowed from multiple apps. His mother said callers threatened relatives over repayment. Cops filed an abetment of suicide case.

Dibrugarh Oil India blast toll rises to 5

Death toll in the Nov 6 explosion at Oil India's tank farm in Dibrugarh rose to five Tuesday after an injured worker died. Kumud Gogoi, 38, suffered severe injuries. Ulfa-I blamed OIL and its maintenance contractor, demanding Rs 1 crore for each victim's family.

CISCE allows frisking to curb cheating

Council for the Indian School Certificate Examinations has allowed board exam centre heads to frisk candidates before exams, leaving the decision to their discretion. It has also banned smart gadgets, including AI glasses. ICSE exams will run from Feb 15 to March 31 and ISC exams from Feb 9 to April 8.

4 govt dirs help BJP-led group win Gokul polls

Another Form Of Vote And Election Chori, Says Cong

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Maharashtra CM Devendra Fadnavis defended the nomination of four govt members with voting rights to Gokul Dairy (in pic) via an ordinance last week, questioning LS LoP Rahul Gandhi's intervention in a milk union election. Bombay HC Monday nixed a plea against the ordinance

Kolhapur: Maharashtra's governing BJP-led Mahayuti alliance snatched Tuesday a win over Congress-backed group Samavichari Aghadi in a high-stakes election for Kolhapur-based Gokul Dairy's chief, riding on the support of four new govt nominees.

Mahayuti candidate, ex-NCP MLA Rajesh Patil, was elected chief after securing 16 votes, three more than his Samavichari rival Patil Chuyekar's 13. Gokul has a 25-member board of directors, for which elections were held last month. Mahayuti had won 12 posts and Samavichari 13. Neither had the quorum of 14 required for the chief's election.

Mahayuti govt had last week promulgated an ordinance to nominate five members to large cooperatives, four with voting rights. This drew flak from the opposition, which accused govt of attempting to grab Gokul, the state's largest milk co-operative. Congress LS leader of opposition Rahul Gandhi alleged "adulteration" of the mandate. A Samavichari plea in Bombay HC against the ordinance was rejected Monday.

"We have nominated individuals with experience. If one is a gynaecologist, what's wrong? When the country's leader of opposition feels the need to intervene in a milk union election, a gynaecologist is just a common citizen," CM Devendra Fadnavis said on Tuesday.

Congress general secretary KC Venugopal denounced the outcome as "another form of vote and election chori".

PMK man shot dead, assailant shot in the leg in escape bid

Vellore: A PMK neta was killed and his friend injured after a history-sheeter allegedly opened fire on them with a country-made gun in a village in TN's Vellore district Monday night, reports **Bosco Dominique**.

The deceased was identified as M Gnanavel, 43, a farmer and PMK functionary from Senguntram village.

Police arrested the accused, S Poovarasan, 28, from the same village within hours of the attack. But on Tuesday, Poovarasan assaulted two policemen and attempted to escape when he was taken to a place where he had hidden the firearm. Cops shot him on the leg and nabbed him. Poovarasan faces 13 cases registered at various police stations, including murder, attempt to murder and highway robbery. He had also been detained several times under the Goondas Act.

PMK chief A Ramadoss said Gnanavel was shot because he pulled up Poovarasan for alleged poaching of animals.

Cops, however, said the attack was due to a previous enmity over a quarrel a week ago.

Being underweight with high BP can be a problem too: Study

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iStock

The findings are significant for India, where one in five men and women in the 15-49 age group is underweight (BMI below 18.5)

While obesity with hypertension is the most widely recognised high-risk category, a recent study has shown that being underweight with elevated blood pressure or hypertension may also be a high-risk sub-group in Asian populations.

The study done in Japan and published in Hypertension Research, an open-source journal in the Nature group of journals, showed the combination of being underweight and having elevated blood pressure or hypertension was associated with increased risk of major adverse cardiovascular events like heart attacks and strokes, particularly among women and among adults aged 40 and above. This is significant for India, where one in five men and women in the 15-49 age group is underweight (body mass index below 18.5).

"Conventional prevention strategies for obesity with hypertension appropriately emphasise weight control and cardiometabolic risk reduction; however, the same approach may not be sufficient for underweight individuals with elevated BP or hypertension," stated the study, suggesting the need for additional assessment for unintentional weight loss, malnutrition, low muscle mass, frailty, and underlying chronic disease for those who are underweight with hypertension.

Potential management strategies may, therefore, include nutritional assessment and support, resistance exercise or muscle-strengthening interventions where appropriate, and individualised BP control that considers frailty, and symptoms like dizziness or fainting when rising from sitting or lying down.

The association between being underweight and cardiovascular events and mortality has been observed in previous studies but significance of high blood pressure was not as well studied or understood. This is of particular significance in Asia where being underweight is relatively common and the distribution of BMI is different from Western populations. In India, the latest National Family Health Survey of 2023-24 showed about 20% of men and women above 15 years had elevated blood pressure or were taking medicine to control it.

Understanding cardiovascular risk across the full range of BMI, rather than focusing exclusively on obesity, is expected to enhance understanding of risk stratification in hypertension. The study used the nationwise claims and health-check database of Japan for the period Jan 2005 to Oct 2023 and analysed 62.6 lakh adults without prior cardiovascular disease, chronic renal failure, dialysis, or antihypertensive medication use.

File FIR, freeze bank accounts: Madras HC on TN books scam

Madurai: Madras HC Tuesday directed the directorate of vigilance and anti-corruption to register an FIR and freeze the bank accounts of Agal Vilakku Publication, its proprietor Mohan, and others involved in the Tamil Nadu public library books procurement scam, reports **K Kaushik**.

HC, while disposing of a PIL, came down heavily on the authorities for allegedly violating a June 2024 order aimed at enforcing transparency in library books procurement. The bench observed, "The writ petition was filed when AIADMK was in office. It was disposed of when DMK was at the helm. TVK leads the governing coalition when the present scandal has erupted. Actors change, actions do not." The judges added that if the comprehensive directions issued by the court in 2024 had been followed, procurement from dubious entities such as Agal Vilakku, Sigma and Phoenix publishers, could have been prevented.

The judges observed that despite the facts coming to light last week, no FIR had been registered. "We wondered what prevented DVAC from filing an FIR. It was too obvious that a crime of this proportion could not have taken place without the active involvement of govt servants," the bench observed.

Person has no claim in grandpa's property held by dad, says SC

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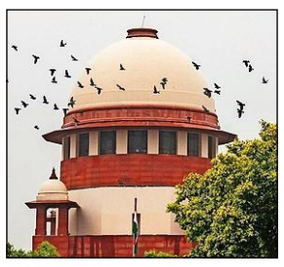

SUCCESSION SAGA

New Delhi: Can a grandson claim a share in property inherited by his father from his grandfather? Supreme Court has ruled that a person becomes the absolute owner of his share in his father's ancestral or self-acquired property and can deal with it exclusively, including excluding his sons.

Ending a 29-year legal battle, a bench of Justices Augustine George Masih and Sunita Agarwal rejected a son's plea for partition of his father's property. The son had filed the suit in 1997, claiming the property was ancestral or joint family property. The court said a son's son is not listed as a Class I heir under the Hindu Succession Act and cannot claim a share in his grandfather's property.

Referring to Section 8, which lays down succession rules when a Hindu male dies intestate, the bench said a son becomes the absolute owner of property inherited from his father, while his own son has no right by birth over it.

SC said Class I heirs inherit simultaneously, to the exclusion of all others. "A son's son is not mentioned as an heir under Class I of the Schedule, and, therefore, he could not get any right in the property of his grandfather," it said.

It added that 1956 law did not preserve right under personal Hindu law of a grandson to claim a share in his grandfather's property during his father's lifetime. Sec 8 must be read as a self-contained provision governing devolution of property of a Hindu male dying intestate, it said.

Citing SC judgements, the bench rejected the argument that a son inheriting property under Section 8 holds it as karta of his undivided family. Such an interpretation would create two classes among Class I heirs, treating property as joint family property for male heirs but not female heirs, it said. The express wording of Sec 8 must prevail.

Upholding HC's order, the bench said a grandson cannot seek partition of property held by his father. The high court had ruled that when a son or daughter receives property through partition, whether ancestral or self-acquired, they become absolute owners of their shares and can deal with them exclusively, including excluding their sons.

NBT loses 20-yr battle as SC says trust a sovereign body not society

New Delhi: Supreme Court has ruled that the National Book Trust (NBT), set up by the Union govt in 1957 under Jawaharlal Nehru, is a 'state' under Article 12 of the Constitution. The Trust litigated for nearly two decades to avoid obligations imposed on govt instrumentalities, reports **Dhananjay Mahapatra**.

NBT challenged a 2012 Delhi high court judgment, arguing it was neither created by statute nor mandated by the Constitution and was not a sovereign authority. It said it was a registered society and the majority of its financial requirements came from sources other than govt grants.

The Trust argued grants were only one source of income and its own receipts formed a substantial part of its income. A bench of Justices Prashant Kumar Mishra and Augustine G Masih said mere financial autonomy cannot be the clinching factor for classifying it as a non-state institution.

Writing the judgment, Justice Mishra said govt's role began with the Trust's creation and extended to its governing composition, appointment of its principal functionary, executive and financial administration, audit, reporting and approval over its framework. This went beyond limited regulatory supervision, he said.

SC said the Trust was financially, functionally and administratively dominated by or under govt control, which was particular to it and pervasive. Its registration as a society or ability to generate income independently could not displace its constitutional character.

While upholding the HC decision, the bench issued an important clarification after the Trust expressed apprehension that declaring it as a 'State' under Article 12 would lead to consequences associated with govt employment.

The SC said the declaration did not make the Trust a Union govt department, nor make every employee a civil servant or confer all constitutional protections available to govt servants under Part XIV.

EC: Code of conduct applies to retd govt officials in state jobs

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: EC Tuesday directed that the "political neutrality" provision of model code of conduct (MCC) will henceforth apply not just to serving govt employees in poll-bound states but also to retired govt officials and staffers attached, employed or re-employed by state govts.

As per relevant MCC instructions, govt employees, and now retired or re-employed officers, "are not expected to take part in any election campaign or canvassing and should take scrupulous care not to lend their names, official position or authority to assist one individual/political party/group against another".

MCC provisions apply to all organisations, committees, corporations and commissions funded wholly or partially by govt, and their employees. Relevant conduct rules in states also prohibit govt servants from taking part in political activities and elections.

EC directed that retired and re-employed officials and staffers will, during the MCC period, not summon any election-related officer of the constituency or district where polls have been announced for official meetings, or hold video conferences with them. Any violation of the directions "shall be viewed seriously", it said in a letter to chief secretaries and CEO of five poll-bound states — UP, Uttarakhand, Punjab, Goa and Manipur.

Until now, there were no guidelines on political neutrality and conduct of retired officials attached or re-employed by states during MCC period. Some are attached to or re-employed by the offices of CMs and ministers.

Unesco: Women ahead in higher edu, but rural-urban gap hits schoolgirls

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New Delhi: India has made substantial progress in closing the gender gap in education, with women now outpacing men in higher education. But a rural-urban divide continues to disadvantage girls at the school-completion stage. A Unesco report found that for every 100 boys completing upper secondary education in rural India, only 59 girls do so, compared with gender parity in urban areas. India has closed at least 65% of its initial disparity in upper secondary completion since 2000.

The 2026 Global Education Monitoring report, Gender Equity in Access to Education, puts India's overall gender parity index for upper secondary completion at 0.89, or 89 girls for every 100 boys. In rural areas, it falls to 0.59.

GENDER DIVIDE

Unesco categorises India as having made "fast progress" among countries with large disadvantages for girls at the start of the century. This applies to students completing school within the expected age window and those finishing late.

Recent govt data point to improvements in participation and retention. UDISE+ 2025-26 shows girls account for 48.4% of school enrolment. The secondary-stage dropout rate fell from 8.2% in 2024-25 to 7%, while retention rose from 47.2% to 51.9%. These indicators cannot be directly compared with Unesco's household-survey-based completion ratios.

At college level, women lead men. AISHE 2023-24 puts the female gross enrolment ratio at 31.2%, against 28.9% for males. Women's enrolment rose from 1.57 crore in 2014-15 to 2.24 crore, a 42.2% increase. The higher education gender parity index stood at 1.08, with women's participation exceeding men's for seven consecutive years.

Unesco's review of Indian studies found free school lunches had nearly twice the impact on primary enrolment for girls as for boys in disadvantaged rural communities. Separate toilets helped raise enrolment among adolescent girls, while girls' clubs offering life skills and social support modestly improved secondary completion in Karnataka.

Globally, Unesco found parity in enrolment from preprimary through upper secondary school. Women increasingly outnumber men in higher education, with 88 male students for every 100 women enrolled and 82 male graduates. Yet 273 million children and young people were out of education in 2024.

Dumped in hosp, CCTV shows 15-yr-old hit by car

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Dehradun: A 15-year-old boy whose death after a Diwali night clash was initially blamed on an assault was apparently run over by a friend reversing a car in haste, CCTV footage that surfaced Tuesday suggested.

Police had filed a murder FIR against a minor and others following a complaint by the boy's father, who alleged that his son's friends had abandoned him at a hospital without revealing his identity.

Arsh Ansari, a Class X student of Doon Blossom School, had gone to celebrate Diwali at a friend's house Sunday night. Around 3am Monday, the teenagers went out in a car and encountered another group near Suri Chowk, where an argument broke out over a previous dispute. The confrontation reportedly continued near Dharampur Chowk, where Arsh was allegedly run over.

A purported 55-second CCTV recording circulating on social media showed the two groups apparently engaged in a scuffle. As the confrontation escalated, Arsh's friends rushed towards their car. One hurriedly reversed while Arsh was standing behind it, apparently knocking him down and running over him with a rear wheel.

Arsh's father alleged that his son's friends took him to hospital but told staff they had found an unidentified injured person on the road before leaving without informing the family. He said he learnt of his son's death from a friend's mother around 6am on Monday.

SP said preliminary findings did not indicate murder, though the circumstances were still being probed.

Woman steps on IED in Manipur, loses a leg

Guwahati: A 41-year-old mother of three lost her left leg after stepping on a suspected buried explosive device while grazing cattle in Manipur's Kangpokpi district on Tuesday, raising fresh fears of unexploded ordnance in farming zones, reports **Prabin Kalita**.

The victim, Durga Devi Bhattarai, is the wife of Jeevan Bhattarai, secretary of Kangpokpi's Bazaghari village.

Fearing more explosives buried in surrounding fields and pastures, villagers have urged authorities to investigate the nature and origin of the device, deploy a bomb-disposal squad and sanitise the area.

Separately, ADGP (law and order) Lhari Dorjee Lhatoo announced in Imphal that a plan had been finalised to destroy illegal poppy farms in 516 villages across 10 districts with the help of security forces. "Anyone involved in the practice will face serious consequences as per the law," he warned.

5 months on, 6 Naga men to get final rites

Guwahati: Six Naga men allegedly abducted by suspected Kuki militants in Manipur's Kangpokpi on May 13 and found murdered a month later will be laid to rest on Nov 16, after their bodies remained at a morgue of Jawaharlal Nehru Institute of Medical Sciences in Imphal for over five months.

The Joint Tribe Council announced the decision Tuesday, with its co-convener Timothy Wijunamai alleging militants belonging to Kuki outfits that signed the Suspension of Operations pact with Centre and state had abducted the Zeliangrong Naga men, calling it a breach of ceasefire agreement.

The decision to claim the bodies followed Sept 26 talks involving JTC, United Naga Council, state and Centre. TNN

Mob attacks Kolkata PS, demands molestation accused be handed over

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Kolkata: A mob of around 50 people stormed a city police station compound around 2 am Tuesday, assaulted cops and tried to vandalise the premises, demanding that a man arrested on charges of molesting a 24-year-old woman be handed over to them.

Cops called in reinforcements and lathi-charged the attackers to disperse them. Four troublemakers were detained and later arrested.

The woman was returning home around 12.15am when three men allegedly molested her in New Alipore. Hearing her cries, her brother rushed to the spot and alerted locals. One of the accused, Jai Kumar Kamath, was caught, while the other two men fled.

Cops took Kamath into custody. The woman was asked to visit the police station and filed a complaint. Matters escalated when the locals accompanied the woman to the police station, forcibly entering the premises and assaulting cops while seeking to deliver instant justice to the alleged molester. Several cops sustained minor injuries.

Missing MP girl found dead, rape suspected

A seven-year-old girl missing since Monday was found dead inside a banyan tree hollow in MP's Mandsaur on Tuesday. Police suspect sexual assault and murder and have detained two men. After the body's discovery, family members marched to police station, demanding that the suspects be handed over to them. TNN

Sanjit 'Bunker' Roy, activist, educator and rural community champion, dies at 81

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Roy, with his wife Aruna (left), spent over five decades proving that India's rural communities could be self-sufficient without needing to be 'rescued'

Jaipur: Sanjit 'Bunker' Roy, who spent over five decades proving that India's rural communities could be sustainably self-sufficient without requiring "rescuing", died at home in Rajasthan's Tilonia at 6.15am Tuesday. He was 81.

Fellow activist Nikhil Dey said the founder of Barefoot College, a community-based movement inspired by the Gandhian dictum that knowledge, skills and wisdom found in villages should be harnessed for their development, "went as he wanted to, surrounded by people who loved and cared for him".

But for his calling, Roy might have lived a different life with his wife and associate Aruna. Doon School, St Stephen's College, three national squash titles and a childhood of privilege pointed one way. He went the other, settling in Tilonia, a remote village in Ajmer district, to make an argument with his life: rural communities needed to be trusted to uplift themselves.

The turning point was witnessing the ravages of the Bihar famine of 1966-67. In 1972, he arrived in Tilonia and began working with farmers on groundwater recharge through open wells. The work grew into the Social Work and Research Centre, later renamed Barefoot College.

Roy believed villagers held knowledge and skills that conventional development models ignored. "Barefoot College trained local people as solar engineers, health workers, midwives, teachers and handpump mechanics. It established night schools for working children and encouraged adults to continue their education," Dey added.

Nothing expressed that philosophy better than the Solar Mamas programme, launched in 2000. It trained women from remote villages, many with little or no formal schooling, to assemble, install and repair solar lighting systems. After six months in Tilonia, they returned home as experts in solar energy.

The organisation has trained over 2,000 women from 96 countries and electrified over 75,000 households, saving 45 million litres of kerosene, according to its brochure.

Roy kept away from attention. At donor meetings and graduation ceremonies, he would slip out of the spotlight and point journalists towards the women instead. For him, they were the real story. He was conferred the Padma Shri in 1986. TIME magazine named him among world's 100 most influential people in 2010.

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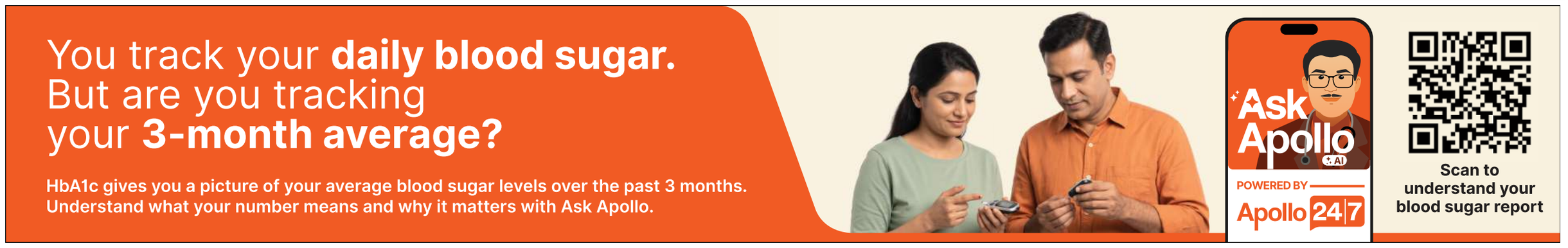
Date: 11.11.2026 Chief General Manager (HRD)



'Nearly 50% with diabetes remain undiagnosed till they're screened'

ASK THE DOCTOR

Ahead of World Diabetes Day on Nov 14, ***Dr Nikhil Tandon,*** *director of AIIMS Delhi and head of endocrinology and metabolism, tells* ***Anuja Jaiswal*** *that preventing and managing diabetes needs informed choices, like focusing on whole meals instead of only cutting off sugar, avoiding two large meals a day, and managing stress with a good night's sleep*

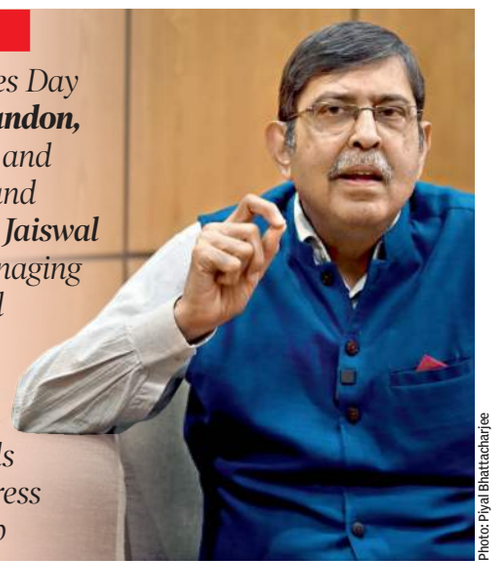


Photo: Piyal Bhattacharjee

A WORLD DIABETES DAY SPECIAL

Many in their 20s and 30s are being diagnosed with diabetes. Is it happening more often than in previous generations?

Type 2 diabetes is increasingly affecting younger people, including adolescents. Unlike type 1, an autoimmune condition, type 2 is influenced by lifestyle, diet and body weight. Key modifiable risk factors include excess weight, physical inactivity, unhealthy eating and poor sleep. We can't change our genes but can address these factors to cut risk. Blaming genetics alone can discourage people from taking action.

Rice, chocolates and sweets make a good part of our daily diet even as many of us spend long hours sitting at work, while watching television or scrolling on our phones. How do these habits contribute to diabetes?

Rather than individual foods, two broad issues matter: poor nutrition and sedentary behaviour. Even if you eat the right kind of food, large amounts can lead to weight gain. Then again, you may eat a reasonable quantity but still make unhealthy food choices. How you distribute food across meals also matters. Eating two very large meals may not be ideal. And finally, even if you divide your food into smaller portions, eating them too close together may not be advisable. Sedentary behaviour goes beyond screen time. Many everyday activities that once kept us moving have been replaced by prolonged sitting. As the saying goes, 'Sitting is the new tobacco'. The risk lies not in sitting itself, but in missing out on regular movement, such as standing and walking.

Is someone who looks fit and slim also at risk of developing diabetes?

A thinner person may have a lower risk than someone who is overweight, but no one is completely protected. Risk also depends on body composition and fat distribution. People with the same BMI may have different body fat and muscle levels. For Indian and South Asian populations, a BMI of 18 to 23 is generally considered a healthier range, but diabetes can still develop within it. Many Indians tend to store more fat around the waist, which may increase metabolic risk.

We add sugar to tea and coffee, but packaged foods also have hidden sugar. What should consumers watch out for?

FSSAI has taken a positive step by introducing back-of-pack labelling. The next challenge is to get consumers to read and understand these labels. Making information available is not enough; people must be able to use it to choose what and how much to eat, and what to avoid.

Some doctors call sugar poison. Is jaggery, honey the same? How much sugar can we eat?

Calling sugar poison may deter some people, but others may assume jaggery or honey is harmless as it's natural. Both have concerns similar to sugar. Sugar is non-essential, so sweets, carbonated drinks and high-fructose products should be limited. However, needs vary with activity levels, and extreme restrictions are unnecessary. An occasional indulgence is different from a daily habit. A balanced diet matters, not just cutting sugar while consuming excess oil or other unhealthy foods.

Should people with diabetes avoid mangoes, bananas, fruit juices and smoothies? Do chocolates and rice have to be given up?

Fruit intake depends on how well diabetes is controlled and the quantity consumed. A small portion of mango is different from eating a kilogram. Mangoes, bananas and grapes need portion control, but absolute restrictions are unnecessary. Apples, pears, peaches and oranges can be eaten in moderation. Whole fruit is better than juice as it retains fibre, which slows sugar absorption. Smoothies are not necessarily a better option. Their nutritional value depends on the ingredients; adding high-fat milk or sugar increases calories, fat and sugar. People need to understand what goes into their food to make informed choices, including when eating out. An occasional small piece of chocolate is fine, but eating a slab every day is not advisable. Moderation is key. Food combinations also matter: rice or roti eaten with vegetables, greens and salad can have a different effect on blood sugar than the same meal without them. People with diabetes need personalised guidance on portions, meal timing, body weight and diet.

Is it possible to have diabetes without knowing it? Are we more likely to have it if it runs in the family?

Absolutely. Under the earlier 'rule of halves', around 50% of those with the condition were estimated to remain undiagnosed until screened. Frequent urination, excessive thirst and hunger usually occur when blood sugar is very high. Other warning signs include recurrent infections and wounds that do not heal. But symptoms may emerge late, sometimes after complications have developed. That is why screening is important. People should not wait for symptoms to get tested. Genetic predisposition may play a role, but family lifestyle is equally important. Since genes can't be changed, the focus should be on habits such as exercise, food choices and meal patterns, which children often inherit from their parents. A family's eating and activity habits can influence diabetes risk across generations.

Any other form of diabetes we need to know about? What is prediabetes? Should people be worried if they are told they have it?

Among the less common forms, gestational diabetes deserves particular attention. Women develop it during pregnancy, and have a higher risk of Type 2 diabetes later on. The risk does not end with childbirth, so follow-up screenings are important.

Prediabetes means blood sugar levels are higher than normal but below the diabetes threshold. It signals an increased risk of developing diabetes. Risk is a continuum: a fasting glucose of 125 mg/dL may be below the diagnostic cut-off, while 126 mg/dL meets it. But risk does not suddenly begin at a certain number. Prediabetes is an opportunity to act through lifestyle changes rather than simply worry about the reading.

Can Type 2 diabetes be prevented? Can it go into remission, and does remission mean the condition is cured?

For those who are overweight, weight loss can help prevent or delay diabetes. This involves reducing dietary fat and refined carbs, increasing fibre and exercising regularly. The benefit depends on the percentage of body weight lost, not just the kilos. Build up physical activity gradually. Start with 15 mins of walking if 30 mins is difficult, and increase over time. Aim for at least 150 mins of moderate-intensity activity a week. If a person has been diagnosed with diabetes and their blood sugar levels remain below the cut-off without medication for a specified period, it may be described as remission. The duration required depends on the prevailing medical definition. However, remission is not a cure. It lasts as long as the necessary interventions are maintained. If they stop, diabetes can return.

What is the biggest mistake people make after being diagnosed with diabetes? What can Indians do to prevent the condition?

When diagnosed, they often react in two extremes — either giving up everything at once, which is difficult to sustain and can affect mental well-being, or denying the diagnosis and continuing with old habits, risking complications. Both are harmful. The key is to understand the condition and make sustainable lifestyle changes. To prevent diabetes, focus on three things: a balanced diet rather than simply avoiding sugar, rice or potatoes; regular physical activity through work or leisure; and stress management with good sleep habits. Stress may be difficult to measure, but managing it is important.

Scan this to watch our podcast with **Dr Tandon**

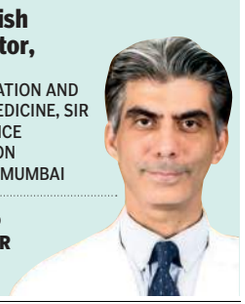
FICTION VS FACT

Do muscles turn to fat if you stop working out?

- ✗ A long break from exercise makes muscles 'soften' and become fat
- ✓ Both are entirely different types of tissue. One cannot turn into the other

"What actually happens is that muscle fibres atrophy owing to disuse after a prolonged break from physical activity, while fat deposits can form separately, changing a person's body composition and making them appear less toned or heavier. Reduced physical activity lowers muscle mass, strength, energy expenditure. If calorie intake remains unchanged despite reduced activity, the excess calories may be stored as fat. Muscle loss can begin as early as 2-3 weeks of inactivity, depending on age, diet and activity levels. Older people may experience faster muscle loss, particularly when protein intake is inadequate. However, lost muscle can be regained through consistent exercise and proper nutrition

Dr Aashish Contractor,
DIRECTOR, REHABILITATION AND SPORTS MEDICINE, SIR H N RELIANCE FOUNDATION HOSPITAL, MUMBAI



As told to Jahnavi TR

TIMES NATION

'I saw Rajiv reaching out to me, smiling at me'

Sonia Recounts Surgeries, Health Scares In Book

▶ **Continued from P1**

After much discussion with her doctors, Sonia Gandhi opted to get operated on by Dr Veronesi, a celebrated surgeon who was the founder and head of the European Institute.

In her book, 'Belonging: A Journey of Love', Sonia writes, "On the day of the surgery, as I was wheeled into the operation theatre, Rahul and Priyanka held my hand and kissed me on the forehead, assuring me that all would be well. Afterwards, still groggy from the anaesthesia, I saw Dr Veronesi with them by my bedside. How relieved I felt to hear him announce, 'Non c'è niente da preoccuparsi, tutto è andato bene e non ci sono residui. (No need to worry, everything has gone well and there are no residues).' He had removed two tumours, including a non-suspicious one to be on the safe side, and conducted an intra-operative radiation to spare me five weeks of radiotherapy."

However, a year later, routine follow-up tests detected a growth in the pancreas. This time Sonia was sent to Erasmus, to be treated by a well-known pancreatic surgeon, Dr Casper van Eijck. Again, Rahul and Priyanka were by her side before the surgery. When she woke up, dazed and parched, she heard them calling out, "Ma, Mama, all is well — nothing bad!" The doctor later explained that fortunately, the tumour was found in a preliminary precancerous stage, having been detected early.

Sonia also mentions that in Aug 2016, she collapsed during a long roadshow in hot and humid weather in Varanasi and broke her shoulder in the fall, forcing her to undergo another operation. While being flown to Delhi and floating in and out of consciousness, she writes, "Then I saw him again — Rajiv, reaching out to me, smiling at me reassuringly as if to say, 'everything will be fine'; Sheila Dikshit, who was by my side throughout, told me later that she noticed me suddenly smile in the middle of the tension-racked flight — I'm sure it must have been that moment."

Apart from these episodes, there have been no other major health scares — though, like most residents of Delhi, the toxic winter air does bother her.

Sonia Gandhi, flanked by Rahul and Priyanka, at Rajiv's funeral

Sonia's memoir a bid to whitewash history: BJP

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: BJP Tuesday slammed Sonia Gandhi's memoir as an attempt to "whitewash history" and rejected her suggestion that Rajiv Gandhi was not responsible for the delay in Army deployment to control the anti-Sikh riots as an "outright lie".

Claiming that Sonia was trying to give a "clean chit" to her husband, the then PM, BJP fielded H S Phoolka, recognised for his decades-long fight as a lawyer of riot victims, who emphasised that official records contradicted her claim that Rajiv contacted then Army chief Gen A S Vaidya on Oct 31, the day Indira Gandhi was assassinated in 1984, and the delay in deployment was due to Gen Vaidya.

The Justice Ranganath Misra Commission in its report had noted that 6,100 Army soldiers were available in Delhi at that time and nearly 2,000 Sikhs could have been saved had 5,000 of them been deployed, Phoolka said. He recalled Rajiv's "earth-shakes-when-a-big-tree-falls" remark which has been slammed for seeking to "rationalise" the massacre of Sikhs.

Sonia writes in her book 'Belonging: A Journey of Love', "Although the Chief of Army Staff General A S Vaidya had received his orders the same night as the assassination, we heard later that he decided not to mobilise the nearest units because they were manned by Sikh soldiers, a factor that might have exacerbated the situation."

Gen Vaidya had told the Misra Commission, Phoolka noted, that he on his own decided to make the Army available in case it was needed. He never said Rajiv had contacted him, Phoolka added.

BJP spokesperson Pradeep Bhandari said Sonia had pandered to vote bank politics by speaking of the Babri mosque demolition in 1992 but omitted any mention of the Bofors scam which, he noted, was a major factor in Rajiv being ousted from office in 1989.

Vehicles set ablaze during the 1984 anti-Sikh riots in New Delhi

From Babri to Batla House, VHP accuses Sonia of 'selective outrage'

New Delhi: VHP Tuesday demanded an apology from Sonia Gandhi for statements that it claimed "have hurt Hindus". VHP's Surendra Jain asked why Gandhi, who had purportedly shed tears over the demolition of the Babri structure, had not shown similar anguish when more than 350 temples were demolished and Hindus were massacred in Kashmir, Congress netas were killed by Naxalites in Bastar, or Sikhs were massacred in Delhi in 1984.

Jain accused Gandhi of selective outrage, saying that she had expressed grief over the killing of terrorists in the Batla House encounter but remained silent on attacks against Hindus and the sacrifices of security personnel.

He questioned whether Sonia had expressed similar grief over the death of inspector Mohan Chand Sharma, who was fatally wounded during the operation in Delhi's Batla House.

He also cited the killing of Hindu tourists in Pahalgam and alleged atrocities against Hindus in Bangladesh, Pakistan, Bengal and Keralam. He further questioned Gandhi's response to the killing of kar sevaks and the 1984 anti-Sikh killings, accusing Congress of remaining indifferent to such incidents.

"Sonia Gandhi's tears are crocodile tears. These are electoral tears, which she is pretending to shed to attract the Muslim vote bank," he said.

Targeting Congress over what he described as Muslim appeasement, Jain also criticised a party leader's reported remarks contrasting pollution levels during Diwali and Eid. TNN

Odisha govt terminates officer held on bribery charges

Odisha govt on Tuesday terminated the service of probationary officer Manisha Mishra, 28, days after her arrest over the charge of accepting Rs 7,000 in bribe. Mishra was caught on Nov 6 while accepting the bribe for facilitating land registration. TNN

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA — TENDER NOTICE

SR NO	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PWD B&R, PALWAL	CONSTRUCTION OF NEW ROAD FROM VILLAGE BHIDUKI TO VILLAGE BHAINDOLI RD 0.00 TO 2.30 KM HAVING CONSOLIDATION PATH MORE THAN 6 KARAM UNDER HODAL CONSTITUTION IN PALWAL DISTT. (WITHOUT GST)	07.11.2026 16.11.2026	237.81 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9466219169 pwd-eepd-palwal@hry.nic.in
2	CONTROLLER, PRINTING & STATIONERY,DEPARTMENT HARYANA, PANCHKULA	PURCHASE OF DELUXE DIARY, POCKET DIARY, VISITING CARD CASE & ORDINARY DIARY FOR THE YEAR 2027.	CLOSING DATE 07.12.2026	65 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9872020766 opbranch06@gmail.com
3	KALPANA CHAWLA GOVT MEDICAL COLLEGE KARNAL	E-TENDER FOR SUPPLY MEDICINE AND CONSUMABLE (CAP. NITROFURANTOIN 100MG, TAB. RANITIDINE 150MG, SYP. ZINC 60ML ETC.) AT KCGMC, KARNAL	16.11.2026 23.11.2026	EMD 10000	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9896154463 director.kcghc-hry@gov.in
4	ZILA PARISHAD, ROHTAK	CONSTRUCTION OF COMMUNITY CENTER DHAMMAR + 1 WORKS	05.11.2026 12.11.2026	51.53 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01262254150 prexeeng.roh@hry.nic.in
5	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, CHARKHI DADRI	REQUIREMENT OF THE MATERIAL FOR REPAIR OF 325 HP & 200 HP ATS STARTER AT PUMP HOUSE NO. 3 OF LOHARU CANAL UNDER JURISDICTION OF LWS (M) SUB DIVISION NO. 1, CHARKHI DADRI & 10 MORE WORKS	CLOSING DATE 20.11.2026	10.48 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01250-220058 xenlwsmech@gmail.com
6	PUBLIC HEALTH ENGINEERING, MANDI DABWALI	MANDI DABWALI STP:- PROVIDING AND INSTALLATION / REPLACEMENT OF EQUIPMENT AND ELECTRIC INSTALLATION AT 16.50 MLD STP MANDI DABWALI DISTT. SIRSA. CH. TO :- MANDI DABWALI:- ESTIMATE FOR REPLACEMENT/UPGRADATION OF EQUIPMENT`S AND ELECTRICAL ITEMS AT 16.50 MLD STP AT DABWALI TOWN DISTT. SIRSA	06.11.2026 25.11.2026	149.58 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8730000001 ee.mandidabwali@gmail.com
7	DIRECTORATE OF STATE TRANSPORT HARYANA, CHANDIGARH	SHORT TERM TENDER NOTICE FOR PROCUREMENT OF NEW STEEL RADIAL TUBELESS TYRE OF SIZE 295/80R22.5-16PR, NEW NYLON TYRE SETS OF SIZE 7.50X16-16PR WITH TUBE AND FLAP AND NEW STEEL RADIAL TYRE SET OF SIZE 10.00R20-16PR WITH TUBE & FLAP FOR MEETING REQUIREMENT FOR THE BUSES OF HARYANA ROADWAYS FOR NEXT ONE YEAR.	11.11.2026 25.11.2026	29.52 CRORE	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01722709809 dtcstore22@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT www.etenders.hry.nic.in

RO No. 50914

Government of Jammu & Kashmir
Jammu & Kashmir Academy of Art, Culture & Languages
Lal Mandi, Srinagar/Canal Road, Jammu
Email : sec-jkaacl@jk.gov.in

TENDER NOTICE

Subject : Notice inviting e-tender for conceptualization, design, fabrication, installation and performance presentation of the Jammu & Kashmir Tableau at Republic Day Parade - 2027/Bharat Parv New Delhi.

The Secretary, Jammu and Kashmir Academy of Art, Culture and Languages invites online bids through J&K e-Procurement Portal from eligible bidders under a two-envelope system for selection of a technical agency conceptualization, design, fabrication, installation and performance presentation of the Jammu & Kashmir Tableau at Republic Day Parade - 2027/Bharat Parv New Delhi, in accordance with applicable procurement rules and Ministry of Defence guidelines.

The bidding documents consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specification, bill of quantities (BOQ), set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be downloaded from **www.jktenders.gov.in**

S.No.	Particulars	Details
1	Name of Work	Conceptualization, Design, Fabrication and Installation of J&K Tableau for Republic Day Parade - 2027/Bharat Parv
2	Tender viewing	**https://jktenders.gov.in**
3	Registration/uploading	**https://jktenders.gov.in**
4	Estimated cost	Rs. 75,00,000/- (Rupees Seventy-Five Lakh only), inclusive of GST (maximum ceiling)
5	Tender fee	Rs. 1,000/- (Rupees One Thousand only), non-refundable, subject to applicable exemptions
6	EMD	Rs. 1,50,000/- (Rupees One Lakh Fifty Thousand only), being 2% of estimated cost, subject to applicable exemptions
7	Performance Security	Rs. 2,25,000/- (Rupees Two Lakh Twenty Five Thousand only) being 3% of contract cost.
8	Pre-bid meeting	13.11.2026 at 12:30 PM, Office of the Secretary, JKAACL, Canal Road, Jammu
9	Bid submission start	09.11.2026 at 4:00 PM
10	Bid submission end	18.11.2026 at 4:30 PM
11	Technical bid opening	19.11.2026 at 12:30 PM
12	Financial bid opening	To be notified after technical evaluation

E-NIT NO. JKAACL/Acctts/2026-27/2114, Dated : 09.11.2026

Sd/-
Secretary JKAACL

DIP No:/DIPK-NB-2086/26/10.11.2026

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT/ EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF FULLY AUTOMATED IMMUNO HEMATOLOGY ANALYZER ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	10.11.2026 01.12.2026	1,26,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	8929299829 equipmentdgm2020@gmail.co m
2	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF FULLY AUTOMATED CHEMILUMINISCENCE (CLIA) ANALYZER ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	10.11.2026 01.12.2026	60,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	8929299829 equipmentdgm2020@gmail.co m
3	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF REFRIGERATED CENTRIFUGE ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	10.11.2026 01.12.2026	2,25,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	8929299829 equipmentdgm2020@gmail.co m

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in RO No. 50912

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

(Regd. Office : PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)
Corporate identity Number U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website : www.pspcl.in
Phone No. - 96461-18774, Email id - semeteringpatiala@gmail.com

Tender Enquiry No. MQP-277/2026-27/PR **Dated : 06.11.2026**

Chief Engineer/Metering, C-3, Shakti Vihar, PSPCL, Patiala invites e-tender for Design, Supply, Testing, Commissioning, Integration, Reading, Analysis and 5 year O&M of ISI marked LT AC 3 phase, 4-Wire CT operated Static, DLMS Compliant, Energy Meters (Category-D3) of -/5 A of Accuracy Class 0.5S (for both active and reactive energy) with 'Optical Port', AMI system & Communication infrastructure with a network platform across Punjab. For detailed NIT & tender specification please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 06.11.2026, 17.00 PM onwards.

Note : Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

C1077/26, DPR/Pb.:1079/12/2026-27/16915

NORTHERN RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/Traction Distribution, DRM's Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi for & on behalf of President of India, invites open e-tender for the under noted work:

1	**Name of Work with its location**	Part-F: Provision of feeder wire for enhancement of existing OHE capacity to cater increasing load requirements of GHH/TSS of DLI Division.
2	**Approx. Cost of work**	Rs. 14,75,17,157.71/-
3	**Earnest Money Deposit**	Rs. 29,50,400/-
4	**Pre-Bid Conference Date & Time**	20.11.2026 (11.00 hrs.)
5	**E-Tender Bid Online Submission Period**	23.11.2026 (00.00 Hrs.) to 07.12.2026 (15.00 Hrs.)
6	**E-Tender Bid Submission End Date & E-Tender Open Date & Time**	07.12.2026 (15.00 hrs.)
7	**Fund Allocation**	Capital (PH-36)
8	**Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen**	www.ireps.gov.in

E-TENDER No.: 35A-TRD-NDLS-2026-27 Dated : 10.11.2026 **3941/2026**

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

DIRECTORATE GENERAL OF MARITIME ADMINISTRATION, MUMBAI

CANCELLATION OF REQUEST FOR PROPOSALS (RFP)

Tender Ref. No.: 20-19/12/2025-TRG-DGS
Tender ID: 2026_DGS_904398_1
Date: 10-11-2026

Tender Title: Request for Proposals (RFP) for Selection of Service Provider for the Development of a Maritime Training Ecosystem

This is to notify all prospective bidders and the general public that the above-mentioned Request for Proposals (RFP) and the tendering process stand cancelled/annulled with immediate effect.

The corrigendum for cancellation dated 10-11-2026 is available on the Central Public Procurement Portal (CPPP: **https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app**) and DGMA Website: **https://dgma.gov.in/**.

Sd/-
(Shri Mugilrajan Devarajan)
Deputy Director General of Maritime Administration

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

(Regd. Office : PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)
Corporate identity Number U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website : www.pspcl.in
Phone No. - 96461-18774, Email id - semeteringpatiala@gmail.com

Tender Enquiry No. MQP-271/2026-27/PR **Dated : 06.11.2026**

Chief Engineer/Metering, C-3, Shakti Vihar, PSPCL, Patiala invites e-tender for Procurement of 4-in-1 Polycarbonate Meter Boxes (Cabinets) for incorporating Single Phase Energy Meters. For detailed NIT & tender specification please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 06.11.2026, 17.00 PM onwards.

Note : Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

C1078/26, DPR/Pb.:1079/12/2026-27/16917

New Okhla Industrial Development Authority

Main Administrative Building, Sector-96, Noida, G.B. Nagar (U.P.)
Website : www.noidaauthorityonline.in

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tenders are invited from eligible contractors/firm for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on Noida Authority's official website: **www.noidaauthorityonline.in** & **https://etender.up.nic.in.** Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/amendments & corrigendum etc.

A) Fresh - Tender Work:

S. No.	Jobs No.	Name of the work	Tender Amount (Rs. Lacs)
1	13/GM/ SM(WC-1)/ ET/2026-27	Request for Proposal for Selection of NGO to undertake various Information Education and Communication (IEC) activities to achieve the objectives & activities of My Bharat Portal in Noida Authority (Request for Proposal)	160.37

The above tenders can be uploaded from dated 12.11.2026 to 25.11.2026 up to 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on dated 26.11.2026 at 11.00 AM

General Manager (Civil)
NOIDA

CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA

उत्तर प्रदेश सहकारी चीनी मिल्स संघ लिमिटेड

9–ए, राणा प्रताप मार्ग, लखनऊ –226001, तार: 'यूपसुरफेड' पीबीएक्स 0522–2612849, 2615722, 2201856, फैक्स नं.: 91–522–2627994, दूरभाष–2200183, 2628310, 2283121
ईमेल: upsugarfed@yahoo.co.in वेबसाइट : www.upsugarfed.org

GEM TENDER NOTICE

On line GeM Tender is invited from registered Civil Consultant firm for the following jobs:-

S. No	Scope of Work	Bid Uploding Start From	Bid Opening Date
1	**Civil Consultant for Morna- Mordenzation/Upgradation Job including Capacity expansion from 2500 TCD to 3500 TCD. GEM/2026/B/8239153 Date 04.11.2026**	**04.11.2026**	**20.11.2026**
2	**Civil Consultant for Bagpat- Mordenzation/Upgradation Job including Capacity expansion from 2500 TCD to 5000 TCD. GEM/2026/B/8239370 Date 04.11.2026**	**04.11.2026**	**20.11.2026**

The details of submission of e-bids along with eligibility of Technical/Financial bids, EMD, experience and other terms & conditions is mentioned in tender document, available on GeM portal. Bidders who have already submitted the required EMD in previous tender **(MORNA-GEM/2026/B/8067777date-22.09.2026)** and **(BAGPAT-GEM/2026/B/8067864 date-22.09.2026)** need not to submit EMD again. Tender without E.M.D. shall be rejected. The Federation reserves the right to cancel bids or the e-bidding process without assigning any reason thereof. The decision of Federation will be final & binding upon bidders.

MANAGING DIRECTOR

NORTHERN RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/Traction Distribution, DRM's Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi for & on behalf of President of India, invites open e-tender for the under noted work:-

1	**Name of Work with its Location**	Part-B: Replacement of overaged PSI assets in PTNR and FDB section inconnection with Design, supply, erection, testing & commissioning for Augmentation/Replacement of overaged PSI assets in DLI area of Delhi division.
2	**Approx. Cost of work**	Rs. 3,72,77,205.79/-
3	**Earnest Money Deposit**	Rs. 7,45,600/-
4	**E-Tender Bid Online Submission Period**	20.11.2026 (00.00 Hrs.) to 04.12.2026 (15:00 Hrs.)
5	**E-Tender Bid Submission End Date & E-Tender Open Date & Time**	04.12.2026 (15:00 hrs.)
6	**Fund Allocation**	Capital (PH-36)
7	**Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen**	www.ireps.gov.in

E-Tender No.: 39-TRD-NDLS-2026-27 Dated: 10.11.2026 **3939/2026**

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GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	THE PANIPAT CO-OP. SUGAR MILLS LTD., PANIPAT	SALE OF PRESS MUD FOR CLUSTER SUGAR MILL DURING SEASON 2026-27	07.11.2026 14.11.2026	160 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9996161393 panipatsugarmills@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in Ro No. 50913

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA CORRIGENDUM

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD CORP./AUTH	OLD REFERENCE/NIT NO.	NATURE OF CORRIGENDUM	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HVPNL	DNIT NO.180212(EPC-D-147/PD&C)DATED 22.09.2026	" OPENING DATE OF CORRIGENDUM-2 IS 06.11.2026 WITH EXTENSION IN DUE DATE OF ONLINE BID SUBMISSION UPTO 13.11.2026 17:00 HRS. "	www.hvpn.org.in	0172-2583789 PRO@HVPN.ORG.IN
2	HVPNL	DNIT NO.180205(EPC-D-149/PD&C)DATED 22.09.2026	" OPENING DATE OF CORRIGENDUM-2 IS 06.11.2026 WITH EXTENSION IN DUE DATE OF ONLINE BID SUBMISSION UPTO 13.11.2026 17:00 HRS. "	www.hvpn.org.in	0172-2583789 PRO@HVPN.ORG.IN

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in Ro No. 50885

SEARCH FOR MISSING

Kuldeep Kumar

General Public is hereby informed that one male namely **Kuldeep Kumar S/o Puran Lal R/o** H.No. 12, Ali No.5/2, Guru Nanak Dev Colony Bhalswa Dairy Near Shiv Shakti Mandir Delhi has been missing since 01.11.2026 at 08.30 PM from the area of P.S. Bhalswa Dairy, Delhi. In this regard a case vides **DD No. 90A** dated **02.11.2026** has been registered at PS. Bhalswa Dairy, Delhi. The description of missing male is as under : **Name** : Kuldeep Kumar, **Father's Name** : Puran Lal, **Age** : 40 yrs, **Height** : 5'9", **Built :** Medium, **Face :** Long, **Complexion** : Shallow, **Wearing** : Mehroom Color T-Shirt & Blue Jeans and Sleeper in feet.

If anyone having any clue/information, kindly inform the undersigned.

SHO
P.S., Bhalswa Dairy, Delhi
Ph.: 011-27811933, 9555110046

Website : http://cbi.nic.in
e-mail : cic@cbi.gov.in
Fax : 011-24368639
Ph. : 011-24368638, 24368641
DP/16270/ON/2026

Appeal for Identification

General Public is hereby informed that a male dead body **Name:** Unknown, **S/o** Unknown, **R/o:** Unknown **Age:** About 30 years, **Height:** 5'5", **Complexion:** Wheatish, **Built:** Normal, **Face :** Round, **Hair:** Normal, **Wearing :** Pant Shirt was found Dhaula Kuan Delhi Cantt, New Delhi. In this regard **FIR No. 513/2026 U/s 281/106(1) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023** has been lodged in PS Delhi Cantt, Delhi.

Sincere efforts have been made by local police to trace out information about the relatives of the person but no clue has come to light so far.

Any, person having any information or clue about the relatives of this person may kindly inform to the following.

SHO
P.S., Delhi Cantt, New Delhi
Ph. : 7065036229

DP/16208/SW/2026

Appeal for Identification

General public is hereby informed that one male **Namely:** Unknown, **S/o:** Unknown, **R/o:** Unknown, **Age:** Approx 32-36 Years, **Height:** 5'5", **Sex:** Male, **Complexion:** Wheatish, **ID Mark:** MK tattoo on right hand & OM on left hand, **Wearing:** Grey coour T-Shirt, Black colour Lower with White colour Strip, was found dead at Kashmere Gate Metro Station, Delhi. In this regard **DD No. 13A, Dated 29.10.2026** has been lodged at **Police Station: Kashmere Gate, Delhi.**

Any clue come to notice please inform undersign.

SHO
P.S.: Kashmere Gate, Delhi
Ph.: 8750870323

DP/16199/METRO/2026

SEARCH FOR MISSING

ARVIND DAS

General Public is hereby informed that one Person **Namely:** Arvind Das **S/o** Paltan Das, **R/o:** H. No. C/79, Aram Bagh, Pahar Ganj, New Delhi , **Sex:** Male, **Age:** 50 Years **Height:** 5'6", **Complexion:** Wheatish, **Wearing:** White colour Vest, White colour Gamcha and White colour Pajama has been missing at H. No. C/79, Aram Bagh, Pahar Ganj, New Delhi since 07.11.2026. In this regard **FIR No. 478/2026, U/s: 140(3) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, Dated: 07.11.2026,** has been registered at **P.S.: Pahar Ganj, New Delhi.**

Sincere efforts have been made by local Police to trace out the missing Person but no clue has come to light so far. If anyone have any information about this the missing Person, please inform to the following.

E-mail: cic@cbi.gov.in
Website: http://cbi.nic.in
Fax: 011-24368639
Ph: 011-24368638, 24368641
DP/16285/CD/2026

SHO
P.S: Pahar Ganj, New Delhi
Ph. : 8750870427

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General public is hereby informed that a unidentified dead body of a male namely **Unknown, S/o Unknown, R/o Unknown has found dead on 22.10.2026 from Mangol Puri, Delhi.** In this regard **DD No. 51A, dated 22.10.2026** has been lodged at Police Mangol Puri, Distt-Outer, New Delhi. Identification of unidentified male is as under:

Name: Unknown, Age: 35 Years, Height: 5'6", Complexion: Shallow, Wearing: Green & Blue Track Suit & Blue Color Pent, Naked Feet.

If anyone have any information or clue about this male may kindly be inform undersigned.

SHO
P.S. Mangol Puri, Delhi
Ph.: 7065036122, 8800626677

DP/16266/OD/2026

SEARCH FOR MISSING/KIDNAPPED

Anshika

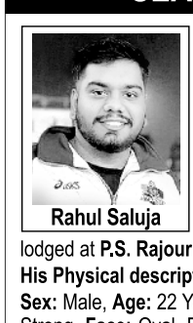
General Public is hereby informed that one female (depicted in the photo) namely **Anshika W/o Rajiv R/o** Jhuggi No. 10, Ambedkar Camp, Peeragarhi, Delhi **Age**-24 Yrs, has been reported missing since 03.11.2026 at around 07:00 PM from her residence, vide **FIR No. 0334/26, Dated 05.11.2026, U/S 140(3) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023,** registered at **Police Station Paschim Vihar East, Outer Distt., Delhi** Her physical description is as under: **Sex:** Female, **Height:** 5'2", **Complexion:** Shallow, **Face:** Oval, **Built:** Normal, **Wearing:** Suit & Salwar and slipper in her Feet.

Sincere efforts have been made by local police to trace out the missing female but no clue has come to light so far. If anyone have any information about this missing female please inform to the following.

SHO,
Police Station Paschim Vihar East,
Outer Distt. Delhi
Ph.: 8750779798

Website: https://cbi.nic.in
DP/16232/OD/2026

SEARCH FOR MISSING



Rahul Saluja

General public is hereby informed that one male (depicted in the photo) Namely: **Rahul Saluja, S/o. Narender Saluja, R/o. House No. C-22, Tagore Garden Extension, Rajouri Garden, Delhi** has been Missing/abducted from his house Since **04.11.2026.** In this regard a Missing/abducted report case vide **FIR No.563/2026 dated 06.11.2026 U/S 140(3) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023** has been lodged at **P.S. Rajouri Garden, West District, Delhi.**

His Physical description is as under:-

Sex: Male, **Age:** 22 Years, **Height:** 5' 10", **Complexion:** Sallow, **Built:** Strong, **Face:** Oval, Beard Black, **Wearing :** Black Shirt, Dark Jeans and Red Color Slipper.

Sincere efforts have been made by local police to trace out the Missing/abducted man but no clue has come to light so far. If anyone having any information about this man please inform to the following:-

Phone No.: 011-24368638, 011-24368641 | Fax no.: 011-24368639 | Email id : cic@cbi.nic.in | Website : https://cbi.nic.in

SHO
P.S – Rajouri Garden, Delhi
Mobile No.:8750871127, 9868060966

DP/ 16246/WD/2026

SEARCH FOR MISSING

Surbhi

General Public is hereby informed that one Girl **Namely: Surbhi D/o Bijendra R/o H. No. 416, Gali No. 4, Rajveer Colony Ghadoli Delhi Sex:** Female, **Age:** 16 Years, **Height:** 5', **Complexion:** Wheatish, **Face:** Round, **Identification Mark:** 'R' Tatoo in Middle Finger Right Hand **Wearing:** Pink Colour Frock and Slipper in feet has been missing since 31.10.2026 from H. No. 416, Gali No. 4, Rajveer Colony Ghadoli Delhi From The Jurisdiction of Police Station Gazipur, Delhi.

In this regard **FIR No 568/2026 U/s 137(2) BNS Dated 02.11.2026** has been registered at **PS: Gazipur, Delhi** Sincere efforts have been made by local police to trace out the missing Girl but no clue has come to light so far. If anyone have any information about this missing Girl Please inform to the following.

Website : http://cbi.nic.in
E-Mail ID: cic@cbi.gov.in
Fax: 011-24368639
DP/16242/ED/2026

SHO
P.S.: Gazipur, Delhi
Mobile: 8588014161, 8750870625

SEARCH FOR MISSING/KIDNAPPED GIRL

CHANDNI

General public is hereby informed that this girl namely **Chandni** D/o Sanjoj Sapera R/o H. No. 525, Fatak Wali Gali, Village Khera Kalan, Alipur, Delhi, **Age:** 16 years, **Height:** 4.6 feet, **Built:** Thin, **Complexion:** Fair, wearing red colour suit-salwar has been missing/kidnapped from her house since 16.10.2026. In this regard a **FIR No. 593/26 u/s 137 (2) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita dated 17.10.2026 has been registered at P.S. Alipur, Delhi.**

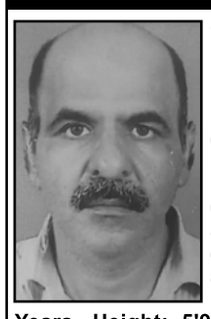
Any person having any information or clue about this missing/kidnapped girl may kindly inform to the following.

E-mail: cic@cbi.gov.in
Website: http://cbi.nic.in
Fax: 24368639,
Tel.: 24368638/24368641

SHO : P.S. Alipur, Delhi
Ph. : 7065036325, 9911549427

DP/16224/ON/2026

SEARCH FOR MISSING/KIDNAPPED



General public is hereby informed that a male namely **Mohd. Gazi Khan, S/o: Late Mohd. Asgar Khan, R/o: A-230/1, Thokar No-7, Shaheen Bagh, New Delhi has been Missing/Kidnapped since 30.10.2026 at 6:00 PM to 2:00 AM from his home. In this regard FIR No. 270/2026, U/s: 140(3) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, Dated: 09.11.2026, has been registered at P.S. Shaheen Bagh, New Delhi.** The description of Missing/Kidnapped male is as under:

Name: Mohd. Gazi Khan, Age: 55 Years, Height: 5'9", Complexion: Fair, Wearing: Blue Colour Shirt & Black Colour Pant and Yellow and Blue Jacket, ID Mark: Schizophrenia Patient.

If anyone have any information about this Missing/ Kidnapped male please inform P.S. **Shaheen Bagh,** New Delhi.

Web: http://cbi.nic.in, Email: cic@cbi.gov.in
Ph.: 011-24368638/24368641, Fax: 011-24368639

SHO
Police Station Shaheen Bagh, New Delhi
Ph: 8750870926, 9968255510

DP/16288/SE/2026

SEARCH FOR MISSING/KIDNAPPED

Shalini

General Public is hereby informed that one Female (depicted in the photo) namely **Shalini D/oRam Raj, R/o** H.No. B-88, Gali No.-2, North Chajjupur, Delhi, **Age**-22 Yrs, has been reported missing since 03.11.2026 at 4.00 PM, from her Residence, vide **FIR No. 501/2026, Dated 05.11.2026,** registered at **Police Station Jyoti Nagar, North-East Distt., Delhi.** Her physical description is as under:

Sex: Female, **Height:** 5'0", **Complexion:** Wheatish, **Face:** Long, **Built:** Thin, **Wearing:** Brown Shirt, Black Jeans and White Shoes in her Feet.

Sincere efforts have been made by local police to trace out the missing female but no clue has come to light so far. If anyone have any information about this missing female please inform to the following.

SHO,
Police Station Jyoti Nagar,
North-East Distt., Delhi
Ph.: 8750870726, 8700794381

Website: https://cbi.nic.in
DP/16248/NE/2026

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General Public is hereby informed that an unidentified Male namely **Unknown S/o:** Unknown **R/o** Unknown, was found Dead on 05.11.2026, from Safdarjung Hospital Near Arvindo Marg Under Footover Bridge, Pootpath, New Delhi. In this regard **DD No. 55A, Dated 05.11.2026,** has been lodged at **Police Station Safdarjung Enclave, South-West Distt., New Delhi.** Identification of unidentified dead body of male is as under:

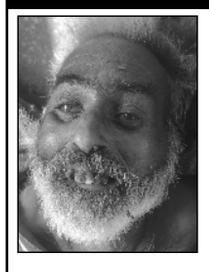
Sex: Male, **Age:** 45 Yrs, **Height:** Approx 5'7", **Complexion:** Shallow. The dead body of deceased has been preserved for 72 hours in Safdarjung Hospital Mortuary, Delhi for identification.

If any one having any information or clue about this male deceased may kindly be informed undersigned.

SHO,
Police Station Safdarjung Enclave,
South-West Distt., New Delhi
Ph.: 8750938971, 9588805681

DP/16178/SW/2026

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION



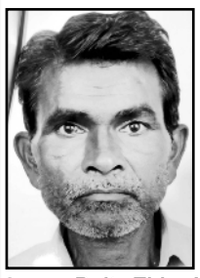
General public is hereby informed that this Person **Named:** Unknown, **S/o:** Unknown, **R/o:** Unknown, **Age:** 60 years, **Sex:** Male, **Height:** 5'3", **Complexion:** Wheatish, **Wearing:** Orange colour Shirt and Coffee colour Pent, **Place of Recovery:** He was found dead Blue Metro Line Pillar No. 347, Old Bus Stand Ramesh Nagar, Delhi on Date 08.11.2026. In this regard **DD No. 39A, Dated: 08.11.2026,** has been registered at P.S.: Kirti Nagar, Delhi.

Sincere efforts have been made by local police to trace out information about identity of this person but no clue has come to light so far. If any person having any information or clue about this person may kindly inform to the following.

SHO
P.S.: Kirti Nagar, Delhi
Ph.: 8750871126, 8800252403

DP/16237/WD/2026

SEARCH FOR MISSING/KIDNAPPED



General public is hereby informed that a male namely **Saravjit, S/o: Late Ram Raj, R/o: LW-33/3, Jhuggi Mangolpuri, Delhi has been Missing/Kidnapped since 25.10.2026 at 4:00 AM from his home. In this regard FIR No. 761/2026, U/s: 140(3) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, Dated: 28.10.2026, has been registered at P.S. Mangol Puri, Delhi.** The description of Missing/ Kidnapped male is as under:

Name: Saravjit, Age: 55 Years, Height: 5'6", Complexion: Fair, Face: Long, Buit: Thin, Wearing: Yellow Colour Shirt & Blue Colour Pant, Hawai Slipper in her feet, (Mentally Unstable), ID Mark: Tattoo Namely Saravjit and Asha Devi on Right Hand.

If anyone have any information about this Missing/ Kidnapped male please inform P.S. **Mangol Puri,** Delhi.

Web: http://cbi.nic.in, Email: cic@cbi.gov.in
Ph.: 011-24368638/24368641, Fax: 011-24368639

SHO
Police Station Mangol Puri, Delhi
Ph: 011-27922168, 7065036122

DP/16127/OD/2026

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General public is hereby informed that this Person **Named:** Mohit, **S/o:** Rajesh, **R/o:** Unknown, **Age:** 22 years, **Sex:** Male, **Height:** 5'5", **Complexion:** Shallow, **Built:** Thin, **Face:** Round, **ID Mark:** "OM" Tattoo mark on his right wrist, **Wearing:** White colour Shirt, Blue colour inner and brown colour Pant, **Place of Recovery:** He was found unconscious condition at Sofia NGO 243, Geeta Ghat Monastery Market, Civil Lines Delhi and admitted in LNJP Hospital, Delhi on 28.10.2026, during the treatment Dr. declared brought him dead. In this regard **DD No. 25A, U/s:194 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023, Dated: 28.10.2026,** has been registered at P.S.: Civil Linesd, Delhi.

Sincere efforts have been made by local police to trace out information about identity of this person but no clue has come to light so far. If any person having any information or clue about this person may kindly inform to the following.

SHO
P.S.: Civil Lines, Delhi
Ph.: 011 23810633, 8750870127

DP/16192/N/2026

SEARCH FOR MISSING/KIDNAPPED

Siya @ Pari

General Public is hereby informed that one Girl (depicted in the photo) namely **Siya @ Pari C/o** Pooja Lamba **R/o** H.No. J-692, Jahangir Puri, Delhi, **Age**- Approx 14 Yrs, has been reported missing since 29.10.2026 at around 8.00 PM from her Residence, vide **FIR No. 479/2026, Dated 01.11.2026, U/S 137(2) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023,** registered at **Police Station Mahindra Park, North-West Distt., Delhi.** Her physical description is as under:

Sex: Female, **Height:** 5'0", **Complexion:** Fair, **Face:** Round, **Built:** Thin, **Identification Mark:** Cut Mark in Left Hand **Wearing:** White T-Shirt, Black Jeans and Blue Slipper in her Feet.

Sincere efforts have been made by local police to trace out the missing girl but no clue has come to light so far. If anyone have any information about this missing girl please inform to the following.

SHO,
Police Station Mahindra Park,
North-West Distt., Delhi
Ph.: 8750870227, 9868047871

Website: https://cbi.nic.in
DP/16217/NW/2026

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT/ EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL COMMITTEE RADAUR	CONSTRUCTION OF IPS ON MC LAND NEAR JMIT AT CHOTA BANS IN MUNICIPAL COMMITTEE RADAUR, DISTRICT YAMUNA NAGAR + 2 WORKS	06.11.2026 20.11.2026	9,21,19,062/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9050970239 secymcradaur@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in RO No. 50895

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
केन्द्रीय भवन प्रमण्डल संख्या–01, भवन निर्माण विभाग पटना
पुर्न अल्पकालीन ई–निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या– 06/26–27 (डबल वीड सिस्टम)
(केवल ई–निविदा पद्धति बेबसाईट **www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in** पर)

निम्नांकित कार्य हेतु तकनीकी एवं वित्तीय वीड सिस्टम में ऑन लाईन ई–निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है :–

कार्य का विवरणी :–

क्र०	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि (लाख में)	अग्रधन की राशि (लाख में)	निविदा कागजात का मूल्य (रू० में) (अप्रत्यर्पणीय)	ई–निविदा प्रक्रिया शुल्क (रू०)	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि
1	सूचना भवन, पटना में अग्निशमन अधिष्ठापन कार्य वर्ष 2026–27.	₹ 324.96 लाख	₹ 6.50 लाख	₹ 10,000=00	₹ 11,800=00	03 माह

1. विज्ञापनदाता का पदनाम एवं पता : कार्यपालक अभियंता, केन्द्रीय भवन प्रमण्डल संख्या– 01, पटना।
2. निविदा आमंत्रित करने की तिथि : दिनांक– 09.11.2026
3. निविदा कागजात प्राप्त (डाउनलोड) एवं जमा (अपलोड) करने की तिथि एवं समय : दिनांक– 24.11.2026 से 16.12.2026 के 15:00 बजे तक। केवल बेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर।
4. निविदा तकनीकी बीड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय : दिनांक– 18.12.2026 को 15:00 बजे। केवल बेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर।
5. निविदा वित्तीय बीड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय : सक्षम पदाधिकारी से तकनीकी बीड मूल्यांकन के पश्चात्।
6. प्री–बीड मीटिंग की तिथि एवं समय : (क) दिनांक– 17.11.2026 को अधीक्षण अभियंता का कार्यालय, दक्षिण बिहार अंचल, पटना। 15:00 बजे अपराह्न (ख) दिनांक– 18.11.2026 को मुख्य अभियंता (पटना) का कार्यालय, भवन निर्माण विभाग, बिहार, पटना। 15:00 बजे अपराह्न
7. निविदा की वैधता की अवधि : 120 दिन।
8. निविदा स्वीकृत करनेवाले पदाधिकारी का पदनाम एवं पता : सक्षम पदाधिकारी।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
केन्द्रीय भवन प्रमण्डल
संख्या–01, पटना

PR- 015239 (BCD) 2026-27

विस्तृत जानकारी वेबसाइट//state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर देखा जा सकता है।

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER (BUILDING) PUBLIC WORKS DEPARRTMENT KALA MANDIR ROAD, SWAGAT BHAWAN, REWA (MADHYA PRADESH)
PHONE No. 07662-406740 E-mail:-dpepiurewa@gmail.com

NIT No. 30/2026/CENTRALISED TENDERING/CE/PWD/BUILDING/2050 REWA, DATE:- 27/10/2026

Online bids for the following works are invited from registered contractors and firms of repute fulfilling registration criteria :

S. No.	Tender Portal ID	Name of work	District	Probable Amount Contract (Rs. In lakh)	Eranest Money Deposit (EMD) (in Rs.)	Cost of Bid Document (in Rs.)	Period of completion (in months i/c Rainy Season)	100% Incumbrance Free Land Available And MOU Signed
1		3	4	5	6	7	8	9
1	2026_ PWPIU_ 545988_1	CONSTRUCTION OF 50 CLASSROOM SCIENCE BUILDING (G PLUS 3) INCLUDING WATER SUPPLY, SANITARY FITTING AND ELECTRICAL WORK AT GOVT. TRS COLLEGE, REWA DISTT.- REWA M.P. (FIRST CALL)	REWA	1891.74	1000000.00	30000	18 Months	YES

1. All details relating to the Bid Document (s) can be viewed and downloaded free of cost from the website, **http://mptenders.gov.in**
2. Bid Document (s) can be purchased after making online payment of portal fees through Credit/Debit/Cash Card/internet Banking.
3. The Bid Document (s) can be purchased only online from 10.00 (time) 30/10/2026 (date) to 05.30(time) 16/11/2026 (date). Other key dates may be seen in Bid Data Sheet.
4. Amendment (s) to NIT, if any, shall be published on website only, and not in newspaper.

G-21240/26

Sd/-
Executive Engineer(building)
P.W.D. REWA (M.P.)

''पॉक्सो है सुरक्षा का हथियार, बच्चों पर न करें अत्याचार''

डेयरी, मत्स्य एवं पशु संसाधन विभाग
(अभियंत्रण कोषांग)
विकास भवन, नया सचिवालय, बिहार, पटना

Corrigendum

एतद् द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि इस कार्यालय के ज्ञापांक–335 दिनांक–13.10.2026 से निर्गत ई–निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या–DFARD/अभि0को0/SBD/37/2026–27 जिसका पी० आर० संख्या–PR-013632 (Animal) 2026-27 के माध्यम से दैनिक जागरण समाचार पत्रों में दिनांक–15.10.2026 को प्रकाशन हुआ है से संबंधित तिथियों में अपरिहार्य कारणवश आंशिक संशोधन करते हुए निम्नलिखित शुद्धि–पत्र निर्गत किया जाता है:–

ई० निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना सं०– DFARD/अभि0को0/SBD/37/2026–27 का कंडिका सं०	विवरण	प्रकाशित ई० निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना में अंकित तिथि एवं समय	नयी संशोधित तिथि एवं समय
3	निविदा कागजात प्राप्त करने (डाउनलोड) करने की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय	दिनांक–2.11.2026 10:00AM से 09.11.2026 तक	दिनांक–11.11.2026 से 18.11.2026 तक
4	प्री–बीड मीटिंग की तिथि, समय एवं स्थान	दिनांक–4.11.2026 11:00 AM अभियंत्रण कोषांग, विकास भवन, कमरा संख्या–316, नया सचिवालय, पटना।	दिनांक–12.11.2026 11:00 AM अभियंत्रण कोषांग, विकास भवन, कमरा संख्या–316, नया सचिवालय, पटना।
5	संवेदक द्वारा निविदा अपलोड करने की अंतिम तिथि/समय	दिनांक–11.11.2026 को 3:00 PM तक	दिनांक–19.11.2026 को 3:00 PM तक
6	निविदा (तकनीकी बीड) खोलने की तिथि/समय	दिनांक–11.11.2026 को 4:00 PM तक	दिनांक–19.11.2026 को 4:00 PM तक

निविदा आमंत्रण संबंधित शेष शर्त्ते पूर्ववत रहेगी।

मुख्य अभियंता
डेयरी, मत्स्य एवं पशु संसाधन
विभाग, बिहार, पटना

PR- 015245 (Animal) 2026-27

विस्तृत जानकारी वेबसाइट//state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर देखा जा सकता है।

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार

Government of Jammu & Kashmir
OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
Mechanical and Hospital Division Anantnag
Mechanical and Hospital Engineering Department, Kashmir
e-mail: xenmhd-ang@jk.gov.in

GIST of e-NIT No. MHDA/TS/2026-27/82 Dated: 04-11-2026

For and on behalf of the Lieutenant Governor, J&K UT e-tenders are invited in two cover system (Technical and Financial) on percentage basis from Original Equipment Manufacturers or their authorized dealers/ firms or firms having substantial relevant experience for the below mentioned work:

Name of the Work	Estimated Cost (In Lacs)	Cost of Tender Doc. (In rupees)	Earnest Money (In rupees)	Time of Completion
1	2	3	4	5
Design, Supply, Installation, Testing and Commissioning of 02 x 1000 LPM Capacity Oxygen Generation Plants along with Operation at MMABM Associated Hospital Govt. Medical College Anantnag.	451.84	4000.00	903680.00	270 days

- Position of Administrative Approval: **Accorded by Secretary to Govt. Health and Medical Education vide order No.: 584-JK (HME) of 2025 dated 22-08-2025.**
- Position of Technical Sanction: **Accorded.**
- **Position of Funds: Available with intending department.**

1. ***Downloading of Bids:*** The Tender document Consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, Bill of quantities (B.O.Q), Set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen from the Govt. website **www.jktenders.gov.in** from **04-11-2026 (16:00 Hrs.)** and downloading documents from **04-11-2026 (16:00 Hrs.)**
2. ***Submission of Bids:*** The bidders shall deposit their bids in electronic format on the above website from **04-11-2026 (16:00 Hrs.)** to **20-11-2026 (14:00 Hrs.)** in two covers.
3. ***Opening of Bids:*** The bid uploaded on the Web Site up to due date and time will be opened on **21-11-2026 (14:00 Hrs.)** in Office of the Superintending Engineer, Mechanical & Hospitals Circle Kashmir, Srinagar. /undersigned after approval.

No: MHDA/ TS-478/3493-94
Dated: 04-11-2026
DIP No:/DIPK-7548/26/10.11.2026

Sd/-
Executive Engineer
M and H Division Anantnag

OFFICE OF THE DIRECTOR GENERAL ASSAM RIFLES, SHILLONG - 793 010

ASSAM RIFLES TECHNICAL AND TRADESMAN RECRUITMENT RALLY 2026

1. Assam Rifles Technical and Tradesman Recruitment Rally 2026 is tentatively scheduled from **18 Jan 2027 onwards** for enrolment into Group C posts against **354** vacancies. Applications are invited from eligible candidates male for the trades/ posts as mentioned below:-

1.1	Warrant Officer (Cipher)	–	124
1.2	Rifleman (Electrical Fitter Signal)	–	32
1.3	Rifleman (Lineman Field)	–	21
1.4	Rifleman (Armourer)	–	29
1.5	Rifleman (Engineer Equipment Mechanic)	–	10
1.6	Rifleman (Recovery Vehicle Mechanic)	–	13
1.7	Rifleman (Electrician Mechanic Vehicle)	–	22
1.8	Havildar (Instrument Repairer/ Mechanic)	–	06
1.9	Rifleman (Metalsmith)	–	19
1.10	Rifleman (Upholster)	–	03
1.11	Rifleman Store Keeper, Technical, Electrical Mechanical Engineer	–	16
1.12	Rifleman (Vehicle Mechanic/ Fitter)	–	23
1.13	Rifleman (Welder)	–	02
1.14	Warrant Officer (Draughtsman)	–	02
1.15	Warrant Officer (Operation Theatre Technician)	–	01
1.16	Warrant Officer (Physiotherapist)	–	02
1.17	Rifleman (Mason)	–	29
	Total	–	354

2. The aspirants are hereby advised to regularly visit the Assam Rifles Official website (**www.assamrifles.gov.in**) for further details and submission of online application.
3. Vacancies are tentative & is subject to variations. The Assam Rifles has the right to make any change in the advertisement or cancel it without assigning any reasons.
4. In case of any query, the following numbers may be contacted on any working day from 0900 hrs to 1700 hrs:-
   (a) 0364-2585118 (b) 0364-2585119 (c) 8794101693
   (d) Email- rectbrdgar@gmail.com

Sd/- x-x-x
(Sunil Kumar)
2IC
SO-1 (Rect)
For Brig (Pers)

DELHI CANTONMENT BOARD
TENDER NOTICE

Delhi Cantonment Board invites tenders from the eligible and experience contractors through e-tendering for the following works as detailed below:

Date of release of tender through e-procurement	:	12.11.2026 at 1700 hrs
Last date & time for downloading of tender documents	:	07.12.2026 upto 1300 hrs
Last date and time submission of e-tenders	:	07.12.2026 upto 1300 hrs
Date and time for opening of e-tenders	:	08.12.2026 at 1330 hrs

Details of work

Sl. No.	Name of work	Amount of Contract	Earnest Money Deposit Amount
1.	Improvements and facelifting of Parade Road, Thimmaya Marg (Part), Srinagesh Garden and Cremation ground at Uri Enclave, Delhi Cantt.	Rs. 12,55,23,570/-	Rs. 9,52,618/-

The bidder may download the "Tender Document" and other terms and conditions as applicable including detailed NIT, terms & conditions, particular specifications, special conditions, signing of Integrity Pact, adherence to GFR 2017 provisions, applicability of Public Procurement (Preference to Make in India), Order 2017 etc as provided in the technical bid from web site of **https://defproc.gov.in** & **https://delhi.cantt.gov.in**.

Please note that any amendment, clarification, errata to tender documents shall be uploaded on website **https://defproc.gov.in** & Cantt Board website **https://delhi.cantt.gov.in**. All intending bidders are required to visit aforementioned websites to check for amendments, clarifications, errata etc prior to quoting their rates & no compensation whatsoever shall be admissible to the bidders for failure to register the same.

Telephone No. 25695450
No. DCB/8/C-1/TN/2026-27/16
OFFICE OF THE CANTONMENT BOARD
Website : https://delhi.cantt.gov.in.

Sd/-
Chief Executive Officer
Delhi Cantonment

भारतीय प्रतिभूति और विनिमय बोर्ड
Securities and Exchange Board of India

NBCC Complex, Tower 1, 8th floor, Block A
East Kidwai Nagar, New Delhi – 110023
Ph: 011 69012922, 011 69012962
Email: auctionsnro@sebi.gov.in,
poonam@sebi.gov.in

Notice of E-Auction / Sale

NOTICE FOR SALE OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY OF ABHEY RAM DAHIYA THROUGH E-AUCTION

Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) invites bids for sale of immovable property attached under **Recovery proceedings** initiated vide the **Recovery Certificate No. 2935 of 2020** dated June 24, 2020 **against Abhey Ram Dahiya (ABVPD0924C), Amardeep Singh Dahiya (AANPD3910B) and Pankaj Dahiya (AGLPD1665M) [Defaulters]** in the matter of Polo Hotels Limited under Section 28A of the SEBI Act, 1992 read with the Second Schedule to the Income Tax Act, 1961 through e-auction platform on ***"as is where is and whatever there is"*** basis.

Quikr India Private Limited (hereinafter referred to as "the Agency", "Quikr") has been appointed as the e-auction provider and online registration and e-auction will be conducted through **https://auctions.quikr.com** using e-auction platform of Auction Tiger.

Intending bidders are invited to submit their bid(s) along with an amount equivalent of **10% of the Reserve Price (RP)** as **Earnest Money (EMD)** for the following property to be paid through EFT/NEFT/RTGS in the bank account of SEBI.

Sl. No	Description of the property	Area	RP (Rs.)	EMD (Rs)
1	Residential house property situated at House No. 329, Sector-21A, Chandigarh	1,001 SYD land and 536.46 SYD built-up area	20,30,40,000	2,03,04,000

The complete description of the property along with Reserve Price, EMD, inspection of property documents, remittance details, date of e-auction, contact details of Agency engaged to assist in the sale, detailed terms and conditions of e-auction etc. are available on the website of SEBI i.e. **www.sebi.gov.in** under **Enforcement > Auction Notice under Recovery Proceedings** and the website of Quikr i.e. **https://auctions.quikr.com**

The intending bidder is required to deposit its **EMD on or before December 09, 2026 up to 5:00 pm** in favour of **SEBI's Bank of India (BOI)** Virtual Bank Account number **'SEBI Recovery Proceeds' (i.e. 'SEBIRNDSG2935', IFS Code of BOI Virtual account is BKID00VAN04)** or in the **Bank account no. 012210210000013 (IFS Code- BKID0000122, Branch BKC, Mumbai)** followed by an intimation at Email IDs: **auctions@quikr.com**, **auctionsnro@sebi.gov.in** and **poonam@sebi.gov.in**. The **auction** in the matter has been **scheduled for December 15, 2026**.

For any further clarification, you may contact Quikr India Private Ltd. on contact numbers +919176197676 / +919321575329 / +91701918483, and on Email IDs: **auctions@quikr.com** and **winnie.manoj@quikr.com** and write to SEBI on Email IDs **auctionsnro@sebi.gov.in** and **poonam@sebi.gov.in**.

Note: The intending bidder(s) should make their own independent enquiries regarding the extent, measurement, nature, type, classifications, encumbrances, litigations, attachments, acquisition liabilities of the property, title, survey number(s)/plot number(s) and claim/rights/ dues, etc. in respect of the property put on auction, prior to submitting their bid(s). The notice of sale does not constitute and will not be deemed to constitute any commitment or any representation of SEBI /the Agency. The property is being sold with all the existing and future encumbrances, whether known or unknown to SEBI / the Agency. SEBI /the Agency shall not be responsible in any way for any third party claims/rights/dues, etc. Taxes/other applicable rates, charges etc. of whatever description, shall have to be borne by the successful bidder(s).

-sd-
Rajan Kumar
Deputy General Manager & Recovery Officer
Securities and Exchange Board of India

Place: New Delhi
Date: November 05, 2026

CBC 15204/11/0137/2627

13001/2421/2627

Bhubaneswar Development Authority
Bhubaneshwar Development Authority
Akash Shova Building, Sachivalaya Marg, Bhubaneswar, Odisha 751001
Ph: +91-0674-2392801
INVITATION FOR BIDS

Bid Identification No 648/EM/BDA **Date. 07/11/2026**

Engineer Member, BDA on behalf of Bhubaneswar Development Authority, Bhubaneswar invites following item rate bids in double cover system in **ONLINE MODE** from eligible bidders as mentioned below:

Sr.	Particulars	Details
1.	Name of work	Selection of an Agency for Operating & Maintaining Gymnasiums in Buddha Jayanti Park in Bhubaneswar, Odisha
2.	Cost of Bid Documents	INR 10,000.00 + 18% GST INR 11,800.00 **(Online Mode)**
3.	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	INR 5,00,000.00 **(Online Mode)**
4.	Availability of Tender	From 10.11.2026 to 05.00 PM of 30.11.2026
5.	Last date and time of submission of Tender	05.00 PM of 30.11.2026
6.	Date and time of opening of Tender	06.00 PM of 30.11.2026
7.	Place of opening of Tender	O/o - Engineer Member, BDA, Bhubaneswar

Further details can be seen from the website: **https://tendersodisha.gov.in.** Any addendum / corrigendum/cancellation of tender can also be seen in the said website.

Sd/-
Engineer Member
BDA, Bhubaneswar
OIPR-13001/13033/1/26-27/0182

34001/1146/2627

GOVERNEMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER,
SOUTHERN (R&B) CIRCLE, BRAHMAPUR
Phone : 0680-2281582, e-mail: ccescbam@gmail.com
INVITATIONS FOR BIDS (IFB) [e-Procurement]
Bid Identification No. CCE, S.C (R&B)-BAM-13/2026-27 No. 4425 // Dated: 28.10.2026

1) The **Chief Construction Engineer, Southern (R&B) Circle, Berhampur** on behalf of Governor of Odisha invites **percentage rate bid** in double cover system in **ONLINE MODE** from eligible contractors for construction of **Road and Building works** as detailed in the table below.
2) Nature of work : Road and Building Works
3) No. of work : 10 Nos.
4) Tender Cost : Rs.10,000/- (online)
5) Class of Contractor : "B" Class / "A" Class / "Special" Class
6) Availability of Bid document in the website : 12.11.2026 10.00 AM to 26.11.2026 5.30 PM
7) Date of Opening of Bid : 27.11.2026 at 11.30 A.M.
8) The Bidders have to participate in ONLINE bidding only. Further details can be seen from the website **https://tendersodisha.gov.in.**
9) Any addendum / corrigendum / cancellation of tender can also be seen in the said website only.

Sd/-
(Damodar Kaibartta)
Chief Construction Engineer,
Southern (R&B) Circle, Brahmapur
OIPR-34001/34103/1/26-27/0013

25001/1510/2627

By E_Mail/e-Despatch
E_Mail ID: serwcbaripada@gmail.com
Ph-No-06792-261343/261344
Gangraj, Baripada

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, BARIPADA
"e" Procurement Notice for Road Work
Identification No.- Online Tender- Road N.C.B No. 436 of 2026-27
Letter No. 5788 / Date: 06/11/2026

1. Name of the work : **Periodical Maintenance Work for financial Year 2026-27 (Road Work).**
2. Total No. of work : 03 Nos. Packages (Three)
3. Estimated Cost : **Rs.107.56 Lakhs & Rs.111.88 Lakhs** (Approximately)
4. Eligible Class of Contractor : As per annexure.
5. Period of Completion : As per annexure.
6. Other details

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Availability of tender On-line for bidding		Last Date & Time of seeking Tender Clarification	Date & Time of Opening of Tender in O/O C.C.E.R.W. Circle, Baripada	
		From	To		Technical Bid	Financial Bid
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Chief Construction Engineer, Rural Works Circle, Baripada	Road On-line N.C.B. No. **436**	Dt. 12.11.2026 at 11.00 A.M	Dt.27.11.2026 up to 5.00 P.M.	Dt. 26.11.2026 up to 5.00 P.M.	Dt.30.11.2026 at 11.00 A.M.	Will be intimated later

- **Further details can be seen from the website: www.tendersodisha.gov.in**
- **Any Corrigendum / Addendum will be displayed in the above e_tender website only.**

Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer,
R.W. Circle, Baripada
OIPR-25001/25181/1/26-27/0025

25001/1507/2627

By E_Mail/e-Despatch
E_Mail ID: serw_balasore@yahoo.in
Ph-No- 06782/260318
Balia, Balasore

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, BALESHWAR
"e" Procurement Notice for Road Work
Identification No: Online Tender- Road N.C.B. No. 17 for 2026-27
Letter No. 4577 Date. 05.11.2026

1. Name of the work : **(MMSY- Improvement to existing RD road & CMRL)**
2. Total No. of work : **23 Nos. of work.**
3. Estimated Cost : As per annexure.
4. Eligible Class of Contractor : As per annexure.
5. Period of Completion : As per annexure.
6. Other details:

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Availability of tender On-line for bidding		Last Date & Time of seeking Tender Clarification	Date & Time of Opening of Tender in O/O S.E.R.W. Circle, Balasore	
		From	To		Technical Bid	Financial Bid
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Chief Construction Engineer, Rural Works Circle, Baleshwar	NCB No.-17 of 2026-27	13.11.2026 at 11.00 A.M	30.11.2026 Up to 5.00 P.M.	27.11.2026 Up to 5.00 P.M.	01.12.2026 at 11.00 A.M.	Will be intimated later

- Further details can be seen from the website: **www.tendersodisha.gov.in**

Sd/- **Chief Construction Engineer**
R.W. Circle, Baleshwar
OIPR-25001/25105/1/26-27/0019

25001/1509/2627

By E_Mail/e-Despatch
E_Mail ID : serwcbaripada@gmail.com
Ph-No - 06792-261343 / 261344
Gangraj, Baripada

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, BARIPADA
"e" Procurement Notice for Plan Bridge Works
Identification No.- Online Tender- Bridge N.C.B. No. 439 for 2026-27
Letter No. 5704/ Date : 05.11.2026

1. Name of the work : Bridge Works under SBY in the District of Mayurbhanj
2. Total No. of work : **09** Nos. (Nine)
3. Estimated Cost : **Rs. 317.94 lakhs to Rs. 899.57 lakhs** (approximately).
4. Eligible Class of Contractor : **As per Annexure**
5. Period of Completion : **As per Annexure**
6. Other details :

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Availability of tender On-line for bidding		Last Date & Time of seeking Tender Clarification	Date & Time of Opening of Tender in O/O C.C.E.R.W. Circle, Baripada	
		From	To		Technical Bid	Financial Bid
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Chief Construction Engineer, Rural Works Circle, Baripada	Bridge Online N.C.B. No. **439**	Dt. 20.11.2026 at 11.00 A.M.	Dt. 05.12.2026 up to 5.00 P.M.	Dt. 04.12.2026 up to 5.00 P.M.	Dt. 07.12.2026 at 11.00 A.M.	Will be intimated later

- **Further details can be seen from the website : www.tendersorissa.gov.in.**
- **Any Corrigendum/ Addendum will be displayed in the above e_tender website only.**

Sd/- **Er. A.K Naik**
Chief Construction Engineer
R.W. Circle, Baripada
OIPR-25001/25181/1/26-27/0024

32001/1304/2627

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
DEPARTMENT OF WATER RESOURCES
Second Dam Rehabilitation and Improvement Project
Additional Financing (DRIP 2-AF)
"INVITATION FOR EXPRESSIONS OF INTEREST"
(Consulting Services – Firms Selection)
e-Procurement Notice No. CE&BM-MB- EOI –14/2026-2027 (Online)

World Bank Project ID: P170873

The Chief Engineer and Basin Manager, Mahanadi Basin, Burla, Odisha, India under the Water Resources Department, Government of Odisha, an implementing agency under the Second Dam Rehabilitation and Improvement Project – Additional Financing (DRIP 2-AF), now invites eligible consulting firms ("Consultants") to indicate their interest in providing the Consultancy Services for "Consultancy Services for Construction Supervision and Quality Assurance of Works, including Detail Engineering Designs and Construction Drawings for the Construction of Additional Spillway of Hirakud Dam on Left of Gandhi Hillock including Drop Structure, End Structure and Spill Channel, Burla, Odisha, India", under DRIP 2-AF. The complete document is available for download on Odisha website **www.tendersodisha.gov.in** (Organisation Name: CE BM UM Basin Burla World Bank Tenders). The interested Consultant firms may submit their application of the Expression of Interest by online in **www.tendersodisha.gov.in.** The details of the bidding process are as follows:

Sl. No.	Particulars	Details
1	Name of Employer	The Chief Engineer & Basin Manager, Mahanadi Basin, Burla
2	Method of Selection	As per the short listing criteria provided in the EOI document
3	Date and time of availability of EoI document in the portal	From Dt.09.11.2026 at 11.00 Hours (IST) to Dt.30.11.2026 up to 17.00 Hours (IST)
4	Last date/ Time for receipt of EoI in the portal	Dt.30.11.2026 up to 17.00 Hours (IST)
5	Deadline for Submission of Pre-Bid Queries	Dt.21.11.2026 up to 10.00 Hours (IST)
6	Pre-bid meeting through virtual mode	Dt.21.11.2026 at 11.30 Hours (IST)
7	Date, Time & Place of opening of EOI Proposal	Dt. 30.11.2026 at 17:15 Hours (IST) in Office of the Chief Engineer & Basin Manager, Mahanadi Basin, Burla, Sambalpur, Odisha

The undersigned reserves the right to cancel any or all EOIs without assigning any reason thereof
Any addendum/corrigendum/cancellation/erratum of tender can be seen from Government Website **http://tendersodisha.gov.in.**

Sd/-
Chief Engineer & Basin Manager
Mahanadi Basin, Burla
OIPR-32001/32508/1/26-27/0016

TIMES GLOBAL

THE TIMES OF INDIA, NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 11, 2026

JEMIMA GOLDSMITH SAYS RUSSELL BRAND ABUSED HER DURING THEIR RELATIONSHIP: 'HAD TO ONCE CALL COPS TO GET HIM OUT OF HOME'

TODAY'S MIGHTY OAK IS JUST YESTERDAY'S NUT, THAT HELD ITS GROUND — DAVID ICKE

JAMES GUNN AND PETER SAFRAN STEP DOWN AS CO-CEOs AND CHAIRMEN OF DC STUDIOS IN A SURPRISE SHUFFLE AT COMPANY

Trump puts chips on Huang as China spy storm gathers force

Prez Says FBI Probing Affair But Nvidia CEO 'Should've No Reason To Worry'

Chidanand Rajghatta | TNN

Reuters/File

US President Donald Trump with Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang

Washington: In Washington, national security issues usually require a healthy dose of suspicion, particularly where China is concerned. But in a remarkable display of trust, US President Trump is repeatedly vouching for Nvidia chief Jensen Huang following disclosures that he may have been ensnared in a Chinese honey-trap.

Speaking at the White House on Monday after revealing he had spoken to Huang, Trump described him as "a great, brilliant person, and we want to protect our brilliant people". Asked whether Huang knew that the woman he was having an affair with was allegedly a Chinese intelligence operative, Trump recounted asking him directly. "He said, 'I had no idea that she was a spy.' And I really believe him." He also said Huang was "suffering greatly," particularly because of the effect on his family.

On the FBI investigation, Trump offered reassurance rather than alarm: "I know the FBI is looking into it in terms of something else, and I think that he'll be in good shape." He even appeared reluctant to contemplate losing Huang as a presidential adviser or off-loading him on an upcoming trip to Asia, saying he would like the Nvidia boss to remain in his role and he had always found him "very above board." It was an extraordinary display of presidential confidence in a man whose company is being investigated by both spooks and lawmakers, coming as it did at a politically vulnerable time when Trump has received a drubbing in the mid-term elections.

The President's critics are now zeroing in on his financial disclosures in filings before the Office of Government Ethics that show Trump investment accounts bought between $500,001 and $1 million of Nvidia shares on Jan 6, 2026, and between $1 million and $5 million on Feb 10. A Sept filing disclosed that the account bought as much as $1.6 million and sold as much as $1 million in Nvidia stock during Aug alone.

These are not necessarily straightforward purchases made personally by Trump. The filings cover transactions in accounts associated with the president and his family, and the White House has repeatedly explained that independent third-party financial institutions manage the portfolio, replicating recognised indexes, including the Schwab 1000, and investment decisions are made without presidential input.

But given reports of widespread "graft" by Trump loyalists, lawmakers are raring to investigate the matter under overarching concerns about China — not that Congress, including Democratic lawmakers, are strangers to charges of insider trading.

Tech analysts meanwhile are digging into Huang's long and well-chronicled battle to sell advanced chips to China despite deep suspicion in Washington that it could result in US ceding its lead in artificial intelligence. In an April 2026 interview to tech podcaster Dwarkesh Patel that is now being viewed with renewed interest, Huang repeatedly bats for selling advanced chips to China.

Dwarkesh: Why would we want to sell China the materials for a cyberweapon? It's like selling them nukes with a casing that says 'made by Boeing' and claiming that's good for US.

Huang: "Comparing AI to nukes is lunacy. Enriched uranium is a lousy analogy. What we have to recognise is that AI is a five-layered cake." He then goes on to call such an approach a "loser attitude" and a "loser premise."

The nuclear analogy rankled Huang, who trashed it for weeks afterwards. But with FBI, Congress and an increasingly sceptical tech community now looking under the Nvidia hood, advanced AI chips have now become the new fissile material in America.

Nvidia intervened in US probe of Megaspeed chip smuggling

Nvidia Corp's general counsel intervened in a US govt probe of suspected smuggling of AI chips by Megaspeed International, questioning whether the Trump administration played a role in detaining an executive from the Singapore-based firm who's now at the heart of a scandal threatening Jensen Huang.

In late summer 2025, Nvidia's Tim Teter called commerce under secretary Jeffrey Kessler, who oversees US chip export curbs, to ask about the Megaspeed investigation, according to people familiar with the matter. Specifically, Teter wanted to know whether Kessler's bureau of industry and security (BIS) was involved in the Singapore govt's recent detention of Alice Huang, a Megaspeed executive, according to the people. Singapore police had brought Alice in for questioning and restricted her from leaving the country. BIS was not involved in that action, said the people, who spoke on condition of anonymity. An Nvidia spokesperson said that Teter was unaware of the affair at the time he called Kessler about Alice's detention in Singapore. It's unclear whether Teter made any specific requests of Kessler related to his agency's investigation into Megaspeed, which was separate from Singapore's. But in the weeks that followed, BIS staff were muzzled in their ability to look into the company, including a mandate that they route all requests of Nvidia through Kessler or seek his approval for outreach — a highly unusual step that remains unique to the chipmaker, the people said. They were also told not to mention Megaspeed or Speedmatrix, the company's Malaysian subsidiary, in external communications. BLOOMBERG

CEO's affair aided shipments of chips worth $7.5bn to China firms: Report

Nvidia shares extended losses Tuesday, putting the chip giant on track to shed about $400 billion in market value over two sessions as concerns mounted over the fallout from CEO Jensen Huang's affair-. The CEO's relationship with **Alice Huang** helped facilitate shipments of at least $7.5 billion worth of Nvidia chips to Chinese firms, The Information reported Tuesday, citing two people who know her. The allegations have intensified scrutiny of Nvidia's governance, export-control compliance and reliance on Huang's leadership. Nvidia shares fell more than 5% after losing 4.3% Monday, when the company shed $192.08 billion in market value. Tuesday's decline put another roughly $221 billion at risk if losses hold.

Alice Huang along with her husband and sister, built a network of companies across China and Singapore to acquire Nvidia chips, The Information reported. At the center of the network was Shanghai Century Litong, a China-based company that secured preferred cloud partner status with Nvidia in 2023, giving it priority access to the company's chips, the report said. When orders for Nvidia chips subject to US export restrictions stalled, Alice Huang used ties to Nvidia and its distributors to secure supplies, helping move about 240,000 H100, H200 and some A100 chips into China, according to the report. Century Litong rented computing capacity and operated data centers using Nvidia chips, including some barred from sale to China. Some of the chips ultimately served Alibaba, Tencent and smaller Chinese AI labs, The Information reported.

Trump signals new Iran strikes unnecessary now

'Keeping Status Quo At Behest Of Neighbouring Countries Of Iran'

US President Donald Trump indicated he's keen to pursue diplomacy with Iran and wind down the war following a White House meeting with Qatar PM, the main mediator between the warring sides. Further strikes on Iran won't be necessary, though US remains "locked and loaded," Trump said Monday after talks with Sheikh Mohammed bin Abdulrahman Al Thani. "Iran, militarily, is effectively over. We're just keeping it at the status quo, and we're doing that really at the behest of countries that are their neighbours."

The comments reflect the change in Washington since the Nov 3 midterms. Many members of Republican party blamed the war and resulting surge in energy prices for their loss of both houses of Congress to the Democrats.

Sheikh Mohammed thanked Trump and Vice President JD Vance and said he was "grateful for the positive discussions on reaching a deal and bringing peace to the region". Negotiations between Iran and US will carry on, according to an official familiar with the matter.

Sanction working fine, no need for combat ops: Rubio

Secretary of state Marco Rubio said Tuesday that he told G7 allies that the US economic sanctions and naval blockade are working so well that President Trump does not need to conduct major combat operations in Iran.

Speaking to reporters in Paris, Rubio repeatedly pushed back on the assertion that not returning to military action would amount to a stalemate or status quo. "The economic pain that is being inflicted on Iran right now is extraordinary and it compounds. It's growing every day," Rubio said. He added that Trump has also received input from regional allies in West Asia confirming this assessment.

Bibi calling Trump 'every day' to resume war: Report

Israeli PM Benjamin Netanyahu has reportedly maintained daily communication with President Trump, urging him to resume strikes against Tehran, according to an assessment published by the Financial Times. "Netanyahu calls him every day [to urge him to resume the war]. Those who don't want a war within the White House and outside have been trying to combat that," a person briefed on the discussions told the FT.

Houthis say targeted Riyadh

Yemen's Iran-backed Houthis Tuesday claimed attacks targeting Saudi Arabia, including Riyadh's airport. The Saudi-led coalition fighting the Houthis said it shot down a ballistic missile launched at the city. Houthi spokesman Yahya Saree said the attacks had also targeted pumping stations along the East-West pipeline in Riyadh, an Aramco facility in Abqaiq region as well as troops in Yemen. AGENCIES

Getty Images/File

A US Air Force B-52 Stratofortress strategic bomber at RAF Fairford

US WITHDRAWS AIRCRAFT FROM UK AIRBASE: REPORTS

The US has withdrawn military aircraft from a second British airbase following a threat from Iran, the Wall Street Journal reported, citing people familiar with events. A number of American refuelling tankers were evacuated Monday from Mildenhall Royal Air Force (RAF) base in eastern England after the purported threat, the newspaper said. Sky News said Tuesday that 12 aircraft — nine tankers and three Osprey transporters — left Mildenhall Monday, citing flight tracking sources. The WSJ noted 'the precise nature' of the Iranian threat remained 'under discussion' among US officials. The Pentagon is yet to comment on the matter

Sanctions will not work, respect and diplomacy will: Iran

Iran Tuesday urged US to meet its demands in a plan to reopen the Strait of Hormuz. These include ending the war on all fronts, unfreezing Iranian assets, lifting oil sanctions and ending the US counter-blockade of Iranian ports. "The conflict with Iran will not be resolved through military means, nor by intensifying sanctions," foreign minister Abbas Araghchi said. "The only solution is to adopt a language of respect, engage in diplomacy, and address Iran's conditions." AGENCIES

Gulf Arab states OK military command HQ in Kuwait

The six Gulf Cooperation Council states have approved the establishment of an advanced headquarters for their Unified Military Command in Kuwait and the deployment of "appropriate" forces to it, the bloc's secretary-general said. No further details were immediately available. The GCC comprises Bahrain, Kuwait, Oman, Qatar, Saudi Arabia and UAE. The Iran war has disrupted air travel and shipping, and raised concerns over the security of the region's oil and gas exports. AFP

Hasina has lost right to appeal, must face death: ICT prosecutor

Ahsan Tasnim

Dhaka: Former PM Sheikh Hasina has lost her right to appeal and must now face death for crimes against humanity, as the 30-day window to challenge the verdict has expired, Bangladesh International Crimes Tribunal (ICT) chief prosecutor Md Aminul Islam said Tuesday, amid growing mobilisation by Awami League supporters and street violence.

Six platoons of Border Guard Bangladesh (BGB) were deployed after protesters set a police vehicle on fire and clashed with law enforcers in Gopalganj Tuesday, a day after a series of crude bomb explosions were reported in Dhaka. Several roads in Dhaka division were blocked by around 3,000 to 4,000 activists of Chhatra League, Awami League and their affiliated organisations, according to authorities.

"If she genuinely wanted to return to Bangladesh, she would have come back while the trial was ongoing and faced the case. She would also have returned within 30 days of the publication of the verdict to file an appeal," he told reporters.

California billionaire tax defeated: California voters have rejected a one-time tax on billionaires, US media projected Monday, despite growing anger over global wealth disparity. The tax would have forced around 200 billionaires in the state to cough up 5% of their total net worth, with money largely dedicated to helping pay for healthcare. AFP

Russia and Ukraine hold first peace talks in 9 months, to continue today

Abu Dhabi: Russian and Ukrainian officials met in Abu Dhabi Tuesday for their first peace talks since Feb as US President Trump's envoys launched a new push to end the war in Ukraine.

The Washington-brokered meeting followed US contacts with both sides in recent weeks that Trump's representative Jared Kushner said had narrowed the gaps between their positions. Addressing delegates, Kushner said the US had some good ideas on how to make progress, and Trump was committed to achieving peace. The first round of talks ended without any immediate statement from any of the parties. A second day of negotiations was scheduled for Wednesday.

Reuters

Jared Kushner with UAE FM Sheikh Abdullah bin Zayed bin Sultan Al Nahyan in Abu Dhabi

Ukraine's chief delegate, Rustem Umerov, said in his opening remarks Kyiv was focused on achieving security guarantees and a lasting peace. Russian foreign minister Sergei Lavrov underlined Moscow's preference for negotiating a broad European security framework before tackling the specifics of the war.

European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen Monday voiced the opposite view, saying wider security talks should come only after a ceasefire. Lavrov again rejected the notion of a truce, saying the Europeans were trying to secure breathing space for Ukraine. Before the start of the main meeting, the Ukrainians met separately with European, Nato and European Union representatives and the two American envoys, Kushner and Steve Witkoff.

France said there could be no lasting peace in Ukraine without addressing European security, and that this required the involvement of the Europeans. Russia had made clear it did not see a place for Europeans at the meeting with the Ukrainians and Americans. REUTERS

Trump nominates Natalie Baker as US envoy to Pak

Islamabad: President Donald Trump has nominated Natalie Baker to be the next US ambassador to Pakistan, paving the way for the appointment of a permanent envoy to Islamabad after a gap of nearly two years, it emerged Tuesday. Baker is currently serving as charge d'affaires at the US Embassy in Islamabad. She assumed the role in Jan 2025, following the departure of then-ambassador Donald Armin Blome.

The White House, in a statement, said the nomination has been submitted to the US Senate, whose foreign relations committee will review it.

Baker arrived in Islamabad as deputy chief of mission in Aug 2024, according to details available on the embassy's website. Prior to that, she served as the deputy chief of mission at the US Embassy in Doha from Aug 2021 to July 2024. Baker oversaw the marked improvement in ties between Pakistan and the US during the tenure of President Trump. PTI

Diaspora grps write to Prez Murmu seeking probe into 'anti-India' protests in London

Naomi Canton

London: Fifty Indian diaspora and community organisations in UK have written an open letter to the President of India expressing serious concerns over "organised overseas campaigns targeting India's democratic and constitutional institutions" following demonstrations on Oct 16 and 17 outside the India high commission in London and the Gandhi statue on Parliament Square which YouTuber Dhruv Rathee flew over to take part in. The demonstrations were held in solidarity with the youth of India calling for the sacking of CEC Gyanesh Kumar.

The letter calls on the authorities in India to "examine credible evidence concerning any coordination, support, or collaboration between political and advocacy networks and extremist or separatist elements, including any alleged foreign-backed activities directed against India's national interests".

The letter says the protests, organised by the Students' Federation of India-UK, South Asia Solidarity group and Indian Overseas Congress's youth wing, triggered "concerns among sections of the Indian diaspora regarding the activities of certain political, ideological, and advocacy networks operating on British soil".

It raises concerns regarding the involvement of Pakistani and Bangladeshi Islamist organisations and pro-Khalistan separatist activists in connection with these demonstrations and "the wider anti-India mobilisation". It calls on the Indian authorities to probe allegations of incitement, violence, unlawful intimidation, deliberate disinformation, or "attempts to destabilise India's democratic processes from overseas".

Bangladesh must act against Chinese vloggers, says MEA

India has condemned the deliberate geographical misrepresentation by Chinese content creators in Bangladesh, terming efforts to pass off low-income neighbourhoods in Dhaka as parts of the Indian capital as "unfortunate". "We would urge that authorities must take action against such people," MEA spokesperson Radhir Jaiswal said. TNN

Hegseth blasts impeachment effort ahead of House vote

Says He Was Proud To 'Execute Orders Of Trump' And He Would 'Do It Again'

Reuters

US secy of defence Pete Hegseth

Washington: Defence secretary Pete Hegseth Tuesday blasted efforts to impeach him as a farce that would embolden US adversaries, as he lashed out at his political opponents in Congress and the media in an unapologetic defence of his record. "It's a farce, and it's a stunt, and everybody knows it," he said at a Pentagon press conference, branding the impeachment push "slander" and "sabotage".

US representative Thomas Massie, a Kentucky Republican, introduced eight articles of impeachment against Hegseth Monday. Massie said in a post on X if the House of Representatives can overcome Tuesday's procedural effort, "we will proceed to a real debate and vote on the Articles of Impeachment". Congressional sources say the resolution may have the votes to pass even with Republicans still controlling the House until Democrats take over on Jan 3. Conviction appears unlikely in the Senate, however, where a 2/3rd majority is required and Republicans hold 53 of 100 seats.

Massie's motion accuses Hegseth of waging Trump's war against Iran without proper congressional authorisation, conducting extrajudicial killings with attacks on alleged drug boats, and ignoring laws designed to minimise civilian casualties including an attack on an Iranian elementary school that killed more than 156 people, mostly children. He also accused Hegseth of illegally kidnapping Venezuelan leader Nicolas Maduro, which Massie called "an act of war against a sovereign country executed under the guise of narcotics law enforcement, though in actuality intended to assert US control over Venezuela's oil reserves."

Striking a defiant tone, Hegseth thanked President Trump for his continued support. Hegseth said past impeachments of Trump had ultimately failed, and added: "Both times he came back stronger, and the American people sent him back to the White House. Now they're trying a third time. This time against a member of his cabinet."

Hegseth cast the impeachment effort against him in Congress as a politicised attack on US troops and lawful military operations ordered by Trump. "I was proud to execute" Trump's orders, he said, "and I would do it again." Hegseth said the impeachment drive was an effort to disrespect the troops. "Make no mistake about what is happening, this is not about me," Hegseth said, adding the impeachment drive was an attempt "to do damage to this president, this country, and most irresponsibly, the warriors who defend it. This is not patriotism, this is sabotage." On Maduro's arrest, Hegseth said the message delivered was, "This is our hemisphere. Act accordingly."

Hegseth defended the Iran conflict, calling Trump courageous and saying Iran's military has been left in ruins. "History will judge the Iran war quite differently than the conventional wisdom right now," he said. Trump repeated his backing of Hegseth in a post on his Truth Social platform just after the Pentagon briefing ended. "Pete Hegseth gets an 'A' PLUS, PLUS, PLUS for his defence against a disgruntled, angry, defeated, former Congressman, Thomas Massie, a TOTAL LOSER!" he wrote.

Hegseth would be the first US defence secretary to be impeached. The last time any civilian leader of the US military was impeached was in 1876, when William Belknap held the title "secretary of war." Hegseth calls himself secretary of war, part of his effort to rebrand a military he said was too weak and "woke" when he took office last year. REUTERS

'The End of Everything' by M. John Harrison wins Booker Prize for fiction

London: British writer M John Harrison won the Booker Prize for fiction Monday for "The End of Everything," a satirical dystopian novel whose themes of "catastrophe and apocalypse" chime with our uneasy times. It's the first work of science fiction to take the prestigious 50,000 pound ($67,000) literary award, but 81-year-old Harrison said he doesn't want to be hemmed in by the sci-fi label.

He said Booker recognition after six decades as an author shows that the era of "genres as fences and boxes, pigeonholes, is over". "I think this book shows, and the prize now shows, that it is very possible to write a book that mixes not just two genres, but three or four," Harrison told reporters at a post-ceremony news conference.

Harrison beat five other finalists including previous winners Douglas Stuart and Marlon James, who had been the oddsmakers' favourites, and Pulitzer Prize laureate Elizabeth Strout.

"The End of Everything" is set on England's Channel coast in the near future, after an unspecified calamity has shattered society and brought an influx of enigmatic alien entities to Britain. It centres on a beachcomber who lives with his gun-toting aunt and discovers a puzzling, shape-shifting artifact on the shore.

Asked what he wanted to convey to readers, Harrison said: "It's a grim world, and it'll keep on being grim. And it's weird. But at the end of things there may be some kind of — I wouldn't say hope, or closure, but there might be some kind of relief."

Historian Mary Beard, who chaired the judging panel, said the book is "the politics of now seen through the lens of the future," and about a society "undergoing a catastrophe that they don't really understand". "What he does is to say, when the catastrophe comes, you won't know what's happening," Beard said. "And there are bits where you are with the characters in not fully understanding. Now, I think that's fantastically exciting."

Founded in 1969, the Booker Prize is open to English-language novels from any country published in UK and Ireland Harrison is the oldest writer to win the Booker, two years older than Margaret Atwood when she won in 2019. "The End of Everything" is his 13th novel. But Beard said the prize was definitely "not a lifetime achievement award". "We thought this was a book that had earned it," Beard said. AP

DAILY PLANET

Aus to create AI safety regulator, mandatory rules

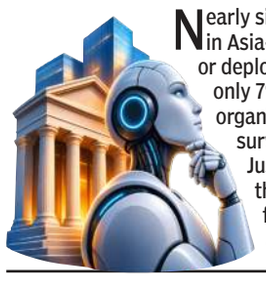
Australia will create a new AI safety regulator that will have the power to impose "significant penalties" on companies that do the wrong thing, PM Anthony Albanese said Tuesday in Canberra. The govt is in the process of writing AI-related legislation, with the new regulator to be included in those bills, Albanese said. Firms will need to provide mandatory notifications of any security incidents to the govt and allow independent evaluation of their models, he added. "Strong mandatory safety and security protections will be legislated through the AI Standards and apply to all frontier AI companies that wish to operate in Australia," the govt said.

UFC chief declines Trump's White House job offer: Ultimate Fighting Championship (UFC) chief Dana White turned down President Trump's — apparently jovial — offer of a job as press secretary in a surprise appearance at the White House Monday. Trump stunned the world by saying on social media on Saturday that he had asked White to take on the high-profile post — but a day later said he was "only kidding."

TIMES BUSINESS

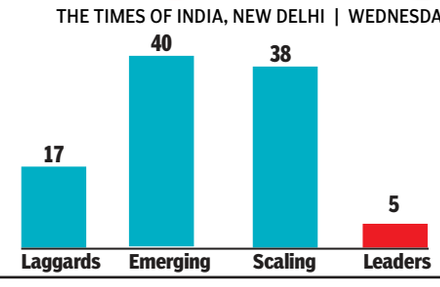
THE TIMES OF INDIA, NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 11, 2026

PLENTY OF PILOTS, FEW TAKE OFF



Nearly six in 10 banks and insurers in Asia-Pacific (Apac) are testing or deploying teams of AI agents, but only 7% run them across the whole organisation, a Capgemini global survey of 1,100 executives shows. Just 5% of financial firms have the cloud, governance and funding discipline to run agentic AI at scale

Financial services firms by agentic AI maturity (%)



CHEAPER TOKENS, BIGGER BILLS
The cost per million AI tokens fell 93%, but enterprises' total token spend rose 497% (Jan 2025-April 2026)

AGENTS AT THE COUNTER
79% of Apac executives expect AI agents to be a key part of customer engagement within three years, against 76% globally

SHOW ME THE MONEY
The number of Apac executives who fund AI mainly on business outcomes is set to rise 139% by 2028, while the number funding it mainly on efficiency is set to fall 43%

Source: Capgemini World Cloud Report for Financial Services 2027

Crude slips below $90, first time since Aug 29

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: Global oil prices on Tuesday dropped below the $90-a-barrel mark for the first time since Aug 29 amid prospects of de-escalation in West Asia. Over the past week, the global crude benchmark has slumped nearly 14% from $104.5 per barrel on Nov 3. Oil ministry's Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell (PPAC) has not updated the Indian crude basket price, which was last recorded at nearly $96.4 on Nov 6.

The development will offer respite to oil marketing companies (OMCs), which were incurring "losses" due to the spike in crude prices.

Brent crude traded between $65 and $70 a barrel before the US-Iran war started on Feb 28. It surged to $138.2 per barrel on April 7 before beginning to moderate. Prices fell to a low of nearly $71 in the first week of July before starting to climb again.

Pankaj Srivastava, senior vice-president at Rystad Energy, said the sustainability of the decline in crude prices would depend largely on geopolitical developments, including changing US political expectations and the prospects of a deal between Washington and Tehran. "A potential $10-20 per barrel geopolitical premium could return or recede depending on whether tensions escalate or diplomatic efforts gain ground, keeping refinery profitability exposed to volatility," Srivastava said.

PLI scheme: Govt invites applications for medical devices

New Delhi: In a bid to promote domestic manufacturing of medical devices, govt has invited fresh applications under the Rs 2,700 crore PLI scheme for the sector and extended the programme till 2035-36, an official release said on Tuesday. This is the second phase of the scheme, which was first announced in 2021-22. The revised guidelines are simpler and more investor-friendly, aimed at promoting ease of doing business, an industry expert said. Under the revised guidelines, govt has eliminated the minimum sales threshold for claiming financial incentives while scaling down the baseline capital expenditure required from manufacturers. TNN

Exports to West Asia fall 7%, Jordan, Oman buck the trend

Shipments To Jordan Double, Oman Gains On Hormuz Closure

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New Delhi: India's exports to West Asia fell 7.2% during the first half of the current financial year, with Oman and Jordan bucking the trend. While Oman gained due to the closure of the Strait of Hormuz, Jordan was a surprise, with exports from India doubling on account of a spike in buffalo meat, oil products and pharma exports.

Among the top products exported from India to the Gulf nations, jewellery, oil products and mobile phones have seen a dip, while ships and boats and basmati rice are among the top gainers. Shipments of petrol and diesel to GCC and other West Asian countries are estimated to have fallen 27% to $3.5 billion, while gold and other jewellery to the Gulf trading bloc is down 8.6% to $3.2 billion, latest available data with the commerce department showed.

HOW DIFFERENT MARKETS FARE

India's Exports ($bn) To:	H1 2025-26	H1 2026-27	% change
UAE	18.6	16.7	-10.2
Saudi Arabia	5	4.7	-6
Oman	2.2	3.2	45.5
Jordan	0.5	1.2	140
Israel	1.1	1.2	9.1
Total	32.3	30.2	-6.5

Source: Commerce dept

While exports to Oman have jumped 45% to $3.2 billion during April-Sept, the value of goods shipped to Jordan soared 2.4 times to $1.2 billion. In case of Oman, the free trade agreement was implemented a few months ago, which has provided a boost to Indian exports, particularly products such as ships and boats, processed minerals, some chemicals, basmati rice and iron and steel. While some of the goods are for the Oman market, the country's port is also acting as the gateway to the UAE as the Strait of Hormuz was shut and traffic still remains disrupted.

In case of Jordan, four product groups added $592.7 million, accounting for 85% of the total increase of Indian exports of close to $700 million during April-Sept, trade think tank GTRI said. Petrol and diesel nearly trebled from $110.3 million to $327.3 million. Rice, mostly basmati, shot up from $47.6 million to $253.5 million, while buffalo meat exports rose from $48.8 million to $192.4 million and medicine exports rose from $13.5 million to $39.7 million, it said.

Trade body Fieo said with Jordan's rising fuel demand, India has strengthened its position by supplying approximately 9,000 barrels a day, although Saudi Arabia remains the dominant source. "Jordan may increasingly be serving a dual role for Indian exporters — as a growing destination market in its own right and as a potential gateway to other markets in West Asia and North Africa. While the increase in petroleum exports appears closely linked to expanding demand and changes in sourcing patterns, the exceptional growth in buffalo meat and pharmaceutical exports suggests that regional distribution and possible re-export activity may also be contributing factors," it said.

Claude nine: Anthropic targets $1.4tn valuation

Looks To Raise Over $90Bn In Blockbuster Public Offering And Private Placement

Anthropic PBC is seeking a fully diluted valuation of about $1.4 trillion in its initial public offering, in a bid to make history as the first frontier artificial intelligence lab to go public.

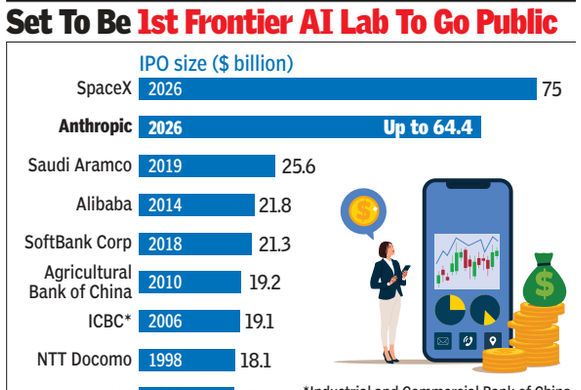
The Claude chatbot maker and its co-founders are seeking to raise as much as $90.4 billion in the IPO and a private placement. The base offering would raise up to $64.4 billion, with shares marketed for $70 to $78 each, according to a filing on Tuesday with the US Securities and Exchange Commission. Anthropic is offering 801.4 million shares, while backers are selling 23.6 million. The figure also includes a private placement set to raise $26 billion in aggregate, to Advanced Micro Devices, Broadcom, Alphabet's Google, Micron Technology, Microsoft Corp, Nvidia Corp and Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing Co, the filing shows.

At the top of the price range, Anthropic would have a market value of about $1 trillion, based on the shares outstanding listed in the filing. Accounting for ESOPs, restricted shares and stock reserved for the company's charitable donation matching programme, Anthropic would have a fully diluted value of about $1.4 trillion. Anthropic's target, including private placement, would hit roughly $100 billion when including over-allotment option or greenshoe, Bloomberg News calculations show. That would top SpaceX's $75 billion base offering, or the $86.2 billion it raised with the greenshoe.

"Anthropic could justify a $1.4 trillion market cap if annual recurring revenue (ARR) reaches at least $150 billion by 2027, supported by at least $5 billion of new monthly ARR after reporting $81 billion in Oct," wrote Bloomberg Intelligence analyst Mandeep Singh.

The company's seven cofounders, including chief executive officer Dario Amodei, are offering nearly 3.4 million shares each in the IPO, the filing shows. The IPO is set to price on Wednesday, Nov 18 and trade the following day. Anthropic reported third-quarter revenue of nearly $17 billion as of Sept 30, versus $1.4 billion in the same period a year ago. BLOOMBERG

Set To Be 1st Frontier AI Lab To Go Public



*Industrial and Commercial Bank of China
Source: Agencies & reports

Anthropic updates Mythos, Fable models

Anthropic has upgraded two of its most powerful AI models ahead of its planned IPO. Claude Fable 5.2 and Claude Mythos 5.2 use the same underlying model, but differ in who can access them and what they can do. Fable is broadly available, with safeguards against misuse in cybersecurity and biology. Mythos has fewer restrictions and is available to organisations vetted through Anthropic's Cyber Verification and Life Sciences Verification programmes. TNN

Nvidia plunges, MS 2nd largest in m-cap

Shares of Nvidia plunged again Tuesday as scrutiny on the artificial intelligence giant intensified after its CEO acknowledged an affair with a woman believed to be a Chinese spy. Near 1715 GMT, the chip specialist was down 6.3% at around $167.4. Since the weekend's revelations about CEO Jensen Huang, Nvidia has lost more than $400 billion in market value, dropping it to third among the world's biggest companies by value, behind Apple and Microsoft. AGENCIES

Premium upgrades drive appliances' festive sales

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New Delhi: India's festive appliance season exposed a divide in what shoppers were willing to pay for. Bigger televisions and higher-capacity appliances found buyers, while demand for some of the cheapest TV sets faded as Diwali approached. Several brands reported faster growth in sales value than in units, helped by both higher prices and a shift towards costlier models. Air conditioners were an exception at some companies, with more units sold as well as higher takings.

"Our premium television portfolio witnessed significant momentum, recording 600% growth this festive season, while our air purifier category recorded over 300% YoY growth this festive season," a Xiaomi India spokesperson said. The company did not disclose the volumes behind either figure.

Hisense India sold 25% more units from Navratri to Dhanteras than in the same festive period last year, while sales value rose 35%. CEO Pankaj Rana said its TV business grew about 35% and ACs about 20%, without specifying whether those figures referred to units or value.

GAINING MOMENTUM

At Thomson, early Navratri offers drew shoppers who had put off purchases, but sales momentum later weakened at the budget end. Avneet Singh Marwah, CEO of Super Plastronics, the Indian licensee for Thomson, Kodak and Blaupunkt, said higher input and freight costs had made buyers of entry-level sets more cautious. "In contrast, the premium segment witnessed robust growth of over 20%," he said, citing strong demand for 55-inch and 65-inch TVs.

Intex Technologies reported a roughly 45% rise in festive sales value, with volume growth trailing. TVs, ACs and washing machines led the gains, with small appliances and speakers also contributing. Director Keshav Bansal said higher input costs and currency movements prompted price increases, while larger screens and higher-capacity appliances lifted the average bill. "Consumers were willing to spend more when they saw a meaningful difference in what the product offered," he said. Blue Star's room AC sales, meanwhile, rose more than 35% in both units and value.

IIFL Fin will raise ₹6,414cr, Blackstone to get 16% stake

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Mumbai: IIFL Finance will raise Rs 6,414 crore through a primary equity infusion led by Blackstone, which will invest Rs 5,000 crore for an approximately 16% stake, while the NBFC's promoters Nirmal Jain and R Venkataraman will invest Rs 1,264 crore through warrants and continue as co-promoters.

Anchorage Capital will invest another Rs 150 crore in primary equity. The entire amount will be infused into the company through a preferential issue, with no secondary share sale.

Blackstone's investment will be made through compulsorily convertible preference shares (CCPS), which will convert into equity at Rs 602 per share within 18 months of allotment. The promoters will subscribe to warrants. The company has not disclosed their post-transaction shareholding or the extent of dilution, following the conversion of the instruments.

The transaction is subject to regulatory and shareholder approvals.

China's trade surplus tops $1tn mark despite import surge

China's trade surplus ballooned to just over $1 trillion for the year despite the biggest surge in imports since 2021, with an increasingly lopsided relationship with European Union accounting for nearly a third of the overall imbalance.

Imports spiked far more than forecast and advanced almost 42% last month from a year earlier, data released by China's General Administration of Customs showed on Tuesday. Shipments abroad rose slightly more than 35%, leaving the surplus for Oct at $105.3 billion, the smallest since May.

Through the first 10 months, China's surplus is nearly 9% bigger than during the same period of last year, when it reached a record $1.2 trillion. In Oct, China exported $33.4 billion more to the EU than it imported from the bloc, bringing the year-to-date difference to more than $310 billion.

China's trade surplus "underscores the resilience and competitiveness of its export sector despite a more challenging global trade environment," said Hao Zhou, chief economist at Guotai Junan International Holdings.

The entrenched imbalance in the flow of goods around China will stay high on the agenda of its biggest trading partners, with European leaders planning measures to manage what they deem to be economic security risks and tighten loopholes to better protect the bloc's single market.

Top Beijing officials like Vice Premier Ding Xuexiang have pushed back by saying China would be importing more products if there weren't restrictions on some high-tech items. BLOOMBERG

Unemployment rate down marginally

New Delhi: The unemployment rate (UR) in July - Sept quarter slid to 5.1% from 5.2% a year ago, with rural males driving the jobless rate downward. Youth unemployment, however, remained concerning as the UR in the 15-29 age group grew to 15.3% from 14.8% a year ago. This is due to the female UR rising sharply to 18.7% from 17% a year ago. TNN

Tech, heavy engg lead profit growth in mfg

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New Delhi: High-value segments, such as technology, heavy engineering and automotive segments, have led the profit growth in India's organised manufacturing sector in 2024-25, the latest annual survey of industries (ASI) data showed. Despite headwinds, these sectors ensured resilient overall value addition and broader wage distribution across the formal manufacturing sector.

Among industries, computer and electronic products recorded a 46% jump in profits to Rs 41,100 crore, alongside a 20% expansion in the wage bill (Rs 33,800 crore). Fabricated metals manufacturing matched this momentum in profits, with a 46% profit jump to Rs 34,180 crore.

The ASI data showed that net profit in the overall formal manufacturing sector rose 7.7% in 2024-25 to reach Rs 11.6 lakh crore, while the total wage bill – including salary, bonus and employers' contribution in the form of provident fund – expanded 12.3% to nearly Rs 9 lakh crore.

PERFORMANCE SHEET

How Major Industry Groups Fare

Industry group	Net Profit (₹ crore) FY24	FY25	Growth (%)
Fabricated metals	23,385	34,180	46.2
Computer & electronics	28,106	41,139	46.4
Textiles	18,020	24,232	34.5
Wearing apparel	13,554	17,567	29.6
Coke and refined petroleum	95,184	25,391	-73.3
Paper products	15,862	13,629	-14.1
All India	10,72,860	11,55,836	7.7

Source: Annual Survey of Industries

The pharmaceutical industry saw a 24% jump in profits to Rs 1.2 lakh crore, while its wage bill increased 19% to Rs 69,300 crore. Labour intensive industries, which employ a vast majority of the formal manufacturing workforce such as textiles and wearing apparel, saw their profitability rise 34% (Rs 24,232 crore) and 30% (Rs 17,567 crore) respectively. Wage bill for these industries, however, grew moderately. Textiles saw a 10% rise to Rs 52,749 crore, while total wages in the wearing apparel rose 17% to Rs 40,888 crore.

Core heavy industries and consumer segments also posted robust gains. Basic metals generated the highest absolute net profits among major groups at Rs 1.4 lakh crore (12.7% rise), while the wage bill crossed Rs 80,000 crore. Motor vehicles saw net profits climb 19% to Rs 1.2 lakh crore, with wage bill rising by nearly 12% to Rs 83,000 crore.

Cheaper Scotch raises stakes for desi whisky

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Bengaluru: Cheaper Scotch is putting Indian whisky makers under pressure, even as lower import duties offer savings to companies that use it in their blends. For small distillers that make their own spirits, an imported label can now cost substantially less than a locally made bottle.

Huli's rice malt whisky was launched in Karnataka at Rs 2,650 for 750ml. By comparison, J&B Rare was priced at Rs 1,375 at Bengaluru retailer Tonique in October, according to TOI's earlier reporting. At these prices, J&B Rare cost Rs 1,275 less, or about half as much. Tonique said the price had fallen from Rs 2,835, attributing the reduction to local bottling.

"The smaller players will not be able to survive," said Huli Spirits founder Aruna Urs. Her Mysuru distillery makes spirits from locally sourced paddy and jaggery and does not import Scotch.

Arun Kumar Parasa of Unistil Alcoblends said falling Scotch prices had adversely affected the Indian single malt industry. Lower duties on bulk Scotch imported by some small and medium distilleries would benefit them "very marginally", he said.

The distinction is between making spirits locally and buying imported whisky for bottling or blending. Bulk Scotch arrives in large containers and can be bottled here or used as an ingredient in Indian whisky.

A lower import bill can help these manufacturers, while cheaper finished bottles intensify competition for other producers.

Jason Holway, senior consultant at drinks research firm IWSR, expects the price gap to narrow further. "Depending on the state, cheaper blended Scotches are expected to become more attractively priced than they used to be and may not be much more expensive than domestic premium brands using Scotch as an ingredient."

India's trade agreement with Britain cut Scotch import duties from 150% to 75%. Customs officials subsequently questioned whether certain bulk shipments qualified for the lower duty. On Nov 2, commerce secretary Rajesh Agrawal assured manufacturers that the duty benefits would be protected, with commerce and revenue officials to work on resolving the classification dispute.

An industry executive, speaking on condition of anonymity, said Indian buyers were also negotiating better purchase prices from Scotland. The executive estimated that the duty reduction could lower retail prices by roughly 8-10%, depending on state taxes and companies' pricing decisions. Distribution difficulties and advertising restrictions remained longstanding hurdles for small manufacturers, the executive added.

IWSR's figures also show the limits of India's shift towards expensive whisky. Its premium-and-above category, defined as Rs 2,899.01 or more per 750ml bottle, accounted for less than 1% of whisky consumed by volume in 2025, Holway said.

THE WHISKY PRICE PUZZLE

Big price gap: J&B Rare at Rs 1,375 costs nearly half as much as Huli whisky at Rs 2,650

Limited benefit for distillers: Lower duties on bulk Scotch offer only marginal savings to some small and medium manufacturers

Retail prices may fall further: Duty cuts could reduce Scotch prices by 8-10%, depending on state taxes and pricing decisions

Premium-and-above brands **account for less than 1%** of India's whisky consumption **by volume**

EPFO to rework process of selling equity investments

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New Delhi: The Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) is working to overhaul how it sells its investment in equities to comply with Sebi regulations, which require transactions with its fund managers to be worth at least Rs 25 crore.

Under EPFO's current mechanism of redeeming its equity investments, units in exchange-traded funds (ETFs) are sold based on the exact day they were bought five years ago. However, because daily investment amounts vary, the units bought on any single day are often not worth Rs 25 crore when the time comes to sell them.

According to calculations by UTI Mutual Fund, which manages part of the EPFO's equity portfolio, the retirement body may be unable to meet Sebi's Rs 25 crore minimum threshold on roughly two-thirds of trading days in 2026–27 under the existing rules. Specifically, sales would be blocked on 159 out of 246 trading days for its UTI Nifty 50 ETF, and on 186 days for its UTI Sensex ETF, TOI has learnt.

To solve the problem, EPFO's central board of trustees (CBT) is slated to discuss a new policy at its meeting next week. Instead of treating each day's investment separately, the new framework will pool together all stock units that have completed the mandatory five-year holding period. This pool will then be divided into equal daily batches for selling to maintain liquidity. If an average batch still falls short of Rs 25 crore, EPFO will be allowed to bundle in extra mature units to hit the required target.

To protect the returns for subscribers, the new policy keeps strict profit safeguards in place. Equity investments will only be sold if their returns beat 10-year govt bond yields by at least 2.5 percentage points, and also outperform the stock market's own five-year average returns. The retirement fund body invests roughly 15% of its fresh inflows into equities through Nifty 50 and Sensex ETFs via daily SIPs to generate higher returns for its interest account.

TECH I'D LIKE TO SEE

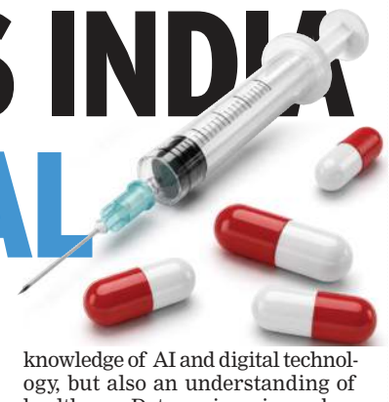
AI MUST REMOVE FRICTION FROM EVERYDAY LIFE

Having spent close to three decades in technology, I've witnessed every major shift from distributed computing and the internet to smartphones and now AI. But the technology I'm most excited about is not necessarily the loudest or most futuristic. It's technology that quietly removes friction from everyday life. Today, AI can simplify tasks that once took hours of research, coordination, or manual effort. What excites me is seeing these capabilities gradually move beyond enterprises and become more accessible in everyday life. In India especially, I'd love to see technology evolve in ways that make quality healthcare, education, and critical services more accessible to people regardless of geography or language. We are already seeing early examples of this but the real impact will come when these technologies become intuitive and widely accessible at scale. I've been involved in digital education and enablement initiatives in smaller towns, and one thing has always stayed with me: people adapt incredibly fast once access is created.

Arun Balasubramanian | MANAGING DIRECTOR - INDIA & SAARC, DYNATRACE

iToons Ajit Ninan & Sunil Agarwal

FOR US HEALTHCARE, THIS INDIA CENTRE IS BECOMING VITAL



UnitedHealth Group's GCC is one of the biggest in India, and combines clinical and tech expertise

Sujit.John@timesofindia.com

Healthcare is one of the defining political and economic issues in the US, and the just-concluded midterm elections again showed how strongly Americans care about the cost and accessibility of care. An AP voter survey found that around six in 10 voters wanted the govt to play a bigger role in addressing medical expenses, while most said President Donald Trump's policies had made healthcare costs worse.

That makes the role of UnitedHealth Group, one of the world's largest companies with revenue of nearly $450 billion, particularly significant. The company operates through two major businesses, UnitedHealthcare and Optum. Together, they serve over 40% of Americans. Optum spans care delivery, healthcare technology, analytics and pharmacy services, while UnitedHealthcare provides health insurance.

Increasingly, an important part of the machinery behind that massive enterprise sits in India.

Optum's India centre, which has more than 30,000 employees, making it one of the biggest GCCs in India, today brings together clinical expertise, knowledge of US healthcare regulation and insurance, technology, data and AI, with the ultimate aim of improving access, affordability and health outcomes.

"We like to think of Optum India as a health innovation global capability centre for the group," says Uma Ratnam Krishnan, MD and CEO of Optum India.

When the centre started in 2002, the rationale was similar to that of many GCCs: access to talent, operational efficiency and cost. But the mandate has expanded into product development, data analytics, clinical technologies and strategic roles as the organisation developed a deeper understanding of healthcare.

> We believe AI will help us in a significant way in many areas. The greatest opportunities are in areas where there is high complexity and high administrative burden – for instance, where you're doing tonnes of paperwork, or where data is fragmented. We can eliminate some of that, we can create better intelligence so that you're making stronger decisions.

> The talent equation is increasingly going to be a combination of skills. It's not about just being a software engineer or a product engineer. On one side you need to know your AI and digital, on another side you need to know about healthcare and have domain expertise. And there's a third element, which is, how do we intersect data engineering, cybersecurity, and the values that humans bring.

Uma Ratnam Krishnan (centre), MD & CEO of Optum India, with colleagues

Combining domain & AI

The India centre, Krishnan says, has become a "significant contributor" to the wider enterprise. The change is visible in the kind of problems it tackles.

One example is an AI-based healthcare knowledge assistant developed in India. Employees can use it to quickly find information about clinical matters, healthcare rules, benefits and whether particular services are covered. Instead of searching through multiple sources, an employee can ask a question and get contextual information in real time.

Another area is analytics for value-based care, where the India team helps bring fragmented patient information together to create more predictive models and help determine appropriate care pathways. AI is also being applied directly to the work of doctors. In one initiative, clinical AI is being used to organise medical records, create case summaries and identify relevant policies and information. The objective is to reduce the amount of time clinicians spend navigating documentation and give them more time with patients.

Another product analyses the utilisation of operating theatres, equipment and other capacity, helping healthcare providers identify underused or overused resources and make better use of what they already have.

A lot of this is work in progress. "Our biggest shift we need to make is from asking what AI can do to actually saying where it can make a meaningful difference and where it can be built at scale," Krishnan says.

Healthcare makes that particularly complicated. Medical records, insurance rules, clinical decisions and patient outcomes involve sensitive information and high consequences. AI can accelerate work, but the final responsibility cannot be outsourced to a model.

"Trust, empathy and compassion are fundamental in healthcare," Krishnan says. So, people remain accountable for understanding the problem, applying judgement, validating outputs and delivering the right outcome.

> To the young people who worry about what's happening to their jobs with AI, I'll say, you can't compete with what AI can do in terms of the simpler tasks, you need to focus on building your capabilities in judgment, creativity, innovation, empathy, these things are important ... AI is also changing the bar for leadership. The role is going to be less about saying, hey, get this task done as cost effectively as possible, to more about navigating ambiguity, and connecting the dots across the system to get better outcomes. They'll need much sharper vision around what the problem is, they'll need to have sound judgment, empathy and compassion, which is a big deal in healthcare business understanding.

Understanding US healthcare

The centre was regarded as one of India's biggest recruiters in the past four or five years, and continues to hire. But Krishnan says the emphasis is changing. She expects the future talent model to be less about isolated specialisations and more about combinations. An employee may need knowledge of AI and digital technology, but also an understanding of healthcare. Data engineering, cybersecurity and the role of humans in the process add further layers.

Problems in healthcare do not fit neatly into one discipline: a clinician brings the patient context, engineers determine what can be automated, and product teams work out how to turn the capability into a useful product. That means Optum has had to invest heavily in teaching its Indian workforce – including people with backgrounds in medicine, pharmacy, biology and paramedical sciences – the intricacies of the US healthcare system.

The differences are substantial. Employees need to understand how insurance plans determine what is covered, how medical conditions are coded, how claims are processed and how care delivered today can affect future care pathways. Optum has various training programmes, including a coding academy that certifies people on their knowledge of how to code medical conditions.

That training is becoming a competitive asset as the India centre takes on more sophisticated work. The centre has even built capabilities in product marketing, content, creative and digital work. Teams are now running campaigns for different UnitedHealth Group businesses, with India increasingly responsible for outcomes rather than simply executing tasks.

Krishnan says the centre is moving towards taking greater accountability for products, AI-native healthcare solutions and their outcomes, while its leaders play a stronger role in the enterprise's strategic direction. "For GCCs to deliver greater value, leaders need to think enterprise first. Rather than just ask, what is the GCC's role. They need to be able to operate across functions, across geographies, and lead through technology change," she says.

Banking's next leap: Knowing all of us better

Akhil George & Sujit John | TNN

Bank of India has a history spanning more than 120 years and data on 12 crore customers. For executive director Rajiv Mishra, that enormous customer base hints at what AI could make possible: banking that understands the needs of a village farmer as closely as those of a customer in Mumbai.

Banking offers fertile ground for AI because so much of its information is structured. Transaction amounts, account balances, repayment dates and borrowing histories can be compared and analysed to identify patterns. These records could help banks assess creditworthiness, spot unusual activity and anticipate financial needs in near real-time.

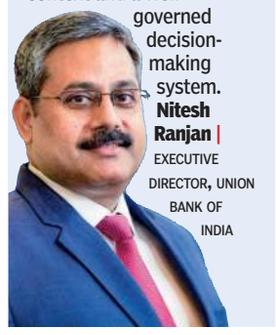
Nitesh Ranjan, executive director at Union Bank of India, described this as a move from occasional interactions to an ongoing understanding of customers. "We will be moving from episodic banking to continuous intelligence, real-time banking – understanding customers as they do transactions and being very contextual to their requirements," he said on our webinar recently.

The first phase of banking's digital transformation gave customers mobile banking, internet banking and digital payments. Ranjan said the next would embed intelligence into customer interactions. "AI and intelligent automation can enable hyper-personalised engagement, near-real-time credit decisions and faster fulfilment, and intelligent fraud monitoring," he said.

> Banking will become much more personalised. I am looking at how we serve a village farmer as well as a customer in Mumbai. But trust is something we cannot lose. Sophisticated frauds and biases can move as fast as our AI models. We need to innovate boldly, with responsible governance, because technology may change, but trust must remain our focus.
>
> **Rajiv Mishra** | EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR, BANK OF INDIA

TIMES TECHIES WEBINARS
Session partner
IBM

> The next phase of banking will embed intelligence into customer interactions, making services more contextual, predictive and proactive. AI should help us understand customers better, serve them faster and protect them more effectively. But its value does not come from the model alone. It depends on trusted data, common business definitions, secure integrations, reliable context and a well-governed decision-making system.
>
> **Nitesh Ranjan** | EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR, UNION BANK OF INDIA



But there is a distinction between knowing something about a customer and understanding what it means. Building that understanding requires banks to bring their information together. Mishra said Bank of India had built a data lake, a central repository that brings data from different systems into one place. The aim is to give teams a consistent basis for analysis and decisions.

"The foundation has to include data quality and consistency, data governance, privacy and security, access controls and system resilience," Mishra said. Ranjan also stressed the need for "common business definitions" – so that information means the same thing across the bank.

Union Bank had taken almost 18 months to build its data system, Ranjan said. AI itself could help improve the information feeding these systems. "It's better to use AI to clean the data rather than waiting for clean data before using AI," he said.

Alongside more usable data, banks need people who can put it to work. Rishi Aurora, managing partner at IBM Consulting India and South Asia, described a future in which employees work with AI agents – software that can carry out steps in a task.

"People, software and agents working together to derive the most optimal outcome for the organisation – that is going to be the model," Aurora said. "AI can take care of analysis, but empathy, judgement and creativity will play an integral role." Organisations that make these capabilities work together, he said, will be most successful in adopting AI. The outcomes, he added, must be auditable and explainable, because agents will have access to sensitive data.

This makes banking knowledge valuable alongside technical expertise. Mishra said Bank of India was hiring specialists who need not have a background in financial services, then bringing them together with bankers to develop applications. Ranjan said Union Bank was developing "AI-aware bankers" through foundational and certification courses.

Some of the expertise must come from outside. Ranjan said no single institution could independently master every capability across AI, cloud computing, cybersecurity and analytics. Technology partners could help banks connect systems, draw on experience from other markets and turn experimental applications into services that operate securely at scale. "Partners like IBM help us transfer those capabilities to our own internal employees," Ranjan said.

> People trust banks with their money, their identity and their data. What excites me is the ability of banks to anticipate our financial needs and prevent fraud through AI-powered systems. But AI is fed by data, so having the right data foundations is essential. Security and compliance must form part of the architecture, because otherwise that trust will be broken.
>
> **Rishi Aurora** | MANAGING PARTNER, IBM CONSULTING INDIA & SOUTH ASIA

My message to women is simple: STOP WAITING

Sangeetha Yanamandra

In the fast-paced world of enterprise technology, most leaders search for a playbook. I learned early in my career that it's often more effective and more fulfilling to write my own. The moments that shaped me were never the ones where the path was clear. They were the ones where ambiguity was at its peak and I had to turn uncertainty into structure.

Leading AI engineering at scale means building teams and systems that operate inside ambiguity, across multiple geographies and within massive product ecosystems. At OpenText, my team develops AI integrations and information management platforms that support thousands of customers worldwide. Building this from the ground up required a deep comfort with the unknown. I often had to make decisions long before clarity arrived.

CAREER LADDER
FOR WOMEN

Over time, I realised that confidence doesn't precede difficult work. It follows it.

How early struggles built the foundation: I entered the industry during an economic slowdown. There was no perfect job waiting for me. I balanced part-time assignments while pursuing my MTech through evening college. Those early years taught me a truth I carry even today. People often wait for confidence before they step into hard problems. I learned that confidence is the byproduct of having survived them.

My foundation in Java slowly expanded into mobile platforms, enterprise systems, cloud computing, analytics, fintech, and eventually AI. Learning to move fluidly between them taught me how to architect solutions across diverse enterprise ecosystems. A strong personal support system made this possible and that discipline around prioritisation still guides how I execute complex enterprise deployments today.

Operating without a playbook: One of the most defining chapters of my journey was a consciously unplanned leap from a stable corporate environment into the chaotic heart of a startup. There was no runway for formal training. I built a method on the fly. Break the problem down. Experiment quickly. Fail small. Move big.

This exposure taught me that good technical leadership isn't about being the smartest engineer in the room. It's about removing paralysis so the team can build. Whether transforming legacy products into cloud-native platforms or creating OpenText's AI unit from scratch, I found that I thrive in what I call the messy middle.

The 3A framework: To navigate the complexity of enterprise engineering and life itself, I rely on a model I call the Three A's: Accept the complexity. Adjust as assumptions shift. Align the team to the broader organisational purpose.

Beyond the binary – law, patents, and marathons: Recognising that an idea is worth protecting requires a different lens. While I hold granted patents in intelligent data extraction and AI, I completed an LLB and earned my certification as an independent director because a decision about data security isn't just technical. It's ethical and legal.

Outside the office, I run, bike, and train for full marathons. Endurance sports mirror my professional philosophy. Showing up consistently compounds in ways that short bursts of intensity never will. Through the Women in Search of Excellence initiative, I mentor women at a career crossroads. My message to them is always simple. Stop waiting.

Sangeetha Yanamandra is VP of engineering and site leader at OpenText Hyderabad

Cola factories to aircraft, India shapes Alten's future

Akhil.George@timesofIndia.com

One of the world's two cola giants relies on manufacturing processes engineered in India to keep its concentrate consistent across plants. Alten, the French engineering group behind the work, would not identify the customer. But the assignment offers a glimpse of how its India teams contribute to engineering that helps protect a global brand's competitive advantage.

"Their core differentiator in the market is the configuration of the concentrate," said Prabhakar Atla, the recently appointed CEO of Alten India. "We have designed the manufacturing process to ensure the consistency of the concentrate they use. Wherever they have a new plant, we are responsible for replicating that process."

CUTTING-EDGE
MADE IN INDIA

The concentrate is the flavour base that is diluted to make the finished soft drink. The work involves reproducing an established process and monitoring plants where it has been deployed. So far, that's 21 factories in 19 countries. Alten is also introducing AI to reduce the time needed to recommend action.

"We deploy three capabilities: manufacturing engineering, monitoring and reporting, and a data intelligence layer, including AI. Sometimes we deploy people at customer locations to track implementation. But most work is done remotely," Atla said.

That combination of physical engineering and digital expertise is increasingly shaping India's role within Alten. Its engineering R&D covers designing products, testing them, supporting manufacturing and improving performance once they are in use, across sectors including aerospace, automotive, industrial equipment and healthcare.

> India is an important part of Alten's global strategic roadmap. We have close to 9,000 employees here, making India our second-largest country by headcount, and we are growing fast. We are scrambling for more space and people. The convergence of technology and engineering will become more pronounced over the next five to 10 years. The group sees India as an engine of that transformation, and that is where we believe we can make a difference.
>
> **Prabhakar Atla** | CEO, ALTEN INDIA

India is already the group's second-largest country by employee numbers, behind France, with close to 9,000 of its roughly 58,000 employees. Atla expects it to become the largest within five years.

"Headcount is no measurement of value creation," he said. "India is already a very important part of Alten's global strategic roadmap."

Dynamic datasets

Atla, who has spent 30 years in engineering, describes a business in which designing a machine increasingly involves understanding its software and the information it produces. The cola project brings those capabilities together in a factory. In aerospace, they extend through an aircraft's working life.

Sensors on an aircraft collect information about how its engines and other systems are performing. Engineers can use this to anticipate which components need maintenance. Alten is now working with a major aircraft manufacturer to improve forecasts by combining information across a fleet.

"If you aggregate the complete fleet data and look at fleet performance, machine learning can help predict the probability of failure of a part much earlier," Atla said.

Learning from multiple machines also features in Alten's automotive work. Its projects include systems that monitor a driver's eyes and identify objects around a vehicle. Atla said the company was now working on systems that could keep learning from information gathered across vehicles.

The next challenge is bringing AI into the decisions engineers make before a machine is built. Creating documents and illustrations, and checking them against standards, lends itself to automation. Atla said Alten was seeing gains of 30-40% in engineering documentation. But at the beginning of a project, engineers still decide how a product should work and which design to pursue.

"Problem-solving is not necessarily always going to be rule-bound in engineering," he said. "We can challenge AI models to give us alternative options to solve a problem, but we have to very carefully analyse their output."

The consequences of a wrong choice can take years to emerge. Developing a new aircraft takes 10-15 years. So an early mistake could undermine a long development programme.

"Human intelligence matters in deciding whether to deploy the tool's output and in challenging it to actually figure out where AI is wrong," he said.

Used carefully, though, the same technology could give engineers more room to experiment. Aircraft engines illustrate the opportunity. Their long development cycles mean manufacturers commit to a design and make relatively small adjustments along the way. Exploring more alternatives early on could make engines tailored to particular requirements more practical. "AI is allowing us to not only reduce design time but also provide more variants to solve a problem," Atla said.

CLEAN DATA CTRL+F(IND)

Clean data means data that is accurate, consistent, complete, properly formatted and free of obvious errors or duplication, so that it can be reliably analysed or used by software and AI systems. For instance, you might have to standardise Bombay as Mumbai, have uniform phone number formats. For AI, clean data is particularly important because AI learns patterns from data. If the underlying data is inconsistent, incomplete or wrong, the AI's outputs can also be unreliable. In a business context, "clean data" can therefore mean things such as common definitions, consistent formats, accurate records, proper labelling, and reliable links between different datasets.

TIMES SPORT

THE TIMES OF INDIA, NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 11, 2026

FORMER WINDIES OPENER CHRIS GAYLE TO PLAY FOR VENICE LIVEWIRES IN ITALIA T10 LEAGUE

MIDFIELDER GRANIT XHAKA OUT OF SWISS NATIONS LEAGUE SQUAD DUE TO CALF INJURY

USHA TAKES ELECTION BATTLE TO IOC

IOA President Seeks Independent Probe Into Alleged Violations In SOM Elections

Sabi.Hussain@timesofindia.com

New Delhi: Indian Olympic Association (IOA) president Usha has urged International Olympic Committee (IOC) president Kirsty Coventry for an independent examination of the IOA's controversial Sportspersons of Outstanding Merit (SOM) elections.

In a confidential three-page complaint dated Nov 9, accessed exclusively by **TOI**, Usha raises serious concerns about the elections, including allegations of incumbent officials canvassing for candidates, messages seeking confirmation of voters' participation and even references to the sports ministry in communications surrounding a secret ballot.

In the letter, Usha has also questioned the handling of her four representations by returning officer (RO) Sanjay K. Srivastava and asked the IOC to ascertain whether any govt or external influence was exerted during the electoral process.

The letter comes after Usha's own electoral setback, with the IOA president finishing fifth with 40 votes in a six-way contest for four women's SOM positions. Anju Bobby George topped the poll with 53 votes, followed by Rani Rampal (50), Dola Banerjee (45) and Saina Nehwal (43). Anitha Pauldurai secured six.

In her letter, Usha has clarified that her complaint is not intended to challenge the election result "merely because of its outcome", nor is it directed against any individual on personal grounds. Instead, she has stated that it concerns "the conduct and oversight of the electoral process" and the need to uphold IOA autonomy.

TOI Exclusive

Elaborating on her first allegation, Usha has written that WhatsApp communications circulated under the names of incumbent IOA executive committee members Dola Banerjee and Yogeshwar Dutt allegedly solicited votes for a particular panel, identifying four candidates by name and ballot details.

She stated that she brought these communications to Srivastava's attention, citing clauses 1.9 and 3.2 of the model code of conduct issued on Oct 30.

Quoting clause 3.2, Usha pointed out that incumbent EC members "shall refrain from making public declarations" and "may in no way support a candidate". She alleged that the communications raised concerns over compliance with the code and equal treatment of candidates.

Usha has also alleged that communications attributed to an incumbent IOA EC member raised concerns about voters being asked to confirm their voting activity. Separately, she referred to messages involving an individual identified to her as Sanjay Mishra, stated to be secretary of the badminton association, who allegedly asked athletes to confirm after voting and invoked the ministry through statements such as "from ministry" and "ministry is asking if we have confirmation msg."

Questioning the reference to the ministry, Usha wrote: "I am not asserting that the ministry issued such an instruction." However, she has asked the IOC to independently establish whether the ministry or any govt official sought information identifying voters or confirming their participation, and, if not, why its name was invoked. She stated that any such monitoring could undermine the independence and confidentiality expected in a secret-ballot election.

On the handling of her complaints, Usha has alleged that she submitted four separate representations to Srivastava during the election process but received "neither an acknowledgement nor a substantive response" to any of them. She has sought an examination of the RO's handling of these representations and whether the mechanisms under the model code of conduct were effectively applied.

Invoking fundamental principle 5 and rules 27.6 and 2 of the Olympic Charter, Usha has argued that the concerns, if substantiated, go beyond an individual election dispute. She has also linked the issue to India's ambition to host the 2036 Olympic Games, stating that the IOA must uphold the standards of "independence, transparency and good governance" expected within the Olympic movement.

Among her specific demands, Usha has asked the IOC to examine the alleged campaigning by incumbent EC members, investigate the reported requests for voting confirmations, ascertain whether any govt or external influence was exerted, and consider referring the matter to its relevant department, Ethics and Compliance Office or Ethics Commission. She has also sought corrective measures to safeguard future IOA elections.

Requesting confidentiality, Usha has stated that some information was shared by individuals who may be reluctant to come forward publicly. She said she had withheld private WhatsApp communications and identifying details of voters to protect them from possible repercussions, while offering to provide supporting material through an appropriate confidential channel. The letter was also copied to IOC officials James Macleod and Jérôme Poivey.

Usha had recently met Coventry on the sidelines of the Youth Olympic Games in Dakar on Nov 2 and discussed India's Olympic and 2038 Asian Games bids.

Meanwhile, sources in Usha's camp said she is neither contemplating approaching courts to challenge the SOM election outcome nor exploring the possibility of seeking nomination from an NSF to regain entry into the IOA general assembly as a voter. They said the camp's hopes rest on IOC intervention following the complaint, alongside efforts to seek the PMO's intervention into "alleged irregularities".

Usha's defeat followed an extraordinary withdrawal phase in which eight male candidates withdrew, leaving four elected unopposed, while five women withdrew, reducing the women's contest to six. All 80 voters cast their ballots and Usha secured 40 votes.

PT USHA

WHAT USHA HAS ALLEGED IN HER LETTER TO IOC HEAD COVENTRY

- Campaigning by incumbents
- Model code violation
- Voter confirmation
- Sports ministry reference
- RO's alleged inaction
- Plea seeking IOC intervention

HOW THE SPORTSPERSONS OF OUTSTANDING MERIT (SOM) ELECTIONS UNFOLDED

- 23 candidates with valid nominations.
- 13 withdrawals within 48 hours (8 men, 5 women).
- 4 names — Gagan Narang, Yogeshwar Dutt, Vijender Singh and Kamlesh Mehta — elected unopposed.
- 6 women contested four available positions.
- 80 eligible voters cast their ballots.
- 40 votes secured by PT Usha, who finished 5th, three fewer than 4th-placed Saina Nehwal (43).

Real battle begins as 30 NSFs in electoral list

Sabi.Hussain@timesofindia.com

New Delhi: The next battle for control of Indian Olympic Association (IOA) has already unfolded among the national sports federations (NSFs), whose representatives could hold the key to determining who calls the shots in the Olympic body for the 2026-2030 term.

Soon after the SOM polls, returning officer Sanjay K Srivastava has notified the initial election schedule, inviting eligible NSFs to nominate their authorised representatives — one male and one female — who will constitute the electoral college and become part of the IOA general assembly for the Olympic body's Dec 5 polls.

IOA POLLS

The provisional electoral college is scheduled for Nov 12, with the final electoral roll to be published on Nov 15.

The nominations will offer the first real glimpse of where the federations' loyalties lie. Their nominees will not merely be there to cast votes; some could themselves emerge as contenders for key office-bearer and executive council (EC) positions.

Not everyone has made it to the starting grid. With just 30 NSFs making the cut, the electoral arithmetic is already taking shape. Among those missing out is the Boxing Federation of India (BFI), effectively shutting out its representatives from the IOA electoral process amid factional infighting and legal disputes. The IOA does not currently recognise BFI as a member and had earlier rejected its nominees, Nikhat Zareen and Narendra Berwal, for the Athletes' Commission elections.

The Indian Golf Union (IGU), Table Tennis Federation of India (TTFI) and Volleyball Federation (VFI) are also absent owing to administrative issues.

RAIN PLAYS SPOILSPORT

Third ODI Between India And NZ Called Off After Toss

Hamilton: Rain played spoilsport as the third ODI between New Zealand and India at Seddon Park here on Tuesday was called off. India lead the five-match series 2-0 as the two teams head to Tauranga for the final two games, scheduled to be held on Nov 13 and 15.

India skipper Shubman Gill won the toss for the third time in a row and opted to bowl, fielding an unchanged side from the previous two games.

However, just as the covers were coming off for a 40-overs-a-side contest, the heavens opened up once again. With at least 70 minutes remaining before the local cut-off time of 7:50 pm for a 20-overs-a-side game, the two umpires decided to call off the match.

The weather forecast for this game had always been gloomy, with a 90 per cent chance of rain predicted throughout the day.

This was supposed to be the last game of the series for skipper Gill and KL Rahul before they link up with the Test squad in Wellington. They will be accompanied by Kuldeep Yadav, Anshul Kamboj and Mohammed Siraj.

Shreyas Iyer will lead the side in the last two matches in Gill's absence, with Ruturaj Gaikwad and Ishan Kishan set to earn places in the playing XI. PTI

Pix: AFP, Getty Images

INDIA IN NEW ZEALAND

DAMP SQUIB: Umpires walk in to inspect the ground in Hamilton. (Right) The giant scoreboard announces the fate of the match

It's similar to Haryana: Kamboj on NZ's cold, seam-friendly conditions

Hamilton: Having played in Haryana's Lahli during winter months since the age of 13, Anshul Kamboj said it has been enjoyable to bowl on bouncy tracks at Auckland's Eden Park and Wellington's Hnry Stadium in the first two ODIs. "I started playing when I was 13 years old. I play for Haryana. So it's like similar kind of, what can I say, weather and wickets as well in Haryana," he told the host broadcasters.

3RD INDIA 'A'-NZ 'A' UNOFFICIAL TEST ENDS IN DRAW

Lincoln: Jasprit Bumrah and Ravindra Jadeja's hopes of getting some serious game time went down the drain as the third unofficial Test between India A and New Zealand A ended in a draw after the fourth and final day of the match was washed out here on Tuesday. The third day of the match was also washed out on Monday. The overall honours were shared by both teams as all three games ended in draws.

The third game was crucial from an Indian perspective as Bumrah and Jadeja were expected to get some game time after coming back from a break. Bumrah had last played on Oct 3 during the Asian Games final. During the match, Bumrah got to bowl six overs in which he gave away 11 runs. Jadeja, who normally plays as a front-line batter on foreign soil, got a chance to play 71 deliveries for his 25. He didn't get a chance to bowl. PTI

Pant fit, scheduled to leave for NZ after simulation test

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New Delhi: In a boost to India's Test team, Rishabh Pant is scheduled to leave for New Zealand on Thursday. Pant will undergo an obligatory match simulation session at the Centre of Excellence (CoE) on Wednesday. **TOI** understands that the CoE medical staff is satisfied with Pant's recovery after the side strain he sustained during the Irani Cup in the first week of Oct.

While the rest of the Test team has already assembled in New Zealand and is getting game time before the two-Test series, Pant will have about a week to get ready for the first Test in Wellington starting on Nov 19.

PANT

Pant had initially requested the selectors to pick him for the ongoing India 'A' tour in New Zealand to get into rhythm for the crucial series which could decide India's fate in the World Test Championship (WTC).

However, sources close to the team management claim that Pant is experienced enough to be ready for the first Test. "This is the first time in a long while that the Test players have got such extensive preparation time for an away Test series. Pant had been part of tours to Australia and England where the Indian team has played a Test match within one week of landing in the country," a source told **TOI**.

It will be interesting to see if the team management decides to go with Dhruv Jurel in the playing XI alongside Pant.

Aaryavir's 160 takes India U-19 to semis

Al Amerat: Aaryavir Sehwag smashed 160 off 168 balls for his maiden hundred in Youth ODIs as India entered the semifinals of the U-19 Asia Cup with a comfortable 70-run win over the UAE here on Tuesday.

India will now face Afghanistan in the semifinal on Thursday.

U19 ASIA CUP

Having lost to Pakistan on Sunday, India found themselves in a must-win situation against the UAE. Aaryavir, son of former India opener Virender Sehwag, allowed India to post 309/7, a total which was beyond the grasp of the opposition. UAE were all out for 239 in 50 overs.

Aaryavir took his time early before producing a barrage of fours and sixes — 17 and seven respectively.

The other major contribution came from VK Vineeth (67 off 69). Anvay Dravid hit a six in his 9-ball 12. In response, the UAE were never in the chase despite Ahmed Khudabad's run-a-ball 74.

BCCI

AARYAVIR SEHWAG

'Promised dad that I would get a big hundred'

Aaryavir Sehwag made a promise to his father that he would score a big hundred in a must-win game of the ongoing U-19 Asia Cup and he lived up to his word here on Tuesday. "I wanted to make a big score. I had promised someone to make a big score today and thankfully I made it. And that person is my dad (Virender Sehwag). I told my dad I will get a big hundred. I have a legacy to live up to as he only likes big hundreds," said Aaryavir.

BRIEF SCORES: India U-19 309/7 in 50 overs (A Sehwag 160, V Vineeth 67) beat UAE U-19 239 in 50 overs (A Khudabad 74; I Sood 4/37) by 70 runs. PTI

SL struggle to 114-3 after Pak declare at 434-9

Rawalpindi: Debutant pace bowler Saqib Khan grabbed two wickets as Sri Lanka struggled to 114-3 by the end of Day Two of the opening Test after Pakistan declared at 434-9 on Tuesday.

Saqib dismissed Dinesh Chandimal for one in his second over and then removed a well-set Lahiru Udara for 42 to leave Sri Lanka on 65-3.

His experienced pace partner Mohammad Abbas took the first wicket, having opener Pasindu Sooriyabandara caught behind for a duck in the third over.

Kamindu Mendis (40) and Dhananjaya de Silva (22) were unbeaten at the close, with Sri Lanka still trailing by 320 runs on the first innings.

Bad light again stopped play 25 minutes before schedule. De Silva was dropped by spinner Arafat Minhas in the penultimate over of the day.

Pakistan middle-order batter Saud Shakeel earlier missed his century by seven runs, a miscued hook off Asitha Fernando giving wicketkeeper Kusal Mendis his fifth catch in the innings.

BRIEF SCORES: Pak 434/9 decl. (S Shakeel 93; A Fernando 3-107, D Madushanka 3-108) vs Sri Lanka 114/3 (L Udara 42, K Mendis 40*). AFP

Starc denies knowledge of tampering plot

Cricket Australia Rules Out New Probe

Melbourne: Fast bowler Mitchell Starc denied on Tuesday any prior knowledge of Australia's plot to tamper with the ball during the 2018 tour of South Africa, even as Cricket Australia boss Todd Greenberg ruled out another investigation after the renewed focus on the 'Sandpapergate' incident.

Starc is the first of Australia's bowlers to respond to Usman Khawaja's assertions in his autobiography and on social media that the whole team knew of a plan to manipulate the ball in order to get it to reverse swing. Starc reiterated the bowlers' position from a 2021 statement that they did not know a "foreign substance" had been taken onto the field to alter the condition of the ball.

MITCHELL STARC

"I haven't really paid much attention to be fair, obviously there's differing opinions of eight years ago," Starc said in Sydney on Tuesday. "We were heavily drilled through the process at the time. I guess I won't speak on behalf of the bowlers, but where I stand, my opinion hasn't changed. My recollection hasn't changed from what we said in 2021," he added.

'Very different views'

Media pundits, including former captain Michael Clarke, have demanded CA reinvestigate the case. However, Greenberg told local radio station SEN on Tuesday there was "no compelling reason" to reopen the investigation and could not see anything to be gained from it. He said players had "very different views" to Khawaja's version of events.

"There are specific details in his book that contradict the versions that have been provided by others," he said. "But we have said we're comfortable with the outcome of the investigation based on the information we've received. That includes what we've seen from Usman, and our position hasn't changed on that," Greenberg added.

Former Cricket Australia CEO James Sutherland, who was in charge of the governing body during the incident, declined to comment on Tuesday. Bancroft, who played his last international in 2019, declined to comment to Australian media on Monday. He said in a 2021 interview with the *Guardian* that it was "self-explanatory" that teammates apart from Smith and Warner were aware of the ball-tampering plan.

Captain Pat Cummins said in South Africa last month that he had spoken to Khawaja before the release of the autobiography and was not concerned about any potential fallout. Khawaja responded on social media on Tuesday, saying he had no commercial motives. "I'm very fortunate, I don't need the money," he said. REUTERS

Women win 25m pistol team gold

...But Quota Hunt Takes Another Hit As Manu, Esha Miss Medals

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Pune: India's women pistol shooters had a mixed day at the ISSF World Championship in Doha on Tuesday. They won the 25m team gold but Manu Bhaker and Esha Singh missed out on individual medals and LA28 quota places.

SHOOTING WORLDS

The trio of Bhaker, Singh and Divya Thadigol Subbaraju won gold with a combined score of 1,761. Singh led the Indian team with 590 points in qualification, followed by Bhaker with 587 and Subbaraju with 584. Singh and Bhaker also qualified for the individual final.

Neither Indian won a medal or an LA '28 quota place. Singh was eliminated first, finishing eighth with 11 hits. Bhaker finished fourth with 27, just outside the three quota places. South Korea's Yang Jiin won gold with 44 hits, setting a world record. Vietnam's Trinh Thu Vinh took silver with 43, while China's Zhang Yueyue won bronze with 34.

At the Doha championship, each national Olympic committee could secure only one quota place in an individual event. Since the three medallists represented different countries, each earned a place. If a country had already secured a place, the quota would pass to the next eligible finisher. Bhaker also missed out on the 10m air pistol quota after finishing fifth with 179.9. China's Jiang Ranxin and Yao Qianxun finished first and second, but China could claim only one quota place. Iran's Haniyeh Rostamiyan, who finished fourth, received one of the three places.

In the final, Bhaker survived several shoot-offs to finish fourth. She started with two hits in the opening series, then hit fours and threes to climb the standings. She missed twice in the eighth series and was eliminated. India coach Jelena Arunovic said the team gold was a good indicator of the shooters' performance.

"Today, India became world champions. The margin between us and Korea was significant. All three girls demonstrated excellence, and this is something we should be extremely proud of. Of course, we always want more, but I prefer to look at the bigger picture," she said.

TOI

GOLDEN GIRLS: Esha Singh, Divya TS and Manu Bhaker with the 25m pistol team gold in Doha on Tuesday

Scots suspend cricket ties with Afghanistan

Cricket Scotland said it will not schedule matches against Afghanistan outside International Cricket Council (ICC) events, citing concerns over the treatment of women and girls under the Taliban govt and broader human rights issues. Women's sport has effectively disappeared in Afghanistan since the Taliban returned to power in 2021.Scotland's move aligns with decisions by Cricket Australia and the England and Wales Cricket Board to suspend bilateral ties with Afghanistan.

QUICK SINGLES

Labuschagne vows to return

Australian batter Marnus Labuschagne, who was axed from the Test squad for the New Zealand series, expressed optimism that he will be back in the team. "You take this opportunity to come back and play for Queensland. Score runs, enjoy the games and I think my path back to the Australian team will work itself out," Labuschagne said.

Ex-India stumper KS Bharat eyes return through UAE

Former India wicketkeeper-batter KS Bharat said he is eyeing a return to international cricket through the UAE national team after his cooling-off period ends in Feb 2027. "That is the plan, to be very honest. UAE cricket has been kind to welcome me and allow me to use their facilities. I'm really loving this second innings," he said. AGENCIES

Odisha youngster Pooja breaks into India squad

Kolkata: Pooja Sahoo's hockey journey reached a major milestone on Tuesday as the defender earned her maiden India call-up after being named in the squad for the Women's Asian Champions Trophy in Bhopal.

Pooja, a resident of Kukuda village in Odisha's Sundargarh district, was the new face in the 20-member squad, capping years of hard work that began after she was spotted by local coach Dominic Toppo. "We are extremely happy and proud. She is bringing recognition not only to our family but also to our village, Sundargarh and Odisha," her father, Bhikhu Sahu, a retired employee of a private mining company, told **TOI**.

Like many children in the region, the 19-year-old initially played with bamboo sticks before Toppo handed her a second-hand stick. With the support of her family and coaches, Pooja eventually made it to the STC Centre in Sundargarh, where she trained from 2018 to 2021 before moving to National Centre of Excellence in New Delhi. From there, she earned a place in the junior national camp and steadily rose through the ranks.

HOCKEY

Meanwhile, veteran goalkeeper Savita Punia has been rested from the tournament.

The squad: Goalkeepers: Bansari Solanki, Bichu Devi Kharibam; Defenders: Nikki Pradhan, Jyoti, Jyoti Singh, Sushila Chanu, Lalthantluangi, Pooja Sahoo; Midfielders: Rutuja Dadaso Pisal, Sunelita Toppo, Salima Tete (c), Neha, Sakshi Rana, Baljeet Kaur, Ishika; Forwards: Navneet Kaur, Deepika, Beauty Dungdung, Lalremsiami, Mumtaz Khan.

GALLERY

Boxer Meetei in Youth Oly semis, assured of medal

Dakar: Boxer Lairenlakpam Ambekar Meetei on Tuesday assured India of a medal in the Youth Olympics here, defeating Namibia's Abraham Kalenga to advance to the semifinals of the men's 50kg category. He will face Izzon Jeffrey Arevalo of Colombia in the semifinal on Wednesday.

Chhetri first male player in FIFA's Impact Programme: Sunil Chhetri has been included in the 13-member FIFA Player Impact Programme, a project that empowers footballers to leverage their platforms, voices and resources for positive social change. He is the first male participant of the FIFA initiative.

India face Singapore in U-17 Asian Cup qualifier: India will begin their AFC U-17 Asian Cup Qualifiers Group E campaign against Singapore on Wednesday. India will next face Guam on Nov 14, Palestine on Nov 17 and hosts Malaysia on Nov 20 in their remaining Group E fixtures.

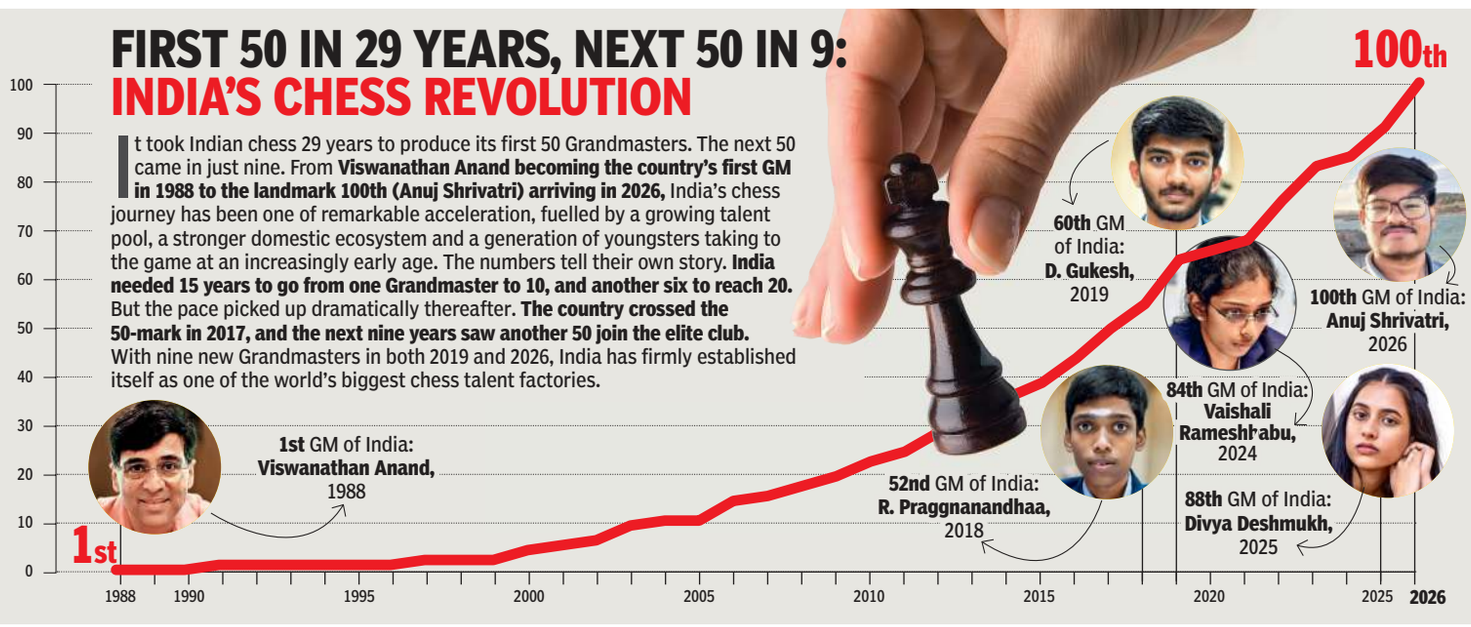
Chennai's 2029 Asian Athletics hosting hinges on state govt guarantee: Chennai is set to be selected as the host city for the Asian Athletics Championships in 2029 subject to the submission of state government guarantees. The decision was taken by the sport's continental body during its council meeting in Tokyo on Tuesday.

Doncic leads Lakers past Hawks: Luka Doncic scored 32 points as the in-form Los Angeles Lakers rolled to a sixth straight victory with a 124-114 defeat of the Atlanta Hawks on Monday.

Aries impressive: Aries, Golden Eye, El Nino and New Star were impressive during the tryouts in Pune. Meanwhile, the stewards of Hyderabad Race Club have come down heavily on a jockey for improper practice. TNN/AGENCIES

FIRST 50 IN 29 YEARS, NEXT 50 IN 9: INDIA'S CHESS REVOLUTION

It took Indian chess 29 years to produce its first 50 Grandmasters. The next 50 came in just nine. From **Viswanathan Anand becoming the country's first GM in 1988 to the landmark 100th (Anuj Shrivatri) arriving in 2026,** India's chess journey has been one of remarkable acceleration, fuelled by a growing talent pool, a stronger domestic ecosystem and a generation of youngsters taking to the game at an increasingly early age. The numbers tell their own story. **India needed 15 years to go from one Grandmaster to 10, and another six to reach 20.** But the pace picked up dramatically thereafter. **The country crossed the 50-mark in 2017, and the next nine years saw another 50 join the elite club.** With nine new Grandmasters in both 2019 and 2026, India has firmly established itself as one of the world's biggest chess talent factories.



END OF THE ROAD?

Man United Hierarchy To Take Carrick Decision Today; Pochettino Open To Take Over At Old Trafford, Say Reports

Manchester: Michael Carrick is set to be sacked by Manchester United after his side's dismal start to the season, according to reports on Tuesday. United's hierarchy have been conducting an internal review of the club's miserable form.

Sky Sports reported that USA head coach Mauricio Pochettino is open to talks with United. The cost of buying him out of his contract with his current job would be around £7m.

United are in the midst of their worst opening to a campaign in 40 years, leaving them languishing in the Premier League relegation zone after an eight-match winless run.

It is believed Carrick's future will be decided at a meeting attended by influential shareholder Jim Ratcliffe, chief executive Omar Berrada and director of football Jason Wilcox in Monaco on Wednesday. Although it is said that no final decision has been made, Berrada and Wilcox are reportedly leaning towards dismissing Carrick. Ratcliffe and United owners the Glazer family will then decide whether to act on that recommendation, with an announcement potentially coming on Thursday.

Carrick was seen arriving at United's Carrington training base on Tuesday, but it appears to be only a matter of time before his turbulent reign comes to an end. The 45-year-old had been granted a stay of execution after he was widely expected to be axed in late Oct following a 3-0 home defeat by Bournemouth. United's surprise decision to let Carrick limp on failed to produce a significant improvement in performances, mainly defensively.

Pochettino, 54, coached Tottenham, Chelsea and Paris Saint-Germain before joining the USMNT in 2024. In August, the Argentine had his contract extended until 2030 after leading the US to the round of 16 at the World Cup.

According to ESPN, United's hierarchy also are considering former Newcastle United manager Eddie Howe for the position, as well as former Ipswich Town coach Kieran McKenna, former German national team coach Julian Nagelsmann and ex-Chelsea chief Antonio Conte. AGENCIES

AP

Man Utd under Carrick

2025-26		2026-27
17	Games	15
12	Won	3
3	Drawn	5
2	Lost	7
71%	Win rate	20%

Source: Sky Sports

UNITED IN THE BOTTOM THREE

A 4-4 draw at home against Aston Villa left United in the bottom three, with just one win and eight points from their opening 10 games.

- They are also out of the League Cup.
- United are 17th in the Champions League, following two wins and two losses from their first four games.

41.5% There have been 41 teams who've earned exactly eight points at this stage of a Premier League season, and 17 of them (41.5%) were relegated.

1930-31 United have managed their joint-fewest wins (1) up to matchday ten since 1930-31 (0).

MBAPPE RETURNS TO FRANCE ACTION IN A 'GOOD FRAME OF MIND'

Berlin: France defender Ibrahima Konate said on Monday that Kylian Mbappe was in a good place as he returns to national team action despite missing out on the Ballon d'Or and the controversy in China sparked by his comments about Mao Zedong. "He's in a very good frame of mind; you can see that from his recent matches - he's been decisive. He's absolutely vital for us in Madrid," Konate said.

"He's a competitor, so of course not winning the Ballon d'Or when he thoroughly deserved it is tough, but the very next day he was giving it his all in training."

Messi voted to World XI by players again: Lionel Messi's peers gave him one more appearance in the FIFPRO World XI lineup on Monday after nearly 20,000 players voted for their best team in a poll organized by the global union. AGENCIES

Gayatri-Treesa pair advances in Japan

Kumamoto: The Indian women's doubles pair of Gayatri Gopichand and Treesa Jolly progressed to the pre-quarterfinals with a straight-game win over home favourites Hinata Suzuki and Nao Yamakita in the opening round of the Kumamoto Masters Japan Super 500 badminton tournament here on Tuesday.

The Indian combination, which won a bronze at this year's BWF World Championships in New Delhi, prevailed 21-17, 21-14 in 42 minutes in a round-of-32 clash. It was, however, curtains for the mixed doubles pair of Dhruv Kapila and Radhika Sharma, who went down 16-21, 15-21 to the second-seeded American pair of Chen Zhi Yi and Francesca Corbett in the opening round of qualifying. The men's doubles pair of Hariharan Amsakarunan and MR Arjun made it to the next round. PTI

Player fatigue concerns after Rybakina pullout

Indian Wells: The Professional Tennis Players Association (PTPA) reiterated its criticism of the tennis schedule on Monday, saying world No.1 Elena Rybakina withdrew from the season-ending WTA Finals as "her body had nothing left to give".

Defending champion Rybakina said she was not physically ready to compete at the tournament, with organizers citing a viral illness for the Kazakh's withdrawal.

Rybakina, who won two Grand Slam titles this year, also withdrew from the Tokyo quarterfinals last month because of a neck injury. "She finishes 2026 with two Grand Slam titles and four titles overall. And still, by the season's final event in Nov, her body had nothing left to give," the PTPA said on social media. "Players shouldn't reach the biggest event of the year running on empty. The PTPA continues to push for a season that leaves players healthy enough to finish it."

The elite women's tour has previously said athlete welfare is a top priority and that it has listened to players' views on the calendar. Concerns over player workload are echoed on the men's ATP Tour, with American Taylor Fritz saying on Sunday that the sport's brief off-season left players with little opportunity to recover. "It's just so year-round, round-the-clock," he said on a show.

AFP

"Players shouldn't reach the biggest event of the year running on empty. We continue to push for a season that leaves players healthy enough to finish it."—Professional Tennis Players Association (PTPA)

Sabalenka downs Muchova to win WTA Finals opener

Aryna Sabalenka battled past Karolina Muchova in straight sets to make a winning start at the season-ending WTA Finals in Indian Wells. Former No. 1 Sabalenka was forced to dig deep before finally prevailing 7-6 (7/2), 7-5.

Sinner positive on Aus Open prospects, won't rush return

Milan: World No. 2 Jannik Sinner is confident he will return in time for next year's Australian Open. The 25-year-old has been out of action since July.

"The goal is to go to Australia; I hope to get there and play a few tournaments beforehand," Sinner told a press conference. "Right now, I need to follow the protocols without rushing things. It is crucial that I take care of my body because I want to keep playing for another 10 to 15 years." AGENCIES

TIMES NATION

HC halts man's deportation to Bangladesh

Kolkata: Calcutta HC's vacation bench has restrained authorities from deporting a resident of Bengal's North 24 Parganas to Bangladesh until Dec 24 or further orders, directing officials to submit a detailed report before the regular bench next month.

The petitioner, Mainul Haque Khan, was detained at a border checkpoint in Ghojadanga area on Oct 27 and sent to a holding centre after immigration officials alleged he held a Bangladeshi passport that expired in 2019. Khan's family saidt he runs an export-import business and was travelling to Bangladesh for work when he was intercepted.

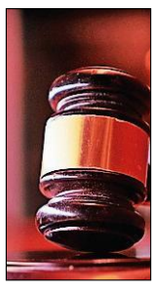
According to his family, Khan is an Indian citizen by birth and holds a valid Indian passport. On Nov 6, Khan's wife and elder sister filed a habeas corpus petition. They alleged the family received no prior notice of his detention. Apprehending that Khan could be deported while their plea remained pending, they sought urgent judicial protection.

—**Srishti Lakhotia**

SC: Pension cut only for tenure of statutory post

'Will Revive After Official Demits Post'

▶Continued from P1



If the cases of the original petitioners were to be accepted and the salary could be determined by adding the pension receivable by them at the time of their retirement from the previous govt service, it would have led to absurd consequences, SC said

Lt Gen Bhandar challenged the deduction before the HC saying the pension was for his service as an Army officer and had no connection with the role he was assigned as PSC chairman and hence the pension amount could not be deducted from his salary.

The HC agreed with him in 2010, forcing Uttarakhand to challenge it before SC.

After more than 15 years, the SC decided the appeal, ruling that Regulation 7(2) had striking similarities with a similar 'pay minus pension' principle enshrined in a provision in UPSC Regulations in case of re-engagement of retired public servants in constitutional posts.

The bench said deduction of the pension amount from the salary was only for the tenure of the constitutional post to which the retired govt servant was appointed and would revive after he demitted the post.

Writing the judgement, Justice Anjaria said, "If the cases of the original petitioners were to be accepted and the salary could be determined by adding the pension receivable by them at the time of their retirement from the previous government service, it would have led to absurd consequences.

"The total amount in such eventuality would exceed the actual salary payable for the post and perhaps would become more than the salary of the highest post. Therefore, by no stretch of logic it could have been contended that in the amount of salary, the pension portion was liable to be added."

Setting aside the HC judgment, the bench said, "The HC committed a manifest error in declaring Regulation 7(2) of the Uttarakhand Public Service Commission Regulations ultra vires and granting relief to the original petitioners."

Prez's guard shot in head over old feud in UP

Meerut: An Army jawan serving in the elite President's Bodyguard regiment was allegedly shot in the head by two neighbours following an old rivalry in Baghpat district on Diwali night. Saurabh Tomar, 28, underwent surgery at a Meerut hospital Monday and was declared out of danger.

His brother, Vineet, also suffered head injuries after being attacked with a stick. Police registered an attempt-to-murder case against the two accused, who remained at large.

Saurabh, a member of the mounted unit of President's Bodyguard stationed at the Rashtrapati Bhavan, was visiting his native village, Gopalpur Khadana.

Saurabh's father said the accused, who harboured an old grudge against the family, had come armed with a country-made pistol and a lathi. They began abusing the brothers, triggering an argument when the two objected.

One of the accused then allegedly opened fire with the intention to kill the brothers, but the bullet struck a nearby wall, ricocheted and hit Saurabh in the head.

—**Sandeep Rai**

25% of Ladakh voters will be away at time of poll: Kargil party

▶Continued from P1

Kargil Democratic Alliance co-chairperson Sajjad Kargili criticised the administration, saying around 25% of Ladakh's population would be outside the region during the elections. "What we are seeing is continuous flow of orders and notifications by UT govt. We are witnessing bureaucracy raj," he said.

Kundra countered that those who had demanded an end to bureaucratic rule were opposing elections. "The elected councils will prepare next year's budget. If the elections are delayed, they may lose valuable time in budget preparation. The timing of the elections is very important," he said.

Nov 17 is the last date for filing nominations, scrutiny will take place on Nov 18 and candidates can withdraw by 3pm on Nov 20. Polling will be held from 8am to 5pm on Dec 4, with the election process concluding on Dec 8. Panchayat and municipal elections are scheduled for Nov 21, with results also due on Dec 8. Of the 192 sarpanch seats, 55 have already been won unopposed. Only 212 of the 1,186 panch seats will go to the polls, with the rest also elected unopposed.

Chief secretary Kundra said the election timing is very important. He added the councils will prepare the budget, and if polls are delayed, they may lose valuable time in budget preparation

The elections follow the Oct 20 notification by LG Vinai Kumar Saxena of the Ladakh Autonomous Hill Development Councils (Amendment) Regulation, 2026, promulgated by President Droupadi Murmu. It paved the way for LAHDCs in all eight districts, including newly created Sankoo. Ladakh earlier had two hill councils, one each in Leh and Kargil.

No clue if he got threats, says Sharif's brother

▶Continued from P1

The court mentioned that the "case would have met a different result had the probe and prosecution been conducted by trained police".

Sharif and the other three men were instead pronounced guilty under Arms Act for illegal possession of weapons and sentenced to 10 years in prison.

Sharif's brother Naeem Khan told **TOI** that his sibling had been living with the extended family since his release and would visit Khajuria police station whenever he was summoned. Naeem said the family had no clue if Sharif had received any threat to his safety.

Police are yet to establish whether the killing was linked to Sharif's past as an acquitted convict in the terror attack case or any other dispute. Rampur SP Anil Kumar Singh was unavailable for comment.

In 2019, the court of an additional district and sessions judge convicted Sharif and others, including two Pakistani nationals, in the case, coinciding with a surge in terror attacks across the country.

Sharif, from Badanpuri-Khajuria village, used aliases Suhail, Sajid, Anwar and Ali, according to police records.

Vande row: Ker mantri defiant as BJP files plaint

Kasaragod: BJP Tuesday lodged a police complaint against Keralam's health minister K Muraleedharan and three others for allegedly disrespecting the national song.

Muraleedharan, who took his seat before the completion of Vande Mataram at a event in Kasaragod Monday, said he would not allow anyone to "hijack" a state govt event.

The complaint, lodged by BJP functionary Gopalakrishna M, also named Kasaragod MP Rajmohan Unnithan, MLA Kallathra Mahin and district collector Sreedhanya Suresh.

Referring to his father, former CM K Karunakaran, Muraleedharan said, "I do not need anyone to teach me patriotism. I am the son of a freedom fighter." He said the state govt's policy was to sing only the first two stanzas of Vande Mataram at official functions. TNN

Govt junks 'biased' USCIRF's remark, says it has a 'blatantly political' agenda

New Delhi: The US Commission on International Religious Freedom (USCIRF) is a "biased" entity with a "blatantly" political agenda, New Delhi said on Tuesday, trashing remarks by two officials of the organisation claiming that Sikh gurdwaras have been targeted in India with vigilante attacks.

Union ministry of external affairs spokesperson **Randhir Jaiswal** also wondered why the USCIRF chose to remain silent on attacks on religious places in the US and on racial abuse targeting the Indian community in that country.

Last week, two senior officials of the USCIRF, flagging concerns over "attacks" on gurdwaras in India, urged the US govt to press New Delhi to hold perpetrators of such violence accountable.

"USCIRF is a biased and ill-informed organisation with a blatantly political agenda," Jaiswal said, responding to a question on comments by USCIRF officials.

"It is particularly telling that the USCIRF and its commissioners have consistently chosen to remain silent on attacks on religious places in the US and on the hate crimes and racial abuse targeted at the Indian community in the US. A prejudiced entity can hardly be taken seriously."

USCIRF commissioner David Anderson had said on social media: "Over the last several weeks, Sikh gurdwaras in India have been targeted with vigilante attacks, including attempts to harm religious leaders." Anderson said the US should link security assistance to the Indian government's response to violence that stops people from exercising freedom of religious belief (FoRB).

Another USCIRF commissioner, Joe Grogan, said attacks on houses of worship in India, including churches, gurdwaras, and mosques, undermine FoRB rights enshrined in international law.

"The United States government should continue to press the Indian government to hold perpetrators of such violence accountable and protect places of worship," Grogan added.

In Aug, USCIRF called for sanctions against RSS and asked Washington not to extend diplomatic courtesies to its leaders. New Delhi had stoutly rejected the remarks.

USCIRF is a bipartisan US federal govt agency. It makes policy recommendations to the US President. PTI

Suvendu visits puja of Didi's estranged bro

Kolkata: West Bengal chief minister Suvendu Adhikari on Tuesday visited a Kali puja organised by former CM Mamata Banerjee's estranged brother, Swapan (Babun) Banerjee.

Mamata had a public fallout with Babun in March 2024, during her tenure as CM, following which she publicly disowned the youngest of her five surviving brothers. Babun has also had a controversial past during his stints as president of Bengal Olympic Association and in other sports bodies.

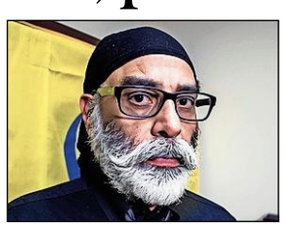
The puja is held just a few metres from Mamata's home on the same street. "Dada (Adhikari) said he was very pleased to visit the Kali Puja. I told him we will stand by him," Babun said. —**Soumitra Nandi**

Summons served by US court said to be 'routine, procedural step'

▶Continued from P1

The summons naming Doval and Goel among the defendants seeks damages for an attempt on Pannun's life and was delivered to the Indian embassy in Washington on Oct 9. Sources described the move as a "routine, procedural step". They said this was not the first time such a summons had been served by US courts.

Former PM Manmohan Singh was served with a civil summons in 2013 in connection with a suit filed by the same outfit, SFJ, alleging human rights violations related to 1984. In 2013, a federal court in Washington DC had issued summons to Singh during his visit to Washington. Former Chinese President Jiang Zemin was also served a similar summons in 2002. Both suits were eventually dismissed.



The summons seeks damages for an attempt on Pannun's life

The court order in the Pannun case came ahead of the Nov 20 sentencing of Nikhil Gupta, an Indian national arrested by the US in the matter.

The state department note also clarified that the action was carried out in compliance with court instructions and does not indicate any US position on the case.

"The performance of state department of its statutory functions under 28 USC (US Codes). 1608 should not be construed as an indication in any way of the US's' position or views on whether plaintiffs have properly complied with all statutory requirements of the FSIA (Foreign Sovereign Immunities Act), the status or character of a defendant, whether service was properly effected, or the merits of any claims or defenses," it said.

Delhi Times

OF INDIA

WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 11, 2026
ADVERTORIAL, ENTERTAINMENT INDUSTRY
PROMOTIONAL FEATURE

Julia Garner says Madonna biopic status changes 'every hour' P2

Paul McCartney becomes a billionaire P2

Rajinikanth, MK Stalin jet off to Greece for Anirudh Ravichander-Kavya Maran wedding P4

HOT TAKES

Any feedback related to stories in Delhi Times?
Mail us @delhi.times@timesofindia.com

Nvidia is in a sticky situation-chip

Samriddhi Raj

Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang once said, "Never stop asking questions and seeking answers. Curiosity fuels progress." A little more curiosity about his romantic associate, Alice Huang, might, however, have been useful to the tech tycoon. Nvidia has launched an investigation into allegations that its chief executive was caught up in a Chinese espionage operation, with an alleged affair at the centre of the intrigue.

Huang has since admitted to having an affair with a businesswoman reportedly suspected by US intelligence officials of being a Chinese spy. The allegations have put one of the world's most powerful technology companies under an uncomfortable spotlight.

CONTINUED ON 4

DT AI imagery

A chipmaking billionaire, a suspected spy and an espionage controversy that could give James Bond a run for his money

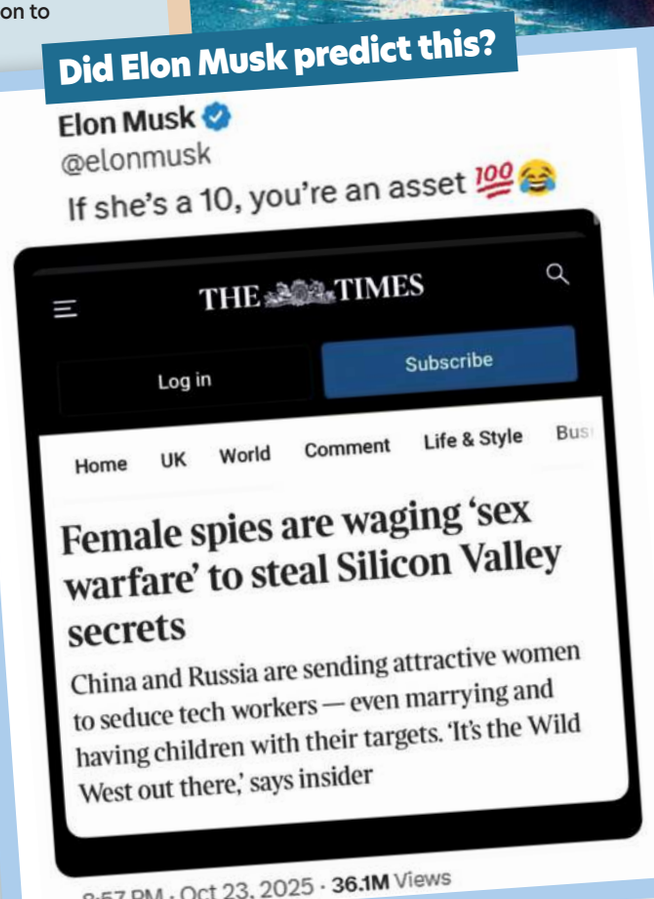
Love may be blind, but divorce comes with a calculator

Nvidia's board has launched an independent investigation into the matter, with the company saying it has no reason to believe that national security information or trade secrets were compromised. Huang has pledged to cooperate with the inquiry. But the tech tycoon's troubles could extend beyond the boardroom, and potentially come with an eye-watering price tag.

With an estimated fortune of **$155 billion**, Huang could see more than half of his wealth tied up in a divorce settlement if his wife, Lori Huang, decides to end their 41-year marriage. Under California's community property laws, she could potentially claim half of their marital assets, putting more than **$80 billion** on the table.

The possibility adds another financial dimension to the affair scandal. The 63-year-old Nvidia chief acknowledged being unfaithful to his wife in an email to employees on November 8, apologising to his family and colleagues.

Did Elon Musk predict this?



When the chips are down

Nvidia's chips power AI systems such as ChatGPT, making them some of the most coveted hardware in the global technology race. Their supply is therefore a matter of both commercial and national security.

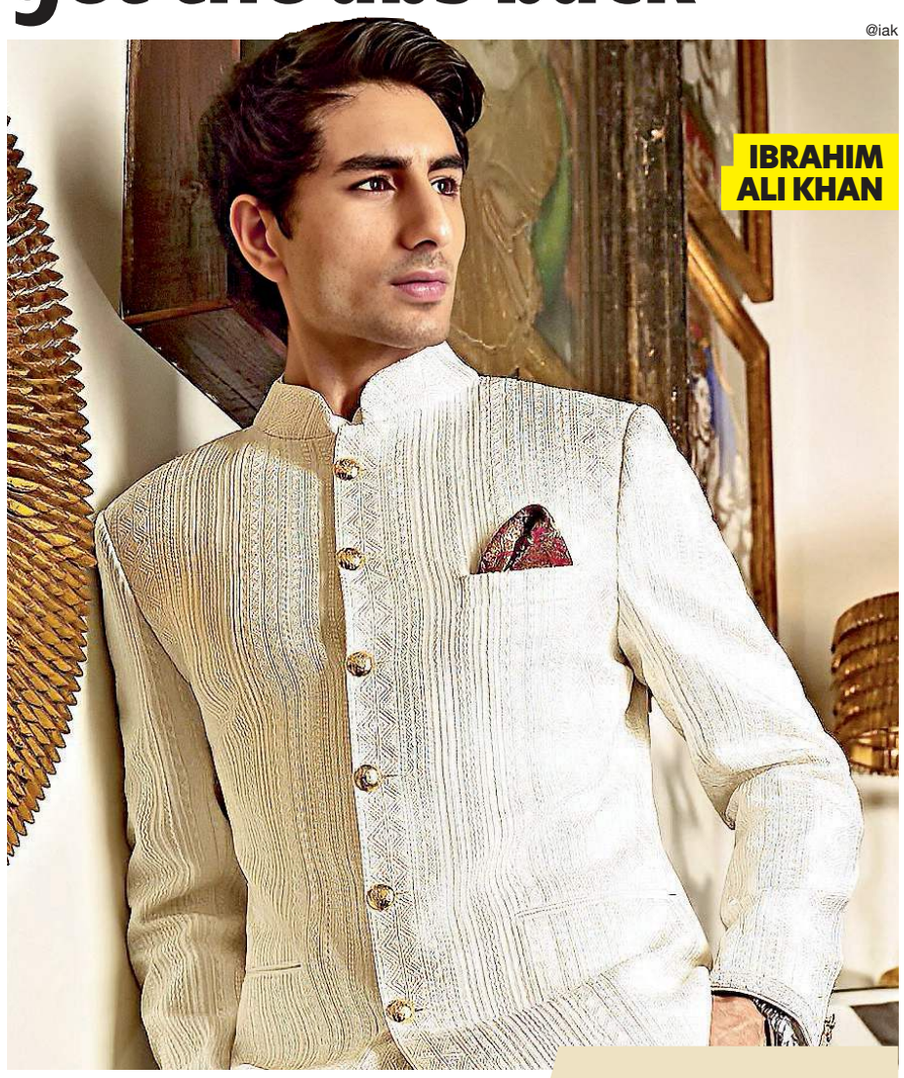
Megaspeed, a relatively little-known Singapore-based data centre firm, reportedly purchased more than US$4.8 billion worth of Nvidia chips over roughly two years. The company has faced scrutiny over allegations that it helped Chinese firms access advanced processors restricted from export to China.

US officials feared these chips could be diverted to Chinese customers, potentially giving Beijing access to computing power Washington has sought to restrict. Simply put, this is about who gets access to the hardware powering the AI revolution, and whether America's technological advantage could be compromised.

Additionally, *Reuters* reported that Nvidia shares fell 4.3% on November 9, wiping approximately $190 billion off its market value.

'Post festivals, I have to slog at the gym to get the abs back'

@iak



Vinay MR Mishra

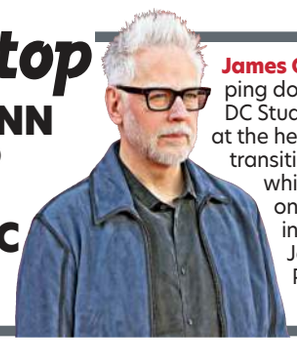
Ibrahim Ali Khan kept his Diwali celebrations simple, with good food, a little laughter and time with friends and family. The actor spoke to us about his festive celebrations, fashion choices and love for traditional sweets. He also revealed that he takes style inspiration from his father, Saif Ali Khan.

CONTINUED ON 3

"I prefer keeping Diwali celebrations simple, enjoying the occasion with my loved ones rather than focusing on elaborate rituals

Buzzstop

JAMES GUNN HANGS UP HIS CEO CAPE AT DC STUDIOS



James Gunn and **Peter Safran** are stepping down as co-CEOs and Chairmen of DC Studios, concluding a four-year tenure at the helm of the company. The pair will transition back into full-time creative roles while remaining attached as producers on a variety of ongoing projects. Taking the reins as President and CEO is Jeremy Latcham, former Senior Vice President of Production and Development at Marvel Studios.

Mumbai Police issue advisory to B'wood celebs after Tiger Shroff firing incident

On October 18, three men opened fire at Tiger Shroff's car in Mumbai's Juhu area

Following the October 18 shooting targeting Tiger Shroff and subsequent police discoveries that multiple celebrity homes were scouted, the Mumbai Police has issued a safety advisory for high-profile Bollywood stars. Senior officers have urged actors to stay away from crowded public spaces, avoid interacting with fans in public, and skip large gatherings as a precaution.

The security warning comes in light of ongoing safety concerns and reported threats to several Bollywood artistes from the Lawrence Bishnoi gang. According to *Reuters*, police officials emphasised that these guidelines are purely precautionary steps aimed at ensuring the safety and security of high-profile individuals while investigations into the reconnaissance activities continue.

Meet looksmaxxing's new cousin, Mogging

Jacob Elordi was playfully said to be 'mogged' by his canine co-star Rak Jasper, who stole the spotlight at the London premiere of *The Dog Stars*

Anagha Sawant

Ever been in a room where someone effortlessly steals the spotlight or spotted a person in a group photo who looks so good that everyone else suddenly feels underdressed? The internet has a word for it: 'mogging'. The slang term has now made its way into mainstream vocabulary, with *Collins English Dictionary* naming it its Word of the Year for 2026.

Mogging refers to outshining or upstaging someone, usually in terms of physical appearance, confidence or social presence. It could be someone with sharper features, a taller frame, or a more striking outfit who stands out in a crowd. Often used humorously, the expression can be both a compliment and a playful put-down. Popular among Gen Z and Gen Alpha, its usage has reportedly increased by 210% over the past year, reflecting how quickly internet slang finds its way into everyday conversations.

CONTINUED ON 2

The Hollywood mog-off

Mogging has also found its way into Hollywood, with celebrities and their co-stars becoming part of the conversation. As *Vogue* reported, Jacob Elordi was playfully described as being mogged by his canine co-star, Rak Jasper, at the London premiere of *The Dog Stars*, where the dog stole the spotlight on the red carpet.

Sienna Miller, meanwhile, joked that her teenage daughter had "totally mogged" her during a brief appearance together at the premiere of *War*. Even Arnold Schwarzenegger joined in on the trend, sharing throwback footage from his bodybuilding days on social media with the tongue-in-cheek caption, "Someone just tried to explain this new trend 'frame-mogging' to me..."

Where did the word originate?

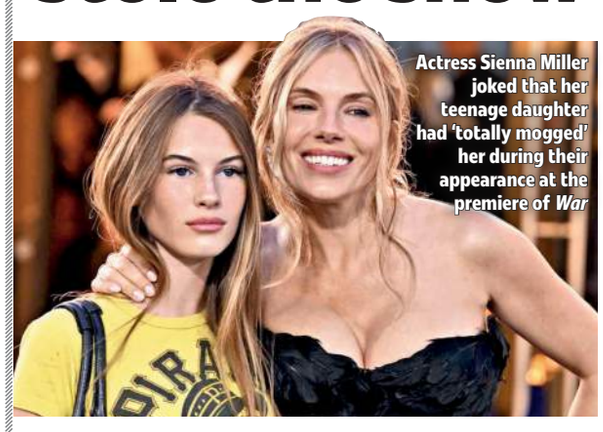
The term is believed to have evolved from AMOG, short for 'Alpha Male of the Group'. According to Collins, it emerged around 2016 in bodybuilding circles, where it described the most physically dominant man in a gym, before spreading to online communities, including the manosphere. According to *The Guardian*, 'mogging' originated in misogynistic online forums in the 2010s as a term for physical superiority. It later gained traction in looksmaxxing communities, where terms such as 'face-mogging', 'height-mogging' and 'frame-mogging' describe different aspects of physical attractiveness. Olympic figure skating gold medallist Alysa Liu described her competition strategy last year as 'to mog'.

Julia says Madonna biopic still in limbo

The much-anticipated Madonna biopic starring **Julia Garner** continues to remain in limbo, but the actress has not given up hope of bringing the pop icon's story to the big screen. According to *Deadline*, Garner is still uncertain about the updates on the project. She says, "I don't know. Every hour it changes, in a way."

The *Ozark* star, who was personally selected by Madonna for the role in 2022, added, "I would love for the movie to get made, obviously. But I also feel whatever happens, I made a great friend. I love Madonna." The film, which was announced in 2020, faced setbacks before being shelved in 2023. Madonna had earlier revealed that disagreements over the film's budget led to its collapse.

A slang that stole the show



CONTINUED FROM 1

Why 'mogging' made the cut

Speaking about the selection of 'mogging' as the Word of the Year, Collins managing director Alex Beecroft said that its lexicographers look at "how often words are used" and "analyse patterns of usage" to identify the latest linguistic trends.

Speaking to the *BBC*, Beecroft said the term "shows how each generation leaves its mark on language". He added, "It's a great example of how Gen Z and Gen Alpha have adopted a word and turned it into humorous slang, making the language their own and 'mogging' the rest of us!"

> **Mogging implies hyper-competitive, hyper-individualist, aggressive selfishness, which has become mainstream behaviour. Yet, many people now understand it, laugh at it and use it themselves, but ironically**
>
> –Tony Thorne, director, Slang and New Language Archive, King's College London, told *The Guardian*

@alwaysanglinguk
Why would you choose a word that was popularised in the Manosphere?! Shocking

@emma.imrick
I LOVE mogging

@Day082913541702
"Word of the Year" has always been some online slang only used by brain dead individuals. All this Gen Z slang about maxxing and mogging is especially r*tarded

Billionaire club now gets a Beatle

From changing the face of popular music with The Beatles to building a remarkable financial legacy, **Paul McCartney** has added another milestone to his illustrious career. The music legend has officially entered the billionaire club, with Forbes estimating his fortune at $1.4 billion, making him the world's third-richest musician, reports *Variety*. He trails Jay-Z, whose wealth stands at $2.8 billion, and Taylor Swift, valued at $2 billion.

McCartney's impressive fortune is attributed to decades of music royalties, publishing rights, touring revenues, real estate and investments. His Got Back tour, which featured 79 shows between 2022 and 2025, has further strengthened his financial standing. A significant contributor is MPL Communications, the publishing company he founded in 1969, which owns thousands of songs and copyrights, including works by Buddy Holly. His share of The Beatles' Apple Corps earnings has added to his wealth.

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LEISURE

SUDOKU CHALLENGE

Level: Medium

			3		2			
		4	6		8	7		
8				5				6
	1						3	
	7		8	9	6		1	
	5						2	
5				8				2
		6	4		7	8		
			2		5			

HOW TO PLAY

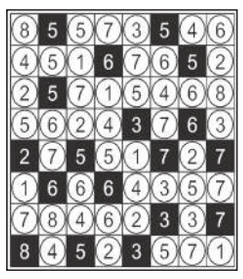
Fill in the grid so that every horizontal row, every vertical column and every 3x3 box contains the digits 1-9, without repeating the numbers in the same row, column or box.You can't change the digits already given in the grid. Every puzzle has one solution.

TIMES HITORI

2	5	7	6	4	5	3	6
2	3	4	6	9	1	3	5
6	6	6	1	2	4	8	3
5	2	9	8	1	1	6	6
3	5	2	3	5	6	1	9
2	1	7	3	6	1	2	1
6	8	3	7	4	9	6	1
9	9	9	4	3	2	5	7

HOW TO PLAY

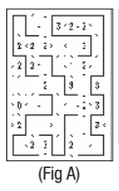
1. A number may appear just once in each row or column. Eliminate repeat numbers by darkening cells. (see example)
2. Darkened cells must never be adjacent in a row or column.
3. Unmarked cells must create a single continuous area, undivided by darkened cells.
4. Every time you darken a cell, you can automatically circle its vertical and horizontal neighbours, which means they cannot be eliminated.
5. Any cell "sandwiched" between neighbours of the same value can be circled. (e.g. 6 [4] 6)
6. A "triple" is a special case of sandwich. Circle the centre cells, and darken the ends. (e.g. [6] [6] [6])

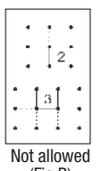

Example

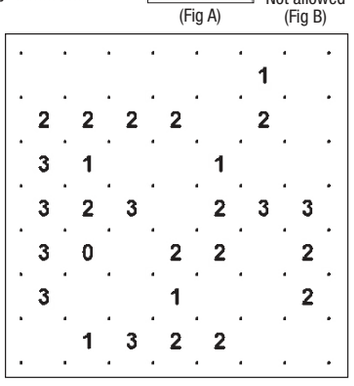
LOOP THE LOOP

RULES

- Connect adjacent dots with vertical or horizontal lines, creating a single loop (Fig A).
- Crossovers or branches are not allowed (As shown by dotted lines in Fig B).
- Numbers in the puzzle indicate the number of lines that should surround it, while empty cells may be surrounded by any number of lines.
- You can't draw lines around zeroes.
- Each puzzle has just one unique solution.


(Fig A)


Not allowed (Fig B)

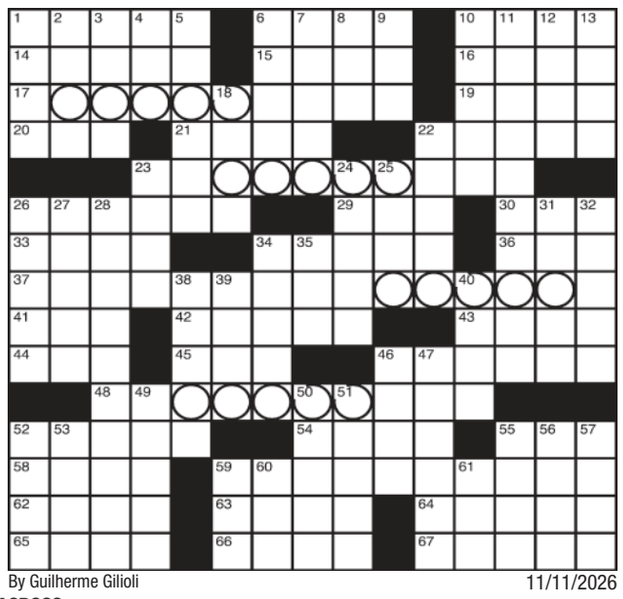


HOW TO BEGIN:

Example (Fig A) - Begin with the zero next to 3. Since no lines can be drawn around zero, mark crosses around it, as shown. Now there is a cross in one space around 3. So we know the three lines of 3 can only be drawn in the remaining three spaces. Next, these lines can only be extended in one direction each. Continue, using the same logic.

Hints: Keep eliminating possibilities by marking crosses in spaces between dots where a line isn't possible, i.e., if you have already completed required lines or where a line extension may create a branch or cause a deadend **(Fig B)**.

THE DAILY CROSSWORD



By Guilherme Gilioli — 11/11/2026

ACROSS
1 Rascal
6 With 30-Across, FIFA women's powerhouse
10 Rip-off
14 Green growth in a pond
15 Rotating shaft
16 Salt-N-Pepa, e.g.
17 1990s grunge icon
19 Learning tools
20 Manatee habitat
21 Ray of McDonald's history
22 General locations
23 Some street food vendors
26 VEX creations
29 Make a choice
30 See 6-Across
33 Azerbaijan neighbor
34 Right-hand page
36 Only word spoken in "Silent Movie"
37 Going the faster way, hopefully
41 Former quarterback Manning
42 1/16 of a pound
43 2026 "Legally Blonde" prequel
44 Taxpayer ID
45 "Sweet!"
46 Make a value judgment
48 Easy A's
52 Result of haste, in an adage
54 Colossal
55 Prefix with -tainment
58 So much
59 Judge's directive, or a feature of each set of circled letters?
62 Junction point
63 Hayride seat, say
64 "All sales are __"
65 Beloved
66 Scrabble board symbol
67 Young horses

DOWN
1 Fifth Avenue retailer
2 Game with secret passages
3 Taj Mahal city
4 Yoga surface
5 Eat like a bird?
6 Frowned upon
7 Spot-on
8 Legend in the ring
9 Big boys
10 Severely plain
11 Throws in the towel
12 Verdi opera
13 Green growth in a terrarium
18 Middle-earth monsters
22 Many a Hollywood Walk of Fame honoree
23 "Un-Break My Heart" singer Braxton
24 Swiss pharmaceutical giant
25 As many as
26 Ceremonial events
27 Spoken exams
28 Science fair volcano ingredient
31 Spiritual essences
32 Pays to play
34 Total stranger
35 Key near F1
38 América del __: México's continent
39 Green dip, briefly
40 Model/activist Holliday
46 Helper: Abbr.
47 Trigger, as an alarm
49 Total
50 Throat dangler
51 More uncommon
52 Steam __: latte-making gadget
53 Sunburn treatment
55 "Giant" novelist Ferber
56 "Works for me!"
57 Web addresses
59 "48 Hours" airer
60 Breakfast bit that might soak overnight
61 Home of Sugarloaf Mountain

Tuesday's Puzzle Solved

P	L	U	S		S	I	N	S			S	A	C	K
I	O	N	S		A	C	H	E		C	A	C	H	E
P	O	W	E	R	B	A	L	L		O	N	I	O	N
S	K	A		Y	E	N		E	A	S	E	D	I	N
		S	T	A	R	T	I	N	G	P	R	I	C	E
E	T	H	A	N		S	N	A	R	L		C	E	L
K	E	E	N		S	E	C		E	A	T			
E	N	D	G	A	M	E		K	E	Y	W	E	S	T
			O	S	U		R	A	D		A	L	O	E
A	B	S		P	R	A	T	T		F	I	E	N	D
F	L	A	S	H	F	R	E	E	Z	I	N	G		
R	E	L	E	A	S	E		M	I	D		A	S	P
I	W	I	L	L		T	W	O	P	O	I	N	T	S
C	O	V	E	T		H	A	S	P		A	C	E	S
A	N	A	S			A	L	S	O		N	E	W	T

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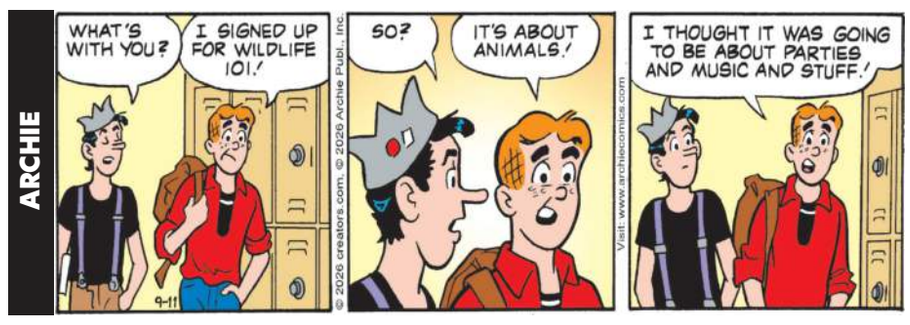
GARFIELD

ARCHIE



SCRAMBLE

Rearrange the letters in the four word jumbles, one letter to each square/circle, to make four ordinary words

EIRAE
EIKRT
BEFOLU
EITWGH

HOW TO PLAY

Now arrange the letters in the circles to form the answer to the riddle or to fill in the missing word as indicated

___ is man's most distinctive emotional expression.
- Margaret Mead (8)

EVENTS

DANCE
India Habitat Centre: *Notes From My World* by Rajeshwari Aravind. 7pm, November 13. Stein Auditorium, IHC.

EXHIBITION
Triveni Kala Sangam: *The Speaking Wall-II* by Harshvardhan Sharma. 11am to 7pm, November 14 onwards. Shridharani Gallery, Triveni Kala Sangam.

Email us at tims.delhitimes@timesofindia.com

ARIES - PISCES

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See what the stars have in store for you - according to your moon sign.

ARIES: The tension is mostly between you and a certain someone. You are not adversaries, just two people addressing individual needs. You can meet both needs, so keep talking.

TAURUS: You'll perform. You'll be nervous, but you'll do very well. Keep dreaming about where you want to be. Then you can work backward to construct a framework for accomplishment.

GEMINI: Your welcoming nature and genuine interest will make the walls between people come crumbling down. This isn't a small gift, though it comes so easily to you.

CANCER: You may feel that you're working at cross-purposes with another. This can be overcome, but not through force. Communicate until you can come to an agreement.

LEO: Small accomplishments lead to bigger ones. Expansive energies are working in your favour. An alluring new person could distract you from your main focus. Just don't let things go too far.

VIRGO: There is stiff competition for the goal you have your eye on. Set the bar higher than you think you can achieve, because this is the kind of ambition it takes to succeed.

LIBRA: Expect perplexing entanglements and ridiculous disagreements. Maybe it's just more fun when it's a bit complicated, but you'll feel compelled to stick to your guns.

SCORPIO: You used to feel you were so far away from another person's point of view, but now the gaps will close without compromise to your integrity. You'll find this liberating. There's more than one right way.

SAGITTARIUS: There's a pulse of unfinished business that keeps you highly motivated. Maybe you won't get to a satisfying ending today, but you're close. Don't give up.

CAPRICORN: Some enjoy debate for its own sake, but not you, at least not now. The ones who take issue just for the fun of verbal volleying will get on your last nerve. Flee the scene. Go to your happy place.

AQUARIUS: The one who seems emotionally unreachable will have the most appeal now. Everyone loves a challenge, but you are the one best equipped to reach out to those remote souls.

PISCES: You'll be rewarded, but perhaps not in the way you wanted to be. However, it's better to be acknowledged than to be overlooked. You'll accept all gifts graciously.

SPELLATHON

Today's Ratings:
10-average | 12-good | 14-outstanding

How many words of four or more letters can you make from the letters shown in today's puzzle? In making a word, a letter can be used as many times as it appears in the puzzle. Each word must contain the central letter. There should be at least one seven letter word. Plurals, foreign words and proper names are not allowed. British English Dictionary is used as reference.

DENNIS THE MENACE

SOLUTIONS TO GAMES/PUZZLES

TIMES SUDOKU

9	8	3	2	6	5	4	7	1
1	2	6	4	3	7	8	9	5
5	4	7	9	8	1	3	6	2
4	5	9	1	7	3	6	2	8
3	7	2	8	9	6	5	1	4
6	1	8	5	2	4	9	3	7
8	3	1	7	5	9	2	4	6
2	9	4	6	1	8	7	5	3
7	6	5	3	4	2	1	8	9

LOOP THE LOOP

TIMES HITORI

7	2	5	1	3	4		9	6
1	9		6	8	3	7		5
	6	8	3	4	1	2	5	9
6	3	1		2	5	9	8	4
9	5	7	4		2	6	1	3
2	4	6	9	1		3	7	8
5	1	4	2	9	8		3	6
	8	3	7	6	9	1		2
3	7	9	8	5	6	4	2	

SPELLATHON

agile, alien, align, gain, genial, inane, lain, LEANING, lien, line, linen, ling, nail, nine

SCRAMBLE

Words: Aerie, trike, befoul, weight
Answer: Laughter is man's most distinctive emotional expression. - Margaret Mead

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My dad is the OG when it comes to festive style: Ibrahim

LIKE FATHER, LIKE SON: Ibrahim Ali Khan loves to emulate his father Saif Ali Khan (inset) for festive dressing. "I like to wear the kind of ensembles he wears, because he makes them look cool," he says

CONTINUED FROM 1

'I JUST WANT TO EAT GOOD FOOD THIS FESTIVE SEASON'

For Ibrahim, Diwali was less about elaborate rituals and more about enjoying the occasion with his loved ones. "My Diwali plans were to have some good *khana*, laugh with family and friends and just enjoy myself," he said, adding, "I don't burst crackers and I don't think others should too."

'I LIKE TO WEAR THE KIND OF ENSEMBLES MY FATHER WEARS'

When it comes to festive fashion, Ibrahim is happy to take cues from his father, Saif Ali Khan, whose classic style he really admires. "I would go for an amazing *bandhgala*. My dad is the OG guy when it comes to this style and festive dressing. He looks classy in one of those, and that's why I take after him. I like to wear the kind of ensembles he wears, because he makes them look cool. And I'm like... I guess I would look cool in it, too."

'I have to slog it out hard at the gym post Diwali'

No Diwali conversation is complete without sweets, and Ibrahim is not one to hold back. "I love *laddoos* and *kaju katlis*," he says, and then laughs about the inevitable gym sessions that come post the festivities. "I have to slog it out hard at the gym and get these abs back. It's not easy, bro."

A box-full of brownie points

POV

Chandrima Pal

THE EDIBLE EDIT

One of Mumbai's iconic confectionery brands landed in Kolkata with three carefully chosen locations. A week later, we dropped in at one of its outlets, where we had to queue up before negotiating our way through the crowd. Brownies, cupcakes, tiramisu cups and other signature offerings were flying off the shelves. The wait time for simple takeaways was 20 minutes, and the response at its other outlets was no different.

Social media chatter, however, offered a more measured perspective. Some dismissed the frenzy as the honeymoon phase; others spoke of how the brand's quality had allegedly dipped over the years. But what was on display was the power of edible souvenirs as an effective form of word-of-mouth advertising.

Founded by sisters Kainaz Messman Harchandrai and Tina Messman Wykes in 2004, Theobroma was once a local hero operating out of its modest Colaba outlet. The siblings got one thing deliciously right: the brownies.

Expanding beyond Colaba and into airport retail evidently changed the game. It put the brand in front of travellers, visitors and returning residents looking for something to take home. A little piece of Mumbai.

Were these the best brownies in Mumbai? Not quite. But that signature box became to Theobroma what tinned *rasgullas* were to Kolkata's KC Das, fruit biscuits to Hyderabad's Karachi Bakery, Shrewsbury biscuits to Pune's Kayani Bakery, Mysore *pak* to Bengaluru or *motichoor laddoos* to Delhi's Evergreen.

iStock

We have all been there and done that. Managed requests for mangoes and pickles, *sandesh* and savouries, often with very specific instructions about where to buy them. And for those queuing up at Theobroma, it may be more about seeking familiar flavours and reviving memories than debating whether the brand's quality has taken a hit. The rest may simply be there for the brouhaha.

Hitting the sweet spot in Kolkata is not easy. The city has the formidable Flurys, the doughty Kookie Jar and an unbroken legacy of *mishti* makers. Come Christmas, you are likely to be inundated with nostalgic posts celebrating Saldanha Bakery, Nahoum's and other old favourites.

Taste is subjective, especially when it comes to those riding a trend. But habits and rituals speak of a loyalty built over decades, carried forward by word of mouth and preserved in memory.

Perhaps that is what the new kid on the block is hoping for: that the city will make a little room for its signature brownie boxes in its food memories, and that the honeymoon will eventually give way to a lasting habit.

chandrima.pal@timesofindia.com

Rejection is just a casting mismatch: Delnaaz Irani

Neha Maheshwri

At a time when many seasoned actors struggle to find work, Delnaaz Irani has continued to remain active across mediums, from theatre, films and television to OTT. Along the way, she has also moved beyond the comic roles that once defined her screen image, taking on characters that showcase a different side of her as an actor.

Having spent nearly three decades in the industry, Delnaaz attributes her longevity to her willingness to work across mediums. She says, "I never looked at a medium as 'too small'. My advice to actors who are struggling today is simple: don't sit at home waiting for that one 'perfect' role. If you aren't getting a massive project, do theatre, short films or create your own space on digital platforms. Most importantly, don't take rejection personally. A rejection isn't a statement on your worth as an actor; it's just a casting mismatch."

'WHEN YOU DO COMEDY WELL, THE INDUSTRY ASSUMES THAT IT IS THE ONLY THING YOU CAN DO'

Moving beyond comedy was another challenge. After being identified with bubbly characters such as Sweetu in *Kal Ho Naa Ho*, she had to convince filmmakers that she could take on more varied roles. She says, "It was an incredibly challenging journey because when you do comedy well, the industry assumes that is the only thing you can do. I had to start turning down steady paycheques. Turning down roles was terrifying because you worry people will think you are being difficult or arrogant. But I had to take that risk to convince filmmakers to see me differently."

Her recent OTT outing with *Chumbak* offered a different working experience. She says, "The biggest difference between television and a streaming project is the luxury of time and having bound scripts. OTT satisfies the artiste in me who craves detail, while television keeps me connected to the grassroots audience that has sustained me for decades."

Delnaaz Irani

"OTT satisfies the artiste in me who craves detail, while television keeps me connected to the grassroots audience

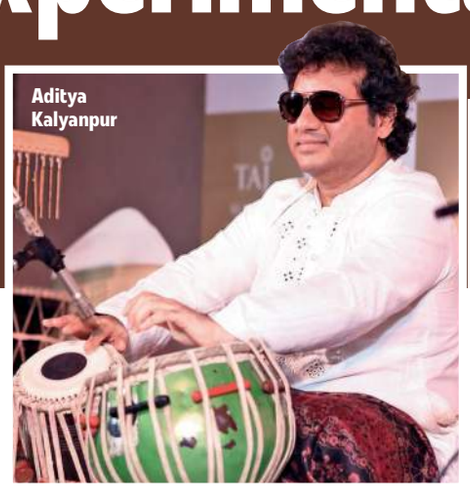
Pics: Lokesh Kashyap

A sitar-led journey through tradition & experimentation

"Sometimes people look at *saaz milana* as an interruption, but it is very much a part of the tradition – Hidayat Husain Khan

Kazim Ali Khan

Simmi Chopra



Aditya Kalyanpur

Shivika Manchanda

From *Ae Ri Sakhi* to *Albela Sajan Ayo Ri* and *Chhap Tilak*, the sitar conversed with the sounds of the djembe, tabla and keyboards, creating a vibrant interplay of classical and contemporary sounds. At *Mausiqui: A Story You Listen To*, sitar maestro Hidayat Husain Khan took the audience, comprising members of an exclusive business club, on a musical journey across genres, bringing the rich classical legacy of the Imdadkhani *gharana* into conversation with tabla player Aditya Kalyanpur and young musicians such as percussionist Mayur Magare and keyboardist Sanidhya Jain.

The son of Ustad Vilayat Khan, Hidayat's musical vocabulary draws on the *Gayaki Ang*, a style of sitar playing that emulates the nuances of the human voice through fluid phrasing, expressive slides and intricate ornamentation. "Never attended such a sitar *vaadan* in my life," said a member of the audience. The evening also spotlighted the other artistes, with Aditya and Mayur showcasing a *jugalbandhi* between the tabla and the djembe.

Sanidhya Jain

Mayur Magare

'Coming back to Delhi feels like coming home'

Speaking about performing in Delhi, Hidayat said, "Being here brings back so many memories. Coming back here feels like coming home." Between compositions, he spoke about *saaz milana* - the tuning of instruments between performances - and its place in the classical tradition. "Sometimes people look at *saaz milana* as an interruption, but it is very much a part of the tradition. In this, both we and the audience get ready for the next composition," he explained, inviting listeners to appreciate the transition as part of the musical experience.

Did You Know?

Meg Ryan worked in a real bookstore to prepare for You've Got Mail

Before filming the 1998 romcom *You've Got Mail*, Meg Ryan and co-star Heather Burns reportedly worked as cashiers at a children's bookstore in Manhattan. The experience helped them prepare for their roles as employees of an independent bookstore.

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Assumptions are the termites of relationships – Henry Winkler

An affair with a billion-dollar chip trail

Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang's personal life has come under scrutiny amid allegations of an affair

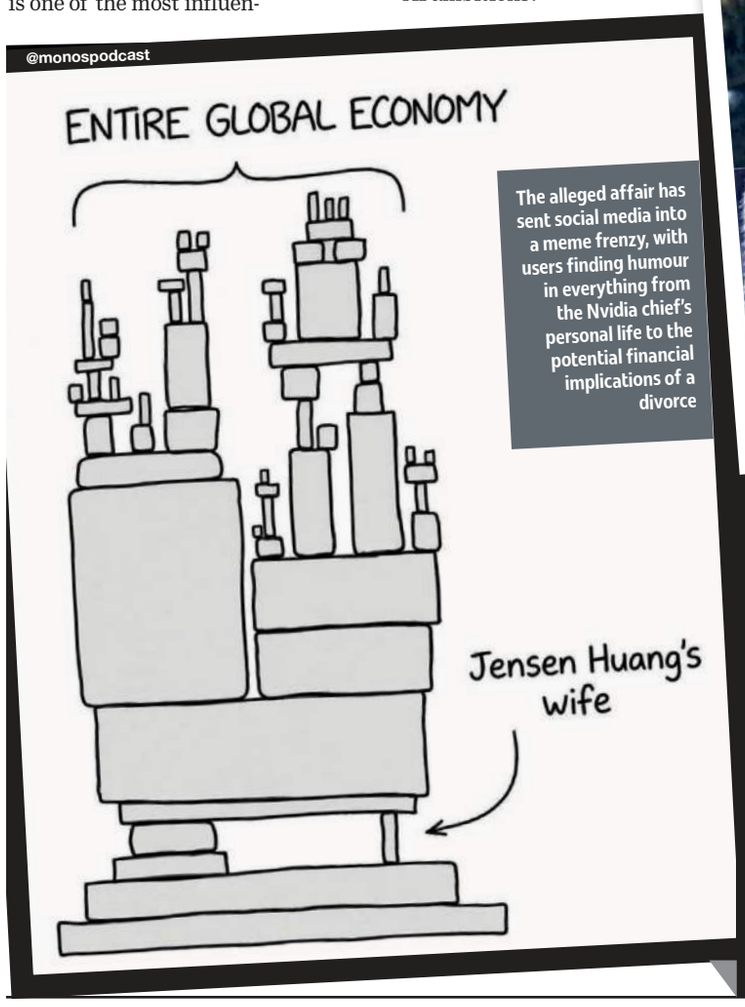
CONTINUED FROM 1

A RELATIONSHIP WITH TOO MUCH BANDWIDTH

In the technology business, access is everything. From chip supply chains and proprietary information to government negotiations and the future of AI policy, the people closest to industry leaders can potentially find themselves privy to some highly valuable information.

That's what makes the allegations particularly sensitive. Jensen Huang isn't just another tech executive. He is one of the most influential figures in the global AI race, with access to policymakers, industry leaders, and US President Donald Trump. He has also been vocal about easing restrictions on Nvidia chip sales to China.

The investigation therefore raises a bigger question: could a personal relationship have provided a back channel into the inner workings of America's AI ambitions?



The alleged affair has sent social media into a meme frenzy, with users finding humour in everything from the Nvidia chief's personal life to the potential financial implications of a divorce

CEOs, crushes and corporate glitches

Huang isn't the first tech boss to find his personal life making headlines.

- Astronomer CEO Andy Byron's viral kiss-cam moment with the company's HR chief turned a concert into a full-blown corporate meltdown.
- Jeff Bezos' affair with Lauren Sánchez in 2019 triggered a public controversy, including a blackmailing incident involving the *National Enquirer*.
- Bill Gates' relationship with a Microsoft employee prompted a board-level investigation in 2019. He stepped down from Microsoft's board in 2020, although he denied the affair had anything to do with his departure.
- Elon Musk's alleged affair with Sergey Brin's former wife, Nicole Shanahan, reportedly strained his friendship with the Google co-founder.

Keeping it cool and desi: Lilly Singh's Diwali bash

Lilly Singh gave her annual Diwali party in Los Angeles a frosty twist this year with the theme 'Diwali on Ice'

Pics: @lilly

Inspired by her hometown of Toronto and its snowy winters, the celebration brought together the charm of a winter wonderland and the glamour of an Indian festive soirée. Among those in attendance were *Never Have I Ever* actors **Poorna Jagannathan** and **Richa Moorjani**

SNAPSHOTS

Jane The Virgin's **Gina Rodriguez-LoCicero** and Lilly shared a candid moment at the celebration

The evening was anything but low-key, with ice-skating performances, *dhol* beats and **Sonu Nigam** setting the mood with *Kal Ho Naa Ho*

@tesherrrr

A dusting of snow, plenty of sparkle and a desi musical twist, with **Tesher** (left) and **Ali Sethi** bringing the festive mix to life

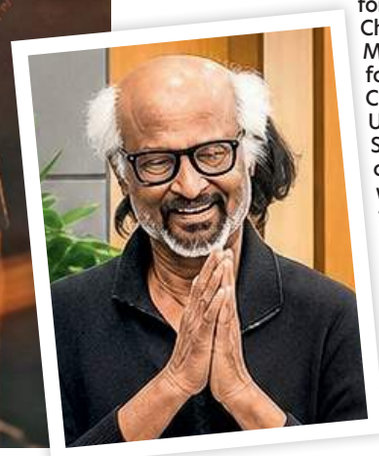
@arjunartist

Arjun, who lent his vocals to the English verses of Guru Randhawa's hit *Suit Suit*, added to the musical mood of the festivities

UP TO DATE WHAT'S #TRENDING AND WHY

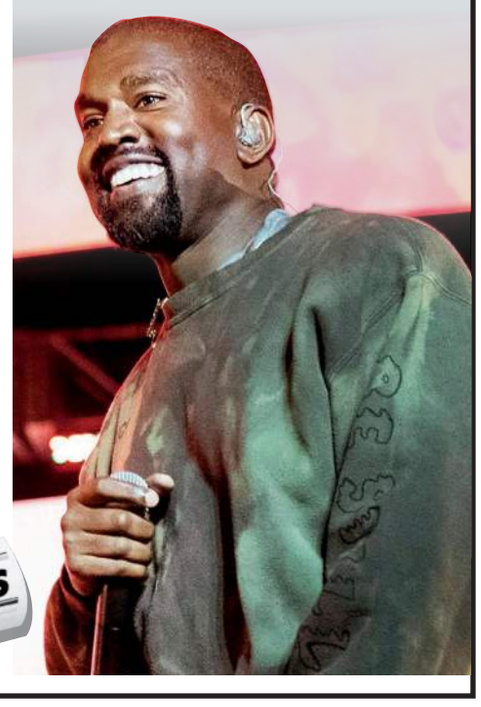
Rajini heads to Greece for Anirudh and Kavya's wedding

High-profile guests flew out of Chennai, reportedly on chartered flights, for Greece for the much-anticipated wedding celebrations of music composer Anirudh Ravichander and entrepreneur Kavya Maran, scheduled to take place today. Among those spotted leaving for the destination wedding were Rajinikanth, former Tamil Nadu Chief Minister MK Stalin and former Deputy Chief Minister Udhayanidhi Stalin. The private celebrations were said to be taking place at a scenic venue near Santorini. A grand, star-studded reception is planned for November 21 at a star hotel in Chennai.



Kanye West breaks his own attendance record for third time this year

Kanye West, known as Ye, has broken his own record with a concert at Dallas' AT&T Stadium, drawing 83,132 fans to become the most-attended hip-hop show in US history, as reported by *Variety*. The concert also grossed over $18 million, making it the fifth-highest-grossing concert in US history. This marks the third time West has broken his own attendance record this year, following his shows in Houston and Los Angeles. His Dallas performance featured hits, guest appearances and an elaborate stage spectacle.



Legal dispute over Dolly Parton's estate ends

A Tennessee judge has dismissed a case filed by Dolly Parton's longtime manager Danny Nozell against her nephew and former head of security, Bryan Seaver, following an agreement between the two sides, as reported by *AP*. Nozell had alleged that Seaver threatened Parton's estate and employees and had sought a permanent injunction against him. The case was dismissed without prejudice, allowing it to be refiled. The dispute emerged in the weeks following the country music icon's death on August 25, after her illness with cancer.

HOT TAKES

Crackers burnt my entire balcony, says Gurfateh, sharing pictures of damage

Pics: @gurfatehpirzada

Gurfateh Pirzada has shared an account of firecracker-related damage at his Mumbai home during Diwali. The actor, recently seen in *Lust Stories 3*, revealed that crackers burnt his entire balcony and the fire almost spread to his room. Sharing pictures of the damage on Instagram Stories, he tagged the Mumbai Police and BMC, writing, "The sheer stupidity of the masses is astounding... Crackers burnt my entire balcony and almost my entire room... The entire city is burning and is a gas chamber (sic)."

While Gurfateh attributed the damage to firecrackers, he did not elaborate on how the blaze broke out or whether anyone was hurt. Details about the full extent of the damage have not yet been shared.

TNN

Jemima Goldsmith

Jemima Goldsmith opens up about 'violence, coercive control' by Russell Brand

Jemima Goldsmith has spoken about her experience of alleged abuse by former partner **Russell Brand**, accusing him of "violence, coercive control and abuse", as reported by *The Guardian*. In a post on X, the 52-year-old TV producer revealed that she had called the police to have him removed from her home following a violent incident in 2014. She also expressed solidarity with the women who testified against him, saying she had always supported his victims.

The statement came shortly after Brand was sentenced to 10-and-a-half years in prison, the *BBC* reported, after being found guilty of raping one woman and sexually assaulting three others between 2004 and 2009. The judge described him as a "sexual predator" who had displayed "staggering arrogance".

Agencies

Goldsmith and Russell Brand were in a relationship for around a year from 2013